Online Advertising Using Google AdWords

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Online Advertising Using Google AdWords

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Preface

Google does intensive research and curriculum enrichment to keep it in line with industry trend AdWords is an advertising product of Google. It is a program that enables users to create and display simple and useful ads. These ads are then viewed by the people who are searching online for relevant information. AdWords together with the tremendous reach of Google has enabled people to attain high returns on investments.

This book begins by introducing users to Google AdWords, account and campaign basics, and ad formats. Then, the book describes AdWords targeting and placements, and AdWords bidding and budgeting policies and ad quality. The book also covers how to manage AdWords data and Google Analytics.

This book is the result of a concentrated effort of the Design Team, which is continuously striving to bring you the best and the latest in Information Technology. The process of design has been a part of the ISO 9001 Certification for Aptech-IT Division, Education Support Services. As part of Aptech's quality drive, this team does intensive research and curriculum enrichment to keep it in line with industry trends.

Design Team

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GROUPS

COLLABORATIVE LEARNING



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SESSION 1 - WEB ADVERTISING AND KEYWORDS: AN OVERVIEW

Session Objectives

This session introduces Web Advertising, different forms, and delivery methods of Web Advertising such as Web banners, frame ads, display advertising, and so on. It also explains the significance of keywords and their usage in Web advertising. The session also covers the selection, management, and status of keywords in Google AdWords advertising platform. Keyword planner and its benefits in selection of keywords are also explained.

At the end of this session, you will be able to:

- Explain Web Advertising
- Explain search engine marketing and online advertising
- Explain Keywords
- Understand Keyword Planner
- Explain keyword matching options

1.1 Introduction

Web Advertising is popularly known as online marketing, online advertising, or Internet advertising. It is a kind of marketing and advertising that utilizes the Internet to send promotional marketing messages to consumers. It consists of e-mail marketing, social media marketing, Search Engine Marketing (SEM), various kinds of display advertising (inclusive of Web banner advertising), and mobile advertising.

Similar to the other advertising media, online advertising generally includes a publisher, who incorporates advertisements into its own online content, and an advertiser, who gives the advertisements to be exhibited on the publisher's content.

Other possible participants are advertising agencies that develop and places the ad copy, an ad server that uses technology to deliver the ad as well as to track statistics, and advertising affiliates who independently perform promotional work in favor of the advertiser.

Online advertising is extensively used across almost all industry sectors.

Consider the following case study to understand how a pizza delivery company successfully used online advertising to control their costs and at the same time increase their customer base while creating brand awareness.

MegaBite is a small pizza delivery services based in New Jersey. For a pizza delivery company to progress in this competitive market place, it needed to expand its marketing efforts to stay at the top. MegaBite decided to try Google AdWords to promote its business.

The challenge from the start was to gain qualified traffic and to convert visitors to sales. Also, MegaBite was looking to make their business more efficient by using the Internet to allow customers to order food online. Their ads of delivering pizza of choice to any location in the city caught the eyes of many

customers. The customers were allowed to choose the pizza and other products with the help of photographs provided in the online advertisement.

As far as the business was concerned, they noticed a sudden upswing. The visibility of their ad on the search engine Web sites gave them a lot of global exposure. The use of appropriately relevant keywords such as 'fresh oven baked pizza', 'delivers anywhere', and so on helped them to increase their customer base. The conventional advertising methods would have been very expensive for a small business such as MegaBite to grow at a global level. However, online advertising helped them to achieve the same at a reasonable cost, at a better pace, and in a wider premise.

1.2 Delivery Methods of Web Advertising

One of the biggest advantages of Web advertising is the immediate publishing of information to the worldwide audience anytime. This is not limited due to geographic regions or time constrains. Web advertisements can be customized or even tailored as per customer needs thus, making the consumer reach for the advertiser more efficient, effective, and precise.

Google AdWords, Google AdSense, and Yahoo! Search Marketing serve as an advertising platform and enable ads to be shown on relevant Web pages or alongside related search results. Within the scope of Internet marketing, Web advertising includes display advertising, affiliate marketing, SEM, and mobile advertising.

1.2.1 Display Advertising

Display advertising communicates its advertising message visually with the help of text, animations, logos, photographs, videos, or other graphics. Display advertisers often aim users having specific features to enhance the ads' effect.

Online advertisers (generally through their ad servers) frequently use cookies, which are distinctive identifiers of certain computers, to choose which ads to offer to a particular consumer.

Cookies can track if any user has left a page devoid of buying anything. Later, the advertiser may retarget the user using ads from the page the user visited.

As advertisers gather data from the numerous external Web sites regarding a user's online action, they can form a thorough picture of the user's interest to provide more specific advertising. This aggregation of data is known as behavioral targeting.

Advertisers can also reach their audience through contextual or semantic advertising to provide display ads associated to the Web page content where the ads are shown. Behavioral targeting, retargeting and contextual advertising are all designed to boost an advertiser's Return on Investment (ROI), more than the untargeted ads.

Advertisers might as well provide ads based on a presumed geography of the user using geo-targeting. The IP address of the user provides some geographic information (at least the country or general region of the user).

The geographic information obtained through an IP can be added and filtered with other information or proxies to determine the range of probable locations. For example, through mobile devices, advertisers may sometimes use GPS receiver of the phone or the position of the nearby mobile towers.

Cookies and other constant data on a user's machine might offer aid in limiting a user's location further.

1.2.2 Search Engine Marketing (SEM)

Search Engine Marketing, abbreviated as SEM, is created to boost the appearance of Web site in the Search Engine Results Pages (SERPs). The search engines offer organic (non-sponsored) results and sponsored results based on a query from the Web searcher.

Search engines generally use visual cues for differentiating sponsored results from organic results. SEM comprises all the activity of an advertiser to make a listing of Web site more noticeable for topical keywords.

SEM is a process using which the users may promote their Web site using paid listing or advertisements on the search engine. SEM has become the foundation of an effective online marketing leveraging the pay-per-click model. The objective is to address the target audience so that the advertiser's business objective can easily get passed onto them. Almost all search engines offer pay-per-click advertising model.

It is necessary to create an exclusive account with the advertising branch or service of the search engine in order to create an advertisement for a particular search engine. In case of Google, the advertising service is AdWords. After creating the account successfully, the users may go ahead and create their advertisement. In addition to this, users also, need to generate their list of probable user search queries or the 'keywords'. These keywords will ensure that the advertisement appears in the search result pages when users specify matching keywords for searching some data.

Generally, the advertisements on most of the search engines follow Pay-Per-Click (PPC) model. In this model, the advertiser pays only if a user clicks the advertisement. The advertiser does not pay anything for the advertisement to just appear on the given page. The other common pricing model followed in the online advertising is the Cost-Per-Thousand Impressions (CPM) model. Here, the payment is on per impression or per appearance basis, irrespective of whether a user clicks the advertisement or not.

Ranking of a Web site plays a major role in marketing. Thus, users are recommended to build Web sites using a technique called Search Engine Optimization (SEO), which can improve ranking. This technique involves creating the new Web site or changing existing Web sites in a manner that they appear at a higher rank in a search engine's organic listings in response to user search queries. Advertisers may visit the Google's Web master Central site to learn more about SEO for Google organic search results.

Site owners often choose to advertise their site instead of or in addition to, optimizing their site for placement in the organic search results. Although, necessary to pay for the clicks received by ads allows users to be proactive about when and where a listing for their site appears. Creating an AdWords account takes very little time. Ads can run almost immediately in response to keywords that they choose.

SEM focuses on putting up ads on the search engine Web pages. However, online advertising is a much broader concept. In case of online advertising, the ads are put up on nearly any type of Web site or a Web page that the users are likely to browse due to relevant content. These may include Web pages related to news, blogs, entertainment, online magazines, and marketplaces. All these other sites that form a part of result pages are known as Google Display Network in AdWords.

The ads which appear as a part of Google Display Network may be in a variety of formats such as basic plain text, various sizes, variety of audio streams, or interactive video ads. It is possible to select the target device such as computer or mobile phone for displaying the ads. Users may also target the ads based on a user's geographical location, language, or demographic.

Online advertising provides a wide spectrum of options for displaying ads. A practical approach for the users to identify the advertising goals before they actually start the process. This will prove helpful in budgeting decisions as well as deciding whether they want to put up the ads on search engines or Display Network Pages or in both the locations.

The online advertising goals can be classified into two types that are as follows:

- **Direct Response**

  In case of direct response online advertising, the advertisers may require the clients to perform some action when the client clicks their ad and reaches the advertisers Web site.

This action may be as simple as signing up a newsletter, requesting a quote, or making a purchase. When the client successfully completes the desired action, it is known as conversion. In order to handle their online advertising costs, advertisers will need to define a particular figure that they would want to achieve with every conversion. This cost is known as Cost-Per-Acquisition (CPA). This cost will enable the advertisers to supervise the performance of their ads and also make sure that they are in tandem with their CPA targets.

- **Branding**

  In case of branding as online advertising goal, the primary focus of the advertisers is on increasing the awareness and visibility of their product or service. That is the main reason the advertisers may want as many people as possible to view their ad.

1.2.3 Social Media Marketing- the best branding tool today

Social media marketing is a business promotion performed using social media Web sites. Various companies endorse their products through posting recurrent updates and providing unique offers via their profiles in social media.

1.2.4 Mobile Advertising

Mobile advertising is an ad version delivered using wireless mobile devices including feature phones, smartphones, or tablet computers. Mobile advertising may be in the form of rich or static media display ads, Multimedia Messaging Service (MMS) or Short Message Service (SMS) ads, advertising within mobile Web sites, mobile search ads, or ads within mobile applications or games (including interstitial ads, application sponsorship or advergaming).

Industry groups including the Mobile Marketing Association have initiated to regulate mobile ad unit specifications akin to the efforts of IAB for general online advertising.

Mobile advertising is growing swiftly for many reasons such as:

- There are many mobile devices in the field
- Speed of connectivity has enhanced (offering richer media ads to be displayed quickly)
- Screen resolutions have improved
- Mobile publishers are being more sophisticated regarding incorporating ads
- Consumers are utilizing mobile devices more significantly

The Interactive Advertising Bureau forecasts increased progress in mobile advertising with the acceptance of location-based targeting and various technological features not obtainable on personal computers.

In July 2014, Facebook accounted advertising revenue for the quarter of June 2014 of $2.68 billion, marking an increase of 67 percent as compared to the second quarter of 2013. Besides this, mobile advertising revenue reported for about 62 percent, a rise of 41 percent, as compared to the previous year.

1.2.5 E-mail Advertising

E-mail advertising is an ad version including a complete e-mail or a part of an e-mail message. E-mail marketing might be unwanted, in which, the sender may offer the recipient to opt out of further e-mails, or might be sent on prior consent from the recipient (opt-in).

1.2.6 Online Classified Advertising

Online classified advertising includes advertising that is posted online in a definite listing of particular products or services. Examples include online real estate listings, online job boards, online yellow pages, automotive listings, and online auction-based listings. eBay and craigslist are the two chief providers of the online classified listings.

1.2.7 Adware

Adware is a type of software which once established automatically shows advertisements on a user's computer. The ads might emerge in the software itself, incorporated into Web pages seen by the user, or in pop-unders/pop-ups. Adware that is installed without the approval of user is a kind of malware.

1.2.8 Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing (also known as lead generation) happens when advertisers use third-parties to get possible customers for them. Third-party affiliates get payment depending on the sales created through their promotion. Affiliate marketers create ‘traffic to offers’ through affiliate networks and when the anticipated action is performed by the visitor, the affiliate receives a commission.

These anticipated actions maybe a phone call, an e-mail submission, an online order being completed or filling out an online form.

1.2.9 Content Marketing

Content marketing is the marketing that incorporates the sharing and creation of publishing content and media to acquire and maintain customers. This information can be obtainable in a range of formats, such as, news, blogs, white papers, video, e-books, case studies, infographics, how-to guides, and many more.

Bearing in mind that maximum marketing includes some form of published media, it is approximately (though not completely) superfluous to call 'content marketing' anything except simply 'marketing'.

There are other kinds of marketing (telephone based marketing, in-person marketing, word of mouth marketing, and so on) where the tag is more beneficial for identifying the kind of marketing.

Though, even these are presenting content in a way which is dissimilar from traditional print, TV, radio, e-mail, film, or Web media.

1.2.10 Online Marketing Platform

Online Marketing Platform (OMP) is an incorporated Web-based platform which unites the advantages of a local search engine, business directory, Customer Relationship Management (CRM) package, Search Engine Optimization (SEO) tool, and Content Management System (CMS).

Amazon and eBay are employed as logistics management and online marketing platforms.

On Twitter, Facebook, Pinterest, YouTube, LinkedIn, and various other social media, retail online marketing tool is exercised. Online business marketing platforms including, Aprimo, Marketo, Pardot, and MarketBright are purchased by major IT companies (Neolane-Adobe Eloqua-Oracle, and Unica-IBM).

1.3 Understanding Keyword Basics

Keywords are phrases or words that are employed to match the ads with the terms customers are looking for.

Keywords are the words that describe a service or product which in turn help to identify where and when the ad can appear. They are harmonized to terms that people look for or Web content which they view. Picking keywords that are linked to the ads can aid in getting in touch with customers who are searching for what the business has to offer.

Choosing high quality, important keywords for the advertising campaign may aid in reaching the customers as and when desired.

1.3.1 Working of Keywords on Google

The keywords picked are employed to display the ads to people. One must choose high quality, important keywords for the ad campaign to aid in reaching only the interested people, who may become the probable customers.

- When a person searches on Google, the ad could be appropriate to emerge based on the resemblance of the keywords to the search terms of the person and the keyword match types. In Google network, keywords are furthermore employed to match the ad to sites which are linked to the keywords and ads.
- A good keyword list may aid to enhance the performance of ads and evade higher prices. Inadequate and bad keywords might eventually result in increased prices and decreased ad position.
- The match types can be combined with the keywords to facilitate control on which searches the ad might be matched with. In figure 1.1, the keywords 'sectional sofa' and 'sectional couch' are matching with the keywords 'sectional sofa', so the ad will emerge before the interested searchers.



Figure 1.1: Working of Keywords on Google

Let us understand this with an example. Suppose a gentleman is longing for a hamburger. He goes to a restaurant and view that the items on their menu are 'Meat in between bread' and 'Food'. Though this restaurant offers the best burger, he may not order. They lose his business because the terms they used were not the exact terms that were on his mind.

To make your ads emerge when customers look for the product or service, the keywords picked have to match the terms or phrases which customers use, or must be associated to the Web site's content the customers visit.

Example 1

If your product is boomerang, you may add 'buy boomerang' as the keyword in the AdWords campaign. When customers type 'buy boomerang' on Google search, the ad will emerge on the search results page. Additionally, the ad may also emerge on Web sites regarding ultimate boomerang.

Negative Keywords

Negative keyword is a kind of keyword that avoids the ad from getting activated by a specific word or phrase. It informs Google not to exhibit the ad to anybody who is looking for that phrase. Following are some distinct features of negative keywords:

- When 'free' is included as a negative keyword in the campaign or ad group, the command to AdWords is given as to not to display the ad for any type of search having the term 'free'. On the

Display Network, the probability of the ad appearing on a site is lesser when the negative keywords match the content of the site.

- When a term is similar, it is a negative match. If one out of the four keywords is a matching option, it is described as negative keywords.
- To add negative keywords, on the Keywords tab click 'Negative keywords' under the main table.
- These keywords are a significant element of each campaign because they ensure that the ads emerge only to customers searching for what is provided. This level of control may assist to boost the Click-Through Rate (CTR), decrease the average Cost-Per-Click (CPC), and enhance the ROI.

Negative keywords can also be inserted such that the ad does not appear for searches that comprises those terms. This may aid in lowering costs by ensuring the ad shows to the exact audience as wished. Negative keywords perform with the normal keywords to display the ads only to the audience as wished. For instance, if a person is selling clothes for dogs but his business does not contain any cat clothes, then he/she may add 'cat' as the negative keyword to be certain that his ad does not emerge when customers search for cat clothes.

At the time of choosing the keywords, it is important to select how much should be paid each time a customer hits the ad (this becomes the CPC). Selecting the most appropriate keywords can increase the functioning of ones ads and aid in maintaining low CPCs.

1.3.2 Choosing Relevant Keywords

Keywords must be appropriate and of superior -quality. This is due to the fact that the keywords which are too common may not help one reach potential customers, thus leading to lesser profits. If a generic keyword such as 'bags' is selected to endorse the luggage products, the ad may emerge to people looking for unrelated items such as 'tea bags' or 'vacuum cleaner bags'. This may end up in a decreased click-through rate. Making the keywords more exact and inserting terms that express what one is selling may aid in getting the right customers through the ads. In such case, selecting of more appropriate keywords should be made such as 'luggage bags', 'carry-on travel bags', or 'buy luggage online.

Steps to choose right number of keywords are as follows:

- **Choose the keywords wisely**:-Incorporate terms or phrases which the customers would utilize to define the products or services. Ensure that the keywords exactly associate to the theme of ad as well as the page towards which the customers are being lead. Keywords consisting of two or three terms work with maximum efficiency.
- **Club similar keywords**: Attempt clubbing keywords into themes. These themes might be chosen depending on services, products, or other categories. For instance, if a gentleman is selling rings, he should have one collection of keywords for 'engagement rings' and another for 'wedding rings'. Then he can build different ad groups for these set of keywords and have particular ads for 'engagement rings' and 'wedding rings' respectively.
- **Select the right number of keywords**: For an ad group, keywords in the range of 5 to 20 are considered beneficial by advertisers.

1.3.3 Understanding the Keyword Status

The status of keyword informs whether the keywords are functioning or not. It also tells whether the keyword is resulting in ads being displayed to the target customers. In a broad aspect, the keyword will be in one of the following general states:

- Showing ads
- Not showing ads as it has been removed or paused a keyword, campaign or ad group

- Not displaying ads as there is a problem with the keyword or account

Following points explain the working of the keywords during the search:

- **Similar keywords that matched to the search terms**

  The ads will be qualified to emerge based on the resemblance of the keywords for searching the terms a customer keys in when searching on Google or sites of our search partner. Only a single keyword is capable of triggering an ad per search term. Following are some examples to ascertain what happens when numerous keywords match a search at the same time.

- **Numerous keywords that are within the same ad group will be similar to the search term**

  In an ad group, there are many alike keywords that match a search. Let us understand this with an example. There are the broad match keywords carpenter training course and carpenter course that can both match the search word training course for carpenter. In this case, the AdWords system employs a series of preferences to find out which of the keywords to use. The preferences are in the following sequence:

  - **Use a keyword that are exactly matching the search term**

    In case, while using the same keyword as the search term, the system will choose to employ this keyword to trigger an ad. This is correct despite of having different keywords in ad group which are identical to the search term.

    Example 2

    Consider that the search word is carpenter course and the ad group comprises both the broad match keyword carpenter course as well as the phrase match keyword carpenter. In this case, the system employs the broad match keyword carpenter course due to the fact that it exactly matches the search word carpenter course.

  - **Use an exact matching keyword when keywords are same**

    In case of having several identical keywords, the system will choose to employ the exact match keyword.

    Example 3

    If the search word is carpenter and the ad group comprises both the broad match keyword carpenter as well as the same match keyword carpenter, the system will employ an exact match keyword.

  - **Use the keyword which has the highest Ad Rank**

    When many broad match keywords in ad group largely match a search word, the system will choose to employ keyword having the highest Ad Rank.

    Example 4

Keyword	**Ad Rank**
Carpenter course	1.5
Plumber training course	1

    In this example, the keyword carpenter course will be chosen because it has a higher Ad Rank.

1.3.4 Exception to Preferences

The AdWords system includes an exception that may be applied to each preference as listed previously. The exception to the preference rules shown as previously may occur for the following example:

On few occasions, the system will choose to employ a keyword which is cheaper – implying it has a lesser CPC bid -- and has a superior Ad Rank.

Example 5

Suppose, someone is searching for carpenter tool. The ad group comprises the keywords carpenter tools as well as carpenter tool.

Keyword	Maximum CPC bid	Ad quality	Ad Rank
Carpenter tools	$0.10	high quality	16
Carpenter tool	$0.15	low quality	11

Generally, the keyword carpenter tool would be chosen as it matches the search word more closely as compared to carpenter tools. Though, carpenter tool is cheaper, has higher quality, and consist of a higher Ad Rank the system will choose to display carpenter tools in this example. Be aware that Ad Rank is calculated each time the keyword matches a search word and the ad is put into an ad auction.

Some of the exceptions to preferences are explained here:

- **Numerous keywords within many ad groups are similar to search term**

  When numerous ad groups have keywords which match a search word, the AdWords system has to make a more difficult decision. The reason being, different ad groups may have different ads, campaign settings, and landing pages. Different experiences for customers can be the result of all these differences and can end in different Quality Scores for exact keywords in different ad groups.

  In this case, the AdWords system employs a series of preferences to find out which of the keywords to utilize. The preferences rank almost in the following sequence:

  - **Use a keyword that matches the search term exactly, rather than a keyword that does not**
    If a keyword is same as the search term, the system chooses to employ that keyword to trigger an ad, despite of the ad group keyword is in. This is very true regardless of having other ad groups that have keywords which are similar to the search term.
    Example 6
    Consider that the search word is carpenter course. One amongst the ad groups comprises the broad match keyword carpenter course, and another ad group comprises the phrase match keyword carpenter. So, at that time, the system will choose to employ the broad match keyword as it matches the search term the same.
  - **Use the exact match keyword when keywords are the same**

    In case of having numerous ad groups with same keywords, then the system will choose to employ the exact match keyword.

    Example 7

    Consider that the search word is local carpenter. If one of the ad groups comprises the broad match keyword local carpenter, whereas, the same match keyword local carpenter is in another ad group, then the system will choose to employ the same match keyword.

  - **Use the keyword that is having the highest Ad Rank**

    When many ad groups consist of keywords that match a search word, the system will choose to employ the keyword having the highest combined Quality Score as well as CPC bid. This combination is called as Ad Rank.

    Example 8

    Consider that a user searches for a carpenter training course and ad groups comprise keywords carpenter course as well as plumber training course.

Keyword	Ad Rank
Carpenter course	1.5
Plumber training course	1

    In this example, the system will choose carpenter course as it has a higher Ad Rank.

In few cases, the keyword having the highest Ad Rank may seem to be less important to a specific each term as compared to the other eligible keywords. As higher relevance is normally correlated with a higher Ad Rank, this should occur frequently. Try running a search words report to view examples in which the less important keyword triggers the ad. Thereafter, add that search word as a negative keyword to the ad group which includes the less important keyword.

- **A campaign is restricted by budget**

The campaign's every day budget may affect every scenarios listed previously. If a keyword lies in a budget-restricted campaign, then the campaign's budget is not sufficient to accrue all probable traffic. It will not be possible for the keyword to trigger an ad even is it could. This helps to avert the campaign from exceeding its budget.

Example 9

Following is an illustration of how a budget-restricted campaign can change the use of keywords when numerous keywords are similar but have dissimilar match types.

Consider that the campaigns are known as 'Clogged Sinks' and 'Broken Water Heater'. In the 'Clogged Sinks' campaign, it has the exact match keyword carpenter, and in the 'Broken Water Heater' campaign, it has the broad match keyword carpenter.

Other aspects being equal, in the 'Clogged Sinks' campaign, the exact match keyword will trigger an ad while someone searches for the term carpenter as it is a restrictive match type. In case 'Clogged Sinks' campaign is budget-restricted, then sometimes the exact match keyword in this campaign will be incapable to trigger an ad. This implies the broad match keyword in the 'Broken Water Heater' campaign will trigger an ad in its place.

- **There is a cheaper keyword along with a higher Quality Score and Ad Rank**

Sometimes, the keyword that is cheaper will be used by the system. This implies that the keyword will have lower Cost-Per-Click (CPC) bid as well as higher Quality Score and higher Ad Rank.

Example 10

Consider that a person is searching for carpenter tools. The keywords that one has are 'carpenter tool' and 'carpenter tools'. For such a search result, the following shall be the maximum Cost-Per-Click (max CPC) bid, Quality Score and Ad Rank:

Keyword	Maximum CPC bid	Quality Score	Ad Rank
Carpenter tools	$0.10	7	0.7
Carpenter tool	$0.15	4	0.6

Often, the keyword 'carpenter tool' will be chosen as it matches the search word more closely as compared to the keyword 'carpenter tools'. Though, the keyword 'carpenter tools' is cheaper and Quality Score is high, as well has a superior Ad Rank, the system will choose to display the keyword 'carpenter tools'.

- **There are a large number of matching keywords**

If an account contains many of the matching keywords, Google mechanically eliminates some of the replicas. After that, preferences are reapplied. (As detailed earlier).

Example 11

Assume that a person duplicates an ad group 5,000 times. Now, he/she has 5,000 cases of the keyword 'carpenter' within his account. When a user searches for 'carpenter', instead of processing every 5,000 instances, Google will lessen the quantity of matching keywords. Then, they employ the preferences described earlier.

1.3.5 Managing Keywords

It is necessary to manage keywords in an effective manner to bring maximum revenue to the business. This can be easily performed by selecting relevant keywords to the business. Keywords trigger ads, ads influence clicks, and clicks are known for earning traffic to the site. Keyword list is a collection of relevant keywords that helps to generate revenue. There are five steps to create a keyword list as shown in Figure 1.2.

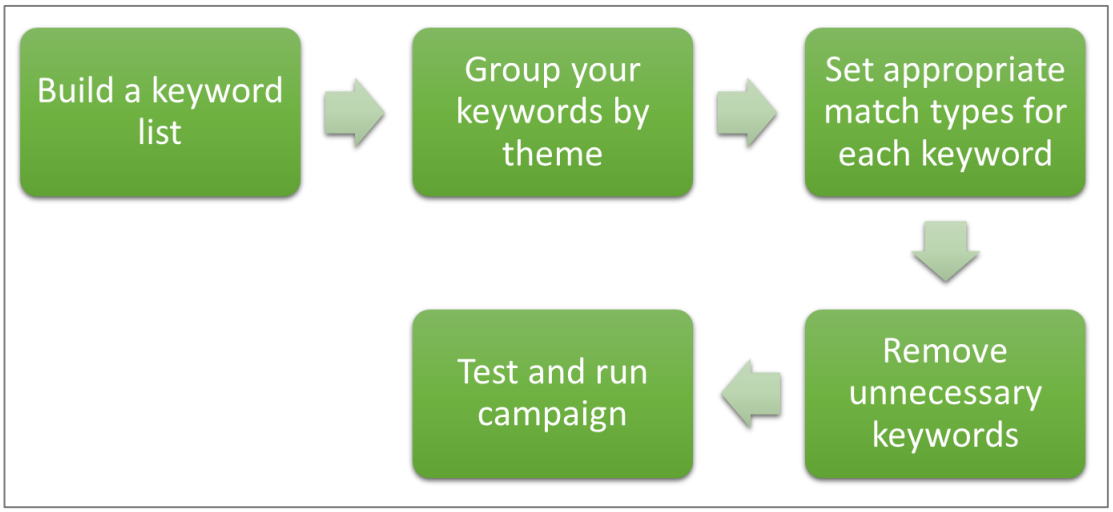


Figure 1.2: Steps to Create a Keyword List

Step 1: Built a keyword list

Prepare a list of terms that is relevant to the business, products, services, and similar phrases that the browsers' might search for. Moreover, the users can also seek help for keyword suggestions from the Keyword Tool.

Step 2: Group the keywords by theme

Group the keywords and ads by a specific theme or a subject in ad groups to draw huge traffic for the ad.

Step 3: Use suitable match types for each keyword (Search Network)

Pick a suitable keyword type to increase the traffic and reduce the cost. This will help to balance the impressions with meaningful click-through or leads.

Step 4: Remove unnecessary keywords

Refine the keyword list by eliminating all the unnecessary words to approach interested users effectively. This also helps to save costs in a long term.

Step 5: Test and run the campaign

In order to test the accurate performance of keywords, try to run the campaign for at least 30 days. Only after analysing the keywords, their performance can be evaluated.

Monitoring Keywords

Keywords help to grow the business by approaching the right target audience in less time. Close check towards the statistics of the business can reveal the performance of the keywords. This can be done by checking the following resources:

If keywords do not perform well, the Quality Score will decrease. The keyword will become inappropriate to trigger the ads for few of the searches at its current CPC bid. It generally happens to

keywords that are very common. Thus, these keywords underperform. For example, keywords with a low Quality Score will get less exposure and clicks for broad- matched or phrase-matched keywords.

Keyword guidelines play a vital role in monitoring the performance of keywords. Various guidelines are as follows:

- The policies must incorporate the demand for selected keywords and their related ads.
- The target audience must see the AdWords ads, which are relevant to the given page.
- Restrict the misuse of AdWords targeting system.

Keywords Best Practices

Keywords help in earning traffic on the Web sites. By using relevant keywords, users can boost their business. Following are the points that should be considered while managing the keywords:

- Combine the keyword list into similar items. Every individual group creates an ad group. The user can write several ads for a single ad group so that the keyword groupings can easily match its particular theme. For example, organize keywords about green tea in one ad group and keywords defining Dragon Well (one of the green teas) in another group.
- The option of broad match offers more visibility, but increases the cost. Additionally, it is always recommended to analyze broad matched keywords to ensure better performance. By using See search terms report, user can also ensure the outspread of ads to the right type of searches. Therefore, the users can also use other matching options such as phrase-match and exact-match.
- Narrower matching options give fewer clicks, thus lowering the costs. However, it is still advisable to use descriptive words for such matching options.
- Negative keywords are ideal for those cases, where, a particular term does not match the type of business.

There are number of ways to refine the keyword list effectively that are as follows:

- Keywords should be relevant to the products and services. Irrelevant keywords do not attract traffic. Targeted keywords possess high click-through and conversion rates, whereas irrelevant keywords have low Click-Through Rates (CTR) and conversions.
- The keyword list should be small and manageable. It should be limited to 20-30 tightly themed terms.
- It is best to list with two-word or three-word phrases. For example, use the keyword ‘laptop accessories’ instead of using the keyword ‘laptop’ because such general keywords can bring number of clicks from people who are least interested for the products offered by the advertiser.

Note - Test and refine the keywords regularly to update with the productive nature of online advertising to earn qualified traffic. Use keywords that are relevant to the business and remove irrelevant keywords from the campaign to gain better performance statistics.

1.3.6 Tips for Building a Keyword List

Choosing the correct keyword list for the campaign may help in showing the ads to the appropriate customers. The keywords must match the terms that probable customers would use to search the products or services. Think as a customer while making the list. It is beneficial to pen down the key categories of the business that one has. After that, write down the phrases or terms that may fall under every category. Include phrases or terms that the customers would utilise to explain the products or services.

Example 12

If a person is selling men's athletic footwear, then he may begin with some simple categories that customers might use, such as, 'men's sports shoes'. He may as well add 'men's sports shoes,' plus, 'men's sneakers sports,' if he gets to know that these are frequently used terms for his products. He also increased his list more by including the product names and brand.

Here are the tips for building keyword list:

- **Select specific keywords to target specific customers -** Choose more specific keywords that absolutely relate to the ad's theme if one wishes to target customers who might be interested in a specific product. Utilizing very specific keywords will imply that the ad appears for terms that are related to the business. However, if the keywords are very particular then, wide range of customers cannot be reached.

  Example 13

  If a gentleman retails men's athletic footwear, he may select particular keywords such as 'men's basketball shoes,' a kind of shoe to offer. In this way, his ad will be qualified to appear when a person searches for such kind of shoes or visits a Web site regarding basketball.

- **Select common keywords to reach more people -** Pick up more fundamental keywords to reach as many persons as possible. It may be hard to reach to the probable customers at the time of adding very basic keywords as the ad can appear for searches that may not always be associated to the business. Also, more basic keywords may be more competitive and might need higher bid amounts.

  Analyze basic keywords and then decide that which ones are giving the better results. Irrelevant of how basic the keywords are, they must always be important to the ads and Web site. One must avoid using copied keywords in the account, as Google displays only a single ad per advertiser on a specific keyword.

  Example 14

  If a gentleman has a big shoe store, he may pick up a basic keyword such as 'shoes'. That way, for instance, his ad would be qualified to appear when any person searches for a large range of shoes or visits Web sites regarding fashion.

- **Group similar keywords into ad groups -** To display more pertinent ads to probable customers, unite the keywords and ads into the ad groups that should be based on the services, products, or other categories.

  On the other hand, each of the keywords and ads can be added into one ad group, a customer looking for 'men's evening shoes' might look at the ad regarding 'men's sports shoes'.

  Example 15

  If a gentleman owns a shoe store, he may build two ad groups: one for the running shoes and another one for evening shoes. The ad group for the running shoes can involve ads having keywords such as 'running sneakers' and 'running shoes' and ad group for the evening shoes can have keywords such as 'evening shoes' and 'dress shoes'.

  In such a way, potential customers can look his ad regarding evening shoes at the time they search for 'evening shoes' and not when they are looking for 'running shoes'.

- **Select the right number of keywords-** We advise 5 – 20 keywords for every ad group. However, one may have more than 20 keywords in a single ad group. Remember, every ad group must have keywords that directly associate to that group's theme.

  The keywords will directly match alterations such as probable misspellings or plural versions. Thus, there is no need to add those in the list.

Example 16

In case the ad group has the broad match type keyword 'sports shoes', in that case, ad will be qualified to appear at the time if someone searched for that keyword or any alteration of the keyword such as 'running shoes', 'buy sports shoes', or 'sports sneakers'.

- **Select keywords that associate to the apps or Web sites the customers view-** On the Display Network, the keywords let the ads display on important Web sites or in apps. Select keywords that are associated to each other, plus, linked with the content the customers surf.

  For apps, AdWords might increase the scope of the keywords to match the ads to important search terms. As the ads are matched to significant Web sites via keywords, all keywords utilized for Display Network campaigns are regarded as broad match. The keywords can be fine-tuned by leaving some keywords from ad groups that aim the Display Network.

  Example 17

  Suppose, a keyword list is formed that has terms associated to boots. Web sites regarding boots would be aimed by keywords on that list. Also, you could leave the terms 'snowboard' and 'ski' to avoid the ads from being displayed on sites about winter sports.

- **Optimize the keyword list-** After building a keyword list, here are some suggestions on how to make it function better:
  - **Find new keywords with the Keyword Planner -** At the time of building a Search Network campaign, have keyword ideas and gauge traffic for those keywords having the Keyword Planner.

    This tool will display how a list of keywords may perform and the regular number of times people looked for those terms. Utilise this information to fix on which keywords may raise the clicks on ad and enhance awareness of the product.

    Example 18

    In the Keyword Planner, after entering the words 'running shoe', it may show 'motion control running shoes' or 'discount running shoes' as additional keywords to consider. For every keyword idea, statistics will be gained, depicting how competitive the keyword is, along with the average number of times persons searched for that term globally.

  - **The click-through rate must be improved with the negative keywords -** In some instances, one may wish to avoid ad from displaying for terms that are not important to his product or service. Strive to add negative keywords to aid in decreasing costs and make the ad show just for the search terms according to the wish.

    Example 19

    Suppose, there is a running shoe store that sells only men's shoes. The owner of the store may wish to add 'women' and 'girls' as negative keywords for avoiding his ad from displaying when people look for girls' shoes or men's shoes.

  - **Use report of the search terms-** The report of the search terms report provides information on what the people were looking for at the time of seeing ad and clicked it.
    This information may aid in eliminating badly performing keywords or include new keywords. The search terms report can also be used in order to help in recognizing the negative keywords.

  - **Utilize the keyword match types to enhanced control who sees ads-** Keyword match types provide a greater control over who perceives the ads. For instance, with the exact match option, one may enumerate the exact keyword or the close variations of that particular exact keyword

such as plural versions or misspellings. Another kind is phrase match that allows target an exact phrase.

Example 20

If a person wishes to display their ad specifically to people concerned in buying men's running shoes, then he may wish to include terms such as ‘running shoes for men’ or ‘men's running shoes’ as the exact match keywords.

In such away, his ad will be qualified to be displayed when people look for those same terms or close variations of those such as ‘men’s running shoes’. His ad will not display when people look for terms such as ‘best running shoes for men’ as that phrase involves the term ‘best’, which is not the part of his keyword or any close variation of it.

- **Select the right keyword match types -** Keyword match types aid to control which searches may trigger the ad. For instance, one can utilize broad match to display the ad to a large audience or can utilize exact match to reach particular groups of customers.

- **Use a broad-to-narrow strategy-** While selecting the right match type for the keyword, it is recommended to employ a broad-to-narrow strategy.

  First, begin with broad match keywords in order to increase the capability to display ads on important searches. The default kind of keyword is broad match, so if one has previously added keywords, probabilities are that he will not need to do anything unique to make them broad match.

  After that, watch keywords' performance time and again. If it is observed that the ad displays for larger number of inappropriate variations of keywords, attempt to add negative keywords to particularly prevent these irrelevant matches. It is possible to make the keyword match types particular to decrease the audience even more.

- **See which search terms triggered the ads-** After keywords have drawn impressions and clicks, use the ‘search terms’ report and observe what people who looked ads really searched for:
  - **See how closely the search terms are to the keywords:** Within the ‘Match type’ column, look for how search terms which triggered the ads match the keywords. By using this information, manage the keyword match types. For instance, if one employs banana bread as a keyword, then he may see banana bread by ‘Exact’ as the match type. This implies that people who looked for the exact phrase ‘banana bread’ have seen his ad.
  - **See keyword ideas.** There may be such terms that triggered the ads to the surprise. Include these terms as keywords.
  - **Get negative keyword ideas.** In case search terms that are not important trigger the ads, so combine those terms as negative keywords.

1.4 Keyword Planner

Keyword Planner is type of free AdWords tool created for experienced or new advertisers for the purpose of building new Search Network campaigns or expanding current ones. One can look for keyword as well as ad group ideas, see the way a list of keywords may perform, also even form a new keyword list by multiplying many lists of keywords together. Keyword Planner helps to select competitive budgets and bids to use along with the campaigns.

1.4.1 Benefits of Keyword Planner

Keyword Planner can be used to achieve the following tasks:

- **Research keywords:** Helps to find extra keywords to include to the current campaign. One can look for keyword as well as adgroup's ideas that are based on terms which are important to the service or product, landing page, or various product categories.
- **Get historical statistics and traffic forecasts:** Employ statistics such as search volume to aid in choosing which keywords to employ for a new or current campaign. Get forecasts, such as estimated conversions and predicted clicks, to have an idea of the way a list of keywords may perform for a given bid as well as budget. These predictions can also help in assessing budgets and bids to set.

  It is significant to keep in mind the fact that as Keyword Planner may give some good keyword ideas and traffic forecasts, the campaign performance depends on a range of factors. For instance, budget, bid, product, and customer behavior in industry may alter the success of the campaigns.

  Keyword Planner can be employed to aid in getting historical statistics, including, search volume data for the new keyword ideas, or to gain predictions on keyword ideas so that may plan the budget. This segment describes every option present in the Keyword Planner.

- **Search for the new keywords using Keyword Planner:** With the Keyword Planner, new keyword ideas can be determined for the Search Network campaigns which are significant to service, product, and target customers. Keyword Planner will display historical statistics including, search volume data for these keywords.

1.5 About Keyword Matching Options

Keyword match types aid control which searches may trigger ad. For instance, broad match can be employed to display ad to a large audience or can use exact match to work on particular groups of customers.

How they work?

Basically, if the keyword matching option is broader, the keyword has potential of obtaining more traffic. On the contrary, the narrower the keyword matching option, the keyword will be more relevant to someone's search.

Considering these differences can aid in selecting the right alternatives as well as improving return on investment.

When selecting the appropriate match type for the keyword, it is advised to begin with broad match to increase the capability to display ads on important searches. The search terms report can be used for monitoring which keyword variations are triggering the ads.

Different match types

Every match type will trigger the ad to display for a customer's search in many ways.

Keywords are not case-sensitive, which implies they are matched without taking into consideration lowercase or uppercase letters. For instance, there is no need to enter 'Men's Hats' and 'men's hats' as keywords—only 'men's hats' will cover both cases.

Symbols have unique meanings in AdWords, so it must be avoided while using them. Also, keywords cannot have any non-standard characters such as : ! @ % , *.

Keyword match types can be exercised with campaigns which display ads on the Search Network. On Display Network, keywords are regarded as broad match.

Broad Match Example

The default match type is Broad match with whom all the keywords are assigned. Ads might display on searches that include synonyms, misspellings, related searches, as well as other relevant variations.

- Example keyword: men's hats
- Example search: buy gentlemen hats

When the broad match is employed, automatically the ads will run on important variations of the keywords, despite the fact that these terms are not included keyword lists. This lets to draw more visitors to the Web site, spend less time in building keyword lists, as well as focus spending on keywords that are working.
The default match type to which all keywords are assigned is Broad match, if another match type is not indicated (phrase match exact match, or negative match). Automatically, the Google AdWords system runs ads on important variations of keywords, comprising plural and singular forms, stemmings (including as flooring and floor), possible misspellings synonyms related searches, and various other important variations.

Example 21

Table 1.1 shows Broad match and compared Ads shown on searches

Broad match keyword:	Ads may show on searches for:
High- carb diet plan	carb-rich foods high-carb diets high calorie recipes Mediterranean diet schedules high-carbohydrate dietary program

Table 1.1: Broad Match and Compared Ads Shown on Searches

Broad match modifier (example)

Ads may display on searches that have the modified term (or any close variations, but no synonyms), in any sequence. Symbol: +keyword

- Example keyword: +men's +hats
- Example search: hats for men

Adding modified broad match keywords may boost campaign clicks and conversions and also provide more specific control than broad match. Modified broad match allows mentioning that particular broad match keyword terms, or its close variants, should appear to trigger ad. Close variants comprises singular/plural forms, acronyms and abbreviations, misspellings, and stemmings (such as and 'flooring' and 'floor'). Variants do not involve synonyms or related searches.

A modifier can be added into the broad match keywords to mention that some words should be included in someone's search term that may trigger your ads. As broad match modifier lets to target searches which include a minimum of one of the keywords, it may aid in increasing how important the traffic is to the ads, and hence, improve Click-Through Rate (CTR) as well as conversion rates. To make a broad match modifier, simply add a plus symbol (+) before one or more words in the broad match keyword.

By default, AdWords exercises the broad match option for those targets that involve any combination of the words which comprise keyword term, along with searches having synonyms or other variations of such words (such as related searches). While a broad match keyword such as sports shoes may send a lot of important click traffic to the site, one may reach more searches than initially intended.

By using a broad match modifier, one is capable of controlling and knowing exactly how his keyword will be broadened if that particular keyword terms were part of probable customer's search. If it has been mentioned that the ad has to be just displayed when someone's search involves both sports and shoes, for instance, then the ad unexpectedly becomes more important to probable customers looking for sports shoes. This targeted reach may aid the keywords achieve an increased CTR, which in turn may aid the site get higher paying customers or other conversions.

The feature of broad match modifier just works when used along with broad match keywords. If one wishes to have increased click as well as conversion rates that may result from phrase or exact match

keywords, he may try creating a distinguish ad group, and inserting the corresponding modified broad match keyword to every phrase or exact match keyword as shown in table 1.2.

If currently have...	... could add this modified broad match keywords to get additional relevant clicks
'buy black suede shoes' 'purchase black suede shoes' 'shop suede shoes'	+buy +black +suede +shoes +purchase +black +suede +shoes +shop +suede +shoes
'black suede shoes' 'suede black shoes' 'suede shoes black'	+black +suede +shoes

Table 1.2: Current and Modified Broad Match

Only insert a plus symbol (+) in front of the words in broad match keyword. Every word headed by a plus sign has to emerge in someone's search in the same way or as a close variant. Close variants comprises singular and plural forms, misspellings, acronyms, abbreviations, and stemmings (such as 'floor' and 'flooring'). Synonyms (such as 'quick' and 'fast') and similar searches (such as 'shoes' and 'boots') are not taken as close variants.

Do not give space between the plus sign (+) prefix along with the word that is changing.

- Correct: +leather +shoes
- Incorrect: + leather + shoes
- Incorrect: +leather+shoes

Following tips can be used to enhance keyword listing:

- Use a mixture of two or more keyword match types in order to run a valuable ad campaign. If broad and phrase match is employed, then it is likely to reach a larger audience while also managing who can see ad.
- To be certain that the ads will not be displayed for a particular search term, then insert that term to the ad group or campaign as a negative keyword.
- Removing or pausing or a keyword will not prevent one of the active broad-matched keywords in getting 'expanded' to that term. For instance, if the ad group has the broad-matched keywords tulips and flowers, and keyword tulips is paused, still ads can probably display for the search term tulips, as it is same to the working broad-matched keyword flowers.

Phrase match (example)

Ads may display on searches that are the phrase, or close variations of that particular phrase. Let us take the following example:

- Symbol: 'keyword'
- Example keyword: 'men's hats'
- Example search: buy men's hats

With phrase match, ad can be displayed to customers who are looking for exact keyword as well as close variants of exact keyword, with extra words before or after. Phrase match is much targeted as compared to the default broad match, but very flexible as compared to exact match. It provides more control on how closely the keyword should match a person's search term so that the ad can appear.

With phrase match, the ad may emerge when people look for exact phrase, even though it has one or more words after or before it. Also, ad will appear when a person looks for a close variant or option of

phrase match keyword. Close variants comprise singular and plural forms, misspellings, stemmings (such as floor and flooring), acronyms abbreviations, and accents. Word order is significant with phrase match, implying that the ad will not appear if a person enters an extra word amid the keyword.

Phrase match is much flexible as compared to exact match, but is much targeted as compared to the default broad match alternative. With phrase match, it is possible to reach many customers, displaying the ads to customers who are probably searching for service or product. Table 1.3 shows example 22.

Example 22

Phrase match keyword:	Ads may show on searches for:	Ads will not show on searches for:
'sports shoes'	red leather sports shoes buy sports shoes on sale red sports shoes	shoes for sports sports sneakers laces

Table 1.3: Example 22

Exact match (example)

Ads might display on searches that are the perfect term and similar variations of that perfect term. Let us take the following example:

- Symbol: [keyword]
- Example keyword: [men's hats]
- Example search: men's hats

By the perfect match, the ad can be displayed to customers, looking for perfect or exact keyword, or the close variants of the perfect keyword. Out of the four keyword matching alternatives, exact match provides the best control on who sees the ad, as well as may end up in a higher CTR.

By exact match, the ads will emerge while someone looks for the same keyword, devoid of any extra words after, before, or in the middle of the keyword. Also, the ad is displayed at the time when someone looks for close variants of the keyword. Close or near variants comprise singular and plural forms, misspellings, stemmings (such as floor and flooring), acronyms, abbreviations, and accents.

When exact match is employed, many clicks or impressions may not be received, but perhaps a higher CTR will be achieved. That is due to the fact that the ads may appear to persons looking for terms that are exactly linked to the service or product. Table 1.4 shows example 23.

Example 23

Exact match keyword	Ads may show on searches for	Ads will not show on searches for
[sports shoes]	sports shoes sports shoes	red sports shoes buy sports shoes

Table 1.4: Example 23

Negative match (example)

Ads might display on searches without the term. Let us take the following example:

- Symbol: -keyword
- Example keyword: -women
- Example search: baseball hats

Negative keywords can aid in reaching the most interested customers, decrease costs, and boost Return on Investment (ROI). When negative keywords are inserted (available for 'Search Network with Display Select') and 'Search Network only,') or as keyword exclusions (for the 'Display Network only' campaigns), ad will not display to people searching for such terms or visiting sites that have those terms.

With negative keywords, one may:

- Stop the ad from displaying to people looking for or visiting Web sites regarding things do not offer.
- Display ads to persons who are expected to click them.
- Decrease costs by not including keywords where money was spent but not gaining any return.

When negative keywords are chosen, then those search terms will be selected that are related to keywords, however, indicate that people are searching for a different product.

Example 24

Suppose, a gentleman is an optometrist who is selling glasses. He would wish to stop his ad from displaying to someone looking for or visiting Web pages which have terms such as 'wine glasses' and 'drinking glasses'.

Close keyword variations

Ads with near variations of the phrase and perfect match keywords increase the potential to show on important searches. Close or near variations comprise misspellings, plural forms, singular forms, stemmings (such as flooring and floor), abbreviations, acronyms, and accents. So there is no requirement to independently add close variations as keywords.

For instance, if phrase matches keyword 'kid's scooter', then it is expected to display the ad while someone looks for 'kids scooter' or 'kid scooters'.

Be cautious that although close variations of phrase are displayed, still these match types offer increased control as compared to broad match. Broad match keywords are meant to display synonyms as well as related searches that are not taken as close variations.

1.6 Summary

- Web Advertising is also known as online marketing or online advertising or Internet advertising. Web Advertising comprises Search Engine Marketing (SEM), email marketing, social media marketing, various kinds of display advertising (such as, Web banner advertising), as well as mobile advertising.
- Online advertising is extensively used throughout virtually all industry sectors.
- Display advertising communicates its advertising message visually through text, logos, videos, animations, photographs, or different graphics.
- Online advertisers (particularly via their ad servers) use cookies frequently which are special identifiers of particular computers, to determine which ads to serve to the specific consumer.
- Retargeting, contextual advertising and behavioural targeting are created to boost an advertiser's ROI, on untargeted ads.
- Search engine marketing is created to boost a Web site's visibility in the search engine results pages.
- The ads which pop up as a segment of Google Display Network can be in a range of formats such as various sizes, basic plain text, interactive video ads, or variety of audio streams.
- Users can also target the ads that are based on a user’s language, geographical location or demographic.
- Mobile advertising is ad copy communicated via wireless mobile devices including feature phones, smartphones, or tablet computers.
- Online classified advertising is a kind of advertising posted online in a definite listing of particular products or services.
- Adware is software which if once installed, automatically shows advertisements on a user's computer.
- Content marketing is the marketing which includes the making and sharing of media as well as publishing content to acquire and maintain customers.
- Online marketing platform is a kind of an integrated Web-based platform which includes the advantages of a local search engine, business directory, search engine optimization tool, content management system, and customer relationship management package.
- Keywords are phrases or words that are utilized to match ads to the terms people are looking for. They explain product or service and help in defining where and when the ad can appear.
- Choosing high quality, important keywords for the advertising campaign can enable ad to reach the desired customers.
- It is important to manage keywords in an operative manner to gain maximum revenue to the business.
- Keyword match type said in controlling which searches may trigger the ad.
- Keyword Planner is type of a free AdWords tool for experienced or new advertisers.
- With exact match, it is possible to display the ad to customers who are looking for exact keyword, or the close variants of the exact keyword, exclusively.
- With phrase match, the ad may be displayed to the customers who are looking for exact keyword and the close variants of exact keyword, with extra words before or after.

1.7 Check Your Progress

1. Online advertising involves which of the following components?
   A. Publisher, Advertiser, Advertising agencies
   B. Advertiser, Advertising agencies, Ad server
   C. Advertising agencies, Ad server, Advertising affiliates
   D. Publisher, Advertiser, Advertising agencies, Ad server, Advertising affiliates
2. What does role of advertising affiliate?
   A. To integrate advertisements into its online content
   B. To generate and place the ad copy
   C. To do independent promotional work for the advertiser
   D. All of these
3. What helps the advertisers to target their audience based on their location?
   A. Behavioral targeting
   B. Geo-targeting
   C. Contextual advertising
   D. Semantic advertising
4. What are interstitial ads, Advergaming, and application sponsorship?
   A. Ads within mobile applications or games
   B. Ads posted on social media Web sites
   C. Ads posted in Online classified advertising
   D. Ads sent through email message
5. What does Malware do?
   A. Collect data across multiple external Web sites
   B. Automatically display advertisements on a user's computer
   C. Narrow a user's location
   D. Display ads within mobile applications or games
6. Match the following:

1	Cookies	a	Chooses the appropriate match type for a keyword
2	Malware	b	Can help select competitive bids as well as budgets to use with campaigns.
3	Cost-Per-Acquisition	c	Unique identifiers of specific computers
4	Interstitial ads	d	This can help reduce costs
5	Negative keywords	e	Installed without the user's permission
6	Broad-to-narrow strategy	f	Online advertising costs for every conversion
7	Keyword Planner	g	Ads within mobile applications

A	1-e, 2-f, 3-a, 4-b, 5-d, 6-g, 7-c	C	1-f, 2-g, 3-e, 4,-a, 5-c, 6-d, 7-b
B	1-c, 2-e, 3-f, 4-g, 5-d, 6-a, 7-b	D	1-d, 2-c, 3-b, 4-f, 5-a, 6-e, 7-g

1.7.1 Answers

1	**d**
2	**c**
3	**b**
4	**a**
5	**b**
6	**b**

SESSION 2 - GOOGLE ADWORDS AND ACCOUNT SETUP

Session Objectives:

This session begins with an introduction to the widely used Internet search engine - Google, explains Google AdWords and Google AdWords Express, and lists their advantages. It focuses on Google's Advertising Networks and explains how to create and manage a Google AdWords account. It introduces all the tabs that are part of the Google AdWords Web site and differentiates between Google AdWords and Google AdWords Express.

At the end of this session, you will be able to:

- Describe the key concepts and features of Google AdWords
- Understand the benefits of online advertising and AdWords
- Understand Google AdWords express and its benefits
- Describe Google's advertising networks
- List the steps to set up and manage a Google AdWords account

2.1 Introduction

An Internet search engine is an application that enables users to search for desired information online. These may include Web sites, information databases, music, weather, and so on. Search engines provide an efficient way to procure the required information. Search engine marketing is a type of Internet marketing that markets Web sites by improving their visibility in search engine result pages. It includes specific keywords in the Web content that enables a Web site to achieve a higher ranking in the search results. Online advertising enables individuals or companies to market their products or services using the search engine. The advertisements appear as paid listings on the search engine results page.
The primary focus of Google is to collect and organize huge amount of information from the Internet and then make the information available to the users all around the world.

In order to search the desired information, users may visit the Google home page and specify a search query regarding the information they are looking for in the search field. Click 'Google Search' to start the search. Google displays a varied list of search results. These results include Web sites, articles, documents, as well as a list of files. All the results returned are highly relevant to the user query as shown in figure 2.1.

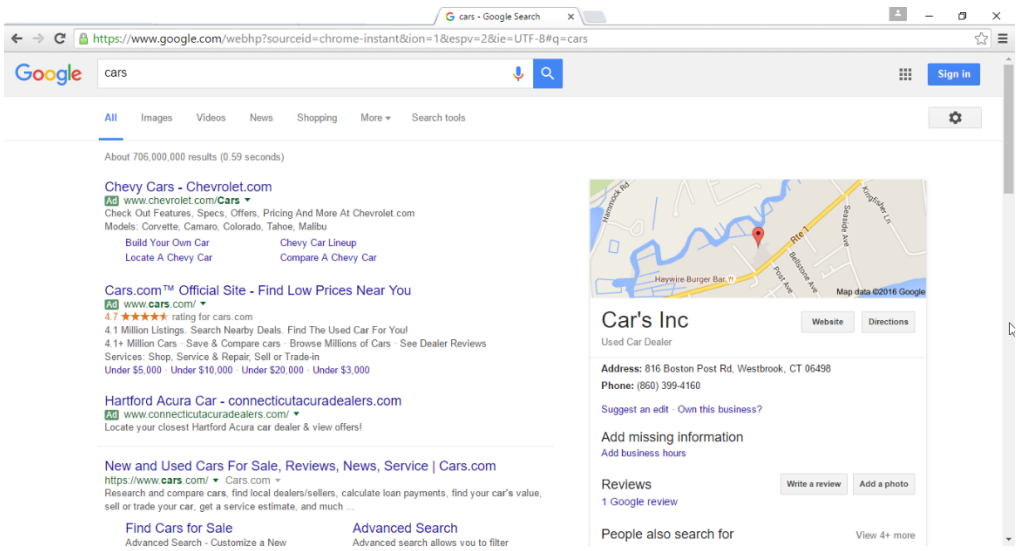


Figure 2.1: Google Search

Other than the text information, users may also search Google for specialized services such as maps, images, videos, and news.

If a user clicks 'I'm Feeling Lucky' button instead of 'Google Search', the user is directed to the first document or Web site in the Google search results. Users are not required to pay for placing documents or Web sites in the Google search results. However, the advertisements that appear on the right side of the search results page and sometimes above the search results can be purchased by the advertisers.

Google provides an advertising service called AdWords that helps businesses to display their ads on Google and its associated networks. This service is equipped with several features that enable business to perform in a better and organized way. Google AdWords helps to set budget for the ads that allows business to pay only when a viewer clicks it. This advertisement service is focused on keywords and the account can be managed by the user or by hired professionals.

The advertising product of Google is called Google AdWords. It is a program that enables the users to create and display simple and useful ads. These ads are then viewed by the people who are searching online for relevant information.

AdWords has proved to be an effective program in targeting huge masses in a precise and objective manner. The tremendous reach of Google coupled with AdWords has enabled people to attain a high Return on Investment (ROI).

Using Google AdWords to advertise your product is the right choice to find new users online. So understanding how AdWords functions and how this investment can aid in expanding a business, keeping in mind your budget limitation, is very important.

2.2 Introduction to Google AdWords

Google AdWords is an application that enables its users to market and advertise their products and services through the Google search engine. As soon as the users setup their AdWords account, they can start building up with all the other information required for operating the account appropriately. This includes the content of their account as well as necessary administrative details.

A typical search engine operates in a logical manner. Users type in their query, which could be a word or a phrase, in the search engine. The search engine shows a list of results that are relevant to the query typed in by the user.

The results of a user query in a search engine appear in a certain order of preference on the result page.

The order generally depends upon the relevancy of the result to the user's query. The most relevant link will always appear at the top of the page. Every search engine may have a different method to calculate relevancy of a search result depending on whether it is an organic or a paid link. The user's decision to use a particular search engine may be widely dependent on this factor.

Organic listings are search results that are displayed on search engine results pages; it appears because of its relevance to the search terms. Paid listings are paid advertisements displayed by the search engine companies such as Google and are non-organic.

Google displays both organic and paid results in response to the same user queries. However, these results are completely independent of each other as far as the rankings are concerned. This means that the ranking of an organic result will not have any bearing on that of a paid result and the same applies to the ranking of a paid result. The advantage of this method is that a promoter is able to perform decently in the paid listing with sufficient exposure, though the site may not be listed at a top rank in the organic search result.

Each page displayed in the page results has a PageRank associated with it. The value of PageRank depends on the incoming links from other Web pages. In simple words, every time a link on Web page of site X directs the user to a page on site Y, it adds to the value of PageRank of site Y. Thus, PageRank is a measure of importance of a page in search results. The PageRank is one of the 200 factors that decide the relevancy of a particular Web page to a user's query in the organic search results. In addition to this, there are other factors that facilitate in ranking the paid listings.

If you are an advertiser or a consultant for an advertiser, Google AdWords helps you to reach out to your customers. When users search a product or a term related to a product using Google, AdWords adds value to the search by displaying relevant ads based on the search result. Your ads can also be visible when customers visit other sites that are associated with the Google network.

2.2.1 Google Account

A Google account can be defined as a username and password which can be utilized across Google to gain access to numerous products, including AdWords. Following are the features of a Google account:

- It includes details that remain unchanged across all the products. For example, the language you prefer and the privacy settings you choose.
- It is created when users create an AdWords account or have logged in to use any Google product.
- It can be linked with only one AdWords account, either an individual account or a My Client Centre account.
- Users can view and modify the information in their Google Account whenever required by logging in to google.com/accounts.

Google AdWords is an online advertising service that creates a competition among advertisers to display their advertisement to Web users, depending on the users' cookies and keywords. The keywords are predefined by the advertisers and it helps to match the copy with the content of Web pages displayed to the users.

Web pages from Google and other partner Web sites are developed such that they permit Google to choose and display this advertising copy.

Advertisers pay when users click to view more details regarding the copy shown and the partner Web sites get a part of the money they generate.

AdWords offers the following advertising:

- Pay-Per-Click (PPC), that is, Cost-Per-Click (CPC) advertising
- Cost-Per-Acquisition (CPA) advertising
- Cost-per-thousand-impressions or Cost Per Mile (CPM) advertising
- Site-targeted advertising for text, banner, and rich-media ads
- Remarketing (also called retargeting)

The AdWords program consists of local, national, and international distribution. Text ads in Google include the following:

- An heading of 25 characters
- Two extra text lines of 35 characters each
- A display URL of 35 characters

Image ads can take up one of the various different Interactive Advertising Bureau (IAB) standard sizes.

In order to start using AdWords, the advertisers first need to create an account with Google AdWords. They may create and manage this account themselves or obtain help of an external agency or a consultant to manage their account. They may take the help of the external agency or consultant as well as Ad Creation Marketplace in order to create their ads.

Google AdWords uses some specific terminologies in its working. A few commonly used AdWords terms are as follows:

- **AdRank:** Indicates a value used to determine your ad position, where your ad shows on the page in relation to other ads, and whether your ads are eligible to be visible at all. Ad Rank is calculated using your bid amount, the components of Quality Score (expected ad relevance, and landing page experience), and the expected impact of extensions and other ad formats.
- **AdGroup:** Indicates a set of keywords, ads, and bids that are managed together, so that ads can be displayed to the people who would be most interested in them.
- **Campaign**: Represents a set of ad groups (ads, keywords, and bids) that share a budget, location targeting, and other settings. AdWords users have exclusive AdWords accounts. These accounts are then organized into campaigns and ad groups. Every campaign is independent with its own daily budget and target audience. Every AdWords user may have multiple campaigns where each campaign promotes an individual product or service that they may want to advertise. Within each campaign, there may be one or more ad groups.
- **Click:** Whenever a customer sees an ad on a Web page and clicks it to know more, this action is recorded as a click in the advertiser's AdWords account. Advertisers can monitor the number of clicks to know the number of people who have been directed to their Web site by clicking the ad.
- **Click Through Rate (CTR):** Advertisers can measure the performance of their ads with the help of CTR. The more relevant the ads may be, more likely are the users to click those ads. More the number of times users click the ad, higher is the CTR. The CTR is calculated using the following formula:

  CTR = Number of ad clicks x 100 Number of impressions
- **Cost-Per-Click (CPC):** Every time an ad receives a user click, AdWords charges the advertiser a certain amount known as Cost-Per-Click. No charge is levied upon the advertiser by Google, if the ad is displayed on a page but is not clicked by anybody. All the ads running on Google and its search network follow CPC by default. It is also the most preferred choice of advertisers who promote direct response ad campaigns such as sale, signing-up, or any other similar action.

- **Cost-Per-Thousand Impressions (CPM):** There may be certain ad campaigns where for an advertiser, visibility may be more important to attract the clients. In case of such campaigns, advertisers have an option to pay for every view of their ad, instead of clicks received on their ad. Thus, maximum CPM is the amount that they may be willing to pay for every thousand views or impressions of their ad on certain Web pages. It is important to note that the CPM bidding option is available only for the Google Display Network campaigns. The Google search pages or search partner sites do not follow the CPM.
- **Display URL:** Represents the Web page address that appears with the ad, typically shown in green text. Display URLs give people an idea of where they will and after they click an ad. The landing page is the destination or final URL tends to be more specific.
- **First page bid estimates:** All the keywords in an ad group have a first page bid estimate associated with them. The AdWords account maintains the record of this estimate. This estimate enables the advertiser to identify the CPC bid required for their ad to attain the top position on Google search result page. However, Quality Score still remains the basis for this estimate in addition to the present competition by other advertisers for that keyword.
- **Image ad:** An image ad is a graphical ad, which could be either static or animated. The image ad that runs on Google Display Network is also known as display ad.
- **Impression (Impr.):** The number of times an advertiser's ad is displayed on the Google network is identified as the number of impressions of their ad. Thus, if they monitor the number of impressions, they will get to know the number of people whom their ad is shown to.
- **Keyword:** As the name indicates, these are the words or phrases that will trigger the appearance of advertiser's ad on the search page. For example, if the advertisers are marketing home-made jams, it will help to use the term 'home-made jams' as a keyword in their AdWords campaign. Whenever Google users specify 'home-made jams' in the Google search box, their ad may appear next to the search results on the result page.
- **Maximum Cost-Per-Click (Maximum CPC):** Maximum CPC is the maximum amount that the advertisers are willing to pay for every click that is registered on their ad. Google AdWords allows the advertisers to set a maximum CPC for every keyword defined in their account or collectively for all the keywords in a particular ad group.
- **Mobile Ad:** The type of ad that can be viewable on mobile devices such as cell phones, smartphones, and tablets. Mobile Ads can be shown in a Web page or through apps. There are two types in Mobile Ad namely, WAP mobile ads for feature phones and Ads for high-end devices such as smartphones/tablets. Since, smartphones have fully functional Web browsers, normal AdWords ads are viewable in these devices.
- **Optimization:** The performance of the AdWords ads can be greatly improved by creating/editing keywords as well as the ad text with the help of process known as optimization. In addition to keywords, the advertisers may also need to moderate some other sections of their Google AdWords account.
- **Placement:** In addition to using appropriate keywords, placement of an ad also plays an important role in its success. It enables the advertisers to decide the Web sites where they would prefer their ad to appear. They need to specify the address of the actual Web pages so that their ad appears on those Web sites.
- **Quality Score:** The quality of the advertiser's keywords and the ad itself can be quantified along with the CPCs with the help of Quality Score. The CTR of the advertiser's keywords and other relevancy factors such as appropriate ad text and performance trend of these keywords play a major role in calculating the Quality Score. A higher value Quality Score indicates a lower CPC advertisers need to pay.

- **Text Ad:** The standard type of AdWords ad. A text ad includes a link to the Web site and a description or promotion of the product or service. Text Ads include a title that is also a clickable link to the Web page, one or two lines of text, and the Web site shown in green.

2.3 Benefits of Online Advertising and AdWords

Online advertising helps to display ads to users who may be keen on the products and services displayed, while filtering out the people who are not interested. It also helps to record whether those keen users clicked the displayed ads. It ensures that the ad reaches potential users as they utilize multiple devices such as desktops, laptops, tablets, and smartphones.

2.3.1 Benefits of Google AdWords

Google AdWords allows to show the ads not only in Google but also in their affiliated Web sites irrespective of how they are accessed. For example, the ads are shown even on mobile devices. The ads are displayed in the display and search results area as shown in figure 2.2.



Figure 2.2: Online Advertising with Google

Online advertising allows your ads to be targeted at the users you prefer and filter out the rest. Using AdWords to advertise online allows you to utilize different targeting methods to target probable users when they are looking for your products or services.

AdWords promotes to take advantage of online advertising by displaying an organizations ads to the right people, in the right place, and at the right time as shown in figure 2.3.



Figure 2.3: Advertise Online with AdWords

Following are the several benefits of AdWords:

- **Reach your marketing goals**: Utilize various ad formats and features to tailor your ads to match your business goals. For example, providing a 'Call' button in your ads to get more phone calls or incorporating video ads to show your brand. Following are a few common marketing goals:
  - Working on your Web site
  - Visiting your store
  - Calling your business
  - Installing your app
  - Targeting your ads with keywords

  When you advertise beside the search results on the Google Search Network, you choose keywords which can direct your ads at users looking for related words. You also have an option to display your ads at specific times of a day and mention the location and language.
- **Get specific about your target audience**: When you use Web sites and mobile apps that display Google ads (also known as the Google Display Network) and YouTube to advertise your product, you can even select the age of the users you prefer to reach, the sites they view, and their areas of interest.
- **Only pay for results**: You decide your budget and pay only when users respond to your ad by clicking the text ad or watching the video ad. You decide your bids depending on what suits your business.
- **Measure your ad's performance**: Easily monitor the effectiveness of your ad and make required changes to enhance results.
- **Advertise across platforms**: Connect with users irrespective of the devices they use—computers, tablets, mobile phones, even in apps.
- **Target your ads**: Targeting allows you to display your ads to users with particular interests and show them only related ads. AdWords uses multiple ways of targeting. Following are the options in online ads which make your marketing campaigns even more targeted:
  - **Keywords**: Words or phrases related to your products and service that help in displaying your ads when users look for those words or view related Web sites.
  - **Ad location**: Display your ads on pages of Google search results and Web sites that are part of the Google Search and Display Networks.
  - **Age, location, and language**: Select the age, geographic location, and language of your users.
  - **Days, times, and frequency**: Display your ads during specific hours or days of the week, and decide how frequently they must be displayed.
  - **Devices**: Your ads can be displayed on all types of devices and you can select the devices on which your ads must appear on and when.
- **Control your costs**: AdWords allows you to control your budget. There is no minimum specified and you can decide your monthly, daily, and per ad expenses. You will only pay when users respond to your ad.
- **Measure your success**: With AdWords, you can monitor if users click your ad. You can track if users purchased or phoned in to order your product or downloaded your app. Monitoring ads also helps you to decide where to invest in your campaign, thus boosting the ROI. You can obtain other valuable information such as the cost incurred, on an average, for advertising that resulted in your users' online buying or phone calls. You can also utilize analytical tools to identify users' shopping habits, such as, the time spent to research your product before purchasing it.
- **Manage your campaigns**: AdWords provides tools to easily maintain and track accounts.
  My Client Center (MCC) manager account is a useful tool that can help you to save time while managing multiple AdWords accounts. It allows you to manage all your AdWords accounts from a specific location.
  AdWords Editor allows you to manage your AdWords account offline. It is a free downloadable desktop application that can help you to quickly and easily modify your account. It allows you to

download account related details, modify your campaigns offline, and then upload your modifications to AdWords. It allows to manage, modify, and view many accounts simultaneously, copy or move data between different ad groups and campaigns, and undo and redo multiple modifications while editing campaigns.

2.3.2 AdWords Express

Google AdWords Express, an advertising product, automatically supervises your online ads, without any daily management or tasks. Your probable users already search Google for the products and services that you sell. AdWords Express helps such users to find your products by using ads on Google or Google Maps.

AdWords Express Operation

Using AdWords Express in not a tedious task. You just design an ad for your business, choose your budget, choose your product or service, and let Google come up with a listing of relevant search phrases. After this initial setup, AdWords Express supervises your ads automatically.

When users search for products or services relevant to your search phrases on Google, your ad is permitted to surface beside, atop, or beneath the search results. On Google Maps, it can surface directly on the map or beneath the search results. An address and phone number can also be added to your ad. You pay only when users click your ad and you can modify or delete your ad whenever you want by visiting your AdWords Express account.

Using AdWords Express to advertise helps to:

- Design an online ad instantly and easily.
- Pay only when users click your ad.
- Draw more users to your Web site or Google+ page.
- Run your ads with minimum ongoing management.
- Reach users on multiple devices such as desktop computers and mobile devices (smartphones and tablets).
- Evaluate your ad’s effectiveness in your dashboard.

2.4 About Google's Advertising Networks

AdWords allows your ads to appear either on one or both of Google's advertising networks the Google Search Network and the Google Display Network. The campaign type you select identifies the network on which your ads will show.

Search Network

The Search Network consists of the following:

- Google search
- Other Google sites such as Maps and Shopping
- Non-Google search partner Web sites that display AdWords ads based on the search results

The Search Network helps advertisers perform the following:

- Display the text ads beside the Google search results.
- Reach users actively looking for a particular product or service.

Display Network

The Display Network consists of the following:

- Collection of Google Web sites (Google Finance, Gmail, Blogger, and YouTube)
- Partner sites
- Mobile sites and apps that display AdWords ads based on the content on a given page

The Display Network helps advertisers to perform the following:

- Utilize attracting ad forms to get through a wide range of users with extensive interests.
- Create brand awareness and customer loyalty.
- Enhance engagement with users.
- Identify particular locations for their ads to appear, and to what type of users.

2.4.1 Ad Location

To understand the working of AdWords, you need to acquaint yourself with some of the key functions such as the location your ads can show up, the quality of your ads, and the amount you pay for the ads.

Based on how you target your ads, the users you prefer to reach and the kind of ads you design, your ads can show up in different locations over the Web.

To know how your ads are displayed on the Search Network, let us begin with the concept of keywords.

Keywords are the words or phrases that define your product or service. When a user searches for terms that are identical to your keywords, your ads are likely to be displayed beside or atop the search results on sites that are included in the Search Network. Your ad is qualified to show up depending on how similar your keywords are to their search terms and also the keyword match types.

Keywords also aid is deciding how much you pay. Every keyword has a maximum CPC bid amount, which mentions the maximum amount you are ready to forfeit for every click that your ad receives.

Search Ad Formats

The types of ads that can be displayed on the Search Network sites are:

- **Text ad**: It is the simplest and most frequently used type of search ad. It consists of a heading, a display URL that gives the address of the Web site, and a description.
- **Ad with extensions**: These are visual enhancements to find ads that more noticeably display details regarding your business, for example, phone number, location, or links to other relevant details within your sitemap. These enhancements generally show up in ads atop the search results. They can be added manually or by Google's automated formatting systems.

You also have an option to display your ads to users as they browse the Web. You can display your ads on particular Web sites or on locations that you select depending on the targeting methodologies that you employ, such as keywords, placement, users, and topics.

Placements are sites across the Internet where your ads can show up. Keywords can cause your ad to appear on such placements. Google automatically identifies where your ads must be displayed by matching your keywords to these placements. You can also identify particular placements yourself in order to maintain control over where your ads are displayed.

You can also utilize various Display Network targeting options to target your ads at particular groups of users depending on their interests, age, gender, or whether they have viewed your site previously.

2.5 Creating an AdWords Account

The two main requirements to create your own AdWords account are an e-mail address and a Web site for your business. The e-mail address should not already be linked with any present AdWords or AdWords Express account. If you do not own a Web site for your business, you can use AdWords Express, Google's simple resolution to online advertising.

To create a Google AdWords account, complete the following steps:

1. Visit the following Web site:
   https://www.google.com/adwords/get-started
2. Click **Start now** button at the end of the page as shown in figure 2.4.

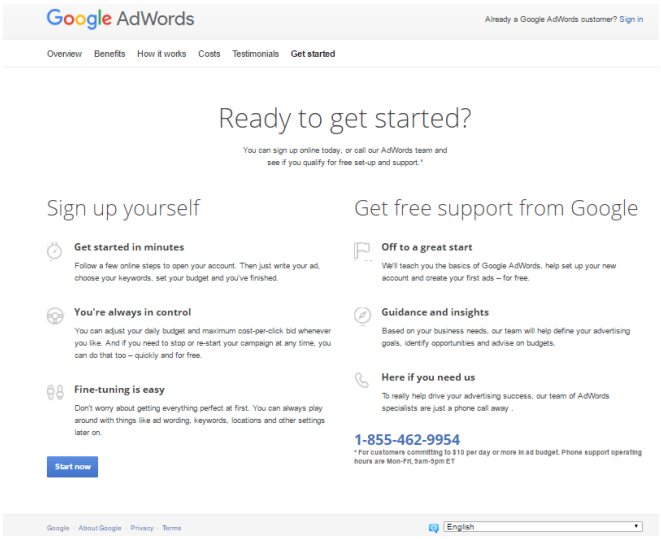


Figure 2.4: Get Started to Google AdWords

3. Enter the preferred e-mail address to sign in to new AdWords account. If there is an existing Google Account, enter Google e-mail address. Enter your business's Web site address. If there is no Web site, click **Skip the guided setup** as shown in figure 2.5.

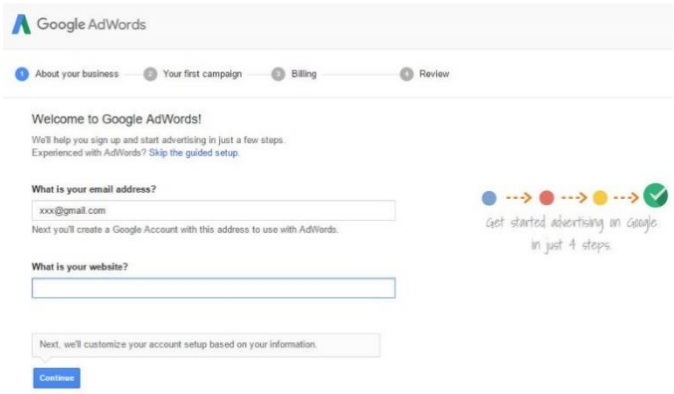


Figure 2.5: Account Setup in Google AdWords

4. If **Skip the guided setup** link is clicked, the window shown in figure 2.6 pops up.

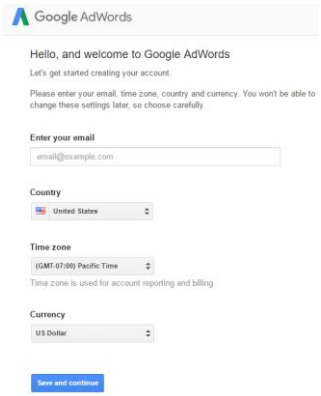


Figure 2.6: Account Setup in Google AdWords

5. Enter Google e-mail address.

   Select the appropriate Country, Time zone, and Currency as shown in figure 2.7. Click **Save and continue**.

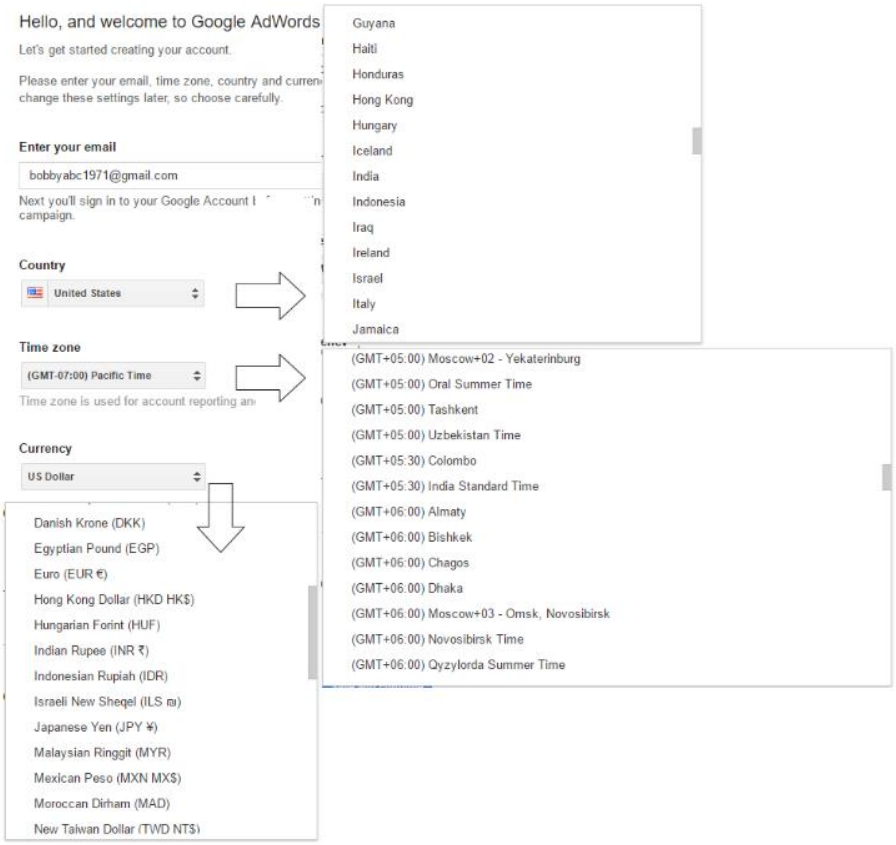


Figure 2.7: Option Setting in Google AdWords Account Setup

6. If an existing Google Account is present, click Sign in on the top-right of the page as shown in figure 2.8.

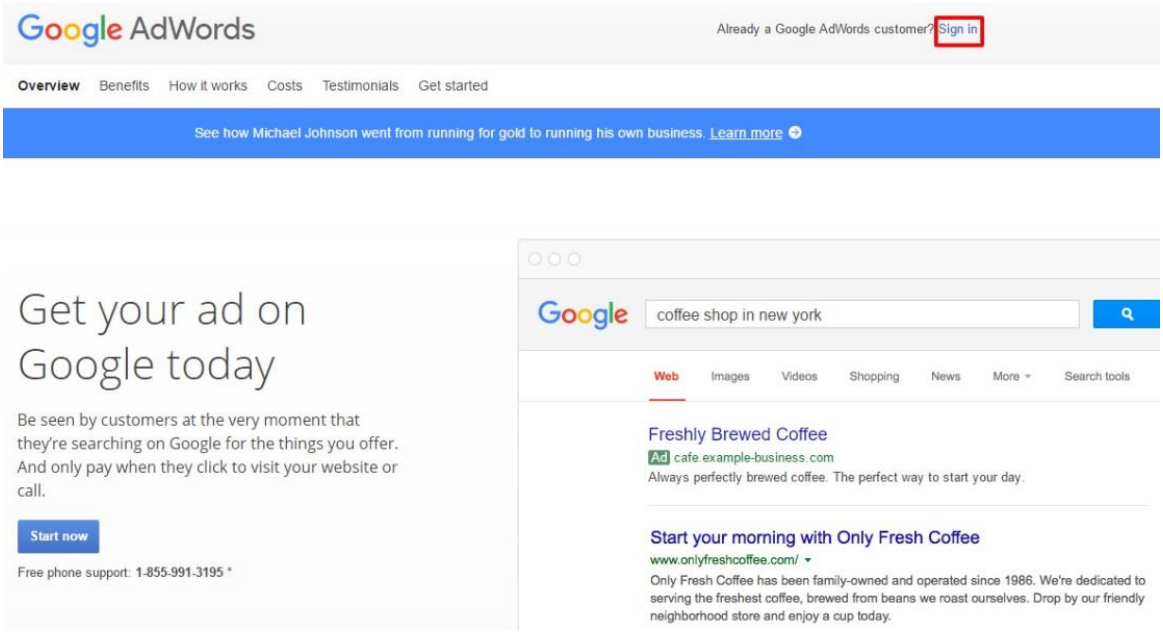


Figure 2.8: Existing User Sign in

7. Enter Google e-mail address and password as shown in figures 2.9 and 2.10 to sign in to existing Google account.

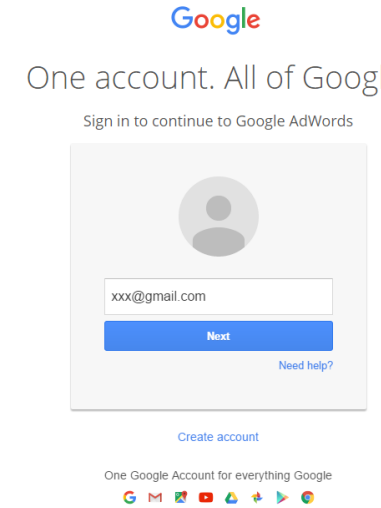


Figure 2.9: Google Account Login Screen

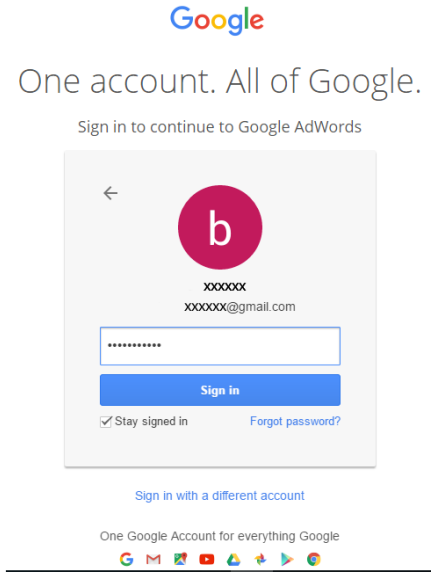


Figure 2.10: Google Account Password Screen

8. After signing in successfully, Google AdWords page shown in figure 2.11 will be displayed.

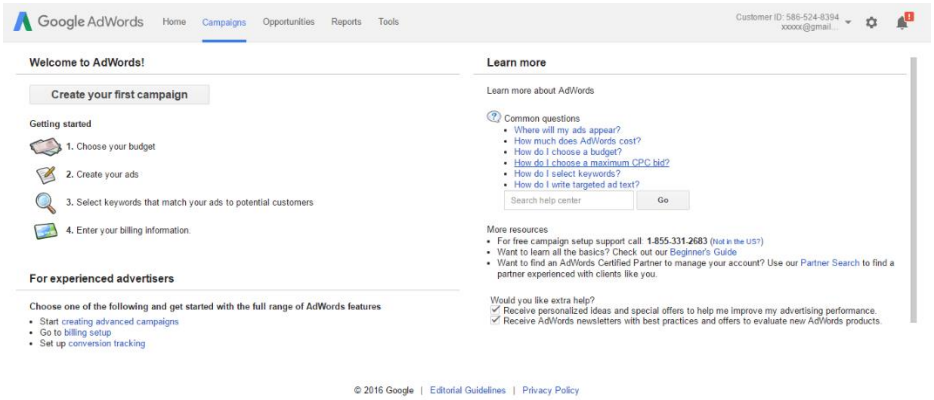


Figure 2.11: Google AdWords Campaign Setup Screen

If there is no Google Account, click **Create account** at the end of the window and follow the steps to create and confirm your new Google account:

1. Enter first name and last name in the Name field. Enter other details such as the e-mail address and the password you desire. Enter all the fields as shown in figure 2.12 and click **Next step**. Ensure to select the button to agree to Google's terms of services.

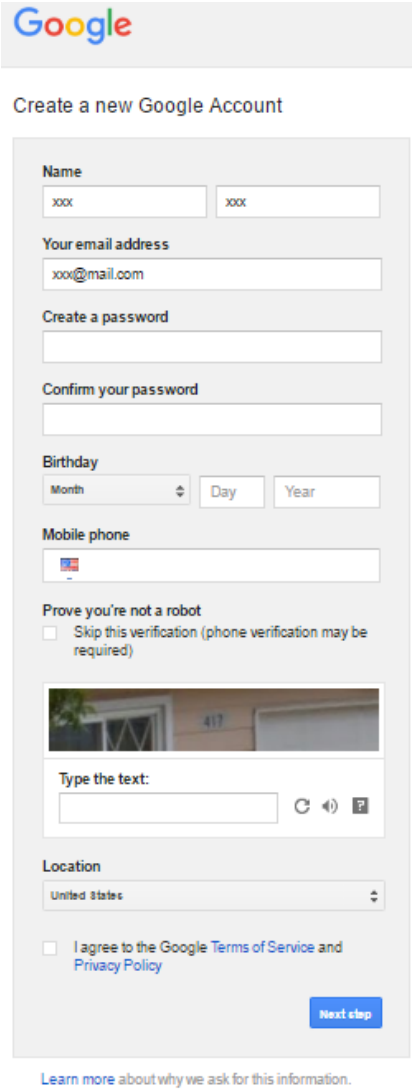


Figure 2.12: New Google Account Window

2. On successfully completion of e-mail creation, a message will be displayed as shown in figure 2.13. Click the link in the e-mail that has been sent to you to confirm the e-mail address.

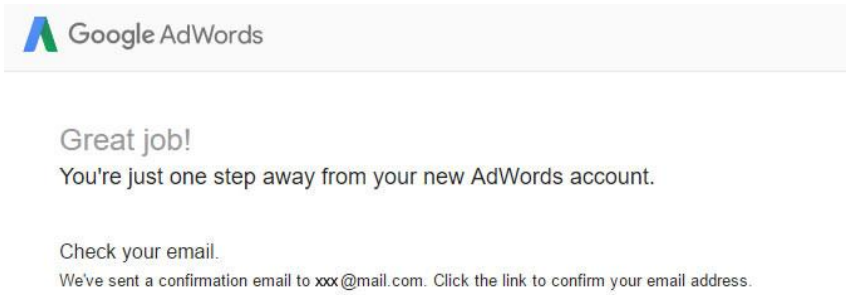


Figure 2.13: E-mail Creation Success Message

2.5.1 Hiring a Consultant to Manage the Account

Generally, most of the advertisers create as well as manage their own AdWords account. However, those who do not wish to manage their own account may take the assistance of Google AdWords Certified Partners to manage their accounts. It is recommended to use the Google Partner Search to locate such partners. Advertisers may also specify their budget, location, and all the types of services that they are looking for while searching a partner and select the partner who suits their requirements.

A client manager handles multiple accounts of multiple clients with the help of MCC program. Following explains how individual client accounts differ from client manager accounts:

- **AdWords client accounts**: When the users set up their own independent Google AdWords account and connect it to that of a client manager, both users and the client manager are able to access the account. Note that users are able to access their account as well as unlink it from that of the client manager's, at any given point of time.

  However, in case, it is the client manager who sets up the AdWords account, then do ensure that the client managers use their personal sign in e-mail and password while creating the account. This will help users to access as well as keep a tab on the AdWords account. Google will periodically send important updates regarding the account to users sign in e-mail.

  The Google AdWords account allows the client managers to update campaigns, handle account administration for their clients. The account also allows viewing the billing summary history information for the accounts they are handling. However, keeping the safety measures in view, client managers do not have access to proprietary information about the client. This may include monetary information such as credit card and other personal information.

- **Client manager accounts:** A client manager is an individual who manages the AdWords accounts for various advertisers. As a security policy, the access to the client manager account is available only to a client manager. A client manager is able to access all the information regarding all the related accounts with the help of MCC. A client manager can disassociate from a particular client account at any given time.

- **Getting help to create ads:** The Google Ad Creation Marketplace is the program that enables the users to get assistance in creating their ads. The Ad Creation Marketplace is a one-stop place to find the industry professionals talented in various fields of the advertising industry. Various talents such as writing, editing, production, and voice-over are available at the Ad Creation Marketplace at a reasonable cost. The users AdWords account enables them to access the Marketplace. Here, they may search for the required specialists or send project bids to professionals without additional cost. Until the users accept a particular bid, they do not have any obligation to work with the particular professional.

2.5.2 Different Tabs in Google AdWords Web site

The different tabs in Google AdWords Web site are as follows:

Home Tab

The AdWords Home tab includes all your account related details as shown in figure 2.14. You can customize this tab to view only the performance modules you prefer by selecting them. You also have an option to use filters to manage your performance in detail.

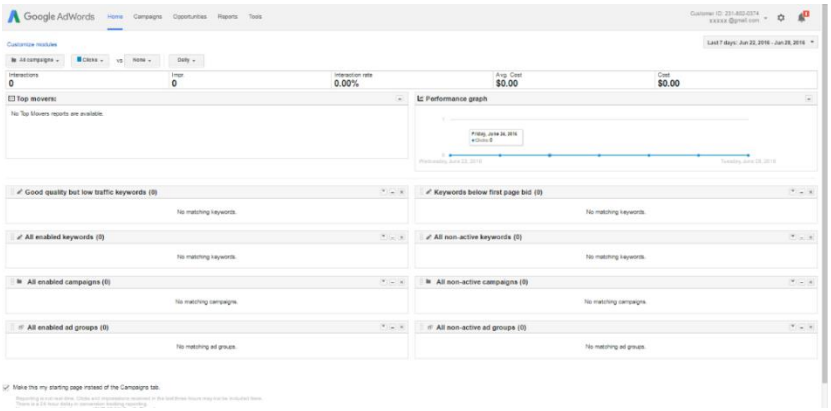


Figure 2.14: Google AdWords Home Tab

Campaigns Tab

The Campaigns tab allows you to set up and manage your ads. You can modify the settings of your ad groups, ads, and keywords. You also have an option to view and customize your account statistics, download information, and more as shown in figure 2.15.

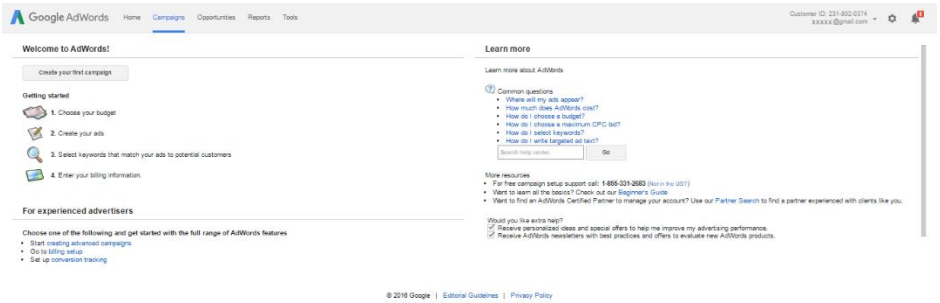


Figure 2.15: Google AdWords Campaigns Tab

Opportunities Tab

The Opportunities tab includes the performance history of your account, your campaign settings, and Google search volume and trends as shown in figure 2.16. This tab automatically creates opportunities that can help you in enhancing the campaigns. Using this tab, you can identify new keywords, enhance your bids and budgets, and more. This tab is worth a try for users who have been using their AdWords account for a considerable long time to have created performance history.

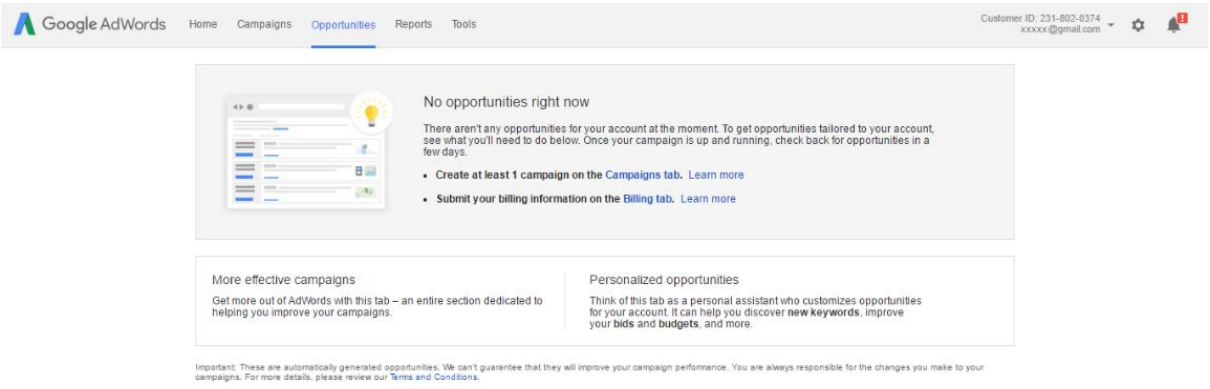


Figure 2.16: Google AdWords Opportunities Tab

Reports Tab

The Reports tab helps you to see, arrange, and evaluate all of your information. Using this tab you can analyze the patterns and trends in your information with the help of advanced tables, charts, and handy reports. This tab helps you to perform the following:

- Develop multi-dimensional tables and charts with the help of the drag-and-drop interface in the Report Editor.
- Obtain further pre-defined reports that simplify your information based on dimensions such as time and user location.
- Modify, delete, and maintain your saved reports for easy accessing and sharing.

Tools Tab

The Tools tab includes links to various AdWords account tools as shown in figure 2.17. Using these tools you can examine and modify your account, ads, ad groups, and keywords.

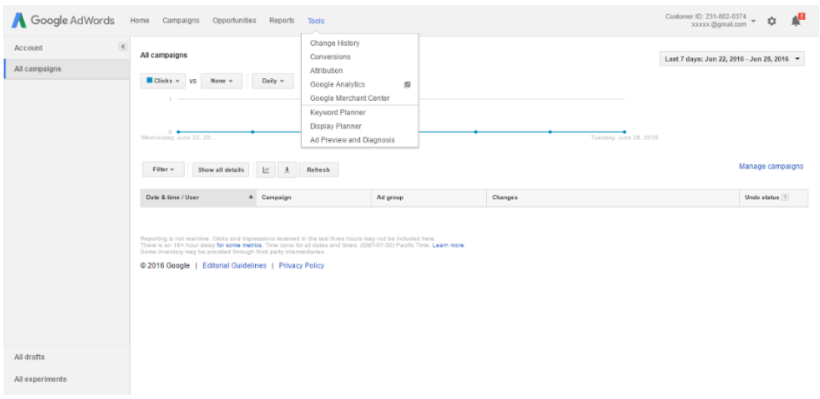


Figure 2.17: Google AdWords Tools Tab

Change History

The Change History tool shows the modifications that you have performed on your account since the last two years. Using this account history, you can track the performance changes and monitor how you have managed your account previously.

Conversions

The Conversions section includes details of users' action after clicking your ad, for example, Do they buy your product? Do they sign up for your newsletter? To monitor this data, a free tool called Conversion Tracking is available. These details about your conversions help you to identify the keywords that are good for your business. Thus, you can invest more capital on your best words and increase your ROI.

The Conversion Tracking tool gives you a complete summary of your conversion data, which complements the reporting data available in the Campaigns tab.

Google Analytics

Google Analytics gives you details regarding what users felt about your site and how they navigated through it. This data helps you to improve your Web site's ROI, enhance conversions, and understand how to offer a better experience to your users. Using Analytics, you can also establish goals (Web site pages that can be used as conversions for your site) and import them into AdWords. Few instances of conversion pages are a 'thank you' page, which can be used after a user has submitted details through a form, or a buying confirmation page.

Keyword Planner

Keyword Planner aids in creating a new Search Network campaigns or developing an existing ones. You can look for keyword and ad group concepts and even view the performance of a group of keywords. This is crucial as the keywords you choose for an ad group are utilized to target your ads to potential users. In other words, appropriate keywords can make your ads appear to the right users at the right time. This Planner also aids in selecting reasonable bids and budgets that can be used with your campaigns.

Display Planner

Display Planner is generally used when you prefer to run ads on the Google Display Network. On the Display Network, you can direct your text, image, video, or rich media ads to appear on particular sites, pages, apps, or videos over the network. This planner can aid in planning your Display Network campaigns by recommending keywords, interests, topics, placements, demographic groups, and remarketing lists to target. It also provides an estimate for cost and reach depending on historical data.

Ad Preview and Diagnosis

The Ad Preview and Diagnosis tool helps to find your ad in a way similar to Google search results page. You can use this tool to obtain a preview of your ad and the results are same as a Google search without any cost. If your ad does not appear in the tool, it explains the reason and offers steps to help you in fixing and running your ad.

2.5.3 Comparing AdWords Express and AdWords

With AdWords Express or AdWords, you can display your ads on Google.com, Google Maps, and other related Web sites which are within the Google Display Network.

Google recommends using either one of these advertising tools at a time. There is no added benefit of incorporating both AdWords and AdWords Express simultaneously. Using both tools together can cause complications in managing your ads and may result in your ads competing against each other. Table 2.1 gives a comparison of both the tools with respect to certain factors.

Factors	AdWords Express	AdWords
Pay only for clicks	Yes	Yes
Automated management	Yes	No
Easy solution for businesses without a Web site	Yes	No
Ads on Google Search and Google Maps	Yes	Yes
Ads on other related Web sites	Limited	Yes
Mobile ads	Yes	Yes
Other advanced ad formats (video)	No	Yes
Ability to target ads geographically	Anywhere	Anywhere

Table 2.1: Comparison of Google AdWords Express and AdWords

Both AdWords and AdWords Express helps you to boost the frequency and the location for you ads to appear. With either of the tools you can employ targeted messaging in your ads to draw and involve potential users.

Using AdWords Express with AdWords

Google recommends using only AdWords Express or AdWords at a time. However, if you wish to employ them together, you need to understand how they function together and how you will be billed.

Following factors that needs to be considered:

- AdWords Express ads management can be done only in your AdWords Express account. Any modifications such as inserting, editing, or deactivating ads can only be performed using your AdWords Express account. When you sign in to AdWords, an alert will be displayed that guides you to your AdWords Express account to administer your AdWords Express ads.
- AdWords Express account's login credentials also gives you access to AdWords (though you do not have any AdWords campaigns). However, this does not allow you to view or administer your AdWords Express ads in AdWords.

Structuring your AdWords Account

An AdWords account can be efficiently managed by structuring it. Hence, the following points need to be considered to structure it:

- Identify ads that are creating the maximum conversions (such as sales or leads) and traffic
- Track and observe changes easily
- Ensure there is control over budgets and costs
- Identify important keywords
- Maintain and edit the ad campaigns easily

Good account organization helps the user to make changes quickly, target ads effectively, and reach the advertising goals. The user will get well-structured campaigns with added enhancements in account appearance such as themes and other products that affects the user experience in a good way. The user can also have similar ads and keywords that is good for Quality Score. The higher the Quality Score, the higher the ROI.

Three major tips that can help you structure your account:

- Prepare and structure your campaign to reflect your Web site

  An effective campaign structure must reflect the Web site's structure. You can create theme oriented or product oriented campaigns and ad groups. You can create relevant keyword lists based on the ad text. You can also have ads that link directly to a product's page on the Web site. Improve the quality and relevance of the ads by adding keyword-specific URLs.

  This format can be changed, if the user needs to match the format to the user's business and the advertising scope, then the user can change the format. For example, the advertiser can have a 'Bakery' campaign, if the advertiser's business related to donuts and the advertiser can have ad group themes similar to Donut and Cupcake as shown in figure 2.18.

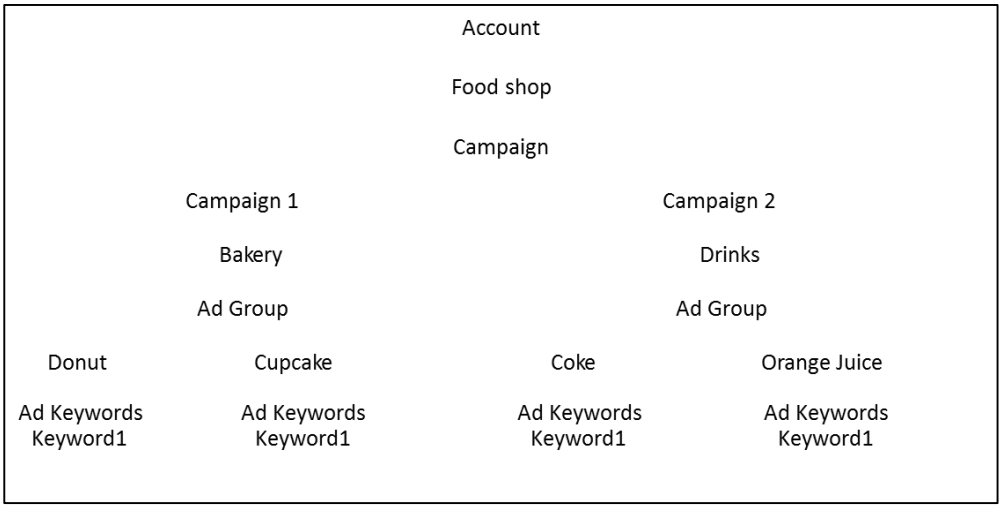


Figure 2.18: Campaign Format

If the user business also deals with beverages, then the user may have to include a 'Drinks' campaign and the ad groups can be added in a similar manner.

If the user business deals with a single product or service, then the user may have a simple campaign structure related to that product alone.

- The AdWords account have all the information about the Food shop.
- The campaigns are built around large product areas (such as Donuts and cupcakes).
- Each campaign contains several ad groups that focus on one specific product (such as Soda and Juice).
- Build distinct campaigns for each region when targeting multiple regions.

The user must maintain separate ad campaigns for separate geographical locations. For example, if the business has branches in Nepal and Sri Lanka, then the user must have two separate ad campaigns depending on that region. The ad campaigns must address the product availability in that geographic region and the campaign must be in the local language of that particular region.

- Utilize AdWords Editor to manage ad campaigns

AdWords Editor is a free Google application for managing AdWords ad campaigns. The user can easily edit and make changes to the AdWords account with this application. The user can make the changes rapidly, whether it is adding one keyword or hundred text ads.

Additional benefits:

- The user can add, edit and remove campaigns, ad groups, ads, keywords, and placements.
- Large-scale changes can be made quickly.
- Advanced searches and edits can be made.
- Performance statistics are viewable.
- User can copy or move items between campaigns, ad groups and accounts.
- User can export a snapshot of the AdWords account for archiving or sharing.

2.6 Summary

- Google provides an advertising service called AdWords that helps businesses to display their ads on Google and its associated networks.
- Google AdWords is a program that enable the users to create and display simple and useful ads.
- Google AdWords is an application that enables its users to market and advertise their products and services through the Google search engine.
- Organic listings are search results that are displayed on search engine results pages; it appears because of its relevance to the search terms.
- A Google account can be defined as a username and password which can be utilized across Google to gain access to numerous products, including AdWords.
- The AdWords program includes local, national, and international distribution.
- Google AdWords is an online advertising service that creates a competition among advertisers to display their advertisement to Web users, depending on the users' cookies and keywords.
- Google AdWords Express, an advertising product, automatically supervises your online ads, without any daily management or tasks.
- AdWords allows your ads to appear either on one or both of Google's advertising networks: the Google Search Network and the Google Display Network.
- The two main requirements to create your own AdWords account are an e-mail address and a Web site for your business.
- Advertisers who do not wish to manage their own account may take the assistance of Google AdWords Certified Partners to manage their accounts.
- The AdWords Home tab includes all your account related details. You can customize this tab to view only the performance modules you prefer by selecting them.
- Google Analytics gives you details regarding what users felt about your site and how they navigated through it.
- Google recommends using either one of these advertising tools at a time. There is no added benefit of incorporating both AdWords and AdWords Express simultaneously.
- Both AdWords and AdWords Express allow you to increase the number of times and the number of places where your business info appears.
- Good account organization helps the user to make changes quickly, target ads effectively, and reach the advertising goals.

2.7 Check Your Progress

1. The search results of search engines are displayed based on:
   a. Relevance of the search terms
   b. The PageRank
   c. Relevance of the ads based on search term
   d. All of these

2. Which advertising model is not provided by Google?
   a. Pay-per-click
   b. Cost-per-acquisition
   c. Cost-per-AdWord
   d. Cost per mile

3. Which of the following is not a key factor in calculating AdRank?
   a. Quality score
   b. Size of the ad
   c. Ad formats
   d. Bid amount

4. Cost-Per-Thousand Impressions bidding option is available on:

   a. Google Display Network
   b. Google search pages
   c. Google search partner sites
   d. Google Search Networks

5. Which of the following is not true for Google AdWords?
   a. It reaches potential customers through desktops, laptops, tablets, and smartphones
   b. It tracks your ad's effectiveness and makes changes to improve results
   c. It automatically manages your online ads
   d. It offers different ways of targeting

6. Which of the following statement is correct?
   a. Google highly recommends to use both the advertising tools: AdWords and AdWords Express, at the same time
   b. Google AdWords Express automatically manages your online ads
   c. In Google AdWords Express advertising, you have to pay when a user views your ad
   d. Using Google AdWords Express you cannot add business address and phone number in your ad in Google Map

2.7.1 Answers

1	**d**
2	**c**
3	**b**
4	**a**
5	**c**
6	**b**

SESSION 3 - ADWORDS CAMPAIGN CREATION AND MANAGEMENT

Session Objectives:

This session explains how to create campaigns and their management. It further focuses on how to manage the campaign settings. It also explains how to create ad groups and test the campaigns.

At the end of the session, you will be able to:

- Know the campaign creation
- Manage campaigns
- Set the campaign settings
- Create ad groups
- Test the campaigns

3.1 Introduction

Advertising with Ad Words begins with designing a campaign. A campaign is a collection of associated ad groups that are generally used to manage the categories of services or products being offered. These associated ad groups (keywords, ads, and bids) share location targeting, a budget, and other settings. It would be good to create at least one campaign before creating ads in your account.

It is possible to design different ad campaigns to run ads in various locations or by using different budgets, as shown in figure 3.1.



Figure 3.1: Organization of Products or Services in a Campaign

The campaign type selected for creation must be based on goals of advertising. For instance, if ads are to be displayed on Google in order to get additional visitors to the Website, the campaign type will be a Search Network campaign.

Every advertising network will have different kinds of campaigns according to the goals. This session, will provide the understanding about the major types of campaigns.

3.2 Campaign Settings

The campaign is tailored by adjusting the campaign settings. The selected campaign settings will apply to every ad in the same campaign. The campaign type identifies the available settings for the campaign.

3.2.1 Campaign Status

The column '**Status'** in the '**All online campaigns'** page depicts whether the campaigns are active or not, and also if they are limited by a budget. While inspecting the top-level statistics and account alerts, review the 'Status' column to check if campaigns are running correctly or fix the issues preventing the campaigns from running.

Complete the following steps to find the Status column:

1. Click the **Campaigns** tab as shown in figure 3.2 to obtain the '**All online campaigns'** page.
2. Search the **Status** column beside the **Budget** column.

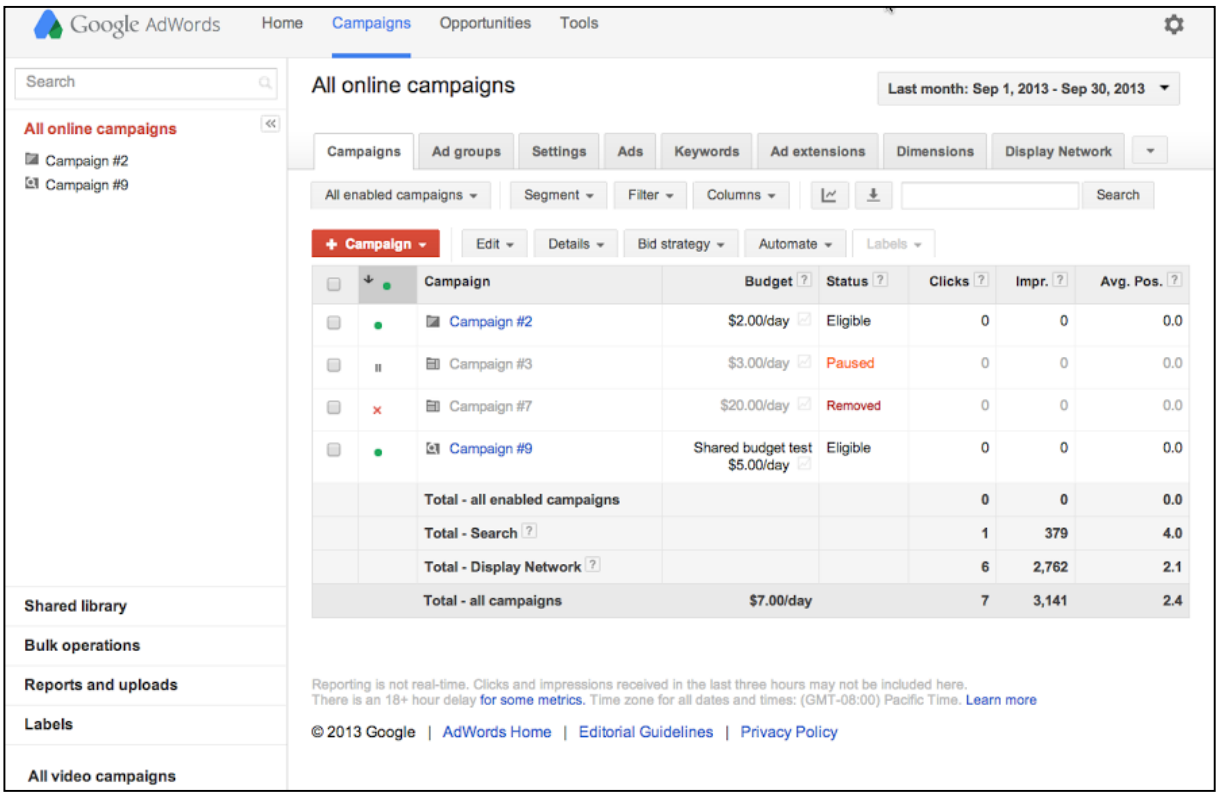


Figure 3.2: Campaigns Tab

The Status column shows details about the current state of every campaign in an account when one signs in to the AdWords account. In case the campaign is not functioning as expected, go to **'Ad groups', 'Ads', and 'Keywords'** tabs from the AdWords campaign page to ensure proper ad status, ad group status, and the keyword status and fix the issues that are preventing ads from running. For video campaigns, go to the **'Ads', 'Videos', and 'Targets'** tabs in the '**All video campaigns'** page to identify any issues and fix them. Table 3.1 lists various kinds of campaign status and their meaning.

Campaign status	Meaning
Eligible	Active and can display ads.

Paused	Inactive. It implies that ads don't display or gain new costs until resumed.
Removed	Inactive as it is removed. It permanently deletes the campaign.
Pending	Inactive, though scheduled to start at a future date.
Ended	Inactive as it has crossed its scheduled end date.
Suspended	Inactive as there is no prepaid account balance. It will not display ads or gain new costs until extra funds are added under 'Billing'.
Restricted by budget	Active, though occasionally showing ads due to budget restrictions. Move mouse on the bubble beside this status to view 'Recommended budget'.

Table 3.1: Campaign Status and their Meaning

3.2.2 Filter Campaigns

In case of many campaigns, to see a certain kind of campaign, one can refine the kinds of campaigns on the 'All online campaigns' page. Following steps will help to perform this:

1. In order to view the **All online campaigns** page, go to main **Campaigns** tab, click the **All enabled campaigns** link which is on the side of the navigation bar.
2. Click the drop-down button beneath the Campaigns tab and select whether you want to view **All enabled** campaigns or **All but removed** campaigns.
3. It is always easy to get back to the full complete list by just clicking **All** as shown in figure 3.3.

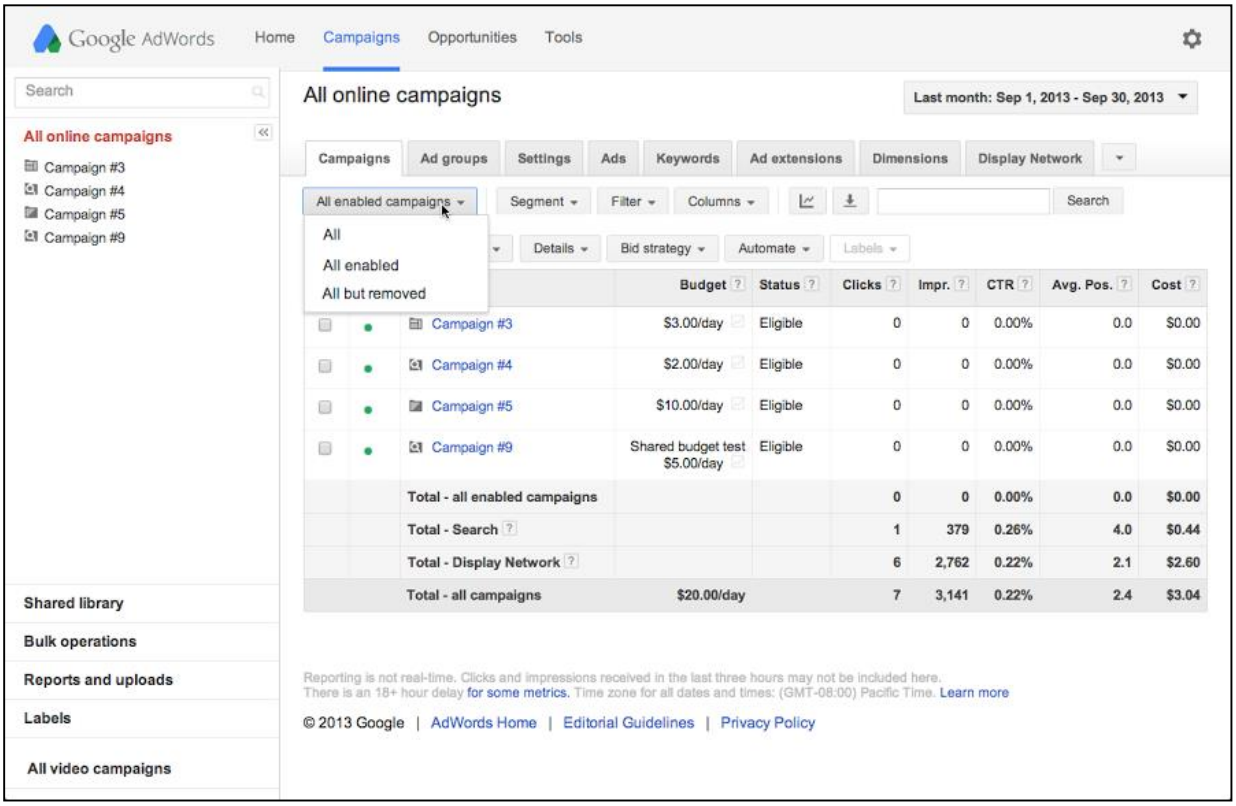


Figure 3.3: Filter Campaigns

3.2.3 Changing Campaign Settings

For every ad campaign that is designed, one can control the amount spent on clicks or conversions and which geographical locations and network ads should display. Campaign settings consist of budget, bidding options and adjustments, network, campaign end date, location targeting, and other settings which impact the complete campaign. Note that not all campaign settings are obtainable with each type of campaign.

Following are the general campaign settings, their meaning and ways to modify them:

- **Campaign name**: Edit the name of a specific campaign.
- **Campaign type**: Identifies which of the options and settings can be viewed while modifying the campaign.
- **Locations**: Helps to define geographic area for the ads. Target for maximum reach.
- **Languages**: Helps to define languages of the ad. Target by language preference of users.
- **Networks**: Identifies where the ads will display on the Internet
- **Devices**: By default, campaigns target all kinds of devices. If there are different kinds of campaign and if these targeting options are to be applied, consider making a 'Display Network only' campaign.
- **Bidding option:** For the ad clicks (Max. CPC), choose the manual or automatic bidding. Advanced options allows paying for per thousand viewable impressions (vCPM bidding) or establish a cost-per-acquisition bid (Conversion Optimizer, CPA bidding).

Note: One can decrease or increase the bids to have more control over where and when ad is displayed by setting bid adjustments.

- **Budget**: Helps to monitor campaign's daily budget whenever required.
- **Delivery method**: Select either accelerated or standard delivery for daily budget. It helps to find out how fast ads are displayed each day in case the campaign is having budget constraints.

Following are the advanced campaign settings, their meaning and ways to modify them:

- **Ad extensions**: Shows important business information including phone with the text ads. Allows managing and creating ad extensions.
- **Schedule (Start date, ad scheduling, end date):** Mentioning certain days or hours of the week will make the AdWords ads emerge at the specified schedule.
- **Ad delivery (Ad rotation and frequency capping)**: The ad rotation selection ascertains how often the active ads are delivered in association to another within an ad group. Frequency capping restricts the number of times the ads emerge on the Google Display Network to an exclusive user.
- **Automatic campaign optimization (Display Network only)**: A campaign is optimized by default based on the targeting elements that have been picked, such as audiences, keywords, or placements.
- **Experiment (BETA)**: Make experimental modifications to keywords bids and ad groups in the campaign.

3.2.4 Editing Campaign Settings

After creating a campaign, one can change its settings by performing the following steps:

1. Click the **Campaigns** tab.
2. Under **All campaigns**, click the campaign that needs to be edited.
3. Click the **Settings** tab.

4. Edit next to the settings to change them, as shown in figure 3.4.
5. Click **Save** after every change.

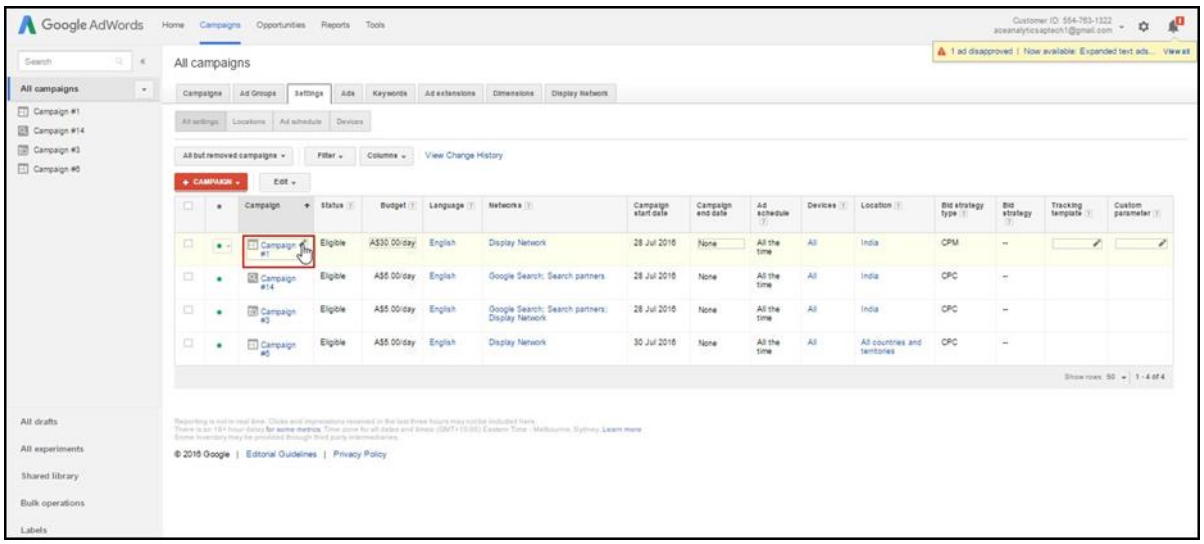


Figure 3.4: Editing your Campaign Settings

Following are the steps to edit the settings for numerous campaigns simultaneously:

1. Click the **Campaigns** tab.
2. Click the Settings sub-tab.
3. Check the box beside all the campaigns that need to be changed.
4. From the **Edit** menu, choose the attribute that need to be changed.
5. Mention the changes in the appearing box.
   Note: We advise to click **Preview changes** to view how the campaigns' settings will alter.
6. Click **Make changes**.

Note: On the **Campaign settings** tab, click **Filter** to display only campaigns that match particular criteria. This will make it easier to make modifications in bulk to specific campaigns.

3.3 Creating a Campaign

As you begin with the campaign setup, there will be a request to select a campaign type as well as a campaign subtype. The campaign type ascertains where users will see the provided ads but it can be made more particular by targeting your ads.

The types of campaign are:

- Search Network with Display Select
- Search Network only
- Display Network only
- Shopping
- Video

The subtype of campaign explains which options and settings are available. These options allow you to make changes to campaign. This is done for matching the business objectives as well as concentrate on the attributes which are most important.

The subtypes of campaign are:

- Standard
- All features

- Marketing objectives

The types of campaign revolve around Google's advertising networks are the Google Display Network, the Google Search Network, and the YouTube Network. Select a network setting by choosing a campaign type.

Following are the steps for creating a campaign:

1. Firstly, there is a need to sign in to the AdWords account.
2. Then, click the **Create your first Campaign** button on the **Campaigns** tab as shown in figure 3.5.



Figure 3.5: Creating a Campaign

3. Enter **Campaign name** and choose **Campaign Type** from the drop-down menu as shown in figure 3.6.

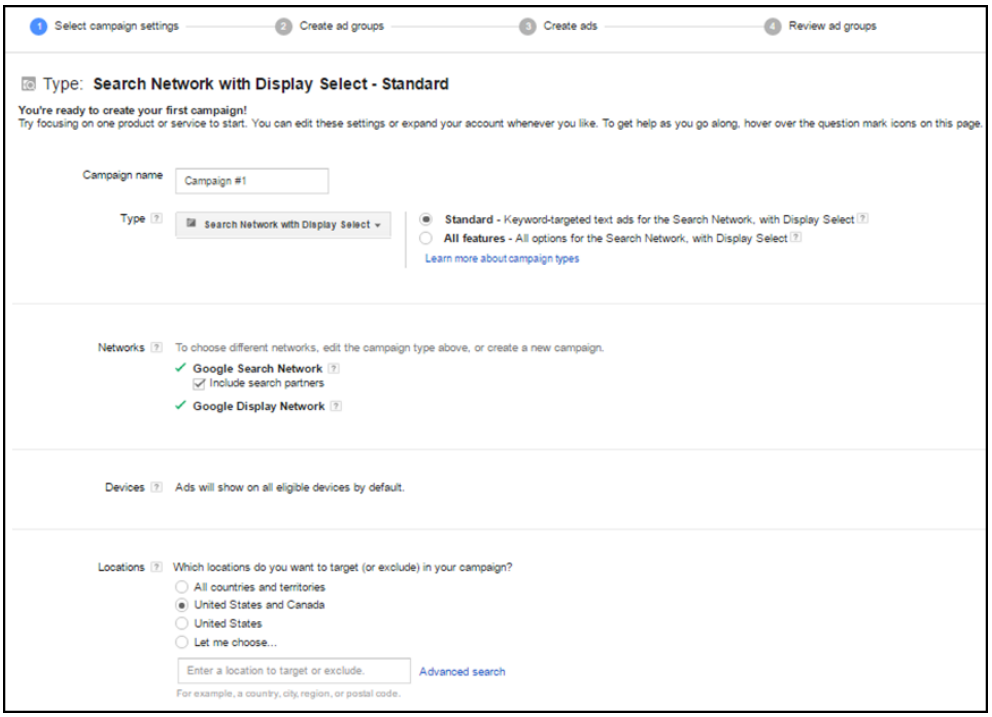


Figure 3.6: Creating Campaign of Search Network with Display Select

Choose the campaign type to use as shown in figure 3.7. Most advertisers use 'Search Network with Display Select' (suggested for new advertisers), 'Display Network only', or 'Search Network only', irrespective of the fact that there are other available campaign types as well.

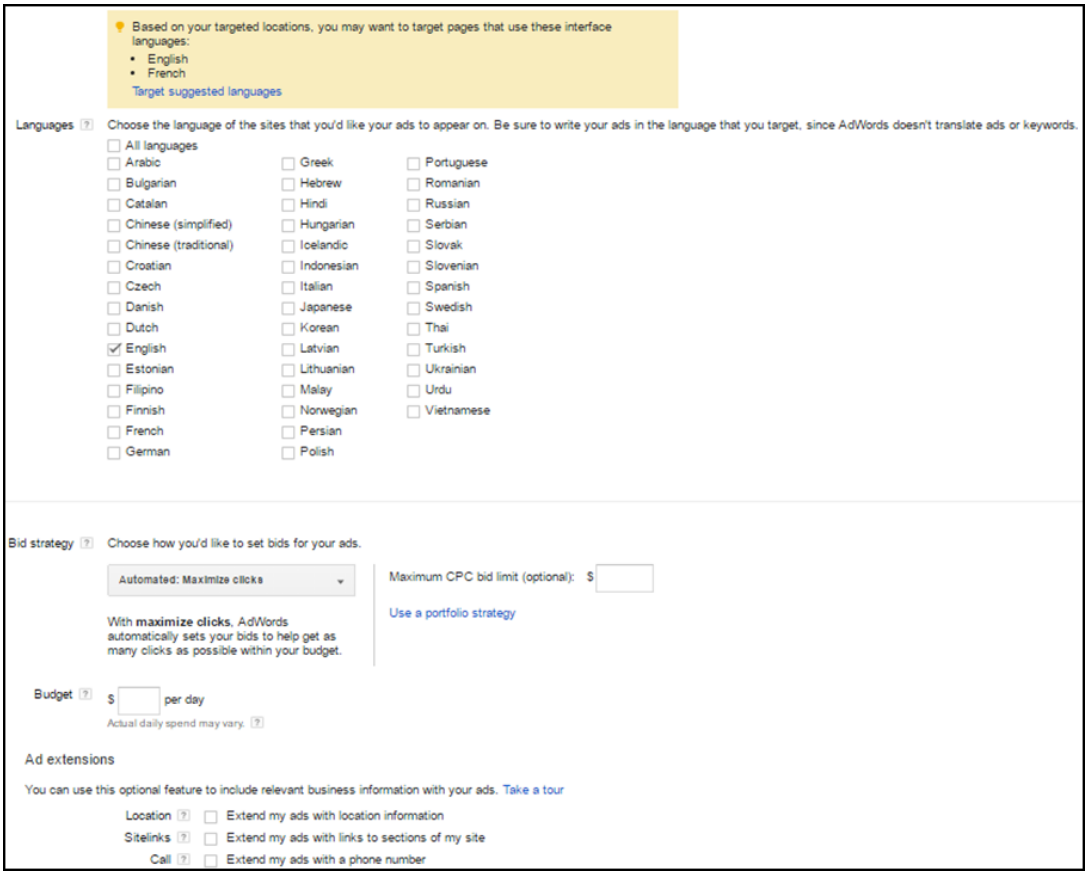


Figure 3.7: Selecting Campaign Type

4. Select the options for the following settings as shown in figures 3.8 and 3.9:
   - Networks
   - Devices
   - Locations
   - Languages
   - Bid strategy (from the drop-down menu)
   - Budget
   - Ad extensions

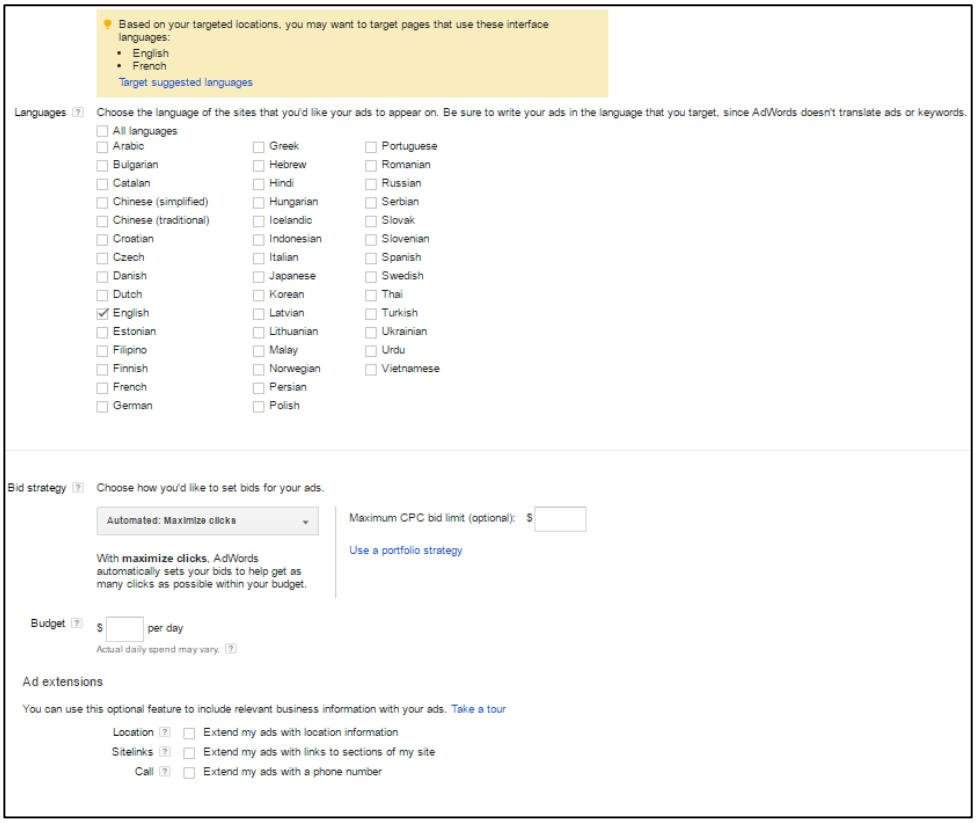


Figure 3.8: Campaign Settings

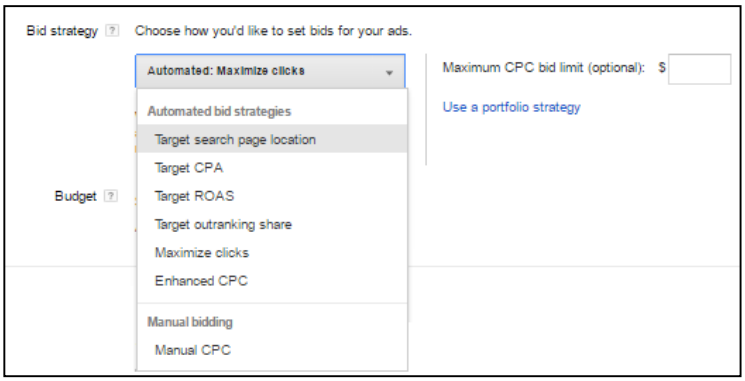


Figure 3.9: Choosing Bid Strategy

5. Click **Save and continue**.

Note: If you have previously set up a similar campaign and wish to use the exact settings, then the time can be saved by loading the settings from the current campaign into the new campaign. You will notice the '**or load settings from'** option as well as the drop-down menu exactly under the campaign type. If not, then copy and paste the current campaign from the '**Edit'** drop-down menu which lies on '**Campaigns'** tab. Ensure to check the box beside the campaign you wish to copy, select '**Copy'** from the '**Edit'** drop-down, and then select '**Paste'** to create the new campaign.

3.4 Creating Ad Groups

In a given AdWords campaign, an ad group allows to conveniently organize the default bids and status for one or more associated ads and their shared set of keywords.

For instance, consider you run an art supplies business. You can make an array of ads for water color paints and pile them into a single ad group called as 'water colors'. From the 'Ad groups' tab, you can pause all water colour ads simultaneously or raise the default bid of all the keywords to get more clicks. Figure 3.10 shows how to create ad groups by entering keywords that match the search words of the user. Also, the default bids can be organized along with the status of ad groups.

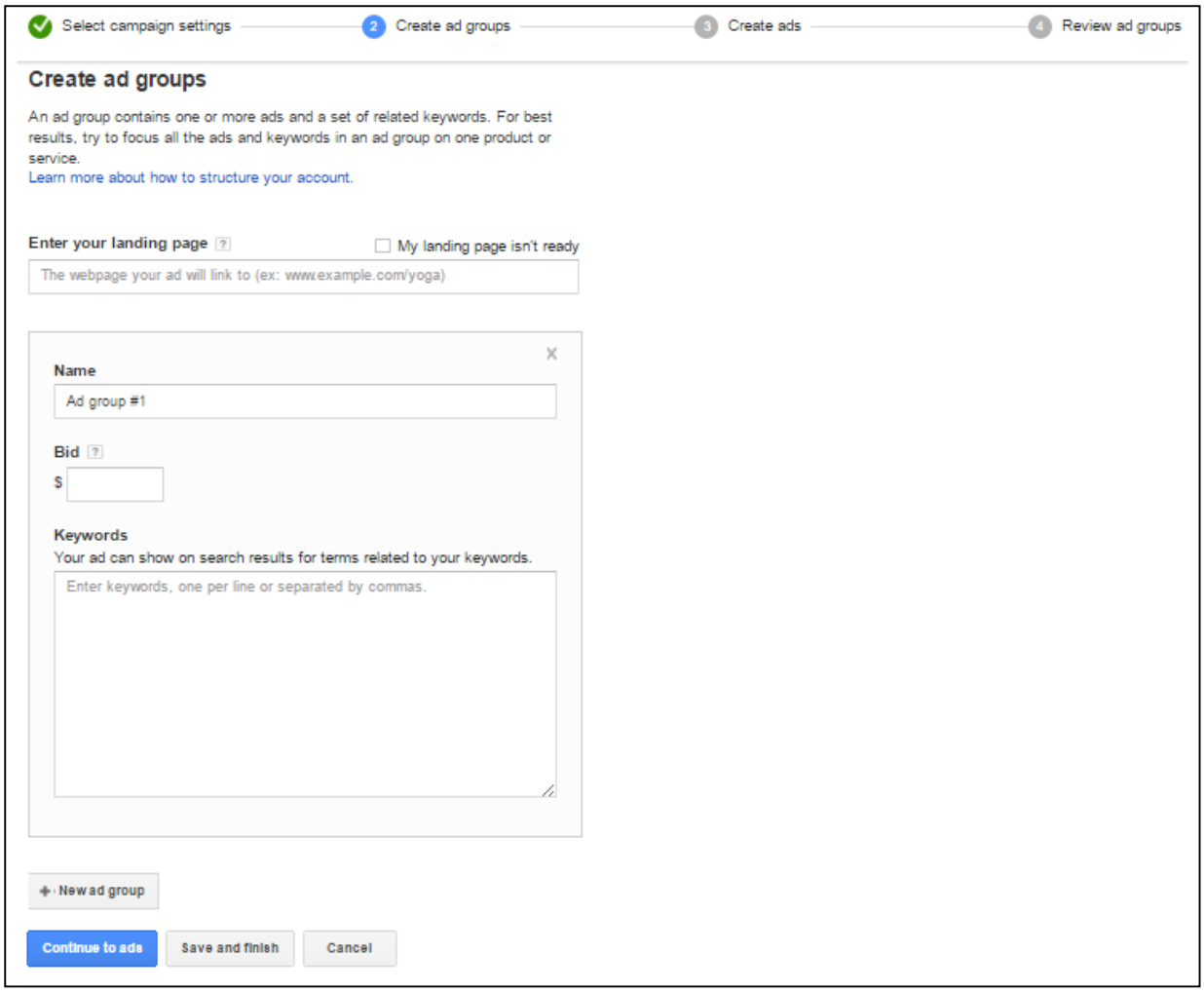


Figure 3.10: Creating Ad Groups

Following are the steps to create an adgroup:

1. Sign in to the AdWords account.
2. After that, click the **Campaigns** tab.
3. Under **All campaigns**, click the campaign's name for which the ad group is needed to be added.
4. Then, click the **Ad groups** tab.
5. Click the **+ AD GROUP** button as shown in figure 3.11.

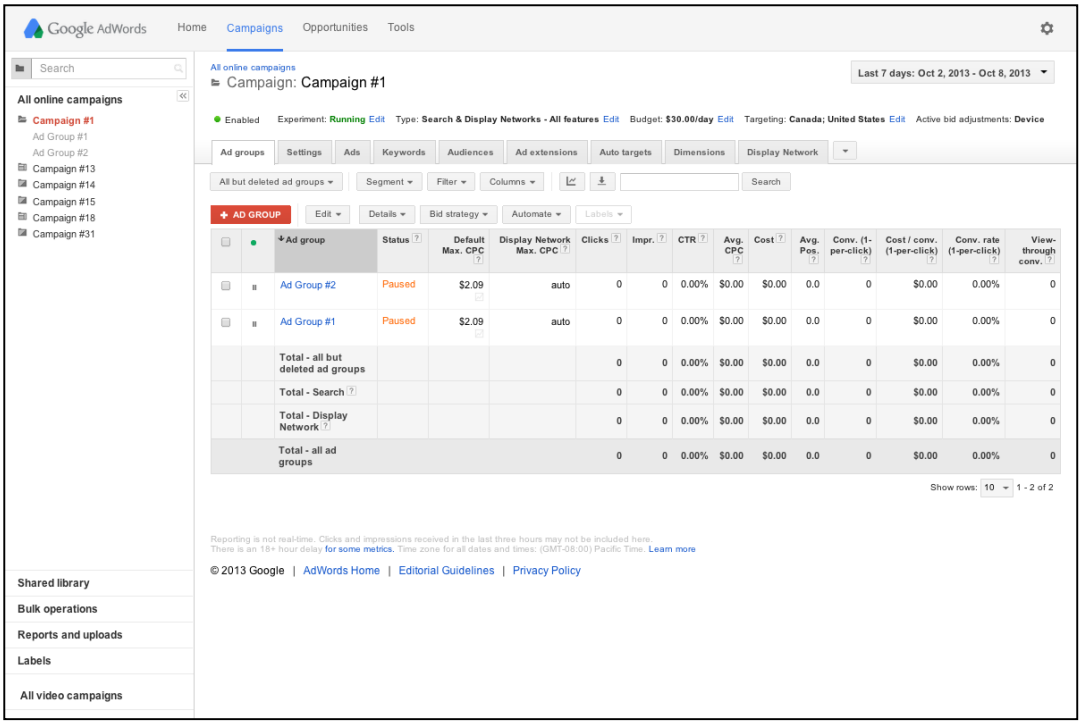


Figure 3.11: Settings in Creating Ad Group

6. On the **Create ad group** page that pops up, follow the guidelines to complete the new ad group (the option would be provided to make an initial ad as well as its keywords) as shown in figure 3.12.

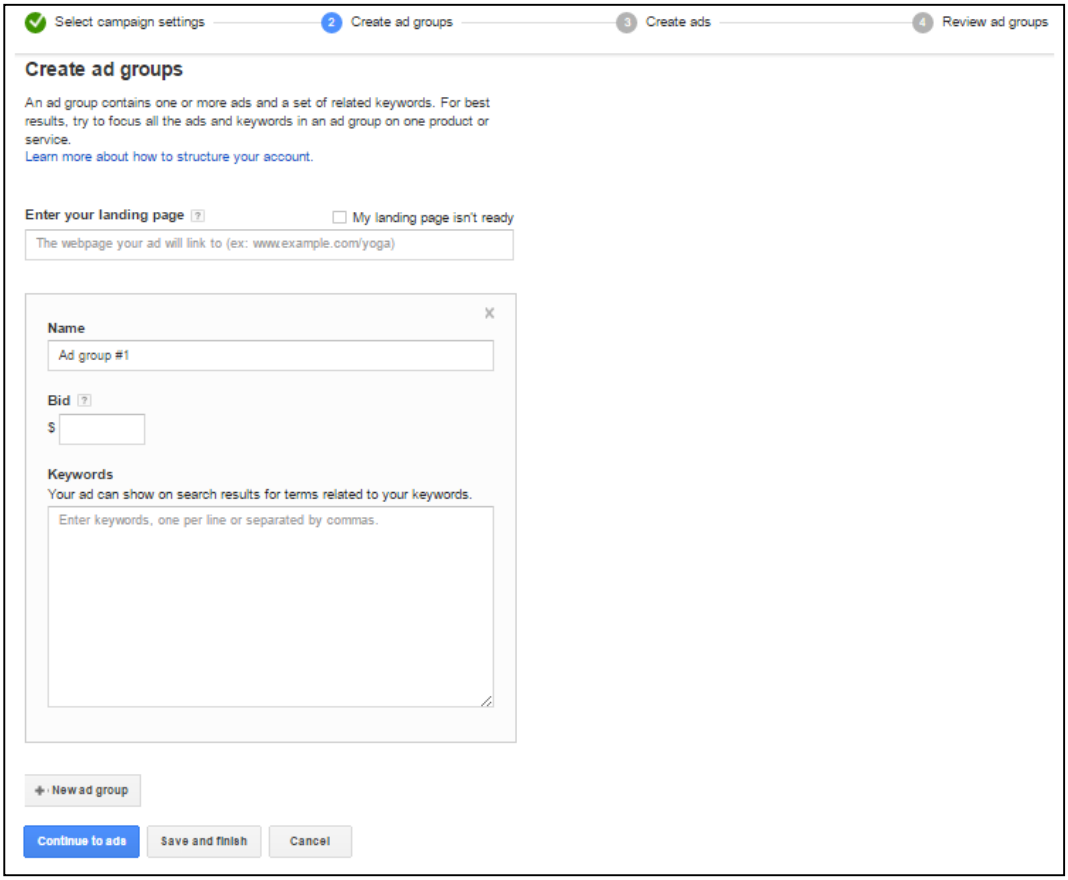


Figure 3.12: Creating Ad Group

7. Click **Save ad group.**

After creation of the new ad group, you will probably wish to fill it out with many more ads and keywords. To do this, click the ad group's name and then click **Ads or Keywords** tabs.

Note:

- A solo ad group may consist of up to 50 text ads, plus, up to 20,000 individual targeting items whereas, a solo campaign may have up to 20,000 ad groups.
- Use the keyword matching options to control which search terms will trigger your ad to emerge.

3.4.1 Editing Ad Groups

In the table, which is on the Ad groups tab, a single ad group can be changed by just hitting on its status icon or its bid which is in the '**Default Max. CPC'** column as shown in figure 3.13. To alter the ad group's name, click the pencil icon which appears when the cursor is beside the ad group's name.

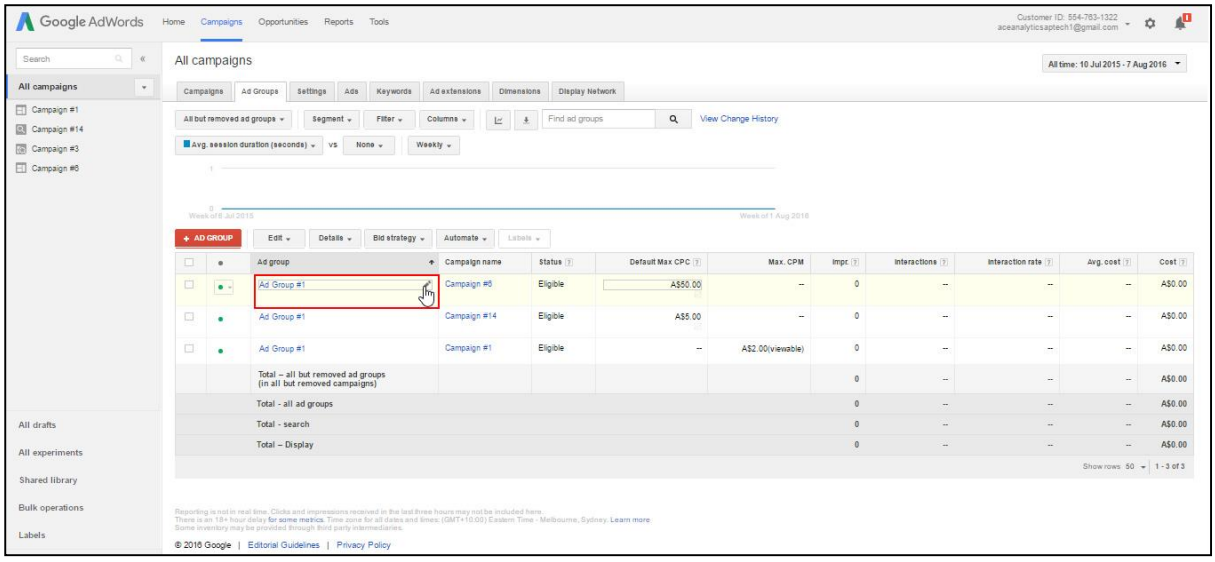


Figure 3.13: Editing Ad Groups

To 'batch edit' in the table which is on the Ad groups tab, click the checkbox beside one or more ad groups in order to enable the Edit button (or just click the header row's checkbox in order to 'Select all') as shown in figure 3.14. This lets to the editing of the status, name, as well as pricing for the chosen ad groups.

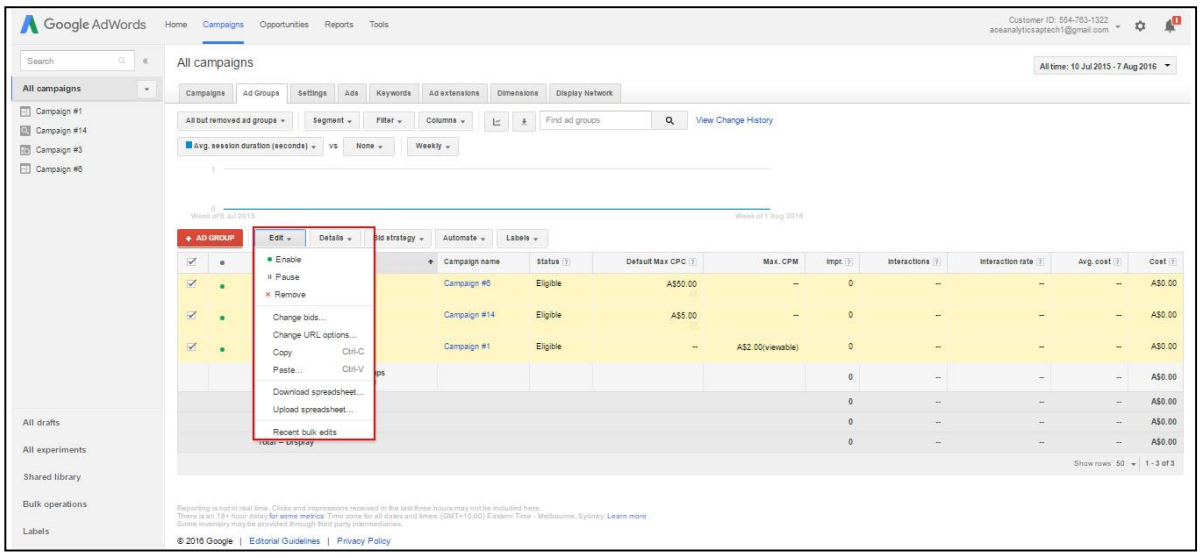


Figure 3.14: Batch Editing Ad Groups

3.5 Managing Campaign

Before designing any additional ads, one must have the knowledge of three-layer design of the AdWords. AdWords is structured into the following three layers as depicted in figure 3.15:

- **Account**: The account is linked with a unique e-mail address, password, and billing information.
- **Campaigns**: The campaigns have their personal budget and settings that tells where the ads appear.
- **Groups**: The ad groups consist of a group of similar ads and keywords.

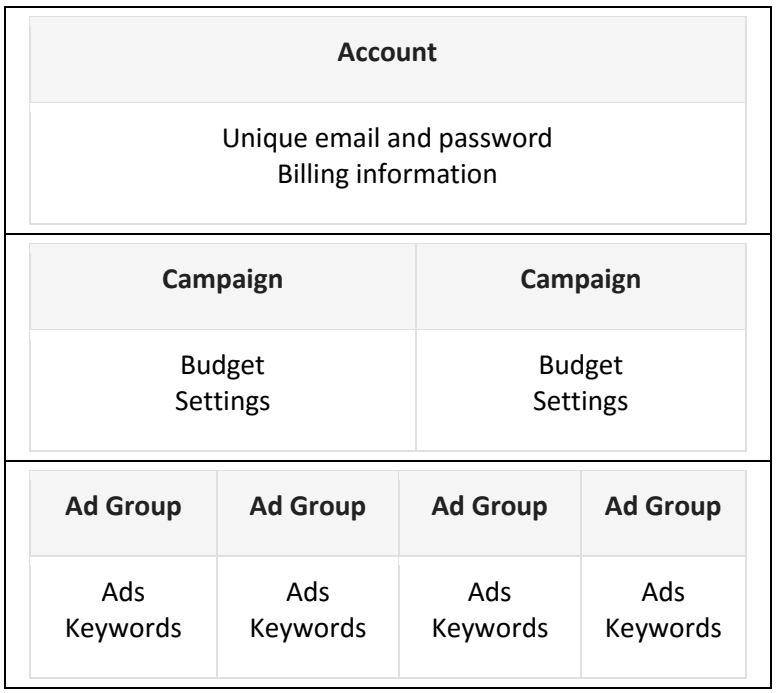


Figure: 3.15: Three-Layer Design of AdWords

3.5.1 Organizing Account with Ad Groups

While people search online, they type a phrase or word. This indicates that they are looking for the information that is closely related to those words.

To show ads that are important to the searches of people you are attempting to reach, bundle all the associated ads together with linked keywords into an ad group. In this way, all the associated ads can be displayed to users looking for similar things.

Note: A general method for managing an AdWords account is to manage it the way your Website is formed, with every ad group depicting a category or different page on the site.

Example 1

Consider that Mr. XYZ owns an online electronics store. He makes an AdWords account that lets him advertise his products. At the account level he may select who can have access to his AdWords account as well as preferred payment method. The upper most layer of his account may look as figure 3.16.

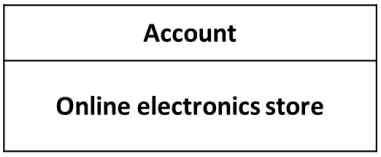


Figure: 3.16: Upper Most Layer of Campaign

He decided that he wants advertise the inventory including, televisions and cameras, so he makes a separate campaigns for each. By splitting the account into two different campaigns implies that he can give at least fifty percent of his online advertising budget to both the product area as shown in figure 3.17.

Campaign	Campaign
Cameras	Televisions

Figure: 3.17: Separating Two Campaigns

Concentrating on his camera campaign, can create many ad groups for various types of cameras, such as compact cameras and digital cameras. For his television campaign, he may create an ad group for each kind of television he sells, such as plasma TVs and flat screen as shown in figure 3.18.

Ad Group	Ad Group	Ad Group	Ad Group
Compact Cameras	Digital Cameras	Plasma TVs	Flat Screen TVs

Figure: 3.18: Creating Ad Groups

Within a specific ad group, he wish to select keywords that are closely related to his ad text. For his digital cameras ad group, he may try keywords for various brands, prices and models for the digital cameras he sell (he has to keep in mind that he follows trademark guidelines). On combining all of it collectively, his whole account structure looks as figure 3.19:

<table>
<tr><td colspan="4">Account</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="4">Unique email and password
Billing information</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">Campaign</td><td colspan="2">Campaign</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">Budget Cameras</td><td colspan="2">• Budget Televisions</td></tr>
<tr><td>Ad Group</td><td>Ad Group</td><td>Ad Group</td><td>Ad Group</td></tr>
<tr><td>Compact Cameras</td><td>Digital Cameras</td><td>Plasma TVs</td><td>Flat Screen TVs</td></tr>
</table>

Figure: 3.19: Collective Account Structure

3.5.2 About the AdWords Account Limits

The AdWords account has highest limits on areas such as maximum number of keywords. Though it may be unnoticed, ensure that these limits are kept in mind while planning the future advertising efforts.

Following are the limits for various sections of AdWords account:

- **Campaign and ad group restrictions (limits)**
  - 10,000 campaigns (includes paused and active campaigns)
  - 20,000 ad group target items for each ad group (such as keywords, placements, and audience lists)
  - 20,000 ad groups for each campaign
- **Ad limits**
  - 4 million active or paused ads for each account
  - 300 image for each gallery ad
  - 50 text and non-image per gallery ads for each ad group
- **Targeting limits**
  - 10,000 location targets, either(excluded and targeted, for each per campaign, including up to 500 proximity targets per campaign
  - 5 million ad group target items for each account (such as keywords, placements, and audience lists)
  - 65,000 placements for each negative placement list
  - 1 million campaign target items for each account (such as geo target and campaign-level negative keywords)
  - 11,000 shared budgets for each account
- **Negative keyword limits**
  - 10,000 negative keywords for each campaign
  - 20 shared negative keyword lists for each account
  - 5,000 keywords for each negative keyword list
- **Limits for business data and feeds**
  - 3,000 bytes for each attribute (750 - 3,000 characters approximately)
  - 5 million feed items or rows for each account for dynamic ads, ad customizers, and extensions
  - 100 business data sets or user-generated feeds for each account
- **Ad extension limits**
  - 10,000 ad group-level extensions for each campaign
  - 250,000 ad group-level extensions for each account
  - 50,000 campaign-level extensions for each account

3.6 Testing Campaigns

A **campaign draft** allows making many alterations to a Search or Display Network campaign devoid of impacting its performance. A draft can be used in following ways:

- The draft can be updated in the same way as it could be done in a normal campaign.
- After completing the draft, it can be applied to the same to the original campaign or do an experiment from the draft for testing the performance of the changes against the original campaign.

A **campaign experiment** allows verifying a draft's performance with the original campaign's performance. Experiments use a part of the original campaign's traffic as well as budget and function alongside the original campaign for a stipulated length of time. The features of experiment are:

- After creating a draft, it can be converted into an experiment.
- While an experiment is running, its performance can be monitored and compared against the original campaign. The experiment can also be terminated. Once the experiment is ended, it stops running only by the end of the day.
- For any campaign, only one experiment can be functioning at a time.
- Experiments are available only for Search and Display Network campaigns.

The results from experiments will aid in making good decisions and increase ROI. Let us understand this with the help of an example.

Example 2

Anthony, who works in a medium-sized clothing company, helps to manage the efforts of advertising for his company. His boss advises that he should attempt a new plan for their search ads and he wants Anthony to show him the possible changes in advance. Anthony forms a draft of the current campaign in his company's AdWords account. The draft allows him to make alterations at the campaign level prior to applying them to the campaign. After Anthony completes making alterations in the draft, he presents them to his boss, who approves them. From there, he puts the draft back to original campaign.

In the next quarter, Anthony and his boss conclude that they want to alter the bids for their campaign and want to be confident that these alterations will improve the performance. Anthony makes another draft having the bid changes and he runs a month long experiment for testing these changes with the original campaign. After gauging the experiment's results, during the end of the month, Anthony observes that his bid alterations performed positively and he then applies his experiment to original campaign. Thus, the results from his experiments have helped Anthony to make good decisions and increase his company's ROI.

3.6.1 Campaign Drafts

Drafts help in preparing numerous changes to a campaign devoid of impacting its performance. From there, the drafts can be updated in the same way as in a normal campaign. At any point, one may leave and return to the draft to make extra changes to it, or can abandon the draft altogether.

Following reports and features are not available for drafts:

- Dimensions tab
- Ad schedule report
- Auction Insights
- Category and Search terms Display Placements report
- Scheduled e-mail reports
- AdWords Campaign Experiments
- Bid landscapes
- Ad customizers that use 'Target ad group' or 'Target campaign'
- AdWords Campaign Experiments
- Keyword diagnosis
- Some portfolio bid strategies:
  - Maximize clicks
  - Target outranking share
  - Target search page location
  - Target Return on Ad Spend (ROAS)

Setting up a campaign draft

Following elaborates how to make a draft and what can be done after that:

1. Click the **Campaigns** tab at the top.
2. Choose the campaign name on which the draft has to be made.
3. Click the Draft drop-down which is on the upper-right corner and select **Create new**.
4. Enter a name for the draft, and click **Create**.
5. The new draft will be opened. Any alterations made to the draft will be automatically saved. You can leave the draft or finish making alterations at any time.

After being satisfied with the draft, the alterations can be applied to the original campaign or make an experiment by clicking Apply, which is on the top right corner.

Note: Campaign drafts are different from drafts that are made in AdWords Editor. Campaigns drafts are used to make the experiment. On the other hand, the drafts in AdWords Editor are the campaigns that you still do not want to export to the account.

Campaign draft status

To observe drafts table, click **All drafts** from the menu which is on the left. Every draft in the drafts table must have a corresponding status fixed to it, which can be seen in the 'Status' column.

Following lists what each status implies:

- **Pending**: The draft has been formed.
- **Applying**: The draft is being attached to the original campaign.
- **Unapplied changes**: The draft cannot be attached to the original campaign**.**
- **Applied**: The draft is now attached to the original campaign.
- **Removed**: The draft has been removed and so can no longer be attached to a campaign or employed to create an experiment.

3.6.2 Campaign Experiments

After finishing the draft, instead of applying the changes to original campaign, draft can be converted into an experiment. When a user searches Google or the partner Website, the original campaign or the experiment active for the auction will be made active randomly, depending on how have divided the traffic share amongst the campaign and the experiment.

Setting up a campaign experiment

Following steps show how to set up an experiment and apply the changes to the original campaign:

1. Click **All drafts** from the menu which is on the left, then click the name of the draft has to be edited.
2. Click the **Apply** button which is on the top right corner.
3. Select **Run an experiment**.
4. Enter a name for the experiment. The experiment should not have the same name as the campaigns or other experiments.
5. Select a start date for the experiment.
6. If you wish to manually end the experiment, then select '**No end date**'. Else, select an end date for the experiment.
7. Enter a percentage of the traffic of the original campaign that wished to be assigned to the experiment. This also becomes the percentage of the budget of the original campaign you will be assigning to the experiment.
8. Click **Create** to complete creating the experiment.

Following factors must be considered about experiments:

- You can arrange about five experiments for a campaign; however, just run one experiment can be run at a time.
- It might take some time for the experiment's ads for finishing the review process and start running, which depends on the size of the original campaign. While the experiment is running, its performance can be monitored.
- While running an experiment, editing the draft can be done and can employ it to make a new experiment after the existing experiment ends.
- If any alterations are made to the original campaign, then those alterations to the experiments or the original campaign at the time when the experiment is running.

In some cases, an error can be encountered when attempting to create an experiment. So, following are some reasons why this happens, and steps by which errors can be resolved:

- **Your original campaign has been removed**: Attempt to make a draft from a different campaign.
- **Your original campaign possesses a shared budget**: Discard the campaign's shared budget.
- **Already, your original campaign has an experiment going on running or is scheduled during your chosen dates**: Try choosing dates that do not overlap with another experiment.
- **Your campaign has attributes that are not supported by experiments**: Try choosing a different campaign for converting into an experiment.

When the experiment has to be ended, then you can apply it to the original campaign. The experiment can be changed to a new campaign:

- If the experiment is applied to the original campaign, the alterations that were testing in the experiment shall be applied to the original campaign.
- If the experiment is changed or converted into new campaign, then the original campaign shall be paused and the experiment will display in 'All Campaigns' having the same budget and dates as the original campaign.

In both cases, the performance data of the experiment will be preserved.

Experiments normally support the same attributes as campaigns, with some exemptions:

- Ad customizers that use 'Target campaign' or ' Target ad group'
- AdWords Campaign Experiments
- Some flexible bidding strategies:
  - Maximize clicks
  - Target search page location
    - Target outranking share
  - Target Return on Ad Spend (ROAS)

Campaign experiment status

To see the experiments table, click **All experiments** from the menu which is on the left. Every experiment in the '**All experiments'** table must have a corresponding status fixed to it that can be found in the '**Status'** column.

Following explains what each status implies:

- **Creating**: The experiment is being formed.
- **Active**: The experiment is running.
- **Scheduled**: The experiment is scheduled to start running for a future date.
- **Finished**: The experiment is complete.
- **Applying**: The experiment is being attached to the original campaign.
- **Applied**: The experiment is attached to the original campaign.
- **Unable to apply**: The experiment cannot be attached to original campaign. Click this status to know why and to attempt applying the experiment again.
- **Unable to create**: The experiment cannot be created.
- **Removed**: The experiment has been ended or removed and cannot be applied to a campaign.
- **New Campaign**: The experiment has been switched or converted to a new campaign.

The campaign experiments can be monitored using the following steps:

1. Expand the menu on the left, and click the name of the experiment to see the performance under the **All experiments** header. A page will open which shows information of the experiment and a comparison of the key metrics for the experiment as well as its original campaign.
2. To modify the date range for this data, make use of the date drop-down which is on the top right corner. Note that only the data between the start and end dates of the experiment will be seen.

3. To view the comparison or assessment at the ad group level, select the Ad groups tab beneath the table. Click the ad group you want to see the data.

Table 3.2 shows a comparison of the experiment's key metrics to the original campaign and the arrows icons for each metric.

Icon	Statistical significance ((1-p) value)
No icon	Not enough data
	<95%
	95%-99%
	99%-99.9%
	>99.9%

Table 3.2: Comparison of the Experiment's Key Metrics to that of the Original Campaign

Following are some specific features of the comparison:

- The direction of the arrows depicts whether the values of experiment are more or less than the original campaigns.
- Statistical significance is indicated by the number of arrows or chances of differences that are not due to chance or possibility. At the most, three arrows  can appear in same direction. Showing up of more arrows will imply that is not because of chance.
- A diamond  depicts that results are not statistically significant. Following are few reasons due to which the results may not be statistically significant:
  - The experiment did not have enough time to run.
  - The campaign did not receive much traffic.
  - The traffic split was too small and the experiment is not receiving much traffic.
  - The chances have not resulted in a statistically significant performance difference.
- Experiments that are having more statistically significant results result in carrying on performing with similar results after they are converted to a campaign.

3.7 Summary

- A campaign is a collection of associated ad groups that is frequently used to manage categories of services or products on offer.
- The AdWords account may have one or more ad campaigns running.
- Separate ad campaigns can be made to manage ads in various locations or using different budgets.
- For every ad campaign that is made, there should be a control spending on clicks and conversions, which geographical locations and networks the ads should be displayed on.
- Campaign settings consist of the budget, bidding options and adjustments, networks, campaign end date, location targeting, and other settings which affect an entire campaign.
- A campaign's status influences all ads and ad groups.
- The campaign type explains where customers will see the ads.
- The campaign subtype explains which options and settings are available.
- Campaign types revolve around Google's advertising networks.
- Within an AdWords campaign, an ad group allows managing the default bids and status for one or more associated ads and their shared set of keywords.
- AdWords is managed into three layers: account, campaigns, and ad groups.
- Managing the account enables users to serve the appropriate ads to the appropriate customers.
- A group of ad groups forms a campaign.
- A campaign draft allows preparing numerous changes to a Search or Display Network campaign devoid of impacting its performance.
- A campaign experiment allows testing the draft’s performance with the original campaign's performance.
- AdWords Campaign Experiments lets testing alterations to the account on a part of the auctions which the ads participate in.
- Campaign drafts differ from drafts that are made in AdWords Editor.

3.8 Check Your Progress

1. Which of the following can be set at the campaign level?
   a. Budget
   b. Language
   c. Location
   d. All of these

2. Which of the following needs to be checked and fixed if one discovers that the campaign is not running as per the expectations?
   a. Ad group status
   b. Ad status
   c. Keyword status
   d. All of these

3. AdWords is organized into:
   a. Account, campaigns, and ad groups
   b. Account, campaigns, and ads
   c. Account, campaign drafts, and ad groups
   d. Bids, campaigns, and ads

4. Which among the following statement is not true for Campaign Draft?
   a. Campaign draft use a part of original campaign's budget and traffic
   b. You can apply draft to the original campaign
   c. When creating a draft, the campaign's setup are actually being mirrored
   d. An experiment can be created from the draft

5. Which among the following statement is not true for Campaign experiment?
   a. It allows testing the performance of the draft against the performance of the original campaign
   b. It run with the original campaign up to a specific time length
   c. Once the experiment is ended, it will stop running immediately
   d. For any particular campaign, only a single experiment can be running at one time

6. Which among the following feature is not supported by Campaign Experiments?
   a. Ad customizers that use "Target campaign
   b. Schedule 10 experiments for a campaign
   c. Maximize clicks bidding strategy
   d. Customizers that use Target ad group

3.8.1 Answers

1	**d**
2	**d**
3	**a**
4	**a**
5	**c**
6	**b**

SESSION 4 - ADWORDS FORMATS AND GUIDELINES

Session Objectives:

This session explains the various ad formats in AdWords and the guidelines for creating ads. It also explains how to create dynamic display ads.

At the end of this session, you will be able to:

- Understand various ad formats in AdWords
- Know the guidelines of creating ads
- Create dynamic display ads

4.1 Introduction

The ads in Google AdWords can be displayed on a Web page in various formats. They could be text ads, images, videos, or any other media. This session identifies and describes the various ad formats that are used in AdWords. The session also focuses on the concepts of creating each of these different ad formats. Finally, the session describes the guidelines and best practices to be used while creating the different ad formats.

There are various methods available to display an ad on a Web page. It could be a simple text message that describes the product or it could be some text along with an image of the product. It also could be an animated image of the product or some other media using which the ad is displayed. The Google Ad Formats define how a particular ad may be displayed on a Web page. All AdWords advertisings should necessarily meet the primary requirement to represent the advertiser's site clearly and accurately. Moreover, it should emphasize over the advantages associated with the product or service advertised by the advertiser.

Details about the business can be displayed visually for searching the ads. More information can be provided in enhancements to display in ads above the search results. There is a possibility for doing these enhancements through manual or automated formatting systems.

Few tips regarding ad formats are as follows:

- Ad extensions are widely used type of ad format that show extra information about the advertiser's products or business. Some extensions can be added manually while some are automated. For example, a location extension using which the advertiser's business address location is added to the ad, a call extension that enables people to click a button to give the advertiser a phone call, and so on.
- Google's automated formatting system can help to add details from the advertiser's Web site or other content along with the ads. For example, an advertiser can display Facebook followers of the business.
- Google's automated system depicts details regarding the advertiser to make the search narrower. For example, it shows the headline noticeably using the words that the advertiser chose.
- Google Shopping ads are usually not recognized as ad formats.

4.2 Ad Formats

The text ads that emerge alongside the Google search results are an example of only one type of ad format that can be created with AdWords. There are numerous other types which can be used to promote the products and services such as image ads, video ads, and digital, or app content ads.

Every ad format has its own advantages, whether it is the simplicity and affordability of running a text ad or the colorful storytelling which comes with a video ad. Various types of ads can be run from the same AdWords account as well as in some cases, from the same campaign. Table 4.1 shows various ad formats that are available in an AdWords account.

Format	Description	Key Benefits
Text	Words only. * Boston's Best Bonsais Ad - www.example.com Florist And Indoor Plant Nursery. Spruce Up Your Desk Today!	Maintain ads speedily and easily. Reach customers when they are searching on Google.
Ad extensions	Extends the ads using more information, such as extra links to Web site, phone number, or store address. These formats generally appear just across the Search Network. However, call extensions and location extensions may also emerge across Google Display Network. Amherst Ice Cream Parlour Ad - www.example.com (413) 123-4567 Our specialty is cashews. English majors, buy 2 get 1 free. 101 Dardanelles Rd, Amherst MA	Supply with extra contact information and details which can make ads more important to customers. Ads can be chosen to extend for the mobile devices a bit differently than how ads are extended for computers and tablets.
Image	Interactive or Static graphics. Animated ads in .gif and Flash format may be used as shown in figure 4.1.  **Figure 4.1: Image Ad** (Image courtesy: https://support.google.com/adwords/answer/1722124?hl=en&ref_topic=3121941)	Display product or service in a visual way. Get in touch with customers on Web sites that are associated with Google.

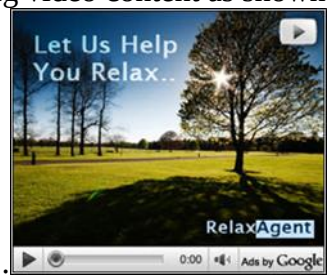
Format	Description	Key Benefits
App promotion ads	Drive app downloads as well as engagement with app promotion ads.	Drive customers to download app only from an app store or incorporate an association directly into app. **Note**: Ads will emerge only on devices that are compatible with the content.
Video	Video ads that are displayed online. Run standalone video ads or insert them in the streaming video content as shown in figure 4.2.  **Figure 4.2: Video Ad** (Image courtesy: https://support.google.com/adwords/answer/1722124?hl=en&ref_topic=3121941)	Deliver engaging and rich experience to customers. Get in touch with customers on Web sites that partner with Google.
Shopping ads	Text ads that have pricing information and product features as shown in figure 4.3. These ads are directed to the product purchase page which is on Web site.  **Figure 4.3: Shopping Ads** (Image courtesy: https://support.google.com/adwords/answer/1722124?hl=en&ref_topic=3121941)	Drive customers to learn about the products that is sold prior to their clicking to Web site.
Call-only ads	Call:(555)555-555 Ad - www.abcd.com Description Line 1 Description Line 2	Direct phone calls to the business using ads that has phone number. Users can click these ads and can call the business directly. These ads will just emerge on the devices that make the phone calls and any field in these ads may hide to fit on the smaller screens.

Table 4.1: Ad Formats Available in AdWords

Note - Text ads may appear different on the Display Network.

4.2.1 Campaign Types and Ad Formats

The ad formats which are accessible depend on the type of campaign (Display Network only, Search Network only, and Search Network with Display Select) as well as campaign sub-type (for instance, Standard or All features).

Mobile Ads and Campaigns

Some campaign types just display ads on mobile, including, app promotion campaigns or call-only campaigns. To know how these ads emerge before customers on the go, Refer to table 4.2 for ad formats accessible with every campaign type.

Campaign type	Text ad	Image ad	App promotion ad	Shopping ad	Dynamic Search Ad	Video ad	Call-only ad
Search Network with Display Select – Standard	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Search Network with Display Select - All features	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Search Network only - Call-only	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Search Network only - Mobile app installs	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Search Network only – Standard	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Search Network only - All features	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗
Search Network only - Dynamic search ads	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
Display Network only - All features	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗
Display Network only - Marketing objectives →	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗

Campaign type	Text ad	Image ad	App promotion ad	Shopping ad	Dynamic Search Ad	Video ad	Call-only ad
Install mobile app							
Display Network only - Marketing objectives → Buy on Web site	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗

Table 4.2: Ad Formats Accessible with Every Campaign Type

Note: If one chooses 'Search Network with Display Select - All features' or some of the 'Display Network only' campaign types, he/she can then access to the Ad gallery which is an ad-creation tool, is provided. However, the actual ad formats depend on the selected campaign type which is available in the Ad gallery.

Go through the following steps to choose an ad format:

1. Choose the campaign as well as the ad group in which the new ad is to be created.
2. Click the **Ads** tab.
3. Click the **+ Ad** drop-down button.
4. Select the desired format of the ad to create and follow the instructions which are listed for that ad format.
5. Click **Save**.

After saving the ad, the new ad can be viewed from the Ads tab. However, ads might not run until they are reviewed or approved, which may take seconds or days, based on the format.

4.2.2 Tips for Creating Effective Display Ads

If anybody is new to designing image-based display ads or prefer to enhance the display ad performance, the following tips will help in achieving the same:

- Use text, color, and image schemes effectively
- Experiment with different content designs and display ad types
- Utilize templates within the Ad gallery
- Create personalized custom images
- Create display ads that are based on the existing text ads

4.3 Creating Ads of Different Formats

In this section let us understand how to create different ad formats such as text ads, image ads, HTML ads, video ads, and mobile ads.

4.3.1 Creating a Text Ad

Every text ad consists of a headline, some lines of text explaining business, along with a clickable link to Web site. Subsequently, while the AdWords text ad emerges next to the search results along with the other Web sites which partner with Google, customers can connect with the business directly.

Text ads appear as classified ads, and have a link to Web site. Figure 4.4 shows an example of a text ad on the Search Network.

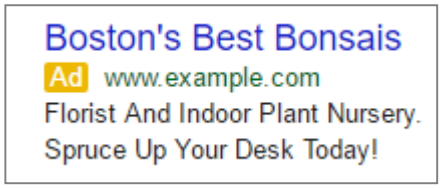


Figure 4.4: Text Ad

Text ads may appear different on the Display Network.

The AdWords text ads are those that are essentially made up of text content. These are the most basic type of ads and are generally known as the 'sponsored links'.

Text ad is a standard type of AdWords ad; it contains a link to the user Web site and a promotion or description of the user product or service.

The text ads created by the advertiser are available for the clients to view on Google, the Google Display Network, and Search partner Web sites. When the search query specified by the client matches or nearly matches the ad text or part of it, then the matching part of the ad text appears bold on the search sites. Generally, the text ads are allowed up to 25 characters for the ad title, 70 characters for actual ad text, and 35 characters for the URL that will be displayed along with the ad. Note that this number of characters includes blank spaces too.

The text ad appears on the search page in four lines with ad title on one line, ad text on two lines, and display URL on the last line. However, the Google partner sites may not have the same format for displaying text ads.

- In a text ad, a title is provided as a clickable link that leads to the advertiser's Web site and contains one or two lines of text. The Web site address is highlighted in green.
- Text ads are displayed in the Google search results and Google Network Web pages.
- Text ads might appear differently on the Display Network, or on mobile.
- In order to indicate viewers that text ads are paid promotions, they often appear with language that portrays them as advertisements.

Refer to figure 4.5 for text ad guidelines and the steps for creating a text ad:

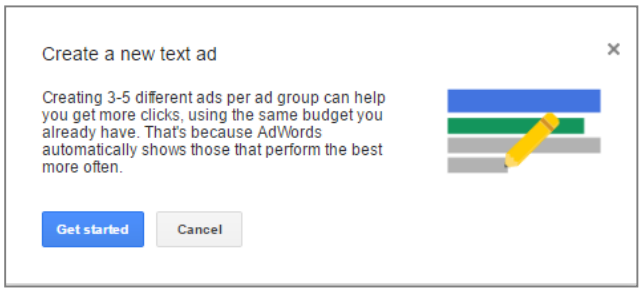


Figure 4.5: Text Ad Guidelines

1. Firstly, sign in to your AdWords account.
2. Then, click the Campaigns tab.
3. Select the campaign in the left menu in order to add the new text ad to.
4. Click the Ads tab.

5. To select 'Text ad', click + Ad. Refer to figure 4.6 for adding ad in Campaign tab.

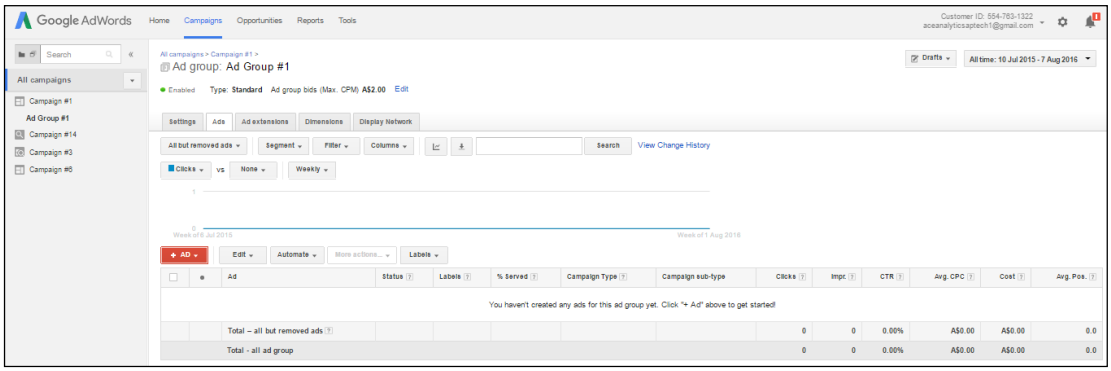


Figure 4.6: Adding Ad in Campaign Tab

6. Click Choose for selecting the ad group in order to add the new text ad. Refer to figure 4.7 for adding ad to Ad Group.

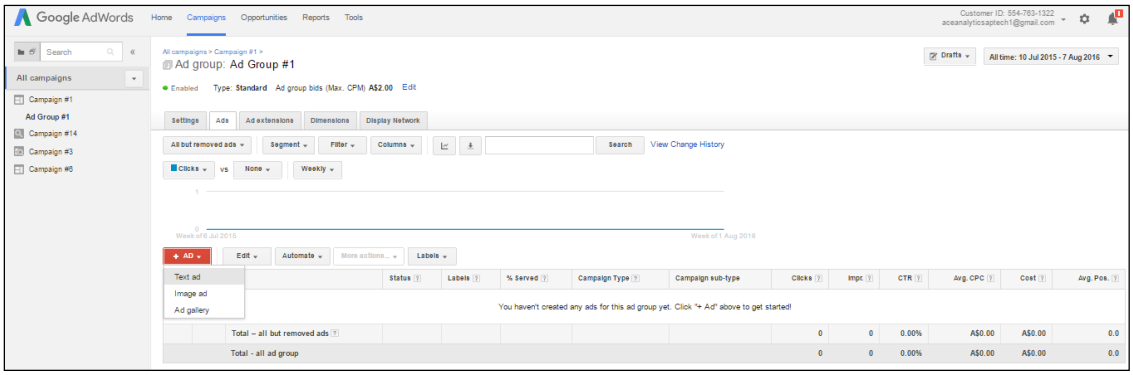


Figure 4.7: Adding Ad to Ad Group

7. Select the Switch to go back to the standard text ads.

8. Now, enter a headline, display URL, short description, as well as landing page URL. While typing, the ad will emerge immediately in the 'Ad preview'. Refer to figure 4.8 for inserting ad content.

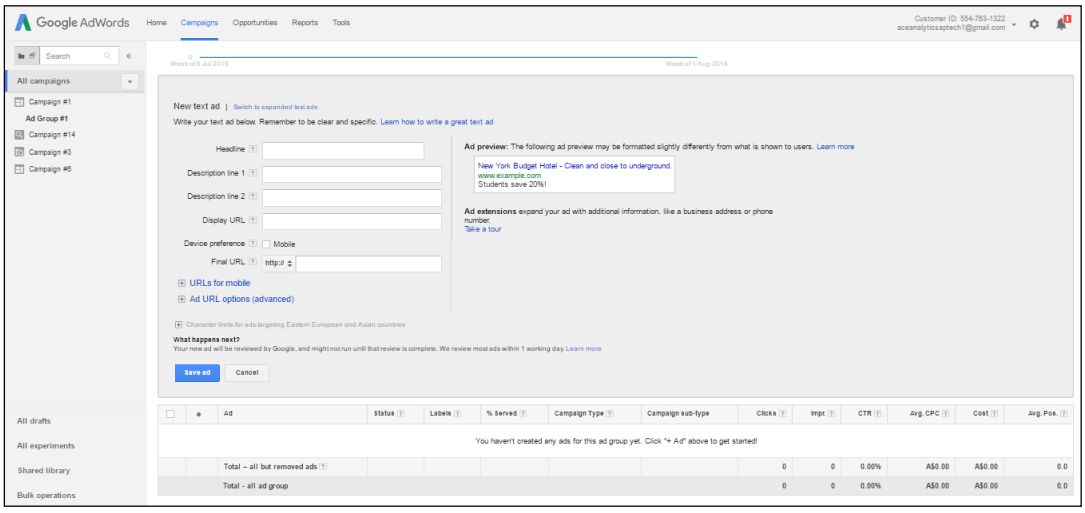


Figure 4.8: Inserting Ad Content

9. In case of adding an extra ad to the ad group, there will be an option for creating a mobile-optimized ad. For doing so, refer the 'Mobile' box which is next to 'Device preference' setting.

10. Click Save ad to save the final ad.

4.3.2 Creating Image Ads

Before creating image ads, let us get familiar with the dimensions of some of the very common ad sizes. Image ads can be designed of different sizes with the Ad Gallery templates or by uploading one's own custom ads. The dimensions of ads seen on a computer vary from ads seen on a mobile.

Computer: Common Ad Dimensions

Following are the example dimensions of ads when people view them on a computer. At the time of viewing this on a mobile, these example sizes might not render appropriately:

250 x 250

200 x 200

468 x 60

728 x 90

300 x 250

336 x 280

120 x 600

160 x 600

300 x 600

970 x 90

Mobile: Common Ad Dimensions

Following are the example dimensions of ads for high-end mobile devices:

320 x 50

200 x 200

250 x 250

300 x 250

320 x 100

Now that we have an idea about the ad dimensions, let us understand how to create an image ad.

The AdWords image ads use static or animated graphics along with text for presentation of the ads. It must be noted that the image ads do not appear on regular search sites. They appear only on those sites in the Google Display Network that have chosen to be a part of image ads program. However, it will be noticed that many sites that are a part of Google Display Network (but may not have explicitly chosen to be a part of image ads program) also display image ads.

Graphical interface combined with AdWords targeting technology make image ads, a powerful media to reach clients. This enables the advertisers to display images in response to the user search query along with the accuracy of corresponding ads on the Display Network sites.

In order to create an image ad, the advertiser first needs to confirm that the ad campaign has opted to be a part of Google Display Network. This is because only Google Display Network placements have the ability to run image ads. The next step is to create an image ad by clicking the Ads tab of the ad group under which the ad is to be created. Then, select the New ad drop-down list. If the image for the ad is already available, then select Image ad from the drop-down list. AdWords will prompt the advertiser to upload the image at this point and also specify the destination URL for this ad.

Providing a clear and descriptive name to the uploaded image will simplify the reporting. This will also help the advertiser to clearly communicate with the AdWords client services team. Few restrictions and guidelines for naming the ad images are as follows:

- The image name should not exceed 50 characters.
- The image should have a description that helps to identify the image.
- The image should have the campaign or ad group name.
- An image ad is comprised an image provided by the user that features information about the business, service, or product. Whenever people click the image ad, they will be directed to the advertiser's Web site.
- Image ads appear on Web pages and other places in the Display Network.
- A static image, animated image, or a Flash format file with varying sizes can be used in the advertiser's image ad.
- To run an image ad, the advertiser can either create an image and upload it to the AdWords account or could use the free tool, the Display Ad Builder.

In case, the image to be used for the image ad is not available, the advertiser may select Display ad builder using the drop-down menu available on the Web page. Ad builder is a helpful tool that helps the advertiser to create an image for the ad using professionally designed templates already built-into the tool.

Google AdWords verifies that the image ads conform to the advertising policies set by Google and only then approves them. Image ads start running on the Web sites only after they are approved. Thus, the advertiser need to wait for few days until this review takes place.

The customers can be attracted to the business by displaying images of the services or products in the ads. The image ad can be run either by uploading an already existing ad or by utilizing the ad templates for creating an ad. AdWords allows to create ads with images from Web site as well. The ad ideas can be further modified according to the needs. The key benefits of using image ads are:

- The capability of creating ads in a cost-effective and simple way
- A range of ad templates on the fingertips
- Flexibility to modify and change the templates as per the needs

Figure 4.9 shows example of image ad.



Figure 4.9: Example of Image Ad

Upload Image Ads in Different Sizes

Image ads grab the attention of users across the Google Display Network's 2 million apps and Web sites. AdWords offers many ways for creating the image ads, however, uploading custom-made image ads provides with maximum control and customization.

Prior to creating ad in AdWords, an image file must be created an image file that is formatted and sized appropriately. The following tables show the applicable dimensions and specifications. In case of uploading a .zip folder, a maximum of 40 files are allowed.

Table 4.3 shows the dimensions and specifications for non-animated image ads:

File type	.JPEG .JPG .PNG .GIF
File size	150 KB or smaller
Image size	Vertical rectangle: 240 x 400 Mobile leaderboard: 320 x 50 Banner: 468 x 60 Leaderboard: 728 x 90 Square: 250 x 250 Small square: 200 x 200 Large rectangle: 336 x 280 Inline rectangle: 300 x 250 Skyscraper: 120 x 600 Wide skyscraper: 160 x 600 Half-page: 300 x 600 Large leaderboard: 970x90 Large mobile banner: 320 x 100 Billboard: 970 x 250 Portrait: 300 x 1050

Table 4.3: Dimensions and Specifications for Non-Animated Image Ads

Table 4.4 shows the dimensions and specifications for animated image ads:

File type	.GIF
File size	150 KB or smaller
Image size	Banner: 468 x 60 Leaderboard: 728 x 90 Square: 250 x 250 Small square: 200 x 200 Large rectangle: 336 x 280 Inline rectangle: 300 x 250 Skyscraper: 120 x 600 Wide skyscraper: 160 x 600 Half-page: 300 x 600 Large leaderboard: 970x90

	Large mobile banner: 320 x 100 Billboard: 970 x 250 Portrait: 300 x 1050
Animation speed and length	Animation length should be a maximum of 30 seconds Animations can be looped, but it should stop after 30 seconds Animated GIF ads should be slower than 5 Frame per Second (FPS)

Table 4.4: Dimensions and Specifications for Animated Image Ads

4.3.3 HTML5 Ads

When the Flash ads run on the third-party ad servers, either a static image ad can be created or HTML5 ad and can be uploaded to the ad server of choice.

HTML5 ads can be created by any of the following free tools from the Google:

- **DoubleClick Studio:** A wide range of HTML5 templates can be browsed and the ads can be built with the help of richmediagallery.com template database.
- **AdWords Ad gallery:** Lightbox ad can be created using the available HTML5 templates. One can also custom the ad ideas that are based on the style and content of Web site.
- **Google Web Designer:** This free HTML5 authoring tool can be downloaded for building ads for the Google Display Network campaigns.

The created HTML5 ads can be uploaded directly into AdWords. Though all Flash ads cannot be changed to HTML5, the converted Flash ads to HTML5 can be run on any inventory which supports either ad format.

Table 4.5 shows the dimensions and specifications for HTML5 ads.

Supported ad sizes	Banner: 468 x 60 Leaderboard: 728 x 90 Mobile leaderboard: 320 x 50 Square: 250 x 250 Small square: 200 x 200 Large rectangle: 336 x 280 Inline rectangle: 300 x 250 Skyscraper: 120 x 600 Wide skyscraper: 160 x 600 Half-page: 300 x 600 Large leaderboard: 970x90 Large mobile banner: 320 x 100 Billboard: 970 x 250 Portrait: 300 x 1050 Panorama: 980 x 120 Top banner: 930 x 180 Triple widescreen: 250 x 360 Netboard: 580 x 400
Supported file size	150 KB or smaller

File type	.ZIP The .ZIP file must have the HTML for the ad and any of the other following types of files: .CSS .JS .HTML .GIF .PNG .JPG .JPEG .SVG

Table 4.5: Dimensions and Specifications for HTML5 Ads

Note:
In case of uploading a .zip folder, a maximum of 40 files are allowed.
UTF-8 should be used for the non-ASCII characters.

Regionally Available Ad Sizes

Table 4.6 shows the image ad sizes that may be used based on the region where the ad is shown. Some of the image ad sizes are available only in specific regions or areas.

Ad type	Dimension	Size limit	Regional use
PL billboard	750x100	150 KB	Poland
PL double billboard	750x200	150 KB	Poland
PL triple billboard	750x300	150 KB	Poland
Vertical rectangle	240x400	150 KB	Russia
Panorama	980x120	150 KB	Sweden
Top banner	930x180	150 KB	Denmark
Triple widescreen	250x360	150 KB	Sweden
Netboard	580x400	150 KB	Norway

Table 4.6: Regionally Available Ad Sizes

4.3.4 Video Ad Formats

Compelling video ads can be designed in AdWords with the TrueView ad formats. By using the TrueView ads, there is no need to pay for any random impressions or for 'maybe they saw it' (assumption). The charges will be only when the users click to watch or engage with the elements of video, or there is no charge.

Publishing a video on Web site is one of the most popular ways to reach audience who are familiar with viewing ads in video format. In case, the advertisers have specific campaign goals in mind, they may collaborate with video publishing partners of AdWords including Google and YouTube to promote the

video ads. Such integrated promotion will help the advertisers in reaching the audience with exclusive video content.

Displaying ads in video format enables the advertisers to promote their brand across larger set of global users. These users may not just view but may also create and share new online video content. As compared to only text or image ads, video ads enable the clients to enjoy an appealing advertising experience while advertising a relevant product or service. This helps the advertisers in securing better online branding for their products and at the same time investing into cross-promotional advertising campaigns.

Before creating the video ads, advertisers may need to consider the following points with respect to video ads:

- **Appearance:** Depending upon the format of the ads, video ads may appear within, along with, or around the video content on a Web page. It is necessary that the content providers must choose to show specific video ad formats before the video ads actually appear on their site. The format of the video selected for displaying the ads decides how the ad will appear to the user. It will also decide how the users will interact with the ad. Advertisers may view the video ad demos available on the AdWords Web site to see various video ad samples.
- **Ad creation:** To create a video ad, advertisers need to use the Display ad builder.
- **Pricing:** Advertisers may select the CPC or CPM pricing based on the video ad format they are using.
- **Targeting:** For the video ads to appear, the advertisers must target their ads to the Google Display Network. Note that these ads will not appear in general Google search results. Advertisers may target their ads locally, nationally, and internationally. The ads may also be targeted based on language and country. Placement targeting can be used by advertisers so that the video ads are either displayed to clients looking for certain categories of content or displayed to target only specific sites.

Following are the benefits of TrueView ads:

- **It's a win-win method**: Users view the videos they are curious to watch and by this, one gets more views from the interested audience. As one selects what he/she wishes to pay for the view, he/she gets the appropriate audience at the right price. There is no need to pay each time the ad is shown, unlike CPM pricing.
- **Freedom to customize**: it is possible to run videos that are longer than 30 seconds that allows to experiment, using different formats. Customer testimonials can be tried, longer product demos, or a how-to video demonstrating a product.
- **Broad reach**: TrueView ads appear on YouTube as well as other publisher sites in the Display Network for desktop computers and high-end mobile devices. Note that the video content for TrueView ads should be hosted on YouTube.

Note: Video interactions comprise the clicks on Call-To-Action (CTA) overlays, companion banners, and cards.

Following tables show the TrueView video ad formats. As there are many ad formats, we have organized our suggestions to construct successful and important ads into the following two groups:

- TrueView in-stream video ads
- TrueView in-display video ads

Table 4.7 shows the specifications for TrueView in-stream video ads.

When can I use it?	How does it function?	Where will ads appear?	How shall I be charged?
Use this type of format when one has the video content that he/she would wish to promote prior to the videos on YouTube as well as the Google Display Network.	After completion of 5 seconds, the user has a choice to skip the ad.	TrueView in-stream videos may appear on YouTube watch pages as well as on the video partner apps and sites in the Google Display Network.	It is paid when any viewer watches the video for 30 seconds (or for the duration if it is lesser than 30 seconds) or engages with video, either of which comes first.

Table 4.7: Specifications for TrueView In-Stream Video Ads

TrueView in-display video ads include the following old formats:

- YouTube Promoted Videos overlay
- Promoted videos suggestions and related videos

The video ad preview unit might differ in size. It can be selected whether the video plays within the ad unit or when any viewer clicks to watch the video on YouTube Watch page. Table 4.8 shows the specifications for TrueView in-display video ads.

When can I use it?	How does it function?	Where will ads appear?	How shall I be charged?
Use this type of format for promoting a video next to the YouTube videos, as a part of the YouTube search result or within any other Web site content across the Google Display Network.	The appearance of ad format will differ, which depends on the ad sizes and ad formats that the content publishers supports. For example, YouTube is the key content publisher within network, and these ads will function and appear in the same manner across YouTube.	On YouTube search results On YouTube-related videos As a YouTube overlay On partner Web sites	It will be charged when the users select to watch ad by clicking any thumbnail.

Table 4.8: Specifications for TrueView In-Display Video Ads

Tips for Creating Effective Video Ads

There are many video ad formats to select from in AdWords and each of these offer unique chances for drawing the attention of the customers with the creative messages. That is why it is relevant to know targeted audience as well as think a best way to reach them.

Engaging content is always a good choice. Discovering the methods to draw the traffic to related videos which are owned by you is very essential. Also it is equally important to draw attention towards content on Web site to video ad. This will allow the viewers to keep coming back for many more.

Tables 4.9 and 4.10 shows the technical requirements for TrueView in-stream video ads and TrueView in-display video ads.

TrueView format	Where the ads appear	Video choices	Image choices	Ad text constraints	Click destination
In-stream ad	YouTube videos Video partner apps and sites on the GDN	YouTube video (recommended up to less than 3 minutes)	300x60 companion (YouTube only)	N/A	Your Web site
In-display ad	YouTube-related videos search results pages; the video releases on a YouTube channel or watch page Video partner apps and sites on the GDN	YouTube video (up to any length)	Select from four thumbnails	Maximum of 25 characters for the headline; maximum of 35 characters for every description Description not shown in the Suggestions	Click your video thumbnail go to video Click CTA overlays and go to your Web site

Table 4.9: Technical Requirements

Asset	Optional/Required	Unit	File type
Video URL	Required for all	N/A	Should upload the video to YouTube
Display URL	Required for in-stream ads	N/A	This URL is not displayed to the viewers. However, the domain is displayed and should match destination URL
Final URL	Required for in-stream ads	N/A	Click through URL to which ad will link
Companion banner	Optional (in-stream ads only)	300x60 (can appear on GDN or YouTube), 300x250 (appears only on GDN)	JPG, static GIF, or PNG

Table 4.10: Technical Requirements

4.3.5 Mobile Ads

The ad formats specifically designed to appear on mobile phones are known as mobile ads.

Considering the small size of the mobile phone screen, these ads are smaller than those that appear on computer screens. These ads are available in text and image format.

Through providing ads on mobile devices, advertisers can reach customers while they are on the go.

There are different types of ads that can be portrayed on mobile devices.

Mobile phones allow the users to browse Internet Web sites. When the users are browsing for information using the mobile, Google Web site, or Google Mobile Display Network, the mobile ads appear on these sites. It must be noted that the mobile image ads can appear only on the Mobile Display Network.

The mobile ads lead the users to a mobile Web site. The advertisers may add a 'Call' link right after the mobile text ad. This will enable the users to call the advertising company directly without visiting the mobile Web site.

Mobile phone market is a largely evolving one. The latest mobile phones, such as iPhone and other smartphones are powerful devices with full-fledged Internet browsing capacity. These phones are designed in such a way that they can display full Internet pages, just as they would appear on desktop computers. Thus, these phones are capable of displaying standard AdWords text, image, and video ads.

It is recommended to create a separate campaign with specific settings just for mobile ads. The objective behind this is to enable the advertiser to supervise and optimize the performance of mobile ads.

It is a type of AdWords ad that appears on both Web pages as well as apps. It can be viewed on devices such as mobile phones or tablets.

- Mobile ads are based on both WAP and advanced mobile devices.
- Text or image ads are made for WAP based mobile devices exclusively whereas for advanced mobile devices, the advertiser can create a text ad and set the campaign's device targeting options in order to display.

Let us now understand how to display ads on different mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets. Following Ads can appear on mobile devices with browsers, for example smartphones and tablets:

- Text ads
- App promotion ads
- Image ads
- HTML 5 ads built with Google Web Designer

Following ads can appear within apps on smartphones or tablets:

- Text ads
- App promotion ads
- Image ads
- Video app promotion ads
- Image app promotion ads
- TrueView for app promotion ads

Call-only ads can appear on devices that can make calls.

Various mobile devices, including smartphones, comprise full Internet browsers. These browsers are capable of displaying the Web sites that are similar to the ones that can be seen on mobile optimized

sites and desktop computers. High-end mobile devices can also host apps, which can be downloaded by users from the app store in their mobile devices or from a Web site.

The huge range of media that is available on the mobile devices implies that the ads can be shown in various different formats. Testing message with the help of multiple ad formats may aid in understanding what attracts the customers to Web site or download mobile app. However, creating message such that it captivates the customers aids ads to appear and perform way better in any format.

A mobile-optimized ad can be created using a message, display URL, as well as a landing page particularly for the mobile devices. This will ensure that ad appears great on small screens. For doing so, choose the 'Mobile' checkbox which is next to 'Device preference' setting. If ad groups consist of ads which are eligible to emerge on all the devices and mobile-optimized ads, then only mobile preferred ads will appear on mobile devices.

Note: Automatically, all the new campaigns are eligible to run on most of the mobile devices. For avoiding showing the ads on mobile, a negative bid adjustment can be set for it.

4.4 Creating Dynamic Display Ads

You can create dynamic display ads – text, HTML5, and image – for showcasing the services or products from your feed. You will have the chance to make these ads when you are setting up your dynamic remarketing campaign, which is in your account's Ad gallery. When you create dynamic ads, you can state whether they should utilize a specific ad layout or your desired layouts.

If using the desired layouts, you will select the features and layouts that you want. AdWords will use only the layouts from this pool of desired layouts (not available for the retails feeds). The features of layouts comprise the multiple product carousels, cropping your images that fit the ads, star ratings, and so on. AdWords can identify the layouts that are expected to perform best for people, platforms and placements where they will be displayed, thus, making your dynamic ads much more effective. Figure 4.10 shows an example of dynamic display ads.



Figure 4.10: Example of Dynamic Display Ad

Complete the following steps to create dynamic ads:

1. Click **Campaigns** at the top of your screen.
2. On the **All campaigns** page, choose your dynamic remarketing campaign.
3. Click the **Ads** tab.
4. Click the **+ Ad** drop-down menu and choose **Ad gallery**. Figure 4.11 shows the how to select Ad gallery.

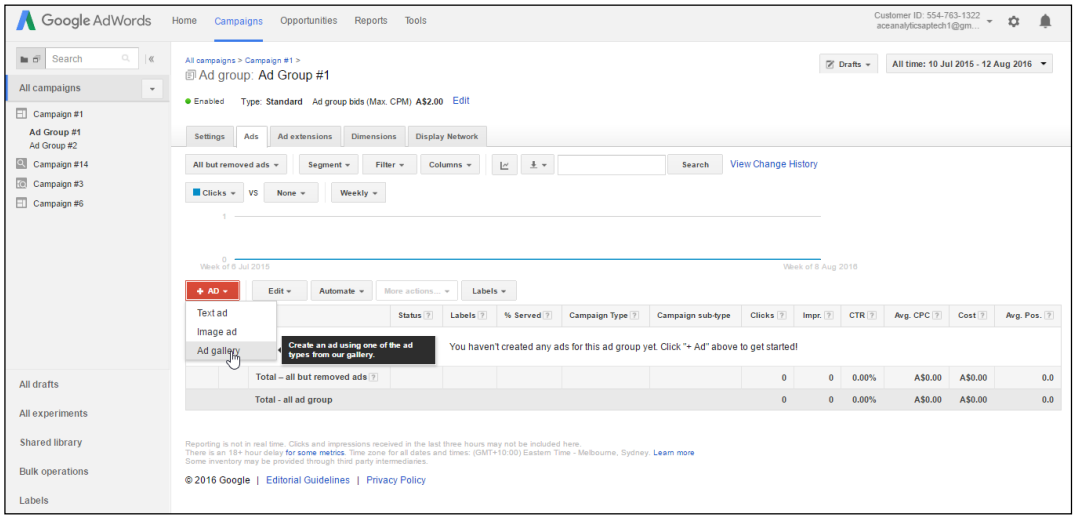


Figure 4.11: Selecting Ad gallery

5. Select **Dynamic ads**, then click **Create**. Refer to Figure 4.12 how dynamic ads are selected.

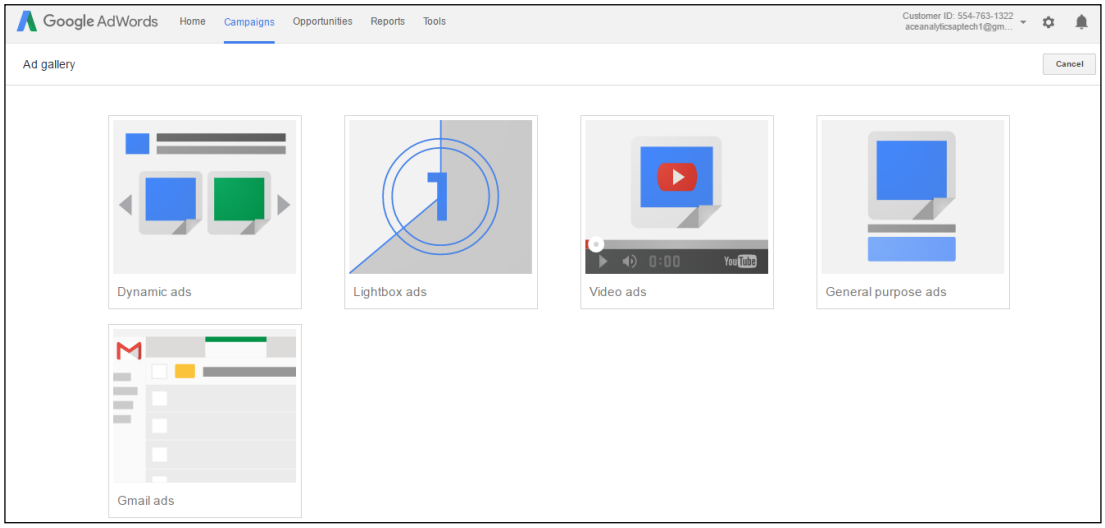


Figure 4.12: Selecting Dynamic ads

6. Select text or image ads and then click **Create**. Depending on the template you choose, you may need to provide a layout, headline, logo, display URL, ad name, final URL, or button. Figures 4.13 and 4.14 shows creating and selecting dynamic ads, respectively.

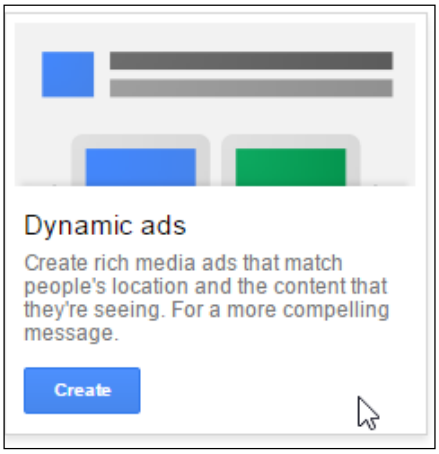


Figure 4.13: Creating Dynamic ads

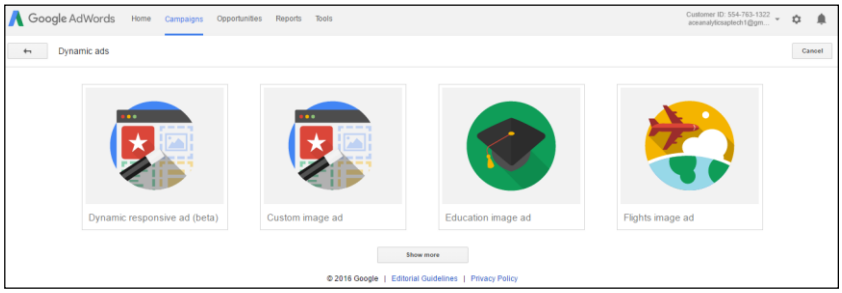


Figure 4.14: Selecting Dynamic ads

7. If you select image ads, go to **Layouts** and select **Let AdWords automatically pick from your preferred layouts** or **Select one AdWords layout**. Preferred layouts are not available for retail feeds currently.
   - Let AdWords automatically choose from preferred layouts. All the dynamic ad layouts and features are by default turned ON, but it is possible to leave out particular layouts and turn off the features that are not required. As more ad layouts with the features you have turned ON become accessible, they will automatically be added to desired layouts.
     a. Click the pencil icon next to the preferred layouts. It will take to **Choose your preferred layouts** screen.
     b. To leave out particular layouts, point the cursor over the layout and click the **x** that appears. In order to turn off the layout features, click the **On / Off** switch.
     c. Click **Apply** after finishing it.
   - Choose one AdWords layout. Click the drop-down menu and select an AdWords layout. Figure 4.15 shows selecting layout of dynamic ads.

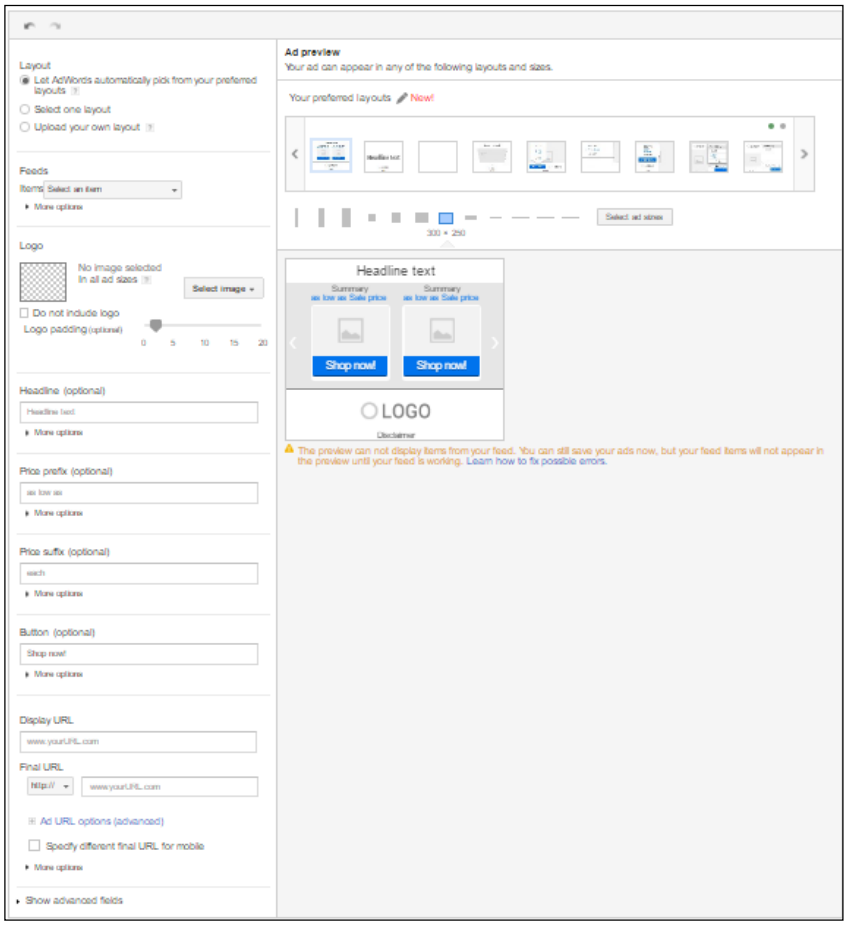


Figure 4.15: Selecting Layout of Dynamic ads

8. Click **Save and preview**.

Customizing Text in Dynamic Ads

While there are many ad layouts that are available, one may wish to further customize the dynamic ads. While using an education, a travel, a flight, or a custom feed, it is possible to customize the arrangements of the attributes from the feed in your own dynamic ads.

Figure 4.16 shows an example of customizing text where the layout utilizes the destination name 'SFO' for ad headline, the flight description 'Cheap daily flights' for ad description and flight price '$900' for the price.

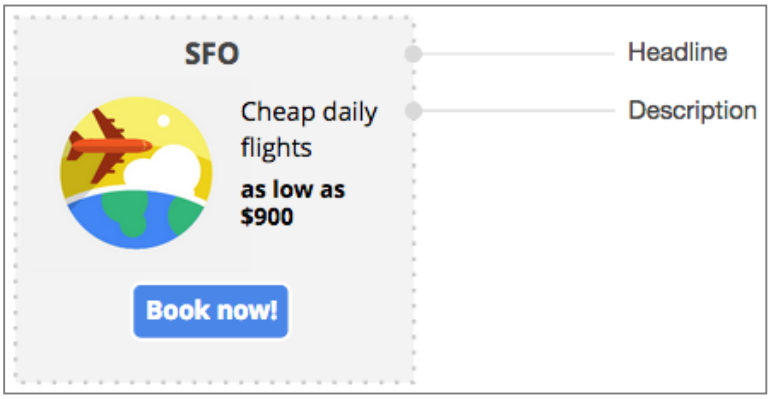


Figure 4.16: Customizing Text Using Destination name in Dynamic Display Ad

However, let us consider that a person wishes to have a more descriptive headline. He/She can instead utilize the name of destination and the description of the flight for the ad headline 'Cheap daily flights to SFO' as shown in figure 4.17.

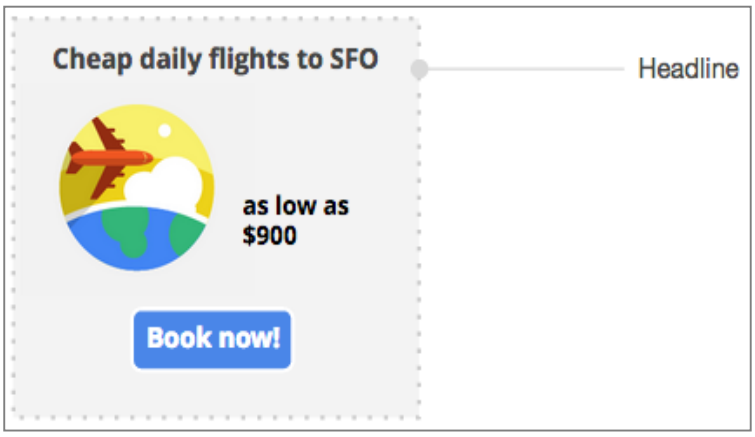


Figure 4.17: Customizing Text Using Destination name and Description of the Flight

Complete the following steps to customize the dynamic ads:

1. Under **Feeds** click **More options**.
2. Click the field which is next to the ad element that needs to be customized, such as **Headline**.
3. In the drop-down menu which appears, choose a feed attribute that will appear in curly brackets. For example, '{Destination ID}'. Insert and arrange features in this field. Static text can also be included. For example, for creating the headline 'Cheap daily flights' shown previously, it will be typed as '**{Flight description} to {Destination name}'** in the headline field.
4. Click **Save and preview**.

4.5 Ad Guidelines and Best Practices

Google AdWords has defined certain policies and guidelines that will enable the advertisers as well as users to use the AdWords feature in the best possible manner.

Text Ad Guidelines and Best Practices

AdWords text ads are expected to strictly follow the AdWords advertising policies and can be disapproved if they do not conform to these guidelines. The ads that are disapproved are not allowed to run on Google or the Google advertising network.

The text ad policies of AdWords are broadly classified into three categories namely, editorial and format, content, and link. The primary goal of these guidelines is to help the advertisers in creating effective ads.

- **Editorial and format:** These policies primarily focus on the ad text that is the first three lines of the ad.
- **Character limit:** The headline of the ad, the ad text, and the destination URL for the ad must fit within the given character limit. Otherwise, they will appear incomplete and cut off when they appear on the screen.
- **Prices, discounts, and free offers:** In case, the ad displayed indicates some kind of special price, discount, or some 'free' offer to be availed by clients, then it must be very clearly indicated on the Web site. This information should be displayed to the clients within one or two clicks from the page displaying the ad.
- **Punctuation and symbols:** The ad text should contain only one exclamation point.
- **Content:** These policies primarily focus on the products and services promoted by the advertiser. They mainly apply to the ads and the content of the advertisers Web site. For example, Google does not permit the advertisers to market weapons or assistance in passing drug tests.
- **Link:** These policies is primarily associated with the display and destination URLs indicated in the ads. It is important that the display URL indicated in the ad is accurate and enables the client to link to the Web site. It is also necessary that the clients are able to enter and exit the landing page with ease.

Image Ad Guidelines and Best Practices

- Image advertising is similar to text ads. Thus, the factors that work best for text ads work for image ads too.
- The images of product and people using the product must be clear and accurate. This enables the user to relate to an advertisement.
- All the advertising messages used should be well aligned in order to create a consistent brand of products.
- For an advertiser, effective offline advertising will improve chances for effective online advertising too. However, advertisers must note that the online image ads should be in sync with the television and print ads.
- The ad text must be simple and effective. Clients should be able to interact using the ad without any ambiguity.
- Catching client's attention is an important task. Typically, if the ad does not hold the clients attention within the first three seconds, it is likely that the clients may move on and the message is altogether lost.

- In case, of multiple ad campaigns or multi-frame ads, it is necessary that each ad is independent and survives on individual merit. Adding the brand logo in each frame may help in achieving this.
- Use appropriate and specific call-to-action such as 'learn more', 'buy now', or 'visit ustoday', whichever suits the ad best.
- The display URL should appear prominently as a major part of the text ad. Typically, this should contain company's name. Image ad provides space and so the advertisers must go ahead and use the company logo along with company name in the ad.
- The pricing information including delivery details and other relevant special offers if any should be clearly indicated.
- The ads appearing on the page should lead to a relevant landing page.
- Make effective use of capitalization in the ad text.
- Encourage a sense of urgency for display-ads containing time-sensitive pricing or offers. Use phrases such as 'hurry!', 'limited time', and 'special offer' to capture a user's attention and push them to take action.
- Keep it simple. The points should be presented in a simple manner. If the ad is cluttered, no one will respond.

Video Ad Guidelines and Best Practices

- Maintain the freshness of the campaign by incorporating new images and videos to keep up the ad interaction rates and also to maintain the interest of users.
- It is advisable to bid by impression instead by click. Thus, the lower CTR will not affect the appearance of ads.
- Use negative keywords and exclusions in the CPC campaigns to avoid the appearance of ad on sites where it may not be effective.
- It is best to emphasize on interaction rates instead of CTR or CPC. Interaction rate is a better indicator of how much time the audience spends with the advertiser's brand.
- Geo-targeting helps the advertiser to concentrate their advertising on regions or are as relevant to their business.
- Placement targeting may be effectively used to customize the ad campaign to specific sites
- In case, of keyword-targeted campaign, the keywords used should be relevant to specific theme or topic of ads.
- The target cost-per-play price may be easily reached by optimizing the bids.

Mobile Ad Guidelines and Best Practices

- **Timely Start:** A lot of competition exists for popular keywords available on desktop search. Some advertisers may find it advantageous to create mobile ads from the point of lower CPC since, these are not very commonly used.
- **Firm Start:** It is advised that the advertisers should bid aggressively to make the presence of their ad felt on the first page of results, where there is maximum visibility. Mobile ads have very few ad spots on each page. Thus, if the advertiser misses one of the top positions then they may miss out on the number of impressions.

- **Device Specific Ad for Improved Performance:** It is recommended that the advertisers create separate ad campaigns and ad groups for their ads that appear on desktops, standard mobile phones, iPhone, and Android devices. This enables the advertiser to monitor as well as evaluate the performance of each type of ads and make necessary performance optimizations for each ad format with tailor made ads, keywords, and bids.
- **Different Choice of Keywords:** As compared to desktop computer users, mobile users specify fewer keywords while searching for information. Mobile campaigns are advised to AdWords Ad Formats use broad-matching and a more general set of keywords for capturing relevant information.
- **Attractive Punch Lines:** The call-to-action phrase plays the most important role in catching the attention of clients. Effective ad text can influence the ad's CTR and conversion rate considerably.
- **Emphasize a Necessity:** Mobile image ads are capable of generating high CTR and lower CPCs as compared to that of desktop ads. They play a significant role in branding a product or a service. The process may be easily set up with the help of MMA-compliant sizes. Mobile Marketing Association (MMA) is the global non-profit trade organization representing players in the mobile marketing value chain.
- **Be Present Where Your Customer Is:** Typically, mobile users search for information, browse the Internet, as well as use mobile apps. Advertisers may easily reach the clients with contextually targeted text and image ads using Google's growing mobile Display Network.
- **Domain for Valuable Demographics:** Advertisers may use standard mobile ads for targeting specific mobile carriers. They may also target the iPhone and Android users with the help of device platform targeting.
- **Measure Results:** Advertisers can easily set up conversion tracking to evaluate the results of mobile ads on the mobile Web site. They may also use a vanity phone number for tracking the responses registered on the click-to-call WAP ad.
- **Perfection is achieved through Exercise:** Advertisers are advised to experiment with mobile ads and work out the best possible strategy for their ads. The results may be evaluated over a period of time and the advertisers may modify or adapt to the strategy that works best for them.

4.6 Summary

- The ads in the Google AdWords might be displayed in various formats on a Web page.
- For displaying ads on Web pages, there are many methods available.
- All AdWords advertisings must meet the primary requirement for representing the advertiser's site accurately and clearly.
- Ad extensions are extensively used type of ad format which exhibit additional information regarding the advertiser's business or products.
- The automated system of Google shows the details regarding the advertiser for making the search narrower.
- Google Shopping ads are generally unrecognized as ad formats.
- Every ad format consists of its own benefits, whether it is the affordability and ease of running a text ad or colorful storytelling that comes with the video.
- It is possible to run various types of ads from the same AdWords account or from the same campaign in some cases.
- The ad formats depend on the campaign type that are available.
- There are some campaigns types that show ads on mobile only, such as app promotion campaigns as well as call-only campaigns.
- Every text ad consists of a headline, some lines of text explaining describing your business, and clickable link to Web site.
- The AdWords image ads use animated or static graphics, including the text for the presentation of the ads.
- Google AdWords checks whether the image ads is conforming to the advertising policies which are set by Google and then only approves them.
- Image ads grab the attention of the people across the Google Display Network's 2 million apps and Web sites.
- AdWords provides many ways for creating image ads.
- On a Web site, publishing a video is one of the most preferable ways to reach the audience who are acquainted with viewing the ads in video format.
- In AdWords, compelling video ads can be created using TrueView ad formats.
- There are many video ad formats in AdWords to choose from. Every video provides special opportunities to be able to attract customers through creative messages.
- Mobile ads are the ad formats that are particularly designed to appear on the mobile phones.
- The large variety of media that is available on the mobile devices implies that the ads can be displayed in various different formats.
- Create vibrant display ads - image, text, HTML5 – for showcasing services or products from feed.

4.7 Check Your Progress

1. Which of the following is not an ad format available with AdWords account?
   a. Call-ads only
   b. Shopping ads
   c. Campaign ads
   d. App promotion ads
2. Which of the following campaign shows ads only on mobile supports?
   a. App promotion and video ads only
   b. Call ads and video ads only
   c. Video and dynamic ads only
   d. App promotion and call ads only
3. Which of the following campaign type supports text ads only?
   a. Search Network with Display Select - Standard
   b. Search Network with Display Select - All features
   c. Search Network only - All features
   d. All of these
4. Which of the following campaign supports video ads?
   a. Search Network with Display Select - All features
   b. Search Network only - All features
   c. Display Network only - All features
   d. Search Network only - Dynamic search ads
5. With which of the following campaign type one will not have access to the ad gallery?
   a. Display Network only - All features
   b. Search Network with Display Select - Standard
   c. Display Network only - Marketing objectives → Install your mobile app
   d. Display Network only - Marketing objectives → Buy on your Web site
6. Which of the following is as per the approved text ad format?
   a. Ad title: 35 characters; Ad text: 70 characters; url: 25 characters
   b. Ad title: 25 characters; Ad text: 70 characters; url: 35 characters
   c. Ad title: 25 characters; Ad text: 35 characters; url: 70 characters
   d. Ad title: 70 characters; Ad text: 35 characters; url: 25 characters

4.7.1 Answers

1	**c**
2	**d**
3	**a**
4	**d**
5	**b**
6	**b**

SESSION 5 - ADWORDS AD PLACEMENT AND TARGETING

Session Objectives:

This session focusses on Ad placement in Web sites and targeting the Web sites. The various targeting methods based on topics, geography, location, language, and so on are covered in detail. The session also compares various targeting methods and exclusion based on the customer requirements and business needs. Placement issues and processes to fix it are also discussed.

At the end of this session, you will be able to:

- Understand about ad placements Web sites
- Target ads based on locations
- Apply language targeting
- Diagnose and fix placement issues

5.1 Introduction

For each advertising campaign, the company can choose to target their ads at particular languages and locations in addition to the budget and other settings. Advertisers are recommended to target only the languages and locations that are relevant to their business. For example, if the company ships its products to locations within a certain distance of the business, the company can target the country, territory, region, or city related to the area, instead of targeting the campaign to 'All Countries'. Placement of the ad plays a crucial role in AdWords targeting.

The concepts of targeting and placements in Google AdWords are largely based on understanding of the Google Network and search targeting and ad placements on the Google Network. We will understand about these concepts in detail in the following sections.

5.2 Ad Placements on Web sites

Displaying ads on Google Display Network (GDN) enables users to view these ads while they are browsing Web sites, apps, and videos. One can also eliminate certain topics and sites which may not be in line with their business.

5.2.1 Targeting Web sites with Specific Topics

Users may have specific choices. Hence, by targeting a specific topic, one can add AdWords ads to pages on a Web site which are relevant to the topic. For example, movies, hotels, and music. Topic targeting enables the ads to be displayed on the pages of the Display Network which have content relevant to the selected topics. The pages on which the ads are displayed change as and when the material available on the Internet changes. Select one or more topics relevant to the ads to display them on the required pages. For example, target the 'Hotels and Restaurants' topic to display the ad on any Display Network Web site or placement which may have material related to food or bed and breakfast topics. One can further select subtopics such as Italian food, French food, fast food and so on.

Topic targeting can be combined with single placements. Single placements are pages or sites selected for the ad to be displayed. One can also combine topic targeting with keyword targeting.

Keyword targeting is selecting keywords that would enable the ad to be displayed. For example, on deciding to target the placement Timesnow.com and the topic Music in the same ad, the ad will appear only on the pages within Timesnow which belong to the topic Music.

Following are the reasons to target topics:

- To generate extra traffic or to reach a wider range of audience quickly. For example, while selling motorcycles, if one gets to know that the users also enjoy river rafting and hiking, then one can reach a wider audience by selecting the Hiking and River Rafting subtopic to display the ads on Web pages of this topic.
- To have a flexible or an unrestricted campaign budget.
- To ramp up the ad delivery or if the CPA goal is a bit flexible.
- To prevent ads from being displayed on pages about specific topics that are not performing well or are not related to the business.

Following are the two campaign types:

- Display Network only - All features
- Display Network only - Remarketing

To target topics, use any one of the campaign types or marketing objectives. Following are the 'Display Network only' marketing objectives:

- View your ad
- Visit your Web site
- Buy on your Web site
- Take an action on your Web site
- Call your business
- Visit your business

Complete the following steps to target topics:

1. Sign in to AdWords account using the link https://adwords.google.com
2. Click **Campaigns** tab at the top of the page. Refer to figure 5.1.

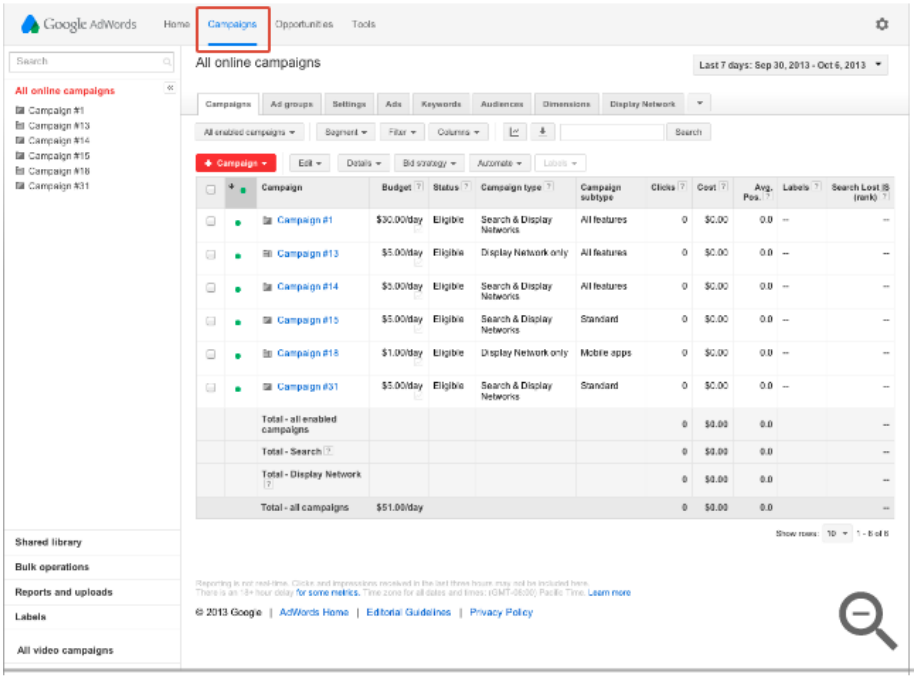


Figure 5.1: Campaigns Tab

3. Go to Display Network and click **+ Targeting** as shown in figure 5.2.

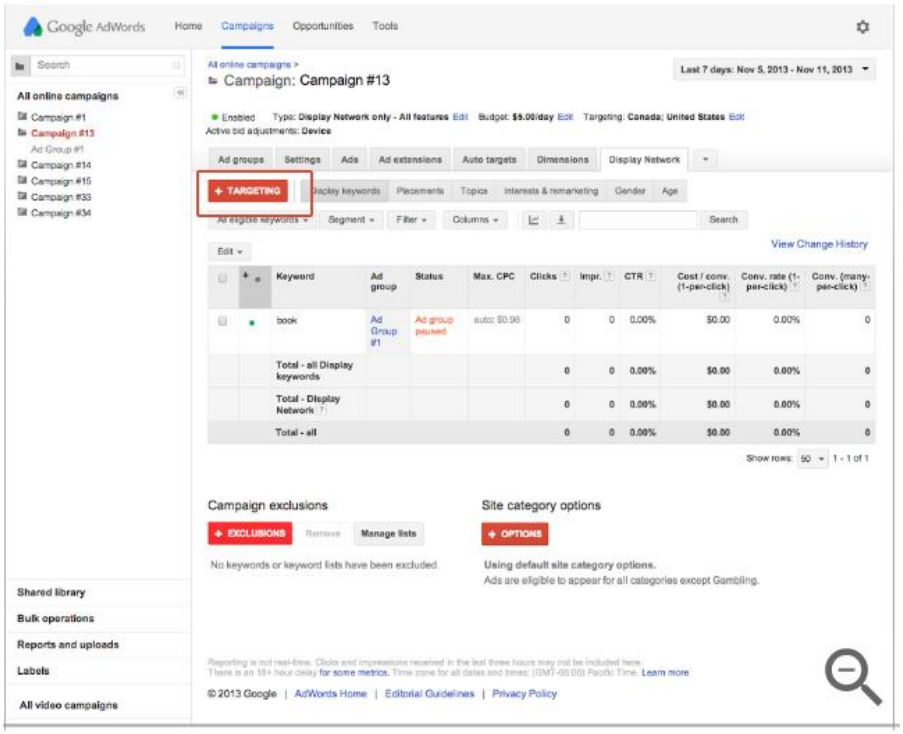


Figure 5.2: Targeting Campaigns

4. Select an Ad Group.
5. Select **Topics** from the **Add targeting** drop-down menu.
6. Select as many topics and subtopics by clicking the double arrows (**»**) next to each topic or subtopic. Any topics and subtopics specified will appear under the **Selected topics** list as shown in figure 5.3.

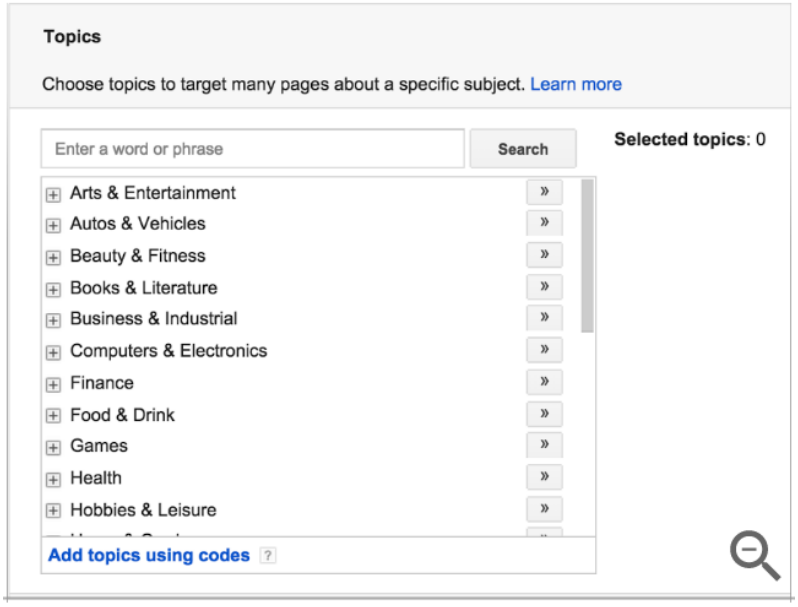


Figure 5.3: Choosing Topics of Campaign

7. Click **Close** and then **Save**.

5.2.2 Copying Topics to Another Ad Group

After you set up topics for one ad group, the topics can be copied to other ad groups in the Display Network only campaigns. To start, copy the topics which are needed and paste them into a new ad group.

Following are the steps to copy the topics:

1. Click **Display Network**.
2. Click **Topics**.
3. Select the checkbox next to the topics to be copied.
4. From the **Edit** menu, select **Copy** (Press Ctrl + C key for PCs and Command + C keys for Macs).

Following are the steps to paste the topics:

1. Click **Campaigns**.
2. Click the name of the campaign where the topics need to be pasted.
3. Select the checkbox next to the name of the ad group where the topics need to be pasted.
4. From the **Edit** menu, select **Paste** (Press Ctrl + V keys for PCs and Command + V keys for Macs).

Note:

- On targeting a top-level topic, all the related subtopics are also targeted. It is recommended to add the subtopics for reporting control and bidding.
- Adding the subtopics is different from adding the top-level topics. There are pages which will not be targeted if only the subtopics are added to the ad group. It is recommended to add the top-level topic separately.
- On adding topics to a target, an estimate of the initial targeting reach is displayed. This estimate does not take into consideration the bid and budget settings or automated targeting methods.

5.2.3 Choosing Where and When Ads Appear

AdWords helps in reaching the users in all possible ways. In this section, you will learn how the ads can be displayed to users in a specific location using specific sites or devices within a time range. Adhere to the following best practices with reference to placement targeting (It is recommended to use relevant keywords for automatic placements.):

Placement Targeting Best Practices

- Advertisers are recommended to use relevant keywords for automatic placements. These keywords can also be used to further improve the managed placements.
- It is a good option to use the keywords to refine the targeting of ads on placements while targeting the sites comprising of wide variety of content such as social networking sites and news sites. The ads are more likely to appear at relevant locations on those sites. Adding keywords limits the potential number of clicks and impressions; hence, an advertiser must monitor the performance of the ads to ensure the desired results are gained.
- Advertisers are recommended to create a keyword-only ad group. This works when contextual targeting is the only deciding factor to determine where the ads appear.

- It is recommended to create an ad group with placements only ads. This would be helpful when it is required that the ads appear anywhere on a given placement irrespective of the contextual matching. The campaign settings for this ad group must be set to Show ads only on pages that match all selected targeting methods. Thus, the placement choices set by the advertiser along with the AdWords auction will be the only deciding factor for determining where the ad can appear.
- It is helpful to take effort in identifying the target audience of the advertisements. Advertisers must select placements that might be of interest to the target audience.
- Advertisers must make an effort to consider the sites the target audience will most likely visit. For instance, if an advertiser is promoting Football shoes, it is a good idea to target placements that appear under the Sports Shoes category.
- Rich media and display ads always perform better than simple text ads. Advertiser should try their best to identify and choose sites that allow these ad formats in their placements. In other words, an image ad of a campaign must be targeted to placements that accept image ads.
- Advertisers should take the advantage of the fact that Google AdWords allows targeting different types of content within the Display Network. A number of Web sites contain engaging user content such as videos and games. Advertisers must target the ads to the potential customer through the types of content they might enjoy.
- Advertisers may find it helpful to raise the managed placement default bid as managed placements are used mostly to manage sites where advertising may be highly competitive. This gives advertiser a stronger chance to win the ranking auction.
- Advertisers may use placement diagnosis to identify whether the display ad is running on particular Display Network placements. In case, they are not running on particular placements, the diagnosis explains the reasoning. It also gives steps to improve the performance of such ads.

5.3 Targeting Ads to Geographic Locations

AdWords location targeting enables ads to be displayed in the geographic locations of the selected countries, particular areas of a country, an area/radius around a location, or for location groups. Location targeting enables to focus advertising on the areas where the right set of users will be found and restrict it in areas where no users may be found. This could help increase the ROI.

Ads perform well only if they are displayed in the right location. Reach the users where they are situated and where your business can help them by using AdWords location targeting. One can then set and adjust the location targeting settings any time.

5.3.1 Targeting the Right Locations for the Business

Table 5.1 gives guidance for selecting the location targets suitable for a business.

Location target	Description	Businesses that could benefit	Businesses that may not benefit
Countries	Targeting ads specifically to a country or multiple countries is recommended if the products and services can	A national business which serves the entire country. An online retailer who ships goods	A business that does not serve all regions or cities. In such a case, one might target individual cities or

Location target	Description	Businesses that could benefit	Businesses that may not benefit
	be provided to those areas. Also, one can get more exposure on targeting entire countries.	worldwide. An international business which serves several countries.	regions to get the required benefits.
Areas within a country	One must use a more specific targeting method if the business does not serve all regions or cities, or if it is required to focus the advertising efforts to few areas within a country. Within the country, one can target regions, cities, or postal codes.	A business serving the local neighborhood. A business which may have special discounts only in selected locations. A business which sells its products in selected regions or cities.	A business which tries to reach most areas in a country, with only a few exceptions (such as all of the Britain. except for Manchester). In this it is recommended to target the whole country and then eliminate the other regions.
Area/Radius around a location	This kind of targeting (also known as 'Target a radius' or proximity targeting) enables one to display the ads to users within a certain distance from the business, rather than selecting individual cities, regions, or countries.	A business which delivers goods only within a selected radius. A local business which has a user base within a radius.	A business which only wants to target selected regions, cities, or countries.

Table 5.1: Guidelines for Selecting Location Targets

Following are some tips for choosing the right locations/areas for a business

- Ensure to target the locations where the users are, as this may not be the same place where the business is located. For example, if one owns an e-commerce company target all the locations and the goods can be shipped to. On targeting an area where the business is not located, one cannot view the ad on Google. However, use the Ad Preview Tool to find the ad.
- Ads may or may not be displayed occasionally on targeting a small radius. This happens as small targets might not meet the targeting criteria.
- Keep the language and location targeting settings consistent. For example, on targeting English speaking users in India, ensure to target English language and write the ads in English. For example, to promote a hotel in France to English speaking audience, target the ads to France and write the ads in English.

5.3.2 Excluding Ads from Geographic Locations

It is important that an ad is not displayed in the wrong location. The **Location Exclusion** feature can ensure that an ad can be prevented from being displayed in certain parts of the targeted locations. For example, an ad can be prevented from being displayed in a city within a state or region within a country. This feature enables one to use the budget judiciously by preventing an ad to be displayed to users who may not be interested. One can either exclude locations one at a time or can exclude a large number of locations at once by using the bulk locations feature. Following businesses may benefit from eliminating areas within the targeted locations:

- A business that does not ship to or offer services to a city or region within a larger area.
- A business which offers special promotions and which are not eligible in a few regions of the targeted area. For example, on running ad campaigns for a real estate brokerage firm in UK, one does not have any offers in Manchester. In such a case, one can target the entire UK excluding Manchester.

Note: Ensure that areas which have not been targeted need not be excluded. Ads will not be displayed in locations which have not been targeted.

5.3.3 Setting up Location Targeting

Following are the steps to target entire country:

1. Use the link https://adwords.google.com and sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns.**
3. Click the name of the campaign to be edited.
4. Click **Settings.**
5. Click **Edit** in the **Locations** section. Refer to figure 5.4.

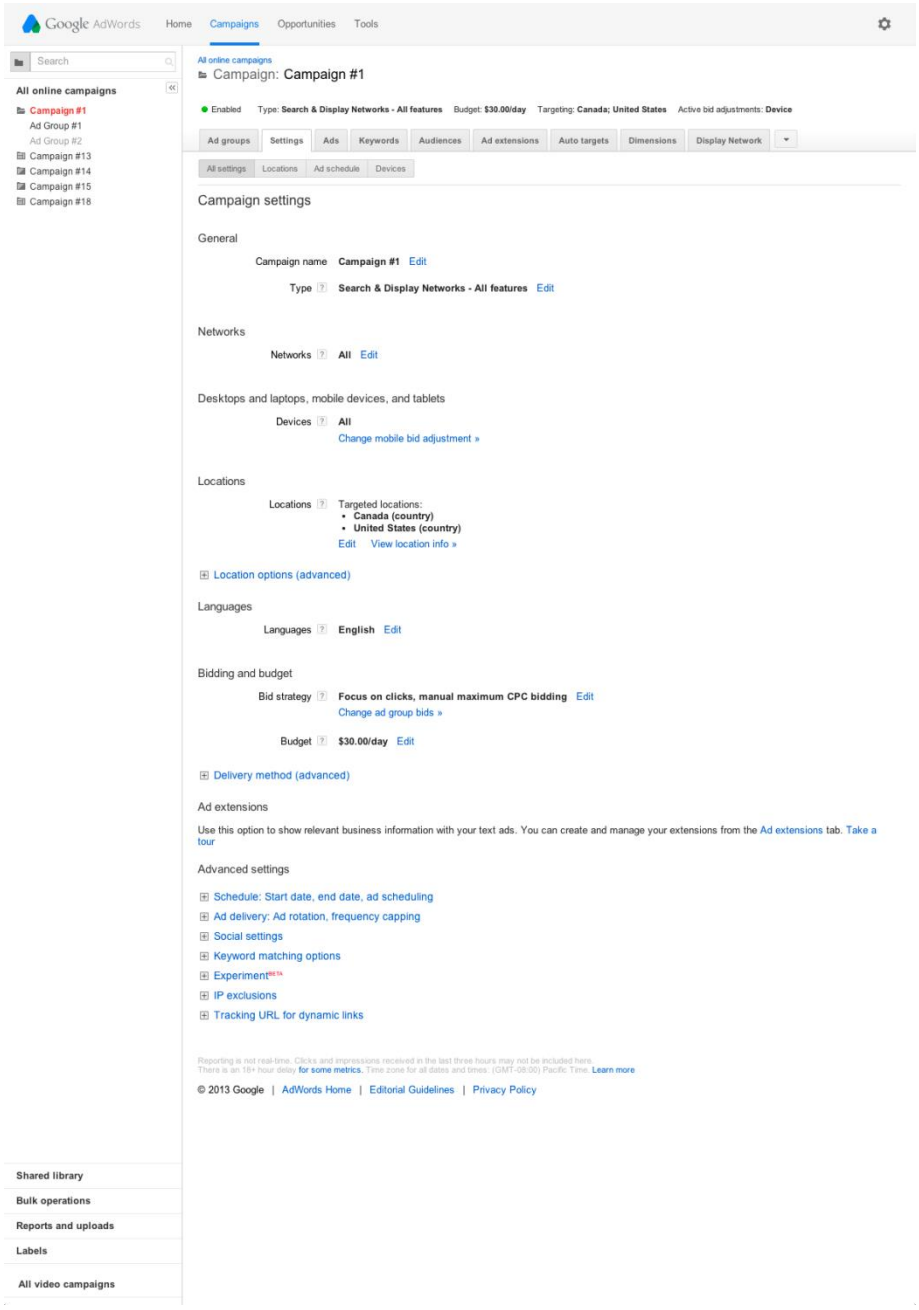


Figure 5.4: Location Targeting

6. Specify the name of the country which needs to be targeted as shown in figure 5.5.



Figure 5.5: Entering Values in Campaign Settings

7. Click **Add** to add the location as shown in figure 5.6.

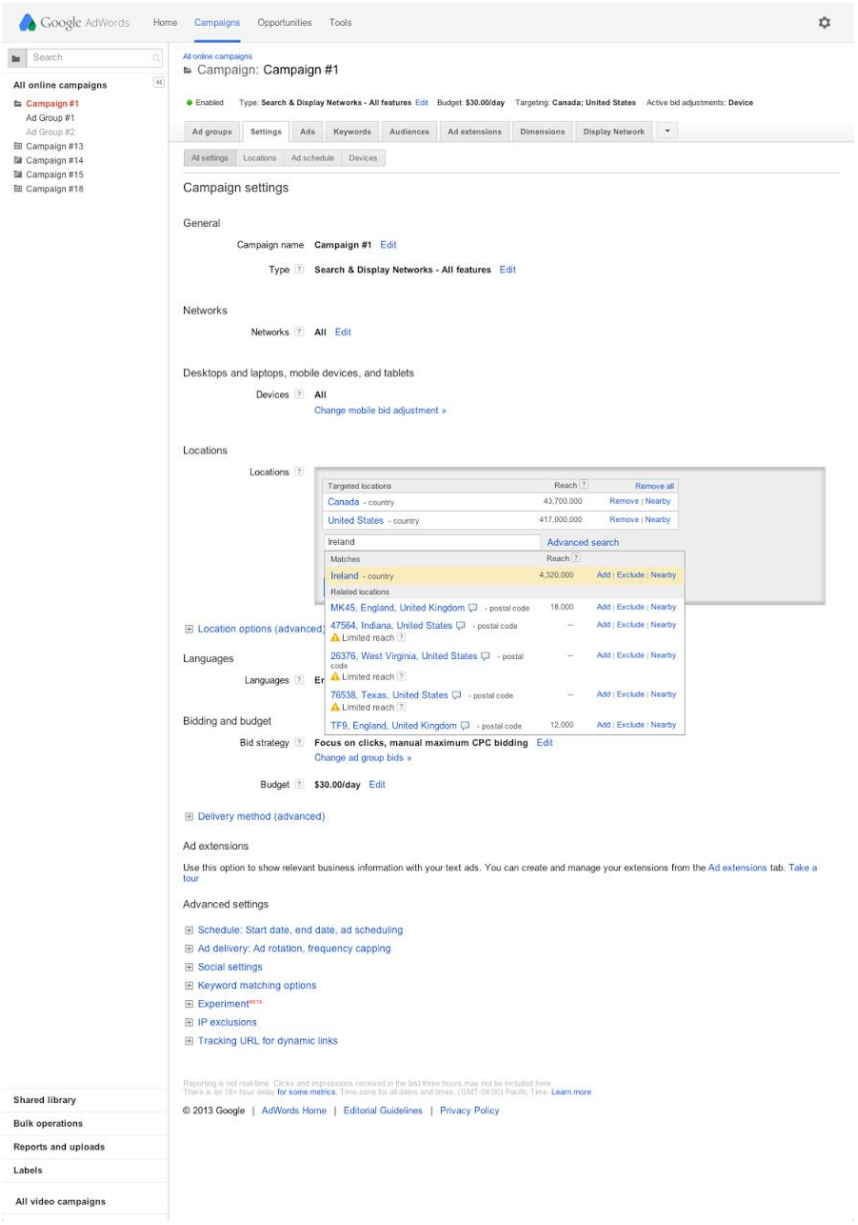


Figure 5.6: Adding Location in Campaign Settings

8. Click **Save** to save the settings.

Complete the following steps to target few areas within a country:

1. Use the link https://adwords.google.com and sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Click the name of the campaign to be edited.
4. Click **Settings**.
5. Click **Edit** in **Locations** section.
6. Specify the postal code or name of the location which needs to be targeted. On specifying a city name, ensure to specify the country name as well as shown in in figure 5.7.

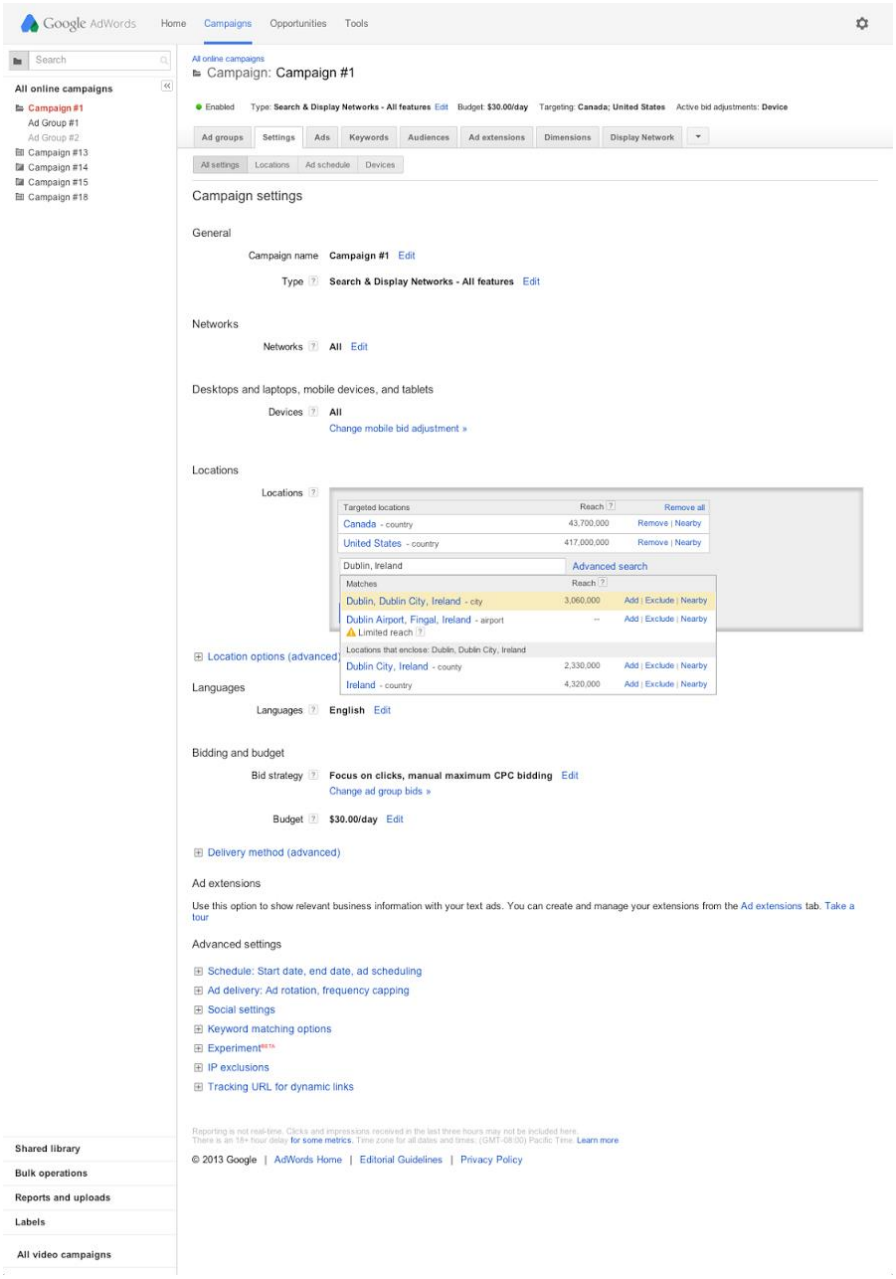


Figure 5.7: Entering Location Details

7. Click **Add** to add the location. Refer to figure 5.8.

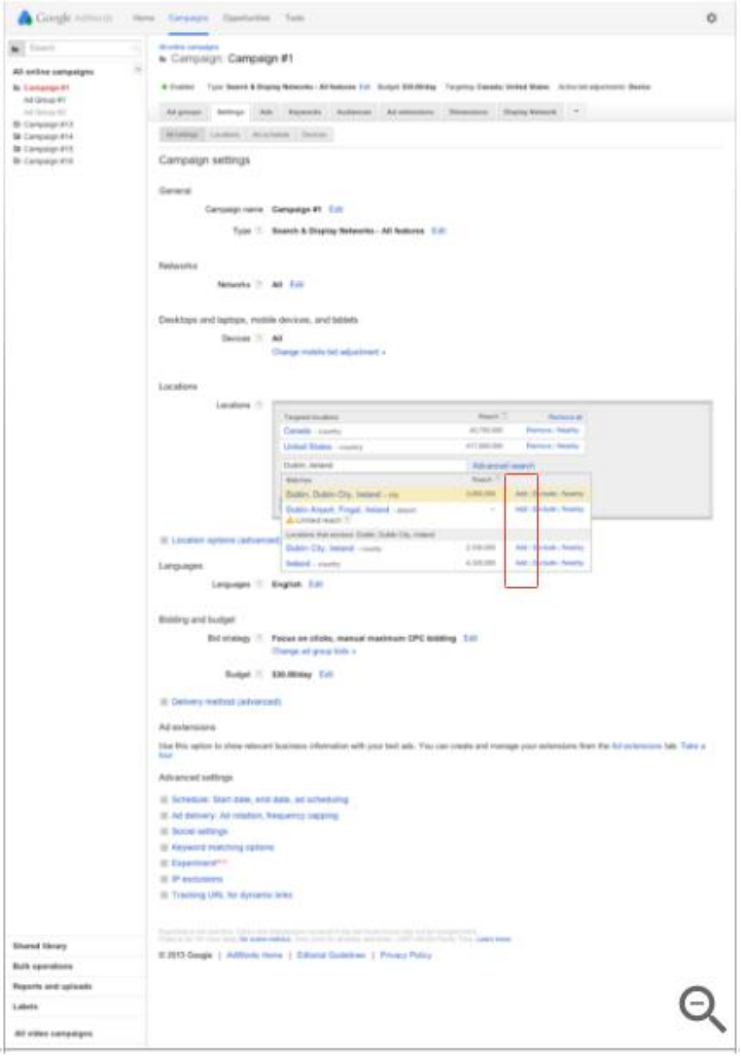


Figure 5.8: Adding Locations

8. Click **Save** to save the settings.

5.3.4 Targeting a Radius around a Location

On targeting a radius, the list of locations available within the radius is displayed. This is also known as 'Locations within this target'. It is a good practice to evaluate these locations to ensure that the desired areas have been captured. Keep in mind that on selecting a small radius, the ads may or may not be displayed occasionally. There is an option to refine targeting by independently selecting cities or regions within the radius.

Complete the following steps to target a radius:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Click the name of the campaign to be edited.
4. Click **Settings**.
5. Click **Edit** in the **Locations** section and then click **Advanced search**.

6. Click **Radius targeting**. Refer to figure 5.9.

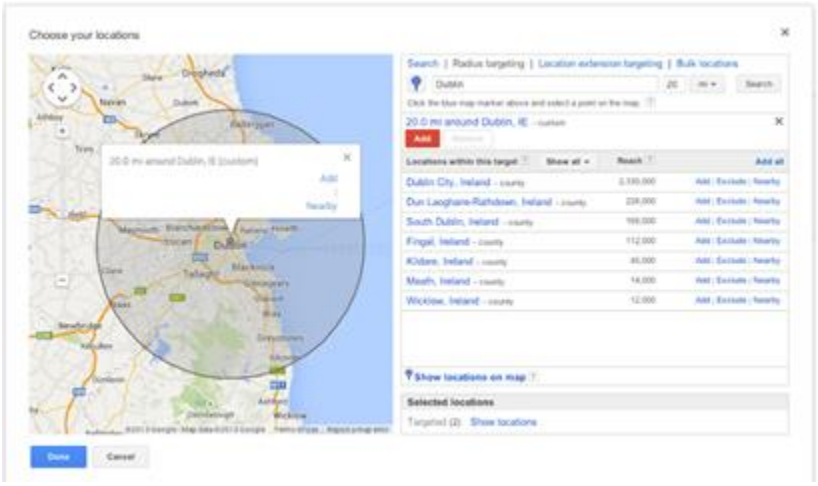


Figure 5.9: Radius Targeting on Map

7. In the search box, specify the address of the location to be used for the centre of the radius. Specify the radius to be targeted and select a measurement unit from the drop-down menu. Refer to figure 5.10.

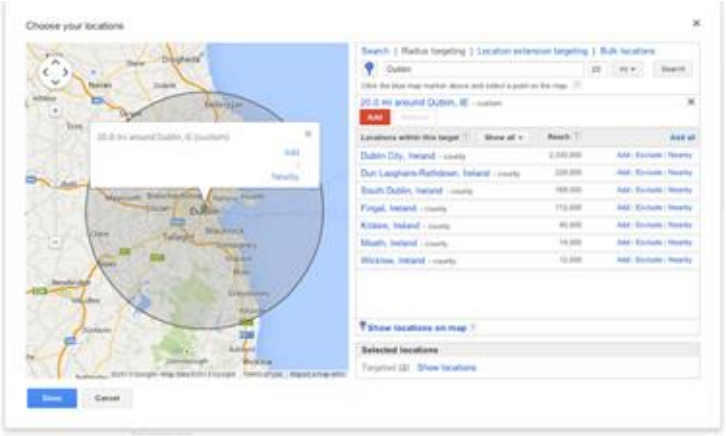


Figure 5.10: Adding Location Details and Units

8. Click **Search** to identify the radius on the map as shown in figure 5.11.

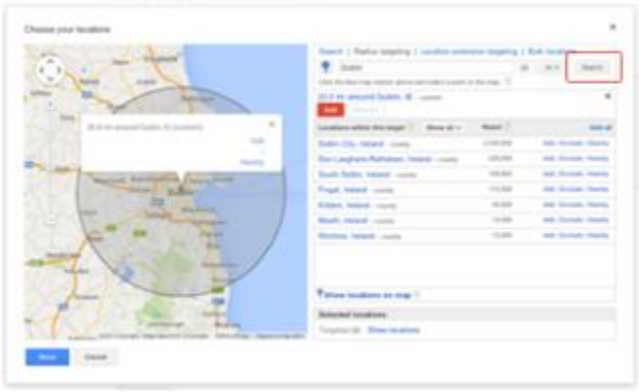


Figure 5.11: Searching Locations on Map

9. Check the map to ensure that the correct area is being targeted. Click **Add** to add the radius target. One can also select **Add all** to add all the individual locations within the radius selected, instead of adding the radius target. To refine the list of areas to be reached, exclude some locations or target only certain locations from this target list. In some cases, if the data is not sufficient for the location or if the area is too small then the reach for the area will not be displayed. Refer to Figure 5.12.

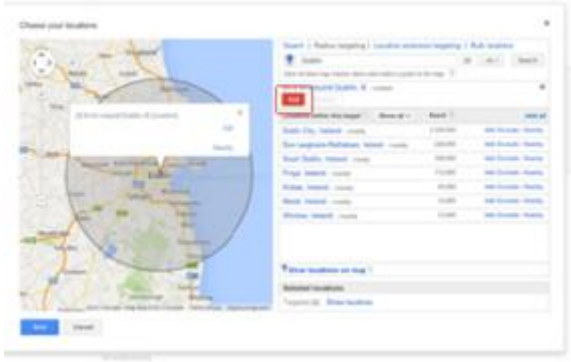


Figure 5.12: Targeting Searched Locations

10. Click **Done.**
11. Click **Save** to save the settings.

5.3.5 Advanced Location Options

Location options enables one to include or exclude users based on where they may be physically present or the places they may be interested in. Advanced advertisers can use these options to restrict their ads to be displayed only in locations where users are present or locations of interest, instead of using the default setting to display the ads in both the locations.

On defining the location targeting and location exclusion settings, one may want to refine the traffic even more.

Advanced location targeting options allows one to reach:

- Users in a specific location, searching for something specific, or users who show interest in the targeted location (recommended).
- Users in the targeted location.
- Users searching for something specific or have displayed interest in the targeted location.

Use advanced location exclusion options to exclude:

- Users in a specific location, searching for something specific, or users who show interest in excluded location (default).
- Users in the excluded location.

The advanced location options are applied to ads on GDN as well as the Search Network.

5.3.6 Comparing Targeting Options

By default, you will be able to reach users who may be physically present in the targeted areas as well as users who have expressed interest in the targeted areas. Users can express interest through their searches. For example, if one was recently present in a certain location, then the content they

view is either related to the location (pages or sites) they are present in or the location they select in their Google Search settings.

Areas that users express interest in are also termed as locations of interest, which can easily be identified irrespective of the Google search domain the user searches on.

It is also possible to switch to a different targeting option. Following example helps us to study the available targeting options and inspect how they might work in some examples:

'Reach people in your targeted location' feature enables one to display the ads to anyone who is thought to be physically located within the area that has been targeted. For example, a US-based taxi company wants to reach users located only in New York and looking for a cab. One can reach users in the targeted location, in order to reach users who may be present in New York when they search for the keyword taxi, irrespective of the Google domain they used for their search.

Targeting option: Reach people in my targeted location

Target location: New York

Target keyword: Taxi

Table 5.2 helps to understand the example.

Network	Person's location	The searched content /interest being shown	Ad will appear for that person?
Search or Display Network	Los Angeles	*New York taxi*	⊘
Search or Display Network	New York (all Google Search domains)	*taxi*	✓
Search or Display Network	New York	*taxi to San Diego*	✓
Search or Display Network	New York	*San Francisco taxi*	✓

Table 5.2: Understanding Reaching People in the Targeted Location Feature Works

Note: If a taxi company wants to reach users who want to travel from New York to San Diego (and assuming there are ads appropriate for those types of users), one can use this default advanced location option. The keyword taxi is eligible to appear for any users in New York. Also, users in New York are eligible to see the New York targeted ads when they search for a San Francisco taxi, though they may not see this ad on Google due to other factors.

If users outside the targeted area specify keywords related to the targeted locations in their searches, they will not be able to view the ads. Most campaigns see a decrease in impressions on changing the default targeting option. It is recommended to change the targeting option only if one wants to refine the traffic that the campaign is generating.

5.4 Language Targeting

While trying to communicate in a different language, one might find it difficult to get the message across. Likewise, with AdWords, the ads need to appear to users who can understand them. Ads can be enabled to appear for users using Google products and third-party Web sites in the languages that the campaign targets. This ensures that the ads appear on sites that are in the language of the users who need to be reached.

5.4.1 Choosing Target Language

Language targeting enables one to select the language of the sites where the ads are likely to appear. The ads are displayed to users who use Google products (such as Gmail or Search) or visit Web sites on the GDN in the language specified. However, AdWords does not translate ads or keywords. For example, if one wants to sell tea powder online and wants to target French speaking customers, then one needs to set up an AdWords campaign targeted in French, with French ads and keywords. As the customer's Google interface language settings are set to French, the tea powder ads will be displayed when the French language customers search for the keywords. If the customers search in French but their Google interface language settings are set to English, then the ads will not be displayed. This is why targeting all languages may be helpful.

Language targeting works for ads that run on the GDN, - a collection of Web sites that partner with Google to display AdWords ads. For example, if a tea powder business has an ad for freshly ground tea leaves with French ad text, then one can target ads to run only for customers who speak French.

5.4.2 Targeting All Languages on the Search Network

It is helpful to target all languages, if the intention is not to display ads to users who speak a certain language only. This helps one to reach users who speak more than one language. For example, consider a user speaks English and French but has set the Google interface language setting to French. It is possible that the user may search for something in English, like 'buy dresses online'. However, one should always keep in mind that targeting all languages is not always the best way forward. For example, if one has an ad with a word like 'motel' that is spelled in the same manner in multiple languages, one should not target all languages. Users who cannot understand the language in the ad, but still can see the ad. It is recommended to display this type of an ad in different languages creating a separate campaign for each language. This way one can make sure the language targeted is the same as the language the ad is written in.

Complete the following steps to set up language targeting:

1. Use the link https://adwords.google.com to sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Click the name of the campaign to be edited to open campaign settings.
4. Click **Settings**.
5. In the **Languages** section, click **Edit**.

6. Choose target language(s). In this example, English has been selected. Refer to figure 5.13.

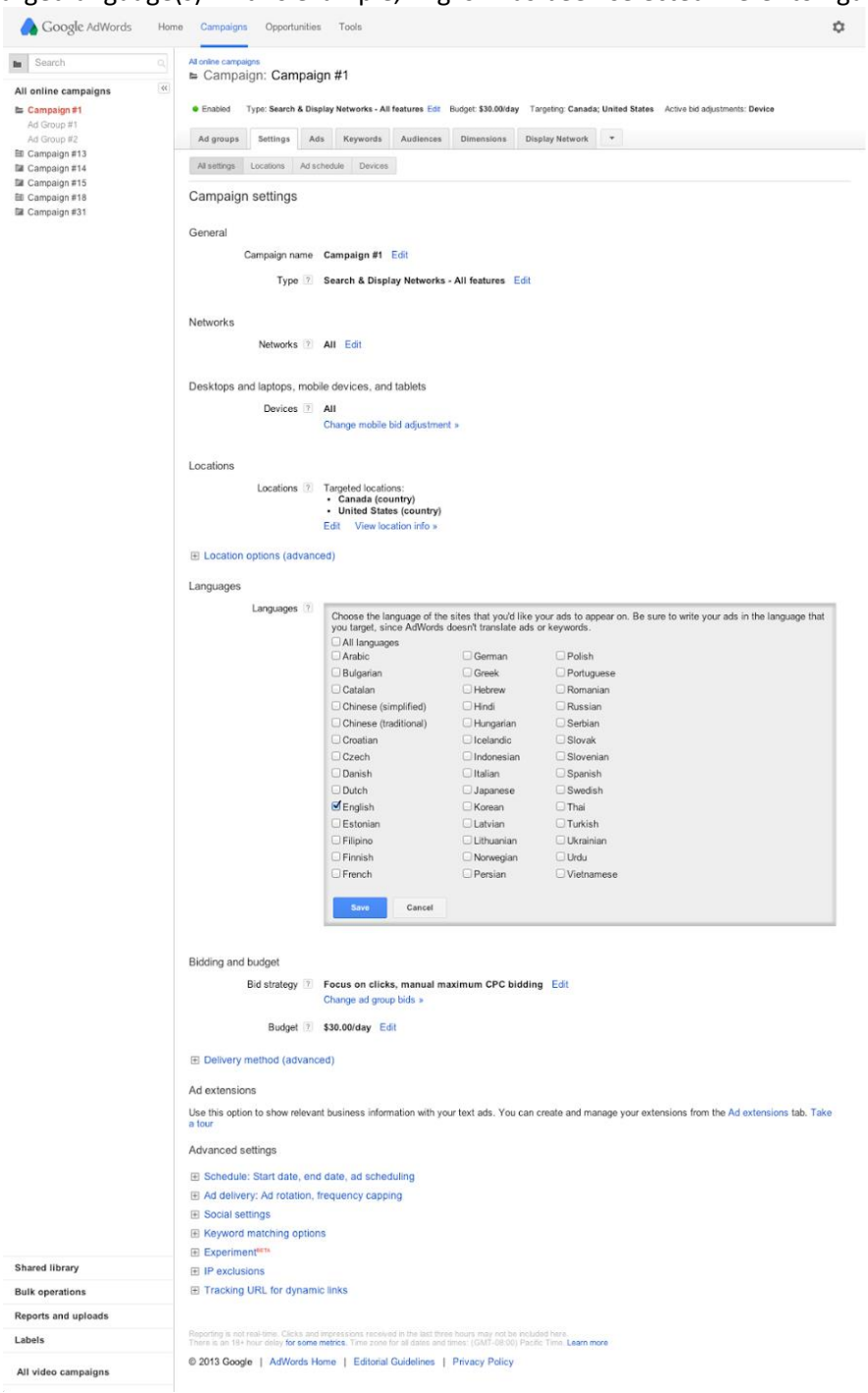


Figure 5.13: Setup Target Language

7. Click **Save**.

5.4.3 Google's Language Detection

Every Google domain has a default language in which the site appears. For example, Google.com automatically is displayed in English, Google.fr displayed in French, Google.cn displayed in Chinese, and so on.

The default language can be modified using the **Settings** link on the Google homepage. A French speaker living in the U.S., for instance, may want to perform a search on the U.S. domain, Google.com. This user can change the interface language setting to French. In such a case, the user can see ads targeting French instead of English.

On the GDN, AdWords may check the language of the pages that one is viewing or has recently viewed to understand which ads to display. This implies that the language is detected either from the pages that a user has already viewed or is currently viewing.

For example, Tanya has viewed numerous blogs related to baking on the GDN that are written in German, thus, she will also see ads from campaigns targeted to German speakers. She may also see German ads even if she reads other blogs on the GDN that are written in English due to her viewing history.

5.4.4 Organizing Campaigns by Language

The settings for language targeting are fixed at the campaign level. Hence, to target more than one language, it is recommended to create a separate campaign for each language. Creating a different campaign for each language ensures that the ad in a specific language also appears on a site that has content in the same language. This is helpful if one is targeting ads in multilingual countries, such as the US or India.

On targeting different languages in a single campaign, ads can be displayed on Web sites which are in different languages and does not match the language of the ad.

One may create ads in the language that one wants to target, because AdWords does not translate ads or keywords. For example, consider you want to target French and German speakers with an ad campaign for donuts. In this case, make one campaign with French keywords and ads related to donuts targeted to French language. Then, make a different campaign with German keywords and ads related to donuts, and this time, target the campaign to German language.

5.5 Fixing Placement Issues

Sometimes an ad may not be displayed on Web sites or other placements specified or may be displayed in unexpected locations. If the ad is not appropriately displayed, conducting a placement diagnosis can answer why the ad is not being displayed and can give instructions to improve the performance. To diagnose and fix placements, use one of the following campaign types or marketing objectives:

Following are the 'Display Network only' marketing objectives:

- View the ad
- Visit the Web site
- Make purchases on the Web site
- Take an action on the Web site
- Call the business
- Visit the business
- Engage with the mobile app
- Install the mobile app

Following are the available campaign types:

- Search Network with Display Select – All features

- Display Network only – Mobile apps
- Display Network only – Remarketing
- Display Network only – All features

Review the following points to ensure the campaign setup is correct:

- Ensure that the settings, ad format, and targeting methods are not preventing the ad from being displayed.
- Ensure that the correct campaign type is available. Check the **Settings** tab to ensure that one of the preceding campaign types is being used. If not, then the placements cannot be fixed or diagnosed. Other than placement diagnosis, one can also check the common issues and solutions to fix them.
- Ensure that the reach is not too narrow. Having multiple targeting methods (like topics and keywords with the placements) restricts the number of Web pages that meet all the criteria. For example, if one has specified certain placements and keywords, the ad will be displayed on those sites on pages that match the keywords which have been specified. This implies that an ad may be displayed on only a few pages, if at all. If the ad is not being displayed, try only one or two targeting methods to widen the reach.
- Ensure that the daily budget is not too low. With the standard delivery campaigns, if the daily budget is low in relation to the CPM bid or CPC bid, the system will spread the ad delivery throughout the day in a manner to restrict the entire daily budget from being exhausted too fast. To maximize the ad visibility throughout the day, try increasing the daily budget to an amount well above the CPM or CPC bid.
- Ensure that the ad scheduling has been set properly. The ad may not be found if it has been scheduled to run only during certain time intervals. Check the scheduling which has been set.
- Ensure that the keywords specified are relevant. It is possible that the keywords do not match the content of the placements on which the ads should be displayed. The ads will be displayed on Web sites only when the content matches the keywords. For example, on targeting an engine supply Web site, if the keywords specified are chocolates and roses, then the ad will not be displayed since the keywords are chocolates and roses.
- Ensure that the format sizes specified in the ad are correct. If an ad is not being displayed, it may be because the format size selected for the ad is not the size which some of the placements accept, For example, if an ad with a 250 x 300 rectangle is created and the placement targeted does not offer this size, then the ad will not be displayed on the targeted placement. Use the Display Planner tool to find out what ad sizes the placements accept.

5.6 Summary

- One can decide to target ads with specific languages and locations along with the budget and other settings.
- It is recommended to target the languages and locations that are pertinent to the business.
- The ideas for targeting and placement in Google AdWords are largely based on the understanding of Google Network, search targeting on the Google Network, and ad placements on Google Network.
- Use any one of the marketing objectives or campaign types to target topics.
- AdWords location targeting enables the ads to be displayed in the geographic locations specified. For example, countries, areas/regions within a country, an area/radius around a location, or location groups.
- Location targeting enables one to focus advertising on areas where the right users are located, as well as restrict certain areas.
- It is crucial for ads to appear at the right place at the right time.
- Location options enables one to include or exclude users based on where they may be present or the places in which they are interested.
- Language targeting enables one to specify the language of the sites where the ads should be displayed.

5.7 Check Your Progress

1. Targeting ads is crucial to:
   a. Reach users interested in certain topics
   b. Restricting ads from being displayed on pages about specific topics
   c. Reach a broad audience quickly
   d. All of these
2. Target the ads when:
   a. You have a restricted campaign budget
   b. Your CPA goal is very rigid
   c. You want to prevent your ads from appearing on pages unrelated to your business
   d. You want to reach a very specific set of audience quickly
3. Which of the following campaign types should be used to target topics?
   a. Search Network with Display Select - Standard
   b. Search Network with Display Select - All features
   c. Display Network only - All features
   d. Search Network only - All features
4. AdWords location targeting does not allow one to target:
   a. A radius around a location
   b. Areas within a country
   c. Certain specific houses in various locations
   d. Countries
5. Which of the following statement is not correct?
   a. If you target an area where your business is not located, the ad will not be shown when you search on Google.com
   b. If you target a small radius, your ads might not show at all
   c. It is appropriate to keep location targeting settings and language consistent
   d. Target only the locations where your business is physically located
6. Advanced location targeting options does not help one reach:
   a. Users in, searching for, or who have shown in your targeted location
   b. Users in, searching for, or who have shown interest in your excluded location
   c. Users in your targeted location
   d. Users searching for, or who have shown interest in your targeted location

5.7.1 Answers

1	d
2	c
3	c
4	c
5	d
6	b

SESSION 6 - ADWORDS COST MANAGEMENT

Session Objectives

This session focuses on how to modify campaign settings in order to tailor the campaign. It explains how to decide, modify and set a daily budget for the ads, and also provides some best practices to be followed while budgeting. It also explains how to bid for the ads and how to change them. It helps to determine a bid strategy based on the goals and provides some best practices to be followed while bidding. Thereafter, it explains how to manage the billing and provides the different payment options available.

At the end of this session, you will be able to:

- Manage Campaign budgets
- Know and apply bid strategies
- Manage your billing

6.1 Introduction

Simon is an advertising professional, new to Google AdWords. He has set up his AdWords account, has identified the kinds of ads that he would display, as well as the location and target of his ads. However, he needs to decide how much he would spend on his ads every day and how much he should spend on the keywords and placements. This is where he can use Google AdWords bidding and budgeting options.

AdWords budget encourages users to maintain the advertising expenses under control and the bid identifies the location and timing for the ad to appear. In this session, you will understand how to manage the daily budget and the different bid options that can be utilized to boost the ROI.

While planning a vacation, you know how important it is to set a limit on your expenses while considering the unexpected. Similarly, AdWords allow users to set daily expenses for their campaigns with an option to modify them at any time.

6.2 Managing Campaign Budgets

One can modify the campaign settings in order to tailor the campaign. The campaign settings chosen apply to all the ads within the same campaign. The type of campaign selected by the user identifies the settings that are available.

Setting and Managing Budgets

The AdWords system provides the advertiser with all the options necessary to set up and manage budgets. They can set up their own budget, choosing the amount to spend each day, or can view and use the system recommended budget on the Settings tab of the ad campaign. For client accounts that are using MDS, client managers can use the Budget tab of the MCC dashboard to modify the client's budget.

Similar to AdWords Bids, setting up and managing AdWords budgets is also very straightforward. The following is an explanation of the important aspects in reference to setting up AdWords budgets and the tools that help advertisers to manage AdWords budgets.

Google provides advertisers with a recommended daily budget for each ad campaign. This recommendation tries to ensure that the ad for the advertiser's keywords appear as frequently as possible. The recommended budget contains a detailed budget analysis. It is based on the ad campaign performance for the last 15 days. The budget allows advertisers to estimate how the new budget affects ad impressions. The new budget amount may vary as it takes into consideration this performance, the current budget, keyword list, and targeting settings.

The recommended steps to calculate a budget are as follows:

- Determine the total potential impressions
- Compare potential impressions with recent performance and costs
- Combine daily estimates
- Moderate recommended amounts to allow for testing

If the budget is high, it can increase the number of times the ad is displayed, which may result in more clicks and conversions. However, advertisers are always in control of their AdWords account and the recommended budgets are optional.

6.2.1 Deciding Daily Budget

Using AdWords allows selecting a daily budget for each campaign depending on the advertising goals and the basic cost one is willing to spend each day. Let us understand this with an example.

Consider your CPC is $0.10 on average and you are expecting around 200 clicks per day. You might budget $20 per day. You will calculate your daily budget as follows:

CPC x Clicks per day = Daily budget

$0.10 x 200 = $20 per day

If you have an advertising budget on a monthly basis, you can obtain the budget per day by dividing your monthly expenses by 30.4, which is the average number of days per month. Let us understand this with an example.

Consider your monthly budget for advertising is $608. To calculate your daily budget, divide $608 by 30.4 and you get a daily budget of $20. You will figure out your daily budget as follows:

Monthly budget / Average number of days per month = Daily budget

608 / 30.4 = $20 per day

You can also allocate shared budgets, which allows you to share your budget across multiple campaigns.

6.2.2 Budget Changes

Any modifications made to the daily campaign budget are reflected immediately in the account. Depending on when the budget is modified, the manner in which the campaign spends the budget can differ.

Table 6.1 shows how the budget is affected depending on the time or frequency of the modification:

Mid-day	Campaigns generally utilize around 50% of the allocated budget during the first half of the day and the remaining budget during the second half. However, if the demand for the ad is more in the first half, then 70% of the daily budget is utilized in the morning. If the budget is modified around noon time, an extra 50% of the new daily budget is spent in the afternoon. Thus, the total expense for the day could be slightly more than the daily budgets allocated for that day. This increase is because the system makes up for low traffic days by marginally surpassing the daily budget on higher traffic days, as long as it never crosses the monthly limit of the advertiser. If the daily budget is reduced significantly, it can cause the ad distribution to slow down significantly for the remaining part of the day.
Multiple times a day	An account is charged depending on the maximum daily budget selected for that day.
Mid-month	An account is charged for the month based on: New budget X the number of days remaining in the month + total amount used for the campaign prior to the budget modification. **Example** If on January 21st your daily budget is $5, and you have already utilized $100, and later you modify the daily budget to $20, you will be charged as follows: $100 spent so far + ($20/day X 7 days remaining) = $240
Multiple times a month	It is calculated similar to the one for changing the budget mid-month.

Table 6.1: Budget Changes

Though a user does not change the daily campaign budget intentionally, the following still reflect as budget changes:

- Altering the campaign end date.
- Altering the delivery mode (standard delivery or accelerated delivery).
- Selecting a new time zone for the AdWords account.

6.2.3 Setting a Budget

Perform the following steps to set a daily budget for a new campaign:

1. Use the link https://adwords.google.com to sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the **Campaigns** tab.
3. Click **+ Campaign** and choose the campaign type to create:
    - Search Network with Display Select
    - Search Network only

- Display Network only

4. On the **Select campaign settings** page, go to **Budget** section and provide a daily budget or use a shared budget as shown in figure 6.1.

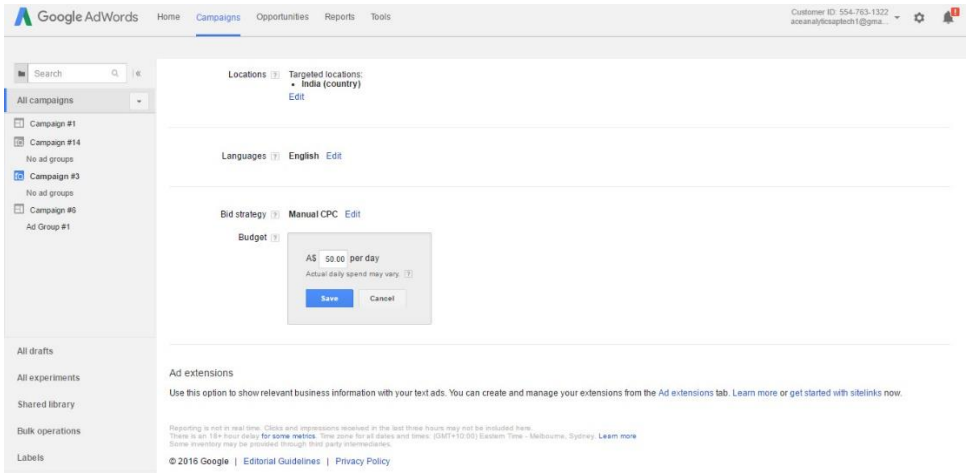


Figure 6.1: Setting Campaign Budgets

5. Finish or select other campaign settings and click **Save and continue**.

Note:

- **Get a recommendation**: AdWords displays recommended budgets for campaigns that recurrently meet their daily budget but have the ability to obtain more clicks and impressions.
- **Do not set and forget**: Check the account frequently to identify campaigns that are restricted by budget or have unused budget. A restricted budget means lesser clicks than the ad might have otherwise received, whereas a bloated budget increases the CPC of the ads if using automatic bidding. View the Status column on the Campaigns tab to check if any of the campaigns show a 'Limited by budget' status.

With AdWords, users can alter their budget at any time.

Changing Daily Budget

1. Daily budget can be modified any number of times and at any time. Perform the following steps to edit the daily campaign budget using the Campaigns tab: In the **Campaigns** table, click the budget cell to edit.
2. Enter a new campaign budget as shown in figure 6.2.
3. Click **Save**.

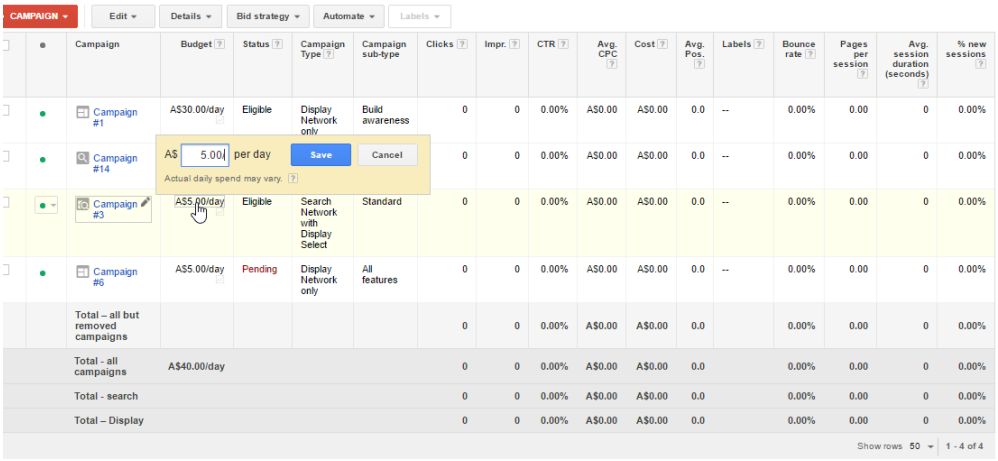


Figure 6.2: Managing Your Daily Budgets

Perform the following steps to edit the daily campaign budget using the campaign's Settings tab:

1. Select the campaign to edit.
2. Click the **Settings** tab.
3. In the **Budget** section, click **Edit** link next to the campaign's daily budget as shown in figure 6.3.

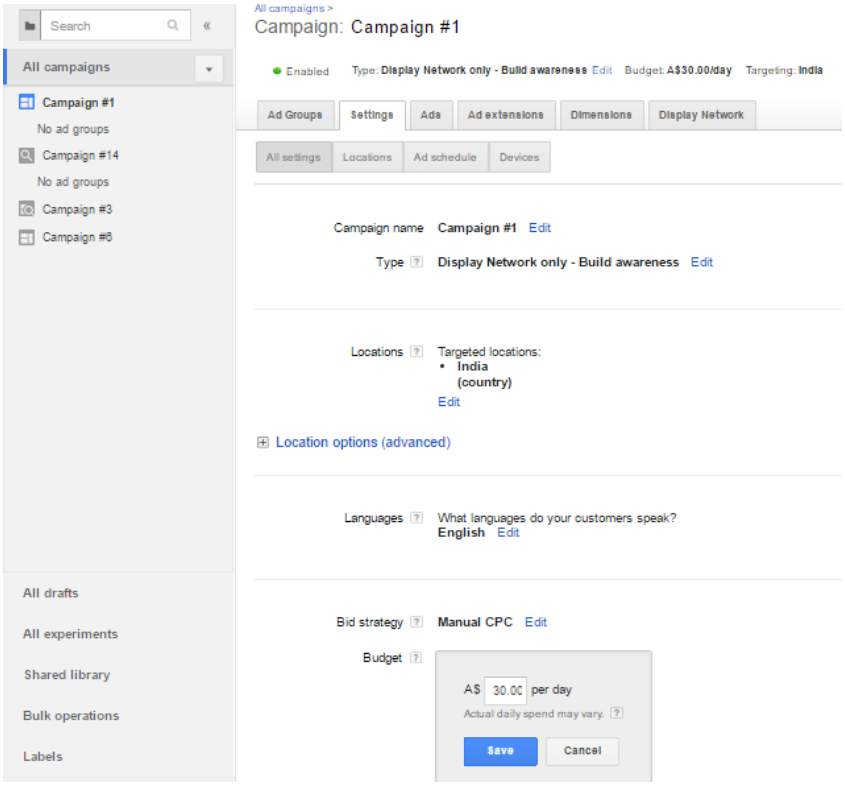


Figure 6.3: Editing Your Campaign Budgets

4. Provide the new budget.
5. Click **Save**.

Best Practices for AdWords Budgets

Similar to AdWords bidding, AdWords budgets can help in optimizing an ad campaign. It also allows an advertiser to have more control over their marketing costs.

Some best practices that advertisers can follow when using AdWords Budgets are as follows:

For Normal Accounts:

- The daily budget is not equal to the total account spend. The daily budget applies to individual campaigns only.
- Monitor the bids carefully as they are the primary way to control advertising spends.
- Advertisers may like to try different budgets for their ad campaign. However, advertisers may modify the daily budget for each campaign a maximum of ten times in a single day.
- Optimize the ad campaign to control advertising spend. If the budget limit is reached before the end of the day, optimize the ads and keywords to ensure that the ads receive more targeted traffic and displays throughout the day.

For Managed Accounts on MDS:

- Ensure that the accumulated monthly spend for the MDS managed accounts do not exceed the company's approved credit line with Google. Contact Google to know the credit line.
- It is possible to create as many budgets as required for each managed account. The duration of each budget can vary - monthly, quarterly, yearly, and so on. Be consistent with each managed account so the end dates can be managed easily.
- The start date of a new budget is, by default, set to three days in the future. For example, if a budget is created on January 19, the start date is automatically set as January 22. If necessary, update the start date.
- Start dates for new budgets cannot overlap with other budgets that may have been set up for the managed account. This is especially important for accounts that are currently on credit terms with monthly budgets.

6.3 Bid Strategy

AdWords bidding allows AdWords professionals to optimize the traffic to their Web sites generated by pay-per-click, pay-per-impression, or pay-per-conversion advertising. It is important to understand the value of each click, impression or conversion, and how to maximize the profits generated from a marketing investment.

A 'bid' is the amount that an advertiser pays per click, per thousand impressions, or per acquisition. This is an important factor when reviewing the performance of ads because, each time an ad meets the requirements to be displayed, it will compete with other eligible ads in an auction.

The bid is one of the most important factors that will determine whether the ad will show up. It also determines what position it will be displayed.

6.3.1 Determining a Bid Strategy Depending on the Goals

AdWords has numerous bid strategies that are adaptable to different types of campaigns advertising goals. Users can identify the appropriate strategy based on the networks their campaign is targeting, and on what they are focussing such as receiving clicks, impressions, or conversions.

Consider the Goals

While bidding, the three basic goals to be considered along with the current campaign settings are:

- To create traffic to the Web site, it is advisable to focus on the number of clicks. Thus, CPC bidding may be appropriate for this type of campaign.

- To maximize brand awareness—not driving traffic to the site— it is advisable to focus on impressions. Thus, Cost Per Thousand viewable impressions (vCPM) bidding is apt to show the message to customers.
- To direct customers to take action on the site while using conversion tracking, it is advisable to focus on conversions. Thus, CPA bidding may be appropriate for this type of campaign.

Focussing on Clicks with CPC Bidding

If the goal is to obtain clicks to create traffic to your Web site, consider the following two CPC bidding strategies:

- **Maximize Clicks**: Being an automated bidding strategy, it is the simplest means to bid for clicks. To use this, select a daily budget and AdWords automatically administers the bids to gain most clicks possible within the budget.
- **Manual CPC bidding**: It allows users to administer their maximum CPC bids themselves. They can choose different bids for every ad group in their campaign, or for each keyword or placement. If they have identified particular keywords or placements that generate more profit, they can select manual bidding to assign more of the advertising budget to such keywords or placements.

Focussing on Impressions with Manual vCPM Bidding

Manual bidding for viewable impressions allows managing the visibility of the ads by refining the maximum vCPM bids. Following are some examples for which Google advises to use manual vCPM bidding:

- Ads that are created to enhance awareness, but may not generate clicks or traffic.
- Using the traditional industry metrics of vCPM campaigns.
- Targeting specific placements, not only keywords. (Bidding for impressions along with placement targeting ensures that the ads show up to particular customers who will be interested in those ads.)
- Maximizing brand awareness is achieved mostly using image ads and other multimedia formats, which run on the Display Network.
- Ads that do not require any clicking as the message is included in the ad itself for example, events (television premiere) or political advertising.

Manual vCPM bidding is not the right choice if the ad's aim is to receive a direct response from customers, like purchasing a product or filling out a survey.

Example

Consider you are offering a free concert in London and you want to get many music lovers to attend it. You have designed a campaign for the same using vibrant image ad that includes the date, time, and place of the concert. Just viewing your ad can give the whole message a person needs to attend the concert. vCPM bidding can aid you to reach as many people as possible.

Focussing on Conversions with Target CPA Bidding

Target CPA bidding is an advanced type that allows to bid directly for conversions. However, the campaign must meet the following requisites to be authorized for Target CPA bidding:

- Conversion tracking must be enabled.
- Campaigns must target either the Search Network or Display Network, or both.

- Campaigns are direct-response oriented. For example, the campaign's goal is to generate sign-ups or sales on an e-commerce Web site.
- Campaigns must have a well-defined conversion type, for example, a completed purchase or sign-up.
- Campaigns must have a fairly steady conversion rate, with no major modifications (redefining the conversion event or changing the conversion tracking code) within the previous two weeks.
- Campaigns should obtain a minimum of 50 conversions per month. As AdWords depends on historical conversion data, the longer the conversion tracking has been operating, the more details the system provides, and the better it can perform to optimize the ROI.

6.3.2 Understanding Bidding Basics

AdWords offers numerous ways to bid for the ads, based on what is important to the business. Advertisers mostly concentrate on clicks, impressions, conversions, or views (for video ads).

Before advertising on AdWords, users must have a defined goal in mind for their ads. For example, if you sell coffee, your goal may be to attract more people to visit your coffee shop. If you run a hiking club, your goal may be to get people to sign up for your newsletter.

Knowing what you prefer your ads to do will aid in deciding how to bid.

Note: Whenever there is an empty space available on a search result, blog, news site, or other sites, AdWords runs an auction. Each auction determines the AdWords ads that will appear at that instant in that space. The bid helps customers to be a part of the auction.

While bidding, users can focus on various factors such as clicks, impressions, conversions, views, or engagements, based on their campaign type.

There are three types of bid strategies that can be applied to different types of campaigns. These strategies are as follows:

- **Cost-Per-Click (CPC)**: This strategy can be manual or automatic. The goal of using this strategy is that it should drive more customers to your Web site.
- **Cost-Per-Impression (CPM)**: This strategy ensures that the customer views the message. This goal of this strategy is that it increases brand awareness.
- **Cost-Per-Acquisition (CPA):** This strategy focuses on conversions. This means the customer can take direct action on your Web site. Example sign in, shopping, and so on.

The most common of these three is the maximum CPC bid. When using CPC bidding, advertisers pay for the ad only, when someone clicks the ad. Advertisers can improve the ad's position by raising the CPC bid; while on the other hand, lowering the CPC bid lowers the ad's position.

The AdWords system provides advertisers with multiple bidding options that can be used as per requirement. Currently, there are three main categories of keyword bidding:

- **Focus on clicks (involves Search and Display Ads)**: If the objective is to ensure people visit your Web site, then clicks are the right choice to start with. Use CPC bidding and you will be charged only when people actually click your ad and view your site. Following two options are offered by CPC bidding:
  - **Automatic bidding**: This is the easiest type of bidding in which users assign a daily budget and let AdWords manage their CPC bids to get the maximum clicks possible within that budget.
  - **Manual bidding**: This allows users to completely control the CPC bids. It lets them assign bids at various levels such as the ad group level, individual keywords, or ad placements. This allows

them to know they are bidding just for the clicks that are important. For example, if you own a hiking club in the U.S., you might prefer to bid more for direct-hit keywords like 'U.S. hiking' and a lesser bid for 'hiking maps' which is broader keyword.

- **Focus on impressions**: Rather than paying by the click, users can pay depending on the number of times their ad is displayed, if their campaign is targeting just the Display Network. This type of bidding is also called vCPM bidding as users pay for every 1,000 times their ad is shown and is viewable. This type is the right choice if users mostly prefer their name or logo to reach lots of people.

  vCPM bidding, similar to CPC manual bidding, allows to assign bids at the ad group level, or for single placements.

- **Focus on conversions (involves Search, Display, and Shopping ads)**: This advanced bidding allows users to choose the amount they are ready to pay for a conversion, or CPA. A conversion (also known as an acquisition) is defined as a specific action that users want to see on their Web site. Mostly it is a sale, but it can also be an e-mail sign-up or some other action. Though users pay for every click, AdWords automatically sets their bids to get maximum conversions at the CPA they specified.

  To use CPA bidding, conversion tracking must be turned ON, therefore, CPA bidding is suitable for intermediate and advanced AdWords users.

6.3.3 Changing the Bids

AdWords provides multiple methods to set the bids ranging from manual CPC bidding to a number of automated bid strategies. Each strategy is created to ensure a particular business goal is achieved. Sometimes, the goals may change and this may require updating the bid strategy.

Perform the following steps to update the existing bids:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. In the **Campaigns** tab, click the campaign to edit.
3. Click the **Settings** tab.
4. Go to the **Bid strategy** section and click **Edit**. Change the bid strategy as shown in figure 6.4.
5. Select the new bid strategy.
6. Click **Save**.

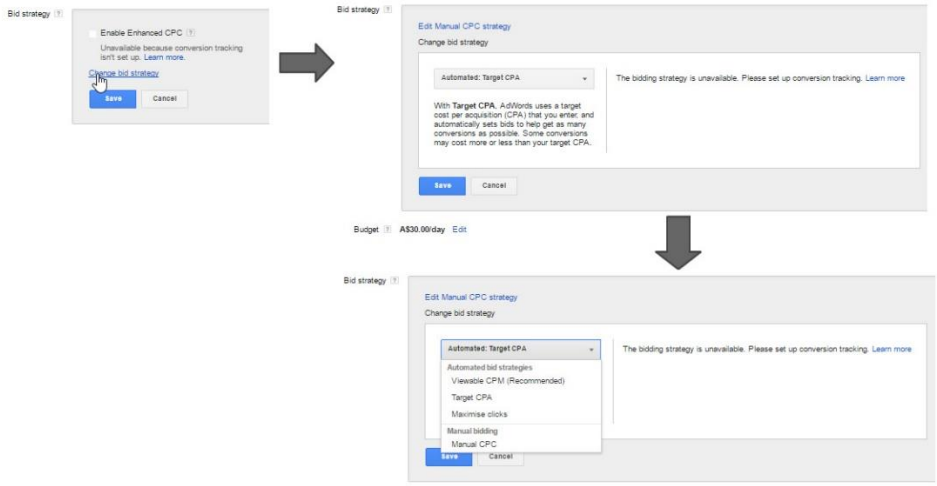


Figure 6.4: Setting Bid Strategy

Note: One can save time managing the bids using the portfolio bid strategies. Portfolio bid strategies combine many campaigns, ad groups, and keywords into an automated bid strategy. Thus, the bids can be optimized more strategically to the whole campaigns or particular ad groups and keywords.

6.3.4 Automated Bidding

Automated bidding requires some guesswork to set bids that match the performance goals. Each strategy is created to help to achieve a particular goal for the business. Let us understand this type of bidding with an example.

Example

Consider you want to increase the clicks for a low-performing keyword in one of your campaigns, but you do not have the time to set an individual maximum CPC for each single keyword. You can add those keywords to a portfolio Maximize Clicks strategy and set a target budget. This allows AdWords to automatically increase the bids of those low-performing keywords, while you manage your most important keywords.

To increase your performance in ad auctions, some strategies alter bids with the help of the following:

- Auction-time details such as device, location, browser, and time of day.
- Whether someone is on one of your remarketing lists or not.

There are different types of flexible bid strategies which can be created and applied. You can create strategy for campaigns, ad groups, or keywords that will be stored in the Shared Library for centralized management and performance monitoring.

Table 6.2 explains the different types of bid strategies along with their goal and range.

Goal	Bid Strategy	Range
Enhance site visits. Enhance clicks on low-traffic terms while maintaining a particular spend.	**Maximize Clicks** automatically fixes the bids to obtain maximum clicks within the budget. It is available as either a standard or portfolio bid strategy. It was previously known as 'automatic bidding'.	Campaigns, ad groups, keywords
Enhance visibility on the initial page of Google search results or to be in the top position.	**Target Search Page Location** automatically fixes your bids to enhance the possibility of your ads showing up at the top of the page or on the initial page of search results. It is only available as a portfolio bid strategy.	Campaigns, ad groups, keywords
Obtain more visibility than other **domain**s within the search results.	**Target Outranking Share** allows you to select a domain that needs to be outranked in search results and how frequently you want to outrank it. AdWords automatically fixes the bids to meet that target. It is only available as a portfolio bid strategy.	Campaigns, ad groups, keywords
Obtain more conversions with the target CPA.	**Target CPA** automatically sets bids to help get maximum conversions at the target CPA you set. Some conversions may cost higher or lower than your target. It is available as either a standard or portfolio bid strategy. It was previously known as 'Conversion Optimizer'.	Campaigns, ad groups

Goal	Bid Strategy	Range
Enhance conversions while controlling keyword bids.	**Enhanced Cost-Per-Click (ECPC)** automatically fixes the manual bids to increase conversions. ECPC is presented as an optional feature with Manual CPC bidding or as a portfolio bid strategy.	Campaigns, ad groups
Meet a target Return on Ad Spend (ROAS) when you each conversion is valued differently.	**Target ROAS** automatically sets bids to get maximum conversion value at the target ROAS you set. Some conversions may have a more or less return than your target. It is available as either a standard or portfolio bid strategy.	Campaigns, ad groups, keywords

Table 6.2: Different Types of Bidding Strategies

Creating a Portfolio Bid Strategy

Portfolio bid strategies are automated bid strategies that are goal-driven and assist in maximizing the bids across many campaigns, ad groups, and keywords. The bid is set automatically for every auction to aid in achieving the performance goals, and to offer a single place to instantly modify bidding settings for all ad groups, campaigns, and keywords that are using a single portfolio bid strategy.

Perform the following steps to create a portfolio strategy with a new campaign:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the **Campaigns** tab.
3. Click **+ Campaign** and select the campaign type.

Note: Portfolio bid strategy is not an option for video campaigns or universal app campaigns.

4. In the **Bid strategy** section, select the strategy type from the drop-down menu. Based on the bid strategy type selected, click **Use a portfolio strategy** as shown in figure 6.5.

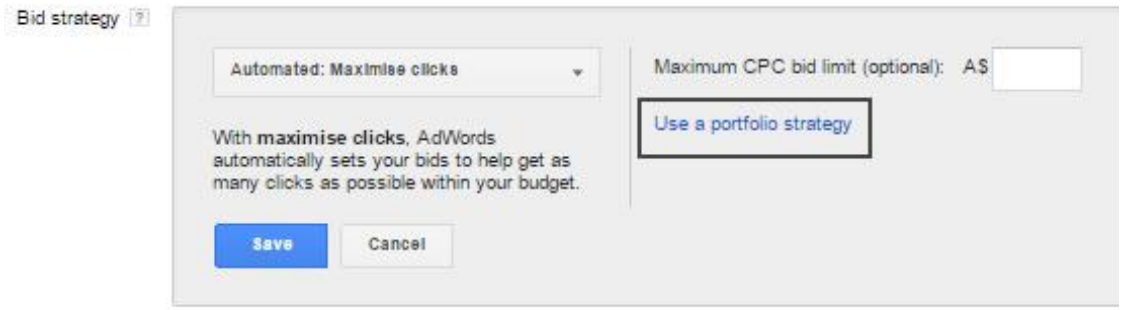


Figure 6.5: Automated Bid Strategy

5. Select **Create a new portfolio strategy**.
6. Enter the settings for the new strategy and name it.

Perform the following steps to create a portfolio strategy using the campaign settings:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the **Campaigns** tab.
3. Click the campaign to edit.

4. Go to the **Bid strategy** settings and click **Edit**.
5. Click **Change bid strategy**.
6. Select the bid strategy type from the drop-down menu. Based on the bid strategy type click **Use a portfolio strategy**.
7. Enter the settings for the new strategy and name it as shown in figure 6.6.

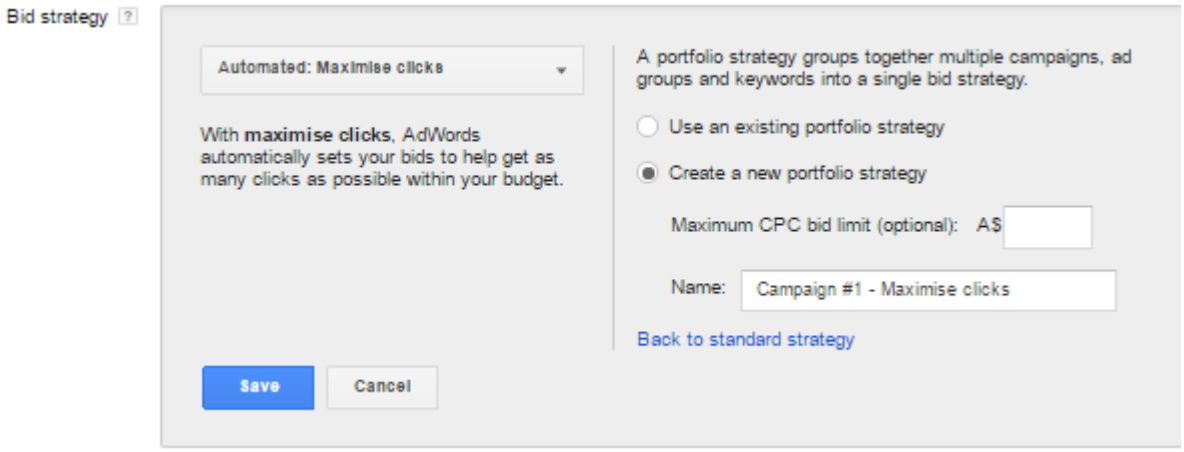


Figure 6.6: Setting Portfolio Bid Strategy

Perform the following steps to create a portfolio strategy in the Shared library:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the **Campaigns** tab.
3. Click **Shared library** on the left hand side.
4. Click **View** in the **Bid strategies** section.
5. Click **+ Bid strategy** and choose a bid strategy type.
6. Enter the settings for the new portfolio bid strategy and click **Save**.

Best Practices for AdWords Bidding

AdWords bidding is one of the most critical factors that help in optimizing an ad campaign. It is, therefore, important to use bidding options optimally. Some best practices that advertisers can follow when using AdWords bidding are as follows:

- **Choose the correct bidding strategy:** Choose a bidding strategy that conforms to the advertising goals. When focusing on clicks, use CPC Bidding. When focusing on visibility use CPM Bidding. When focusing on customer action, use CPA Bidding (Conversion Optimizer).
- **Implement AdWords Conversion Tracking:** Check the cost per conversion when using different CPC bids.
- **Use Bid Simulator:** Use this to see the possible advertising results based on a different keyword maximum CPC bid. Note that this tool does not predict the future, but it does give advertisers a fair idea of how each bid will perform for making an informed decision.
- To see a bid simulation for a keyword, click the bid simulator icon next to the maximum CPC bid.
- **Identify keywords and placements providing best results:** Identify the best keywords and placements, and then adjust and create the ads based on them.

6.4 Managing your Billing

The Billing tab in AdWords account servers as a single point from which users can manage all the billing settings and pay for the advertising costs.

6.4.1 Understanding your Billing Options

Two factors to consider while setting up your payment details for AdWords are the payment setting and payment method.

- **Payment setting**: How to make payments can be adjusted using payment setting. Following are the options:
  - **Automatic payments**: In this method, users are automatically charged soon after their ads run. It is, either 30 days following the previous automatic charge or after a predetermined amount (also called threshold) is reached, whichever occurs first. There is also an option to make payments at any time to manage the costs.
  - **Manual payments**: In this method, users pay when they prefer for future costs but before their ads run. Later, as the ads run, the cost builds up and the credit from the payment decreases. When all the payment is utilized, the ads cease to run.
  - **Monthly invoicing (credit line)**: Some businesses are offered a Google credit line provided they meet particular requirements. In this method, the costs are accumulated and a monthly invoice in generated. Later businesses pay either with a check or bank transfer. The payments are calculated for a time period that is fixed with Google, according to their terms and conditions. Reach out to AdWords online specialist for more information about monthly invoicing.
- **Payment method**: This is the method with which bills are paid, such as a credit or debit card. The options available depend on the country (the country mentioned in the business address) and the currency chosen for the AdWords account.

6.4.2 Invoices and Payment Information

In AdWords account, click the gear icon and select **Billing** from the options displayed to view the transaction history, settings, payment methods, and billing profile details as shown in figure 6.7.

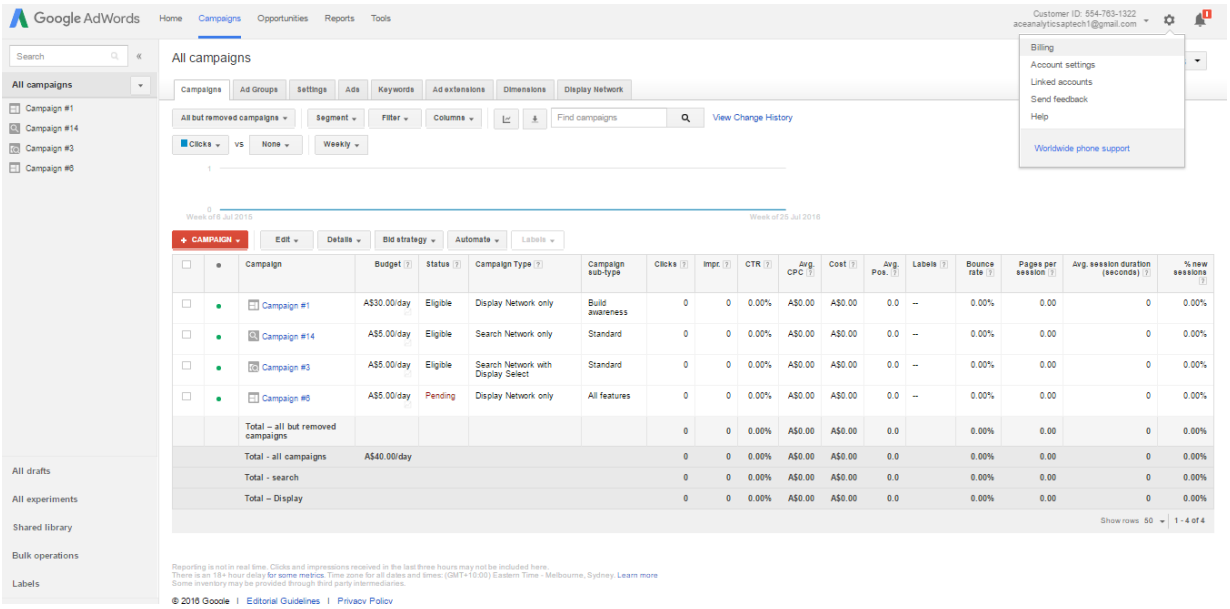


Figure 6.7: Billing and Payment Information Screen

6.4.3 Obtaining an Invoice or Payment Receipt

In most countries, AdWords does not e-mail invoices or payment receipts; users can obtain them from their account.

Automatic or Manual Payments (applies to most advertisers)

Perform the following steps to find and print current and previous invoices:

1. Sign in to AdWords account using the link https://adwords.google.com.
2. Click the gear icon and select **Billing** to go to the transaction history page.
3. Set the date to view the invoices as shown in figure 6.8.
   - The default view is **Last 3 months**, which shows the most recent invoice.
   - To view older invoices, set the date range with the help of the drop-down. For example, select **This year** to see invoices for the current year.

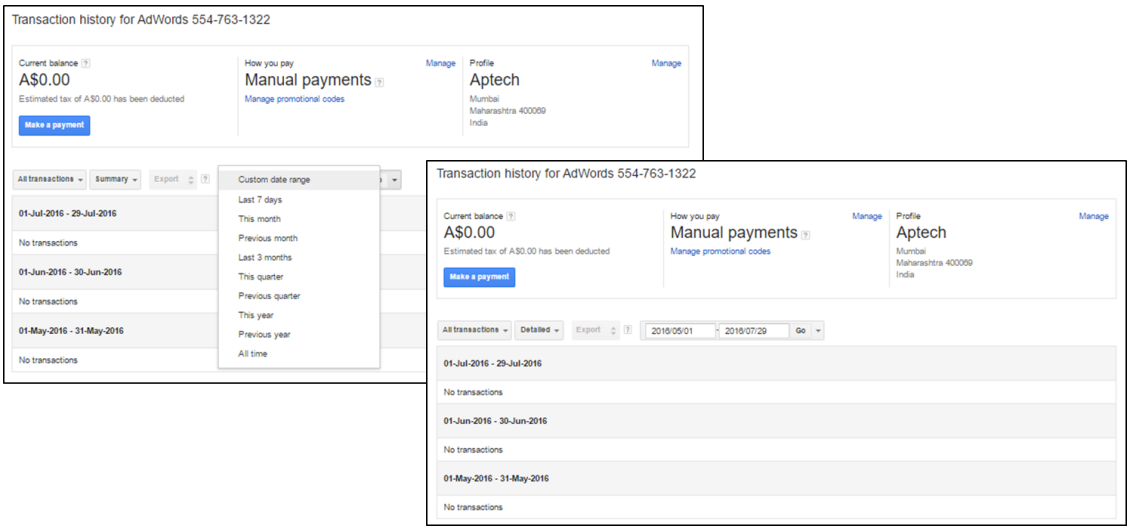


Figure 6.8: Obtaining Invoices

4. In the table, click the invoice number adjacent to the month to view the invoice as shown in figure 6.9.
   - Users cannot view the current month's invoice as it appears only at the end of the current month. In place of the link, **Invoice not ready** is displayed.
   - Invoice for a particular month is available only from the 5th business day of the preceding month. For example, August month invoice will be ready by September 5th. Invoices are not produced on weekends or on bank holidays. However, a receipt can be printed for each payment.
   - Invoice is created for payments made in the month and not for click costs. If no payments are made in a particular month, either the invoice is not generated for that month or a blank invoice is generated.

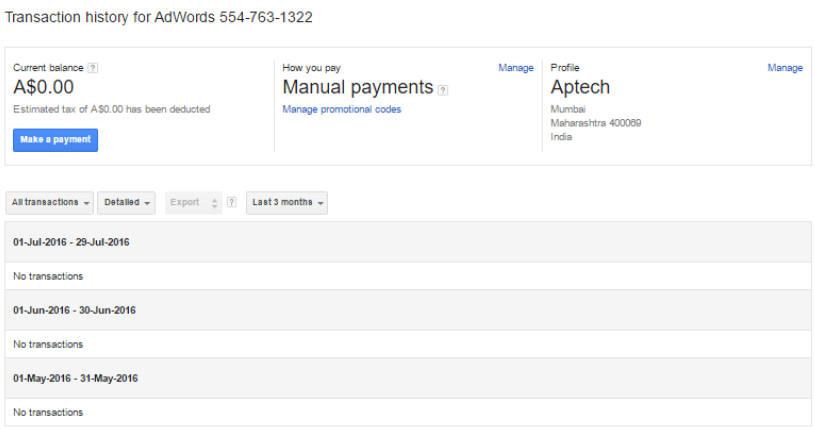


Figure 6.9: Transaction History

5. The invoice appears in a new window. To print it, from the browser menu select **File** and **Print**. Another way is to right-click the invoice and click **Print**. To download the invoice and save it, right-click and select **Save as**.

Note: Ensure browser settings do not block pop-ups as this may stop the invoice from opening.

Credit Line (Monthly Invoicing)

Following methods are applicable only to users on the monthly invoicing payment setting:

- **E-mail**: An e-mail will be sent with an invoice within five working days of the start of every month. It includes the costs for the previous month (The e-mail must be verified to get these invoices).
- **Mail:** If this option is chosen while setting up the account, the hard copy of the invoice will be mailed. One can also view and modify these settings on the Billing settings page, in the Mail invoice delivery or Email invoice delivery section.
- **Your account:** An electronic version of the invoice will be made available in AdWords account to view, print, or download it.

If the monthly invoicing payment setting is selected, following are the steps to find the invoices:

1. Use the link https://adwords.google.com to sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the gear icon and select **Billing**.
3. Click the **Invoices** link on the side of the page.
4. Find the invoice to view in the Invoice number column.
5. Click the Download Icon adjacent to the invoice number. A .pdf version of the invoice begins to download, which can be printed.

If users are not certain about the payment setting, they can verify the payment setting by clicking the gear icon and selecting **Billing** within AdWords account. The payment setting is available at the top in the **How you pay** section as shown in figure 6.10.

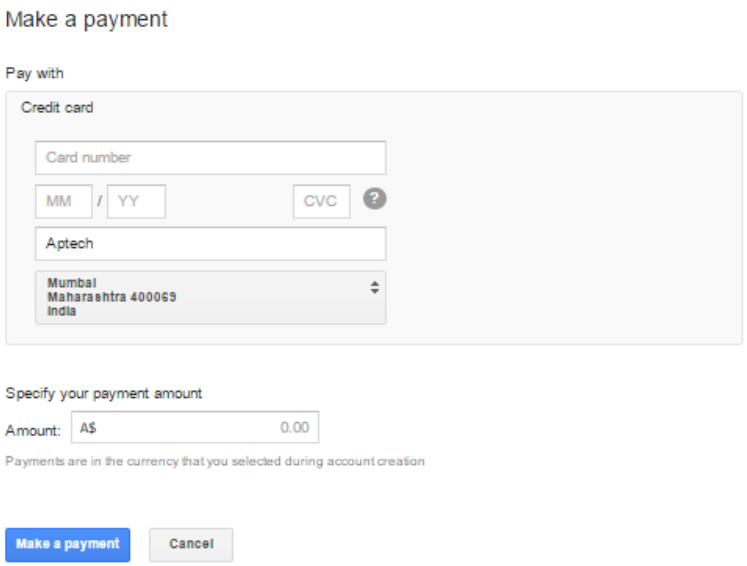


Figure 6.10: Making a Payment

6.4.4 Payment Method

A payment method is the mode you select to pay for AdWords. The payment methods can differ based on the country and currency chosen. In this section, let us understand how to utilize the payment methods available in a country and also about the types of credit cards that are accepted.

Bank Account (also called direct debit)

In this payment method, the payment for AdWords is deducted directly from the users' bank account. If the automatic payment setting is selected, Google directly charges the bank account for the accrued costs. If the manual payment setting is selected, users can pay manually.

To use this payment method, save payment details in the AdWords account and then validate the bank account. This process differs based on the country. Following steps help to set up a bank account as the payment method:

1. Use the link https://adwords.google.com to sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the gear icon and select **Billing**.
3. Click the **Billing settings** link.
4. In the **Your selections** setting, click the **Add a new payment method** button.
5. Select Bank account, fill in the bank details, and agree to the terms and conditions.
6. Check the box adjacent to **Set this payment method as primary** to set this as your primary payment method.
7. Click **Save**.

Following are some of the factors that need to be considered:

- It can take couple of days to process the payment.
- If a new account set up, the ads will be shown only after the bank account is verified. If users want their ads to run in the meantime, they must pay using a credit card.
- If the account is already set up, use the bank account as a primary payment method. This again works only after the bank account is verified.
- If users prefer their ads to not appear soon after their bank account is verified, they can pause the campaigns.

- Users must save all records of the payment made until they can view them in AdWords account.

Credit Cards and Debit Cards

Along with certain types of credit cards, Google also accepts debit cards, which have the Visa or MasterCard logo. Users can use a credit or debit card irrespective of the type of payment automatic payments or manual payments.

In order to make use of a credit or debit card with the automatic payment setting, add the same to AdWords account and set it as the primary payment method.

When using the automatic payment setting, if the primary payment method does not function due to some reason, a backup credit card can keep the ads running.

Perform the following steps to set up a backup credit card:

1. Use the link https://adwords.google.com to sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the gear icon and select **Billing**.
3. Click **Billing settings**.
4. In the **Your selections** section, click **Add a new payment method**.
5. Fill in the payment details and click **Save**.
6. The **Billing settings** page appears. Here, search the credit card just added and click **Set as Back up**.

Users can make a payment using any payment method available to them using the following steps:

1. Use the link https://adwords.google.com to sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the gear icon and select **Billing**.
3. Click the **Make a payment** button as shown in figure 6.11.

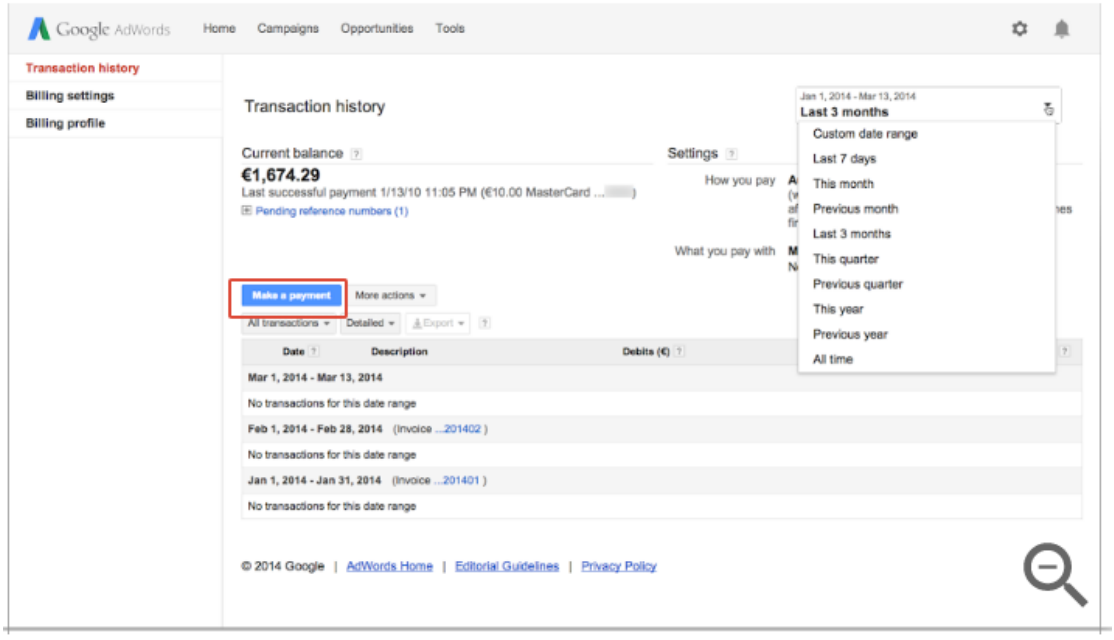


Figure 6.11: Transaction History

Note: Users have to give details regarding their payment method if it is not already part of the account.

Payments Using the Manual Payment Setting

In manual payment setting, users pay even before their ads run and that payment is used to pay the ad cost once they start running. The same steps recur every time users want to make payment to the AdWords account. As the amount in the account starts getting low, an e-mail will be sent to reminding to make another payment.

Following are the factors to be considered while making payments with this setting:

- **Pay any amount**: One can decide the amount to pay provided it is more than the minimum transaction amount fixed for that particular location and currency. This minimum can be seen while making the payment.
- **Save the favorite payment methods in the account**: One can pay easily and more quickly by saving many payment methods in the account.
- **Utilize any payment method**: One can either pay with any payment method in that account, or with a new method offered in that country and currency.
- **Keep the ads running**: Pay consistently to ensure the ads run—the recommended is 30 times the cumulative amount of the ad campaign daily budgets. If the balance is running low, an e-mail (depending on the notification settings) will be sent when the budget has lesser than a week's worth of advertising cost.
- **Allow for processing time**: Based on the mode of payment, it requires 24 hours to 7 days or more for the amount to reach the account. Allow for this time while trying to keep the ads running.
- **Remember VAT**: In few countries, a Value-Added Tax (VAT) is also applied on the payments. In such cases, ensure to factor the VAT deduction into the payments.

Payments Using the Automatic Payment Setting

While using the automatic payment setting users still have an option to make a separate, manual payment at any time. Users might choose to make such a payment for the following reasons:

- **To monitor how and when they are charged**: Using manual payment users can pay their complete AdWords account balance, a part of it, or more than the balance to include future costs. They can either choose a new payment method or distribute the balance among a number of them. This aids in delaying when the primary payment method is charged.

  Note: When users pay using manual payment method close to the automatic payment due date, in some cases they might be charged twice. Let us understand this with an example.

  Consider you have a campaign which has an everyday budget of $1,000 and you are charged whenever your costs reach $500. This implies that you are charged many times a day.
  Now assume you pay $5,000 with another payment method, implying that you are paying for five days of advertising costs ($1,000 x 5 = $5,000). This implies that your primary payment method will not be charged until you have consumed the $5,000 payment and an extra $500, which triggers another charge.

- **Automatic payment is rejected but users want the ads to run**: Sometimes banks reject credit card or bank account payments for numerous reasons. In such instances, a manual payment can be made to ensure the ads continue to run while the issue is being fixed with your bank. If users pay using another credit card, by bank transfer, or using another bank account, the ads will run again after the payment is received by Google.

6.5 Summary

- The AdWords budget encourages maintaining the advertising expenses under control and the bid identifies the location and timing for the ad to appear.
- The campaign settings that chosen applies to all the ads within the same campaign. The type of campaign that selected identifies the settings that are available.
- The AdWords system provides the advertiser with all the options necessary to set up and manage budgets. They can set up their own budget, choosing the amount to spend each day, or can view and use the system recommended budget on the Settings tab of the ad campaign.
- Using AdWords allows selecting a daily budget for each campaign depending on the advertising goals and the basic cost users are willing to spend each day.
- Any modifications made to the daily campaign budget are reflected immediately in the account.
- Similar to AdWords bidding, AdWords budgets can help in optimizing an ad campaign. It also allows an advertiser to have more control over their marketing costs.
- AdWords bidding allows AdWords professionals to optimize the traffic to their Web sites generated by pay-per-click, pay-per-impression, or pay-per-conversion advertising.
- AdWords offers numerous ways to bid for the ads, based on what is important to the business.
- Whenever there is an empty space available on a search result, blog, news site, or other sites, AdWords runs an auction.
- AdWords provides multiple methods to set your bids ranging from manual CPC bidding to a number of automated bid strategies.
- Automated bidding requires some guesswork to set bids that match your performance goals.
- There are different types of flexible bid strategies which can be created and applied.
- Portfolio bid strategies are automated bid strategies that are goal-driven and assist in maximizing the bids across many campaigns, ad groups, and keywords.
- The Billing tab in AdWords account servers as a single point from which one can manage all the billing settings and pay for the advertising costs.
- A payment method is the mode selected to pay for AdWords. The payment methods can differ based on the country and currency chosen.

6.6 Check Your Progress

1. Match the most appropriate bid strategy based on the advertiser's purpose.

1	Cost-Per-Impression	A	To generate traffic to the Web site
2	Cost-Per-Acquisition	B	To increase brand awareness
3	Cost-per-Click	C	Customers expected to take direct action on the Web site

   a. 1-C, 2-B, 3-A
   b. 1-B, 2-C, 3-A
   c. 1-C, 2-A, 3-B
   d. 1-A, 2-C, 3-B

2. Which of the following is not the budget control option with the advertisers?
   a. Mid-day
   b. Mid-week
   c. Mid-month
   d. All of these

3. Which of the following action by the advertiser will affect the advertiser's daily campaign budget?
   a. Altering the campaign end date
   b. Altering the delivery mode
   c. Selecting a different time zone for the AdWords account
   d. All of these

4. Which of the following is not the eligibility for Target CPA bidding?
   a. Conversion tracking must be enabled
   b. Campaign must target the Search Network
   c. Campaign must target the Display Network
   d. Conversion tracking to be disabled

5. Match the following:

1	Maximize Clicks	A	Automatically adjusts your manual bids to maximize conversions.
2	Target Search Page Location	B	AdWords automatically sets your bids to help meet the target of outranking in search results with the chosen domain.
3	Target CPA	C	Automatically fixes the bids to obtain as many clicks as possible within your budget.
4	Enhanced cost-per-click	D	Automatically fixes the bids to obtain as many conversions as possible at the target cost-per-acquisition.
5	Target ROAS	E	Automatically fixes the bids to obtain as much conversion value as possible at the target return on ad spend.
6	Target Outranking Share	F	Automatically fixes the bids to enhance the chances of the ads appearing at the top of the page or on the initial page of search results.

   a. 1-D, 2-F, 3-E, 4-C, 5-A, 6-B
   b. 1-F, 2-E, 3-D, 4-C, 5-B, 6-A
   c. 1-C, 2-D, 3-A, 4-F, 5-B, 6-E
   d. 1-B, 2-D, 3-C, 4-E, 5-F, 6-A

6. Which of the following is a goal of Portfolio Maximize Click strategy?
   a. Allocates the highest budget to the ads with maximum clicks
   b. Invites the traffic to Web site for maximum clicks
   c. Allow AdWords to automatically maximize the bids of low-performing keywords
   d. Allow AdWords to automatically allocate the maximum budgets to high traffic Web pages

6.6.1 Answers

1	b
2	d
3	d
4	d
5	c
6	c

SESSION 7 - MANAGING ADWORDS DATA AND GOOGLE ANALYTICS

Session Objectives:

This session helps you to understand all about AdWords data, tracking sales, and other conversions. This session also explains how to analyze reports and how to connect the goals to data and how to link Google Analytics and AdWords. Finally the session explains how to evaluate basic account, ad group, and campaign information.

At the end of this session, you will be able to:

- Explain AdWords data
- Explain how to track sales and other conversions
- Explain how to analyze the reports
- Explain how to connect your goals to data
- Explain how to link Google Analytics and AdWords
- Explain how to analyze basic account, ad group, and campaign information to increase the Return on Investment (ROI).

7.1 Understanding AdWords Data

AdWords data can be managed through Google Analytics as it provides a user with an exact view of the data. This data can be customized according to one's needs and shared across an organization.

AdWords is arranged into the following three layers (levels):

- Account
- Campaigns
- Ad groups

One must understand these levels in order to find the exact performance data easily. Using these three levels, the view of the performance data can be customized to make it more specific or broad. For navigation purposes in the Adwords account, the side panel begins with the broadest level, which is '**All Campaigns**' and narrows down. On clicking an individual campaign, one can view the ad groups associated to each campaign.

A unique e-mail address, password, and billing information are associated with every account. However, it is recommended to consider the account as a collection of campaigns for reporting purposes. Click **All Campaigns** to view the performance data of the entire account. The total for all the rows is visible at the bottom of the statistics table. Following are the steps to see the data for the entire account:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Click **Dimensions**.

4. Click **View** to select the time period that will be used to organize the statistics.
5. Once the statistics table is presented in the desired manner, it can be downloaded as a report by clicking the download button ( ).

Campaigns can be tailored by adjusting the campaign settings. The campaign setting selected is applicable to all the ads in a campaign. The campaign type determines the settings which will be available.

Use the campaign type selector to shift swiftly between reporting views by campaign type, like Music or Display Network. This feature is available as a drop-down menu next to **All Campaigns** if there are multiple campaign types associated to an account. One can select a campaign type only if the account contains that specific type of campaign.

7.1.1 Understanding Campaign Data

Each and every campaign has a specific budget and settings, which determine where the ads will be displayed. Campaigns are a collection of ad groups. All the campaigns available are displayed on the side panel of the AdWords account. They are also displayed on clicking the **Campaigns** tab as shown in figure 7.1.

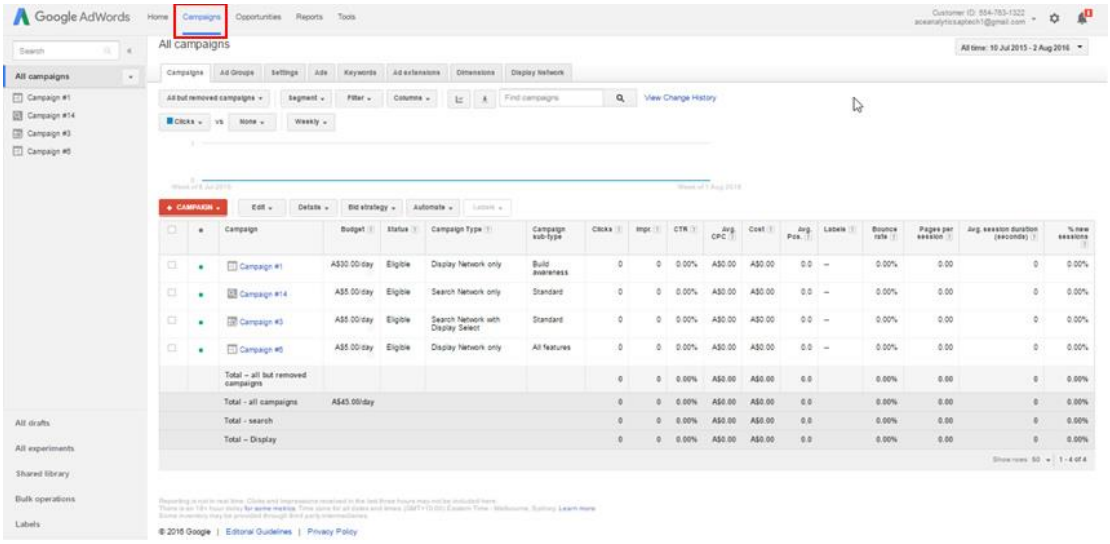


Figure 7.1: Campaigns Screen

Following are the steps to view the campaign performance data:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Click the name of the desired campaign to see how the associated ad groups are performing. To see the campaigns for reporting, click **Filter** to set up a campaign filter. Refer to figure 7.2.

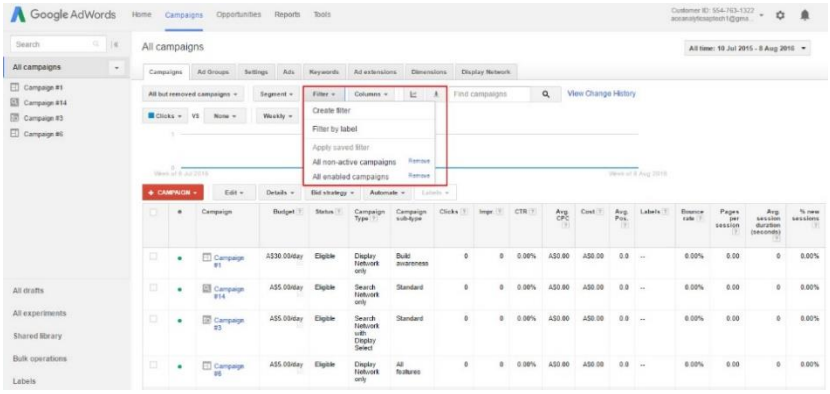


Figure 7.2: Setting up Campaign Filter

4. Once the statistics table is presented in the desired manner, it can be downloaded as a report by clicking the download button ( ).

Campaign details reports help you to see the features and settings enabled in each of the campaigns. Following are the steps to view campaign details reports:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Click **Dimensions**.
4. From the **View** drop-down list, select **Campaign details**.

7.1.2 Ad Group Data

An ad groups contains a collection of similar ads. The words and phrases in ad groups are termed as keywords and they enable the ads to be displayed. On clicking a campaign, AdWords displays the campaign's performance split into individual ad groups. One can also view the ad group data by clicking **Ad groups** as shown in figure 7.3.

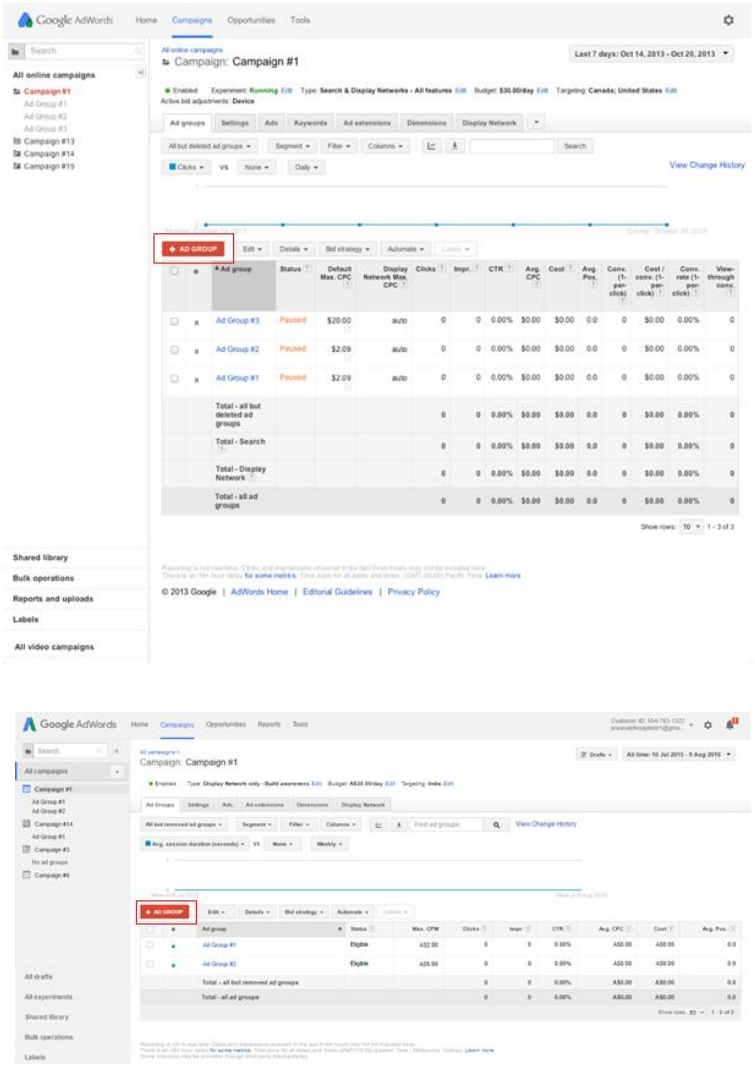


Figure 7.3: Ad Group Data

Following are the steps to view the ad group data:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Select the ad groups and perform one of the following:
    - To include all the ad groups from a specific campaign, choose the campaign name from the table. This displays the **Ad Groups** tab for that campaign.
    - To include all the ad groups in the account, while viewing **All Campaigns,** click **Ad Groups** tab.
    - To include specific ad groups from different campaigns, while viewing **All Campaigns,** click **Ad Groups**. Then to set up an ad group filter, click **Filter**.

Ad group details reports help one to view the features and setting enabled in each of the ad groups. Following are the steps to view ad group details reports:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.

2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Click **Dimensions**.
4. From the **View** drop-down, select **Ad group details**.

Let us now understand the AdWords campaigns and ad groups with an example. Consider a chocolate manufacturer wants to set up AdWords campaigns and ad groups to increase the online sales.

The manufacturer decides to organize the advertising efforts into two campaigns. The first campaign promotes their new range of chocolate bars and the other one endorses their holiday gift boxes. The manufacturer now divides the campaign into relevant ad groups to be targeted. One of the ad groups for the chocolate bars campaign promotes the company's popular almond bar. The other campaign promotes the vanilla bar and the third campaign promotes the chocolate infused with cinnamon bar. Considering these factors, the account looks as shown in table 7.1.

Account: Chocolate manufacturer	
Campaign 1: Chocolate bars	**Campaign 2:** Christmas Day gift boxes
Ad groups: Almond bar Vanilla bar Chocolate with Cinnamon Infused bar	**Ad groups:** 20% off gift boxes Free shipping on gift boxes Luxury Christmas chocolate

Table 7.1: Ad Group Detail Reports

Every ad group can have multiple ads associated to it. This helps the manufacturer to compare the performance for different ad texts and view if one version received more clicks than the other.

After understanding the structure of AdWords account, one can view and customize the data available in the statistics table. One can also download reports to monitor the performance of the individual campaigns, campaigns, and ad groups as well as the ads and keywords.

7.1.3 Exploring the Data with Report Editor

Report Editor is a tool which allows one to engage with the performance data using multi-dimensional tables and charts. As it can view the tables and charts directly within AdWords, it discards the need to download the data for analyzing.

Following are the benefits of the Report Editor tool:

- The drag-and-drop interface enables one to swiftly manipulate and create multi-dimensional tables and charts. This in turn reduces the need to download data for thorough understanding.
- Multi-segment analysis enables one to inspect the data present in the tables and charts thoroughly.
- One can quickly view the trends and patterns of the data with custom charts.
- One can filter segmented metrics, for example, mobile clicks and sort by multiple columns using the Advanced Filtering options.

To use the Report Editor tool effectively, one must have an understanding of its different parts. Following are the parts of the Report Editor tool:

- **Tiles**: These are dimensions and metrics which enable the user to drag data onto the canvas to create a report. Metrics are numerical values about the data, such as impressions, clicks, and conversions. Dimensions describe the characteristics quality of the data, such as device, ad group, or location. Figure 7.4 shows the tiles screen.



Figure 7.4: Tiles Screen

- **Sidebar**: This area includes filters and tiles. Drag tiles to the canvas to create reports. You can use filters to refine the data available in the reports. Click the tiles button ( ) to view the dimensions and metrics. Click the filter button ( ) to view the filtering options. To hide the sidebar, deselect both the filter and the tiles buttons. Figure 7.5 shows the sidebar.

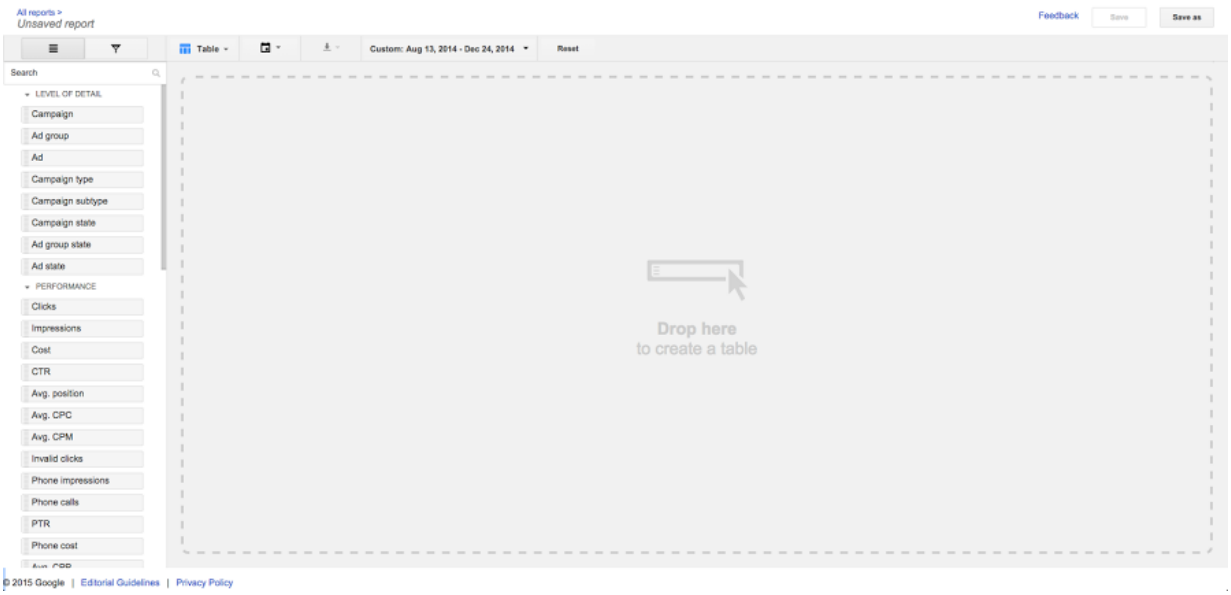


Figure 7.5: Sidebar Screen

- **Canvas:** This is the large gray area, where one can drag tiles to create reports as shown in figure 7.6.



Figure 7.6: Canvas Screen

- **Shelf:** This is the area on top of the canvas. The shelf displays the tiles added to the report. It is displayed only if one has dragged a tile onto the canvas. Figure 7.7 shows the shelf screen.

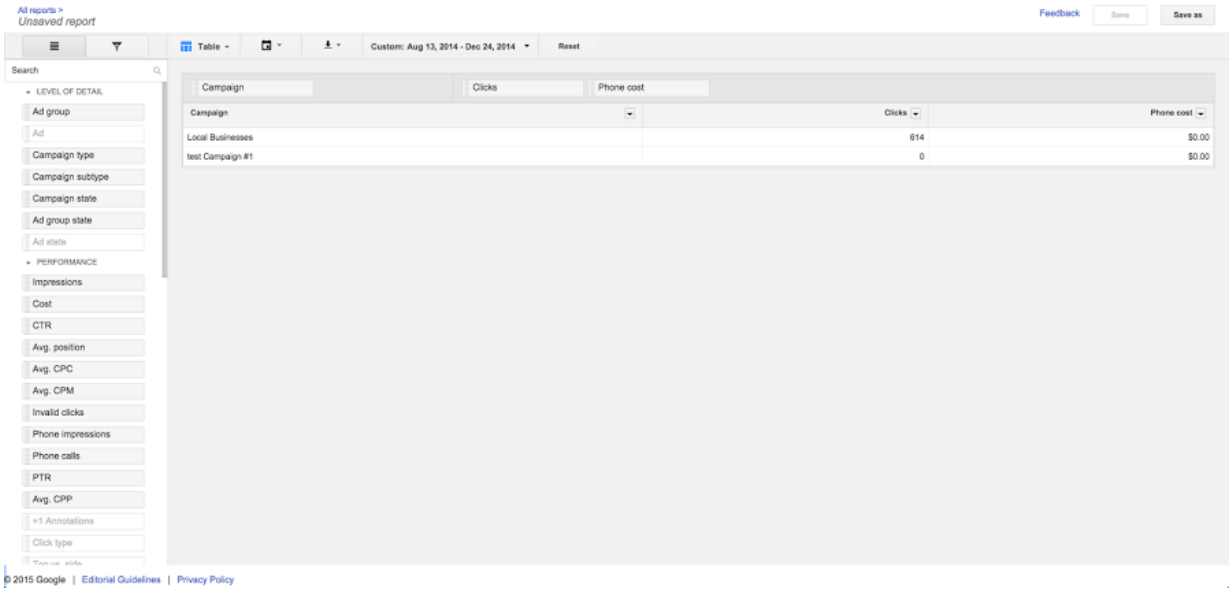


Figure 7.7: Shelf Screen

7.2 Tracking Sales and Other Conversions

A conversion occurs when someone clicks the AdWords ad and performs a valuable behavior on the Web site such as signup, purchase, and so on. Conversions may include the purchase of a mobile phone, visitors submitting their contact details for a quote on the insurance, or a potential buyer downloading a brochure. Conversions are counted only on Google and Google Network partners.

Types of Conversions

There are two main kinds of conversions that include 1-per-click and many-per-click conversions. The types of conversions are as follows:

- **Conversions (1-per-click):** These are known for counting a conversion, for each AdWords ad click, which results in a conversion within 30 days. Adding to it, if conversion happens more than one time followed by a single ad click, then conversions after the first will not be counted.

  These metrics are used to measure conversions that approximate unique customer acquisitions such as leads.

  The other metrics related to Conversions (1-per-click) are as follows:

  - Conversion Rate (1-per-click): Conversions (1-per-click) divided by total clicks.
  - Cost/Conv. (1-per-click): Total cost divided by conversions (1-per-click).

- **Conversions (many-per-click):** These are known for calculating a conversion, each time a conversion is completed within 30 days of following an AdWords ad click. Additionally, conversions (many-per-click) will count one or more conversions per click. These metrics are used to measure conversions which are valuable each time they are made such as ecommerce transactions.

  The other metrics related to Conversions (many-per-click) are as follows:

  - Conversion rate (many-per-click): Conversions (many-per-click) divided by total clicks.
  - Cost/Conv. (many-per-click): Total cost divided by conversions (many-per-click).

7.2.1 Conversion Tracking

Conversion tracking is one of the best ways to identify which keywords are making sales. Conversion tracking is proved to be valuable for online advertising. Perhaps, advertising is only effective if it generates measurable results in terms of ROI for the business.

AdWords help advertisers to drive customers to the Web site to boost their business and estimate the ROI, determining the effectiveness and performance of ads or campaigns.

Conversion tracking helps to track the users' significant actions, such as mobile app downloads, online purchases, and calls made to the business. It is a free tool that shows the events which occur after a user clicks on the ads. It tracks whether the user purchased the product, signed up for the promotions, made calls to the business, or downloaded the app.

Following are the reasons to use the conversion tracking tool:

- To view which ads, keywords, ad groups, and campaigns derive the most valuable customer activity.
- To understand the ROI and make calculated decisions for the ad budget.
- To use bid strategies which are flexible (such as enhanced CPC, target CPA, and target ROAS) that automatically optimize the campaigns according to the business goals set.
- To view how many users have been interacting with the ads on a device or a browser and making conversions. One can also see cross-browser, cross-device, and other conversion data in the **All conversions** reporting column.

So far we have gathered information about conversion and conversion tracking, let us now understand how conversion tracking works.

Conversion tracking begins with creating a conversion action in the AdWords account. A conversion action is a unique customer activity that has been identified as valuable to the business. One can use conversion tracking for the following sources:

- **Web site actions**: Purchases, sign-ups, and other actions that users perform on the business Web site.
- **Phone calls**: Calls made directly from the ads, calls made to a phone number on the business Web site, and clicks on the phone number provided on the business Web site.
- **App downloads and in-app actions**: Download of Android or IOS mobile apps, purchase or other activity made on those apps.
- **Import**: Customer activity which starts online but ends offline. For example, a customer clicks an ad and submits a contract form online, but later signs a contract in the office.

Each conversion source has a different tracking source. Other than offline conversions, the conversions fall into either of the following two categories:

- Adding a conversion tracking tag or code snippet to the Web site or mobile app code. Once a user clicks the ad either using Google Search or the selected Google Display Network (GDN) sites, a temporary cookie is placed on the user's computer or mobile device. On completing the specified action, the system identifies the cookie (through the code snippet) and a conversion is recorded.
- Few conversion trackings do not require a tag. For example, to track calls made from call-only ads or call extensions, one uses the Google forwarding number to track details such as the duration of the call, caller area code, and call start and end time. App downloads from Google Play are automatically recorded as conversions without the tracking code.

7.2.2 Counting Conversions

Conversion tracking metrics can be viewed in the conversion tracking reports. Following are the two important conversion tracking metrics:

- **Conversions**: One can decide to count each conversion after a click. The **Conversions** column in the reports displays conversions within the specified conversion window, according to the specified counting method. Using the **Every** setting one can count every instance of sales and using the **One** setting, only the conversion completed when the same person generates multiple leads can be counted. For example, one person adds the details in two different forms and requests to be contacted for the different services offered.
- **Converted clicks**: The **Converted clicks** column displays the number of AdWords ad clicks which result in one or more conversions within the specified conversion window.

> **Note**: The converted clicks do not convey the relative value of each converting click. High value conversion clicks (such as multiple purchases) are not distinguished from the conversions which are low value (such as a single newsletter sign-up). Also, the **Converted clicks** column cannot be segmented by the conversion name or category. To distinguish by the conversion name, some converted clicks could be counted multiple times. This leads to the segmented total clicks being added up to more than the actual total.

7.2.3 Understanding Security and Privacy

Google has a strict set of rules and standards to ensure the security and privacy of its users. Only pages containing the Google conversion code can be tracked through the program. Data encryption and secure servers are used to ensure complete security.

Following steps are taken to ensure a users' privacy and security:

- Conversion tracking cookies exist for a limited time only.
- Conversions are not isolated. This means that one cannot match the conversion data to specific users. One can only view the overall data for keywords and ads.
- Conversion tracking has the choice to notify users about cookies. During the setup process, a notification box is created for the business Web site which lets the users know they are being tracked. This box is called the Google Site Stats box and it is displayed on the conversion page. This is the page users see after completing a conversion as shown in figure 7.8.



Figure 7.8: Customer Notification Cookies

- Google Site Stats notification is displayed only for users who have been referred by Google to the business Web site on the same device. On clicking the notification, a page explaining how cookies are used and how to disable them is displayed to the users. Users can also provide feedback about the Web site.
- Promote a clear privacy policy. If the Google Sites Stats box is not used, it is recommended to review the Web sites' privacy policy to ensure that the use of tracking technology is disclosed to the users.

7.2.4 Understanding Offline Conversion Tracking

Clicking an AdWords ad does not always directly lead to an online sale but at times, it may lead to a sale offline, such as over the phone or at your office. Importing offline conversions helps one to measure the actions which occur offline after a user clicks the ad.

Importing offline conversion events helps one to achieve a detailed understanding as to which keywords and targeting criteria (for example, location or day of the week) derive the budget friendly conversions. This data can help in targeting and optimizing the ad campaigns in order to increase profit.

On attracting leads or buyers online, or both, it is recommended to record a conversion for the following cases:

- On closing a sale offline (for example, in person or over a call) and tracking the sale in another sales tracking tool, such as Salesforce.
- On making a sale to a new customer.

- 30 days post an online sale so that the transactions which have resulted in a return can be excluded.
- On a customer's second purchase.
- On closing a sale online but not being able to use the standard JavaScript-based conversion tracking solution.

AdWords offers the following two options to understand how the AdWords campaigns generate offline leads and sales:

- **AdWords Conversion Import for Salesforce**: It allows one to import sales events from Salesforce into AdWords. If one uses Salesforce Sales Cloud, then this is a best option to track the sales data.
- **AdWords Conversion Import**: It enables one to import conversions which are tracked in any other system to AdWords. It is an option which applies to multiple ways of tracking offline conversions. This is considered the best option if one does not use Salesforce.

Following are the two steps to track offline conversions:

1. Set up offline conversion tracking
2. Import conversions into AdWords

Understand how offline conversion tracking works.

AdWords provides a unique ID, called a 'Google Click Identifier (GCLID),' for every click on the business Web site from an AdWords ad. To track offline conversions, save that ID with the lead information collected from the person who clicked the ad.

If that person turns into a customer offline, for example, by signing a contract, one has to give that GCLID back to AdWords with details of the type of conversion it was and the time it took place. AdWords then records this conversion along with the other conversion tracking data. Let us understand this with the help of an example.

Consider John designs, builds and sells designer sofas. He uses AdWords to attract prospective users to his Web site, where they can submit their contact information and opt for sales call. If a click on an AdWords ad results in a lead, then the lead's contact information will also have a GCLID.

Once a week, the sales employees review the week's sales and send the details of the prospects (and associated GCLIDs) which are converted into customers, with the date and time of each sale. John then compiles that data into a five-column spread sheet and uploads it into the AdWords account. Within a few hours John can view the keywords and queries that are generating new leads and actual sales. This new data saves time and makes it easier to optimize the investment in AdWords.

One can use the automated bid strategies to optimize offline conversions. To use the automated bidding with offline conversions, perform the following steps:

- Import the offline conversion data frequently. It is recommended to do this every day.
- Upload conversions (tracked offline) and then wait for the length of the conversion window (the number of days after a click during which a conversion will be recorded) before turning on automated bidding.
- If tracking both online and offline conversions, it is recommended to use the target Return On Ad Spend (ROAS) bid strategy. With target ROAS, the online and offline conversions can be

better optimized by allocating separate values to different conversion actions, such as offline sales and leads. On tracking leads via an online conversion action and final sales via an offline conversion action, one can assign different values to each conversion. The value assigned to each conversion reflects the value each conversion has for the business. For example, if the value of a lead is $30 and that of a sale is $700, then these details give a detailed understanding of the sales funnel. The more understanding one has about the sales funnel, the easier it is to optimize bids.

7.2.5 Measuring Sales and Conversions

When using AdWords to increase conversions or sales, one can keep track of the conversions using a free tool called conversion tracking. Using this tool helps to keep track of important details such as cost per conversion and conversion rate.

A conversion can be a purchase or a call from a mobile phone, a shopper submitting his/her contact information for the season's offers, or a prospective customer downloading a white paper about the company's software skills. It may also be a request for more information, or the number of views on the page which displays the latest offers. It is the advertiser's choice to decide what it must be.

After setting up conversion tracking, one can note the statistics to measure the success of an ad campaign. Following conversion information can be measured:

- **Number of conversions and cost-per-conversion**: Assign monetary values to the conversions while setting up tracking to get a detailed revenue analysis in the reports. Reviewing the number of conversions and the worth of these conversions can help one in deciding if the budget needs to be increased or if changes need to be made to the ad groups to generate more viewers.
- **Conversion rate**: This helps in tracking the number of clicks which lead to a valuable action. The conversion rate mentioned in the account is calculated by dividing the number of conversions by the number of ad clicks. These conversions are counted only on Google and Google Network partners. The conversion rate is modified to reflect the ad clicks on which conversions can be tracked.
- **Keyword conversion data**: On using conversion tracking, one can identify the keywords which enable users to take valuable actions. One can then improve the keyword list based on this analysis.
- **See how users interact with your ads across devices**: There are instances such as a customer clicking an ad on one device but making a purchase on some other device. This is termed as cross-device conversions and is displayed in the **All conversions** column of the AdWords account.
- **Landing pages**: One can view the landing pages which in turn lead to the most conversions on the **Dimensions** tab of the account. Click **View and** then select **Landing page** from the drop-down list and ensure to add the conversion columns to the data table as shown in figure 7.9.

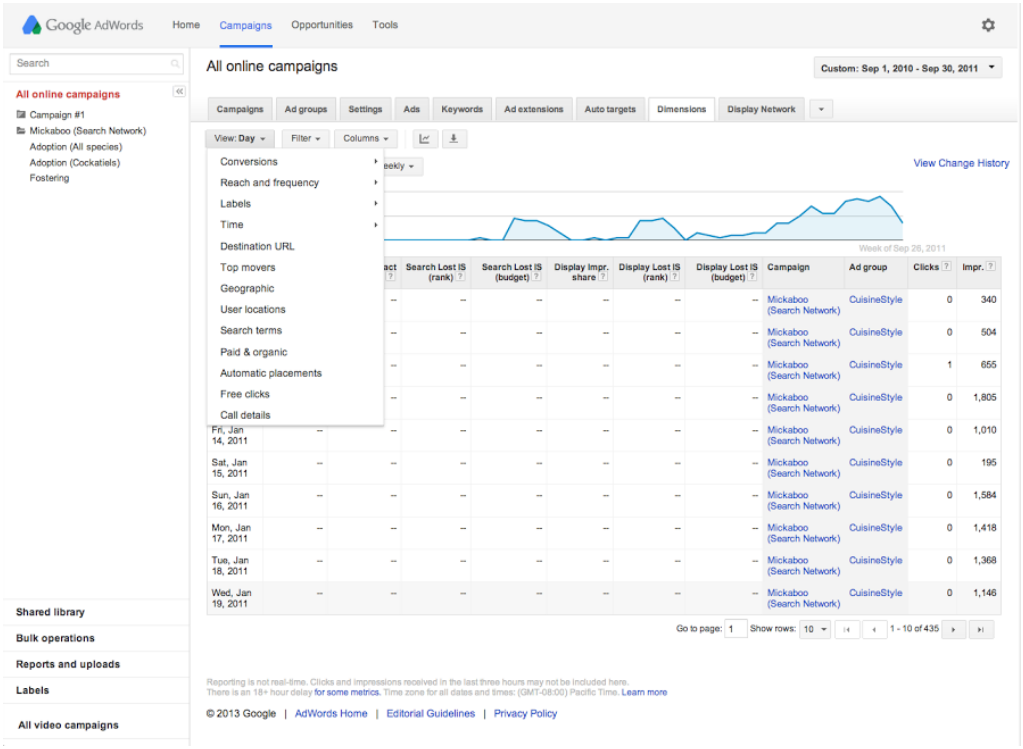


Figure 7.9: Measuring Conversion

Similar to how keywords and ad texts focus on a specific product or service, the landing page selected for each ad should be specific to the product or service. Ensure that the landing page used for each ad directs the users to the most relevant page within the business Web site. For example, if a mobile selling company's ad highlights the latest mobile models for sale in New York, the ideal landing page may feature all latest mobile models for sale in New York, rather than the mobile company's' home page. Users are more likely to buy if they do not have to spend time on your Web site searching for what they are interested in.

Note: Numerous AdWords users decide to use Google Analytics for conversion tracking. It is a free Web analytics tool which enables you to learn how users interact with your Web site.

7.3 Analyzing Reports

AdWords reports are collections of statistics that help advertisers to analyze their performance properly. These reports are completely customizable and provide an analytical information on topics such as ad performance, URL performance, ad group performance, campaign performance, and so on. As these reports are customizable, advertisers can modify and get only the required information to optimize the campaign performance.

Advertisers can view AdWords reports online or they may choose to download these reports on their personal computers. AdWords also provide an option to plan reports to run regularly and automatically send these reports to their e-mail account.

Analyze how many new users connect to business through the ad, where they are coming from, and so on.

Types of Reports

Table 7.2 shows types of report and its description.

	Types of Reports	Description
1.	**Keyword performance**	This report displays data related to chosen keywords and arrange statistics by keywords.
2.	**Ad performance**	This report type displays date related to different multimedia ads such as text ads, image ads, video ads, and mobile ads.
3.	**Destination URL performance**	This report type measures the performance of destination URLs and shows the statistics.
4.	**Ad group performance**	This report type displays data for each ad group in the advertiser's account.
5.	**Campaign performance**	This report type displays data related to campaigns in the account.
6.	**Account performance**	This report type displays data for the entire account.
7.	**Geographic performance**	This report type shows data related to geographic regions of visitors.
8.	**Demographic performance**	This report type shows demographic data of visitors such as age and gender.
9.	**Search term performance**	This report type shows all the search terms and keywords that triggered ads.
10.	**Placement performance**	This report type displays statistics for ads which have appeared on specific domains or URLs in the Google Display Network.

Table 7.2: Types of Report and its Description

7.3.1 Opening a Pre-defined Report

In Adwords, the **Reports** tab contains a set of reports to answer specific questions about the data (such as the information Google stores about customer actions used for conversion tracking). These are called 'pre-defined reports'. Pre-defined reports can be used as a starting point for a newly saved report which can be downloaded, edited, scheduled and shared.

Following are the steps to open a pre-defined report:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Reports** at the top of the account.
3. Click the **Pre-defined reports** drop-down menu and click a pre-defined report to open it in the report editor as shown in figure 7.10.

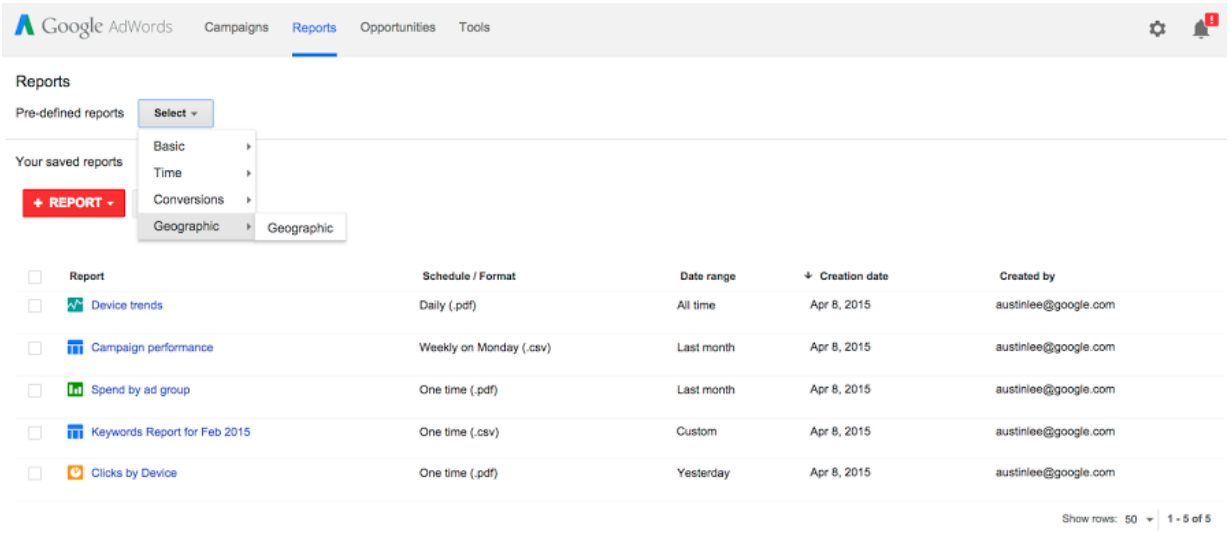


Figure 7.10: Pre-defined Reports

7.3.2 Managing Reports

The **Reports** tab enables easy access to saved reports and a set of curated pre-defined reports. All of these reports can be saved, edited, shared downloaded, and scheduled.

Following are the steps to open a saved report:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Reports** at the top of the account to see a list of the saved reports.
3. Navigate to the report which needs to be viewed and click the title of the report to open it in the **Report Editor** window.

Note: Reports that have been saved while being downloaded from the **Campaigns** tab do not function as the reports created using **Report Editor**.

7.3.3 Scheduling and Sharing a Report

Using the **Reports** tab, one can set up the reports to run at regular intervals, and schedule them to be e-mailed to yourself or other users who have access to one's account.

Following are the steps to schedule and share a report:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Reports** at the top of the account to see a list of the saved reports.
3. Find the report to be viewed, and click the value in the **Schedule/Format** column.
4. In the drop-down menu that is displayed, edit the following settings. Refer to figure 7.11.
   - **Format**: Select to view the information in different formats (for example, a .pdf or a word file).
   - **Send to**: E-mail the report to self and/or others.
   - **Frequency**: Define a schedule to run the reports automatically.

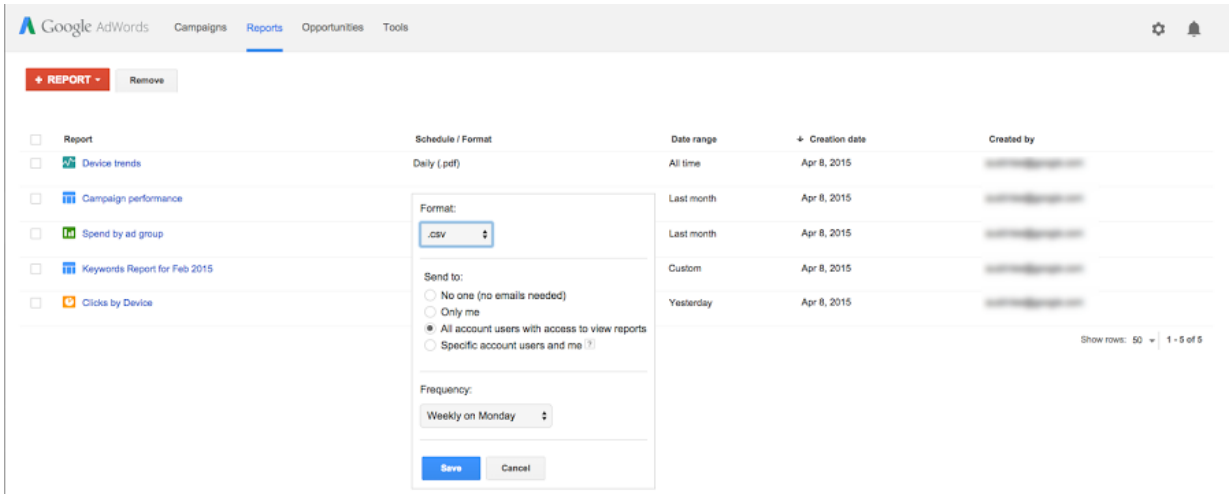


Figure 7.11: Scheduling and Sharing Reports

5. Click **Apply**.

Note: One can also schedule a report within the **Report Editor** by clicking the ( ) icon atop the shelf.

Following are the best practices to be followed while using AdWords reports:

- Use AdWords reports to understand the performance of accounts.
- Schedule reports to run at regular intervals.
- Use AdWords reports to analyze and assess the Campaign Status, Average CPC and Average CPM, Conversion Metrics, and Daily Budget.

7.4 Connecting Goals to Data

It is important to understand the business goals one wants to achieve and the data relevant to these goals to use AdWords effectively.

7.4.1 Customizing the Performance Data

In this day and age we have the option to customize whatever we choose to and the same applies to data. By modifying columns, date ranges, segments, graphs, and filters, one can customize the performance data in the statistics table to view only the data which is of interest. This in turn makes campaign maintenance faster and easier.

Before one begins to customize data, one must decide as to which statistics are the most important to measure the progress towards the AdWords goals. Once the tables are displayed in the desired fashion, either save it or download it. Using the following information, one can adjust the table to highlight the important details:

- Add or remove columns which display the statistics
- Apply segments to break down the data
- Use filters to locate the data
- View or hide items which have been removed
- View performance summary graphs

7.4.2 Return on Investment (ROI)

ROI is defined as the ratio of the net profit to the costs. It is the most important measurement for an advertiser as it is based on the specific advertising goals. The ROI also helps to understand if the advertising has made any difference to the business. The formula used to calculate ROI depends on the goals of the campaign.

ROI can be calculated as: (Revenue - Cost of goods sold) / Cost of goods sold

Let us understand ROI with an example. Consider a product costs $100 to manufacture and can be sold at $200. If six of these products are sold as a result of advertising them on AdWords, then the total cost is $600 and the total sales are $1200. If the AdWords cost is $200, for a total cost of $800, the ROI is calculated as follows:

($1200 - $800) / $800

= $400 / $800

= 50%

In this example, the earning is 50% ROI. For every $1 spent, one gets $1.50 back.

For physical products, the cost of goods sold is the same as the manufacturing cost of all the items sold plus the advertising costs. The revenue is the amount made from selling these products. The amount spent for each sale is termed as cost per conversion.

If a business generates leads, then the cost of goods sold is just the advertising costs, and the revenue is the amount which one makes on a typical lead. For example, if one typically makes one sale for every ten leads, and the typical sale is $20, then each lead makes $2 in revenue on an average. The cost for getting a lead is known as **cost per acquisition**.

Calculating the ROI helps advertisers to understand the amount they have made by advertising with AdWords. They can also use ROI to decide the budget. For example, on realizing that a certain campaign is generating a higher ROI than the others, they can spend more amount from the budget allocated on the successful campaign. The ROI data can also be used to improve the performance of less successful campaigns.

7.4.3 Using Conversions to Measure ROI

It is always a good idea to measure conversions (valuable customer actions) to calculate ROI. In AdWords, one can use the free conversion tracking tool to calculate how many clicks lead to conversions. Conversion tracking can also help in determining the keyword profitability and track the conversion rates and costs-per-conversion.

After starting to measure conversions, advertisers can begin to evaluate the ROI. The value of each conversion should be greater than the amount spent to get the conversion. For example, if one has spent $30 on clicks to get a sale, and receives $35 for that sale, then the profit made is $5 and this indicates a good return on the AdWords investment.

Troubleshooting Conversion Data

- Conversions may not show the reports due to several reasons. Following conditions should be checked to troubleshoot:
  - AdWords Conversion Tracking must be activated within the account. Users can easily navigate to the Conversions page from the AdWords account. The Status column should be changed to Reporting.

- The reports will take time up to 24 hours to get updated.
- Conversions and transactions get accredited to the date on which the customer clicks the ads, rather than the date the conversion occurred. For example, if a user clicked an ad on Friday and converted on Saturday, then the conversion and transaction would display the stats for Friday.

7.5 Linking Google Analytics and AdWords

Google Analytics is a powerful tool which keeps track of all the traffic that comes to a Web site. One can combine it with AdWords to understand the amount of traffic or sales generated on the Web from ads.

Linking a Google Analytics property to the AdWords account can help to analyze the user activity on the Web site after an impression or an ad click. This information can help in understanding how much business and traffic AdWords has generated. This in turn can help to improve the ads and Web site.

Linking accounts enables one to import Google Analytics goals and transactions, view Google Analytics data in the AdWords reports, and import Analytics remarketing audiences. One can also view the AdWords data in the Analytics reports.

A Google Account with the following permissions to AdWords and Google Analytics is required to link AdWords and Google Analytics and to make changes to the link:

- **For the Google Analytics property, edit permissions are required**: To check the permissions in Google Analytics, click **Admin** and select the property to be linked and then click **User Management**. If **User Management** is not displayed in the **Property** column, ask the account administrator for edit permissions.
- **For the AdWords account, administrative access is required**: To check the account access, click the gear icon () and select **Account settings**. From the menu on the left, select **Account access**.

Following are the steps to link AdWords and Google Analytics:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the gear icon () and select **Linked accounts**.
3. Under **Google Analytics**, click **View details**. A list of Google Analytics properties to which one has access to, is displayed (Ensure that the required edit permissions are available if you do not want to view the Analytics property).
4. Click **Set up link** next to the property to be linked to AdWords. Select a property for the business to be advertised with AdWords (multiple properties can be linked). An **Edit** link is displayed instead of a **Set up** link if properties have already been linked.
5. Either of the following two screens are displayed:
   - If the property selected has one view, then the name of that view is displayed. Select **Import site metrics** to view the Google Analytics data in AdWords reports. (To include this data to the reports, follow the instructions in the following section to add Google Analytics columns to the AdWords reports.)

- If the property has more than one view, list of the views which can be linked from this property is displayed.
  Following two settings are available:
  - **Link**: Link as many views as you want. This enables the AdWords click and cost data to be displayed in Analytics and the analytics goals and transactions to be available for importing into AdWords.
  - **Import site metrics** (Recommended): Select the view which will be used to import site engagement metrics. Though this is optional, it is recommended to choose the view which will be used to display the site engagement metrics in the reporting columns of Google Analytics.

- If the AdWords account is being used by an AdWords Manager Account (MCC) which has been linked to this property, a column showing all the views which have been linked to the MCC is displayed.

6. Click **Save**.

Repeat the preceding procedure for any additional properties you may need to link.

Note: On linking an AdWords account to an Analytics view, a user who has access to that view will be able to see the imported AdWords data. Similarly, on importing Analytics data (such as transactions and goals, remarketing lists or metrics) into the AdWords account, a user who has access to the AdWords account will be able to see the Analytics data. The Analytics data which has been imported to AdWords is subject to the terms of service of AdWords.

Complete the following steps to add Google Analytics reporting columns:

1. Sign in to the AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns.**
3. Click the tab where the Google Analytics columns toned to be added, such as Campaigns, Ad Groups, Ads, or Keywords.
4. Click **Columns** and select **Modify Columns** from the drop-down menu.
5. Under **Select Metrics**, click on **Google Analytics**.
6. Select **Google Analytics in Modify Columns.**
7. To select the columns, click on the arrow icon next to each column which needs to be added and click **Apply**.

After creating a link to an Analytics property, one can add or remove views, unlink the property or also edit settings. To do this, one must have the Analytics '**Edit**' permission or the AdWords administrative access to remove or edit a link.
Following is the procedure to edit or remove the linked Analytics properties:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click the gear icon ( ), and select **Linked accounts**.
3. Under **Google Analytics**, click **View details**.

4. A list of Google Analytics properties to which one has access to, is displayed. Select the **Edit** check box next to the property to be edited or unlinked and perform any one of the following steps:
   - **To edit**: Turn OFF links to any of the views which need to be unlinked or modify the view to utilize it for site engagement metrics.
   - **To unlink**: Click **Remove link**.
5. Click **Save**.

On unlinking a property which has been linked, data from AdWords (such as impressions, clicks, CPC, and so on.) will not be visible in the Analytics reports. Session data is displayed till the time the property is unlinked. Any new sessions, which are a result of clicks in the linked AdWords accounts after the property has been unlinked, will be displayed in the Analytics reports as '**Not Set**'. The remarketing lists which are based on the link will also be closed, and any goals or transactions imported to AdWords from Analytics will stop.

7.5.1 Adding Google Analytics Data to AdWords Reports

On linking the Google Analytics and AdWords accounts, one can import Google Analytics data into AdWords and view this data in the AdWords account.

Ensure to perform the following before adding Google Analytics data to the AdWords reports:

1. Enable auto-tagging in the AdWords accounts.
2. Link the AdWords and Google Analytics accounts. Also, import site metrics for the view which has to be displayed in the AdWords account.

Following are the steps to add Google Analytics reporting columns to the AdWords reports:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Campaigns**.
3. Click the tab for you want to add Google Analytics columns, such as Ad groups, Keywords, Ads, or Campaigns.
4. Click the **Columns** menu and select **Modify columns** from the drop-down list.
5. Under **Select metrics**, click **Google Analytics**. Refer to figure 7.12.

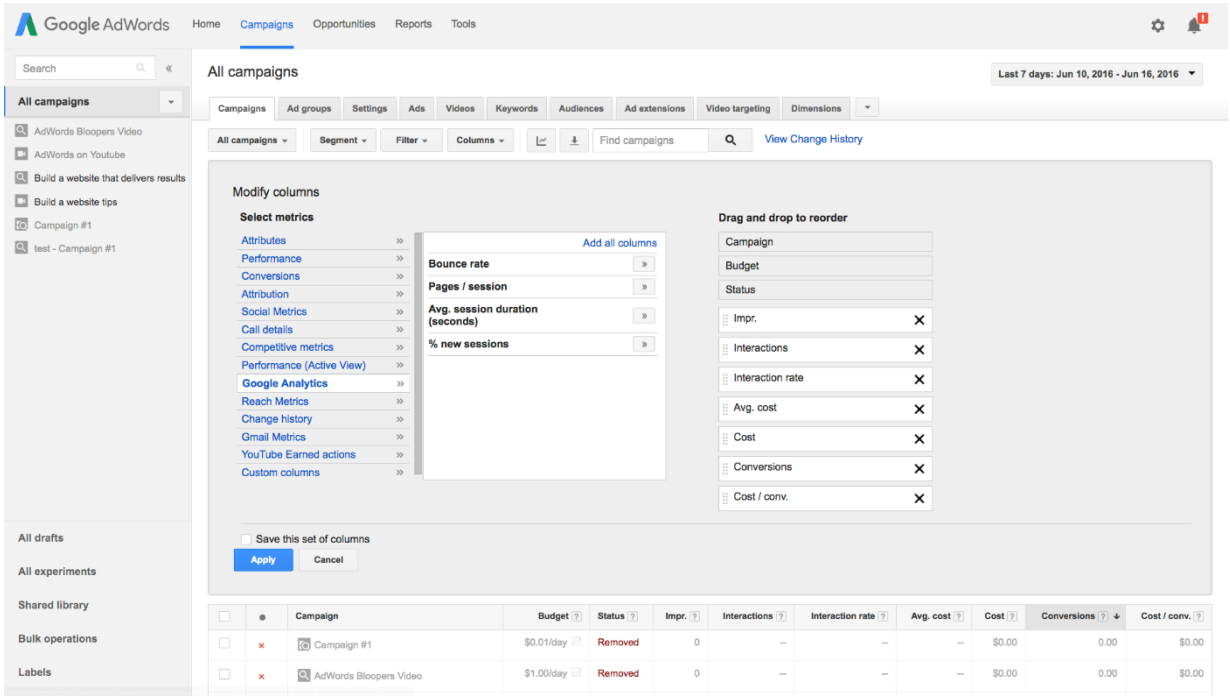


Figure 7.12: Google Analytics Reporting

6. To add the columns, click the arrow icon next to each column to be added as shown in figure 7.13.

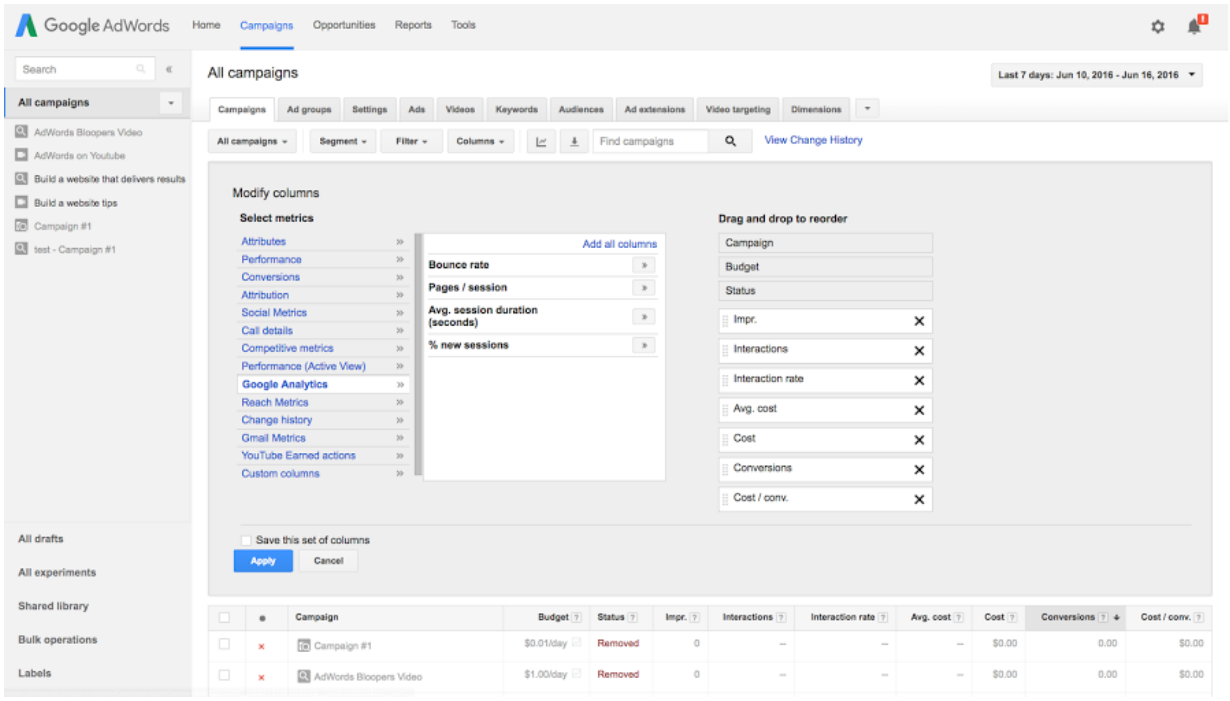


Figure 7.13: Add Column in Google Analytics Reporting

7. Click **Apply**.

Following are some important factors that must be noted:

- Any user using the AdWords account will be able to view the imported Google Analytics metrics.
- To ensure that the right target information is being imported, link your AdWords account to all the relevant Google Analytics views. For example, if the AdWords account has keywords and ads which target landing pages on four different Web sites, it is important to link the AdWords account to a Google Analytics view for each of the four sites.
- One can import Analytics data into the AdWords account from only one view per property and from a maximum of ten properties.
- If the pages to be tracked on Google Analytics are not tagged, the complete data is not displayed.
- The mobile app property metrics cannot be imported from Google Analytics.

7.5.2 Linking Multiple AdWords Accounts to Google Analytics

On managing multiple AdWords accounts, multiple options for linking these accounts to Google Analytics are available. On using an Adwords MCC to work with multiple accounts for the business or clients, you can link the MCC to Google Analytics. This keeps the account's Analytics properties synchronized with AdWords. Multiple AdWords accounts can be linked within Analytics, or individual accounts can be linked.

Following are the benefits of linking multiple AdWords accounts to Google Analytics:

- AdWords accounts can be linked to Analytics in one step.
- It can simplify the task of managing the imported Analytics remarketing lists, goals and transactions, and site engagement stats. It also helps with AdWords cost data which have been exported across various AdWords accounts by managing all of it in one MCC.
- Automatically link an account to the Analytics properties when you add it to the MCC.

Following are the guidelines as to when to link Analytics to a MCC:

- When you have one or more Analytics properties which need to be linked to multiple AdWords accounts, managed by an AdWords MCC.
- When you create new AdWords accounts which need to be automatically linked to the same Analytics properties as the other AdWords accounts.
- When you want to use cross-account remarketing, cross-account conversion tracking or cross-account attribution reports in AdWords.

7.5.3 Managing Conversion Tracking and Remarketing

On linking Analytics to an AdWords MCC, you can modify the conversion actions and remarketing lists in the MCC. Following can be achieved at the individual account level:

- Changing the Analytics view from which you import site stats.
- Importing goals and transactions directly, if you are not using cross-account conversion tracking in AdWords.

Let us consider that an AdWords account is linked to Analytics, directly as well as through one or more MCCs. In such a case, the Analytics views from the direct link and the MCC is visible in the AdWords account.

Google recommends removing the direct links to Analytics after an account is linked through the AdWords MCC, other than the following cases:

- **The managed account has an Analytics remarketing list**: On removing its link to Analytics, the remarketing list is closed.
- **The managed account does not use cross-account conversion tracking**: To continue importing Analytics transactions and goals to the individual account, do not remove its link to Analytics.
- **The Analytics account imports YouTube views and display network impressions from AdWords into Multi-Channel Funnels**: On deleting the AdWords account's direct link to Analytics, the display network impressions will be lost. This feature is not supported currently for linking through the MCC.

7.5.4 Linking Multiple AdWords Accounts Through Analytics

One can set up the Analytics links using Analytics and link multiple accounts at once.

The benefit of linking multiple AdWords accounts through Analytics is that you can link a group of AdWords accounts which you can manage in one step.

Following are the guidelines as to when to link multiple accounts through Analytics:

- When one prefers not to link all the AdWords accounts managed by an MCC to a single Analytics property.
- When one prefers not to link new AdWords accounts under the MCC to the same Analytics property.
- When one prefers not to use the cross-account remarketing, cross-account conversion tracking, or cross-account attributions (Search Funnels).

7.6 Summary

- On understanding the different levels of the AdWords account, you can easily find the exact performance data you are looking for.
- Every individual campaign has a unique budget and settings which govern where the ads appear, and is made up of a collection of ad groups.
- On clicking on a Campaign, AdWords will display a view of the campaign's performance further segmented by its individual ad groups.
- The Report Editor is a tool which enables one to engage with the performance data through multi-dimensional tables and charts.
- A conversion occurs when a user clicks the AdWords ad and performs a valuable action on the Web site such as a purchase, sign up, and so on.
- Conversion tracking is the most efficient way to identify which keywords are deriving the most sales.
- AdWords enable advertisers to drive users to the Web site to boost the business and calculate the ROI, determine the effectiveness and performance of ads or campaigns.
- Conversion tracking is a free tool which displays the events which occur after a user clicks on the ads. Such as if the user has purchased the product, signed up for the newsletter, called the business or downloaded the app.
- Conversion tracking begins with creating a conversion in the AdWords account.
- The two important conversion tracking metrics are conversions and converted clicks.
- A click on an AdWords ad does not always lead to an online sale. It may lead the customer to a path which ultimately results in a sale offline.
- Importing offline conversion events gives a detailed understanding as to which keywords and targeting criteria derive the most cost-effective conversions.
- Use AdWords automated bid strategies to optimize the offline conversions.
- AdWords conversion import enables you to view what happens in the offline world after a user clicks the ads.
- An AdWords conversion occurs when someone clicks on the ad and performs an action on the Web site which has been identified as valuable.
- Many AdWords users use Google Analytics for conversion tracking which free of cost Web analytics tool which helps one learn about how the users interact with the Web site.
- AdWords reports are a collection of statistics which help advertisers analyze the performance.
- The **Reports** tab allows easy access to the reports which have been saved reports, as well as a set of curated pre-defined reports. These reports can be saved, edited, scheduled and shared.
- Understand the business goals you are trying to achieve and the data that is most relevant to those goals to use AdWords effectively.
- Linking a Google Analytics property to the AdWords account helps one to understand the customer activity on the Web site after an ad click or impression.
- On linking an AdWords account to an Analytics view, any user with access to that view is able to see the imported AdWords data.

7.7 Check Your Progress

1. The different levels of AdWords account are:
   a. Account, campaigns, and ad groups
   b. Keywords, campaigns, and ads
   c. Keywords, campaigns, and ad groups
   d. Keywords, account, and ad groups
2. Conversion tracking can be used for:
   a. Web site actions
   b. Phone calls
   c. App downloads and in-app actions
   d. All of these
3. Which of the following statement is false?
   a. Conversion tracking cookies persist for very long time
   b. Conversions are not isolated
   c. Conversion tracking includes the option to notify users about cookies
   d. All of these
4. Which of the following conversion information can be measured?
   a. Cost-per-conversion
   b. How users interact with your ads
   c. Conversion rate
   d. All of these
5. Which of the following reports are not valid?
   a. Search terms report
   b. Location reports
   c. Automated extensions report
   d. Language performance report
6. Which of the following statement is false?
   a. Google Analytics is a powerful tool that keeps track of all the traffic that comes to a Web site
   b. Linking a Google Analytics property to the AdWords account can enable you to analyze customer activity on your Web site
   c. To link AdWords and Google Analytics you will need to use a Google Account
   d. You can import Analytics data into your AdWords account from only five views per property, from a maximum of ten properties

7.7.1 Answers

1	a
2	d
3	a
4	d
5	d
6	d

SESSION 8 - ACCOUNT ADMINISTRATION, COMMON ISSUES, AND RESOLUTION

Session Objectives:

This session focusses on Adwords account administration and explains how the AdWords account can be managed after sharing it with others who are part of the business. It explains the techniques that advertisers can employ to secure their accounts from online criminals and hackers. Thereafter, it discusses common issues with payment and explains refunds, the charging process, and the adjustment process.

At the end of this session, you will be able to:

- Understand account administration
- Manage account security and safety
- Understand and resolve issues with payments and charges
- Know the refunds and adjustments process

8.1 Introduction

Google AdWords is the best tool to boost online business globally. Using this tool, advertisers, enterprises, organizations, agencies, SEMs (search engine marketers), third parties, and others can easily manage tens or hundreds of accounts effectively. The process to manage multiple accounts is quite simple, well organized, and centralized that enables users to bring better business results. AdWords offer some tools that include AdWords Manager Accounts, AdWords Editor, and AdWords Application Programming Interface (API). These tools are widely used to manage accounts easily either online or offline.

AdWords Manager Accounts allows advertisers to manage hundreds of AdWords accounts. Using this tool, the advertisers can easily manage their track performance, manage account budgets, find accounts, create accounts, link accounts, and unlink accounts. This tool monitors the accounts using alerts-summary page. One of the notable features of AdWords Manager Accounts is that it allows users to perform all these tasks from a single location.

AdWords Editor is another tool used to manage AdWords campaigns. It is a free and instantly downloadable application, which allow users to store multiple accounts and update them online or offline. With this tool, online advertising becomes more productive and effective. Using this tool, the users are able to add, edit, copy, move, post, share, or delete their ads, campaigns, ad groups, keywords, and placements according to their requirements.

The AdWords API is used to create applications that can interact directly with the AdWords. With such applications, the users can easily manage their large and complex AdWords accounts in an easier way. AdWords API helps to generate automatic keywords, URL, ad text, and custom reports.

8.2 Account Administration

To share the AdWords account with others who are part of the business, advertisers can invite them to share the access using their Google Account. Every time they give access to their AdWords account, they can decide the features that can be impacted by the customers by setting an access level.

8.2.1 Access Levels in AdWords Account

Table 8.1 shows the access levels that are available in an AdWords account.

Account Access level	e-mail-only	Read-only	Standard	Administrative	Managed - Standard	Managed - Read-only
Can receive notification e-mails and reports	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Can sign in and run reports		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Can browse the Campaigns tab, Opportunities tab, Tools tab, and Account settings		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Can accept and reject manager account link requests				✓	✓	✓
Can unlink manager accounts				✓	✓	✓
Can edit any part of an account and its campaigns, including billing			✓	✓	✓	
Can give account access, change access levels, and can cancel invitations from other users				✓		
Can grant e-mail-only access		✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Table 8.1: Access Levels in AdWords Account

Note: If you have acknowledged an invite to link to a manager account, people who possess administrative access to the manager account will get notification e-mails, and can supervise any part of the account and its campaigns. They can modify and sometimes cease another person's access level as well.

8.2.2 Grant, Accept, or Remove Access to AdWords Account

Sharing access to AdWords account with other users in the business allows advertisers to work with them on the same AdWords account. After granting access, it can be removed anytime if required.

To access the account, the user you send an invite must have a Google Account or must create one. Following are the steps to grant access:

1. Sign in to AdWords account.
2. Click **Settings** icon and select **Account settings** as shown in figure 8.1.

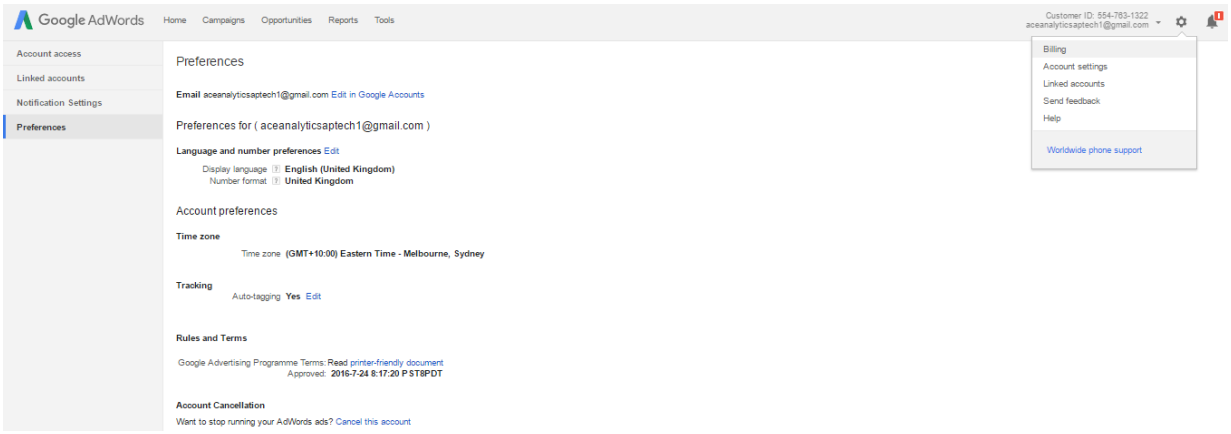


Figure 8.1: Setting Preferences for AdWords Account

3. Select **Account access** from the navigation bar.
4. Click **Invite other users**.
5. Enter the e-mail address of the user to share the account.
6. Enter a name for the new user. This name will be used by AdWords to track who performed the modifications to an AdWords account.
7. Select the access level for this user by clicking the **Choose an access level** drop-down as shown in figure 8.2.

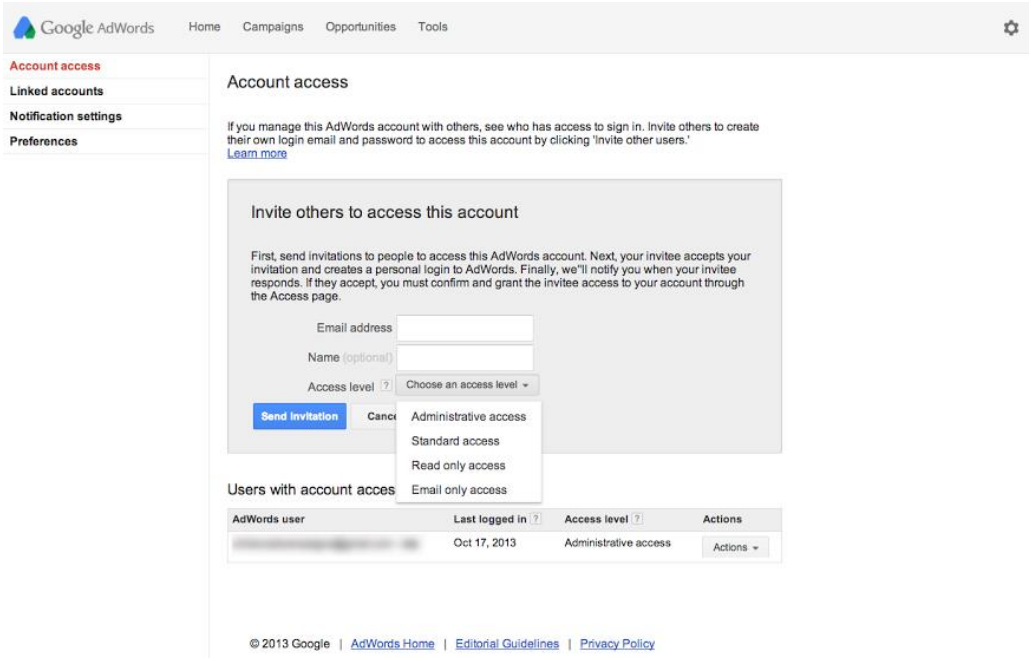


Figure 8.2: Account Access Settings

8. Click **Send invitation**.
9. The user can accept your invite by clicking the link in the e-mail and a notification will be sent to the account.

Note: To resend the invite, click **Resend invitation**.

8.2.3 Managing Multiple Accounts

If one owns an agency or manages many AdWords accounts, a tool called manager account could help in saving a lot of time. A manager account can be considered an AdWords account that allows to easily view and supervise many AdWords accounts (even other manager accounts) from a specific location.

A manager account is a completely new AdWords account and is not an upgrade of the existing AdWords account. This account can be considered as a main account with multiple individual AdWords accounts associated to it. Owners of individual AdWords accounts can access their respective accounts and manage their information.

AdWords Manager Accounts

AdWords Manager Accounts is able to link more than one AdWords accounts in a single location. The users can access multiple accounts using client manager account login. Users need not sign in and sign out to switch between AdWords accounts. In this way, the client managers can view all their individual and client manager AdWords accounts in a single place using the AdWords Manager Accounts view.

A manager account can help to perform the following:

- Use a single sign in to manage multiple AdWords accounts, including other manager accounts.
- Search, browse, and supervise all the accounts from a distinct, easy-to-read dashboard.
- Design and supervise campaigns for the managed accounts.
- Compare performance of all the accounts easily and run reports for multiple accounts simultaneously.
- Get consolidated billing monthly for all the managed accounts.

- Monitor all the linked accounts efficiently using alerts.
- Create and link AdWords accounts quickly.
- View all linked AdWords accounts through the AdWords Manager Accounts view.
- View high-level statistics in a single location for all AdWords accounts that are linked.
- Create AdWords accounts in AdWords Manager Accounts, and automatically link them to the master account upon creation.
- Invite a client through an automated message.
- Generate reports of multiple client accounts at once.
- Download the client dashboard into a .csv file.

Following users can use a manager account:

- Advertisers who have more than one AdWords account
- Third parties such as:
  - Agencies
  - Search Engine Marketers (SEMs)
  - Automated Bid Managers (ABMs)
  - Online marketing professionals having many client accounts or campaigns

Complete the following steps to create a manager account:

1. Visit the link https://www.google.com/adwords/manager-accounts/ and click **Sign up for free**.
2. Enter the preferred e-mail address to use for this account. The address must be a new one.
3. Provide a name to the manager account. This name will be displayed in the clients' managed account.
4. Select whether to utilize the account to manage multiple AdWords accounts of your own, or to manage accounts of other people.
5. Select the applicable country and time zone. This time zone is utilized for account reporting and billing and cannot be altered.
6. Select a permanent currency. This currency is linked to the account for billing purposes (for example, Manager Defined Spend). The clients' accounts will be charged in their chosen currencies.
7. Check the box to agree to the usage rules and click **Save and continue**.
8. The manager account will be activated after the e-mail has been verified.

Linking an AdWords Account to a Manager Account

To start using a new manager account, it must be linked to a manager account or new or existing AdWords account. Then, one can view details across multiple AdWords accounts and shift between all linked accounts making use of just one login.

A single AdWords account can be associated with not more than five manager accounts and the managed account structure cannot be more than six levels deep. A manager account cannot be directly controlled by more than one other manager account as shown in figure 8.3.

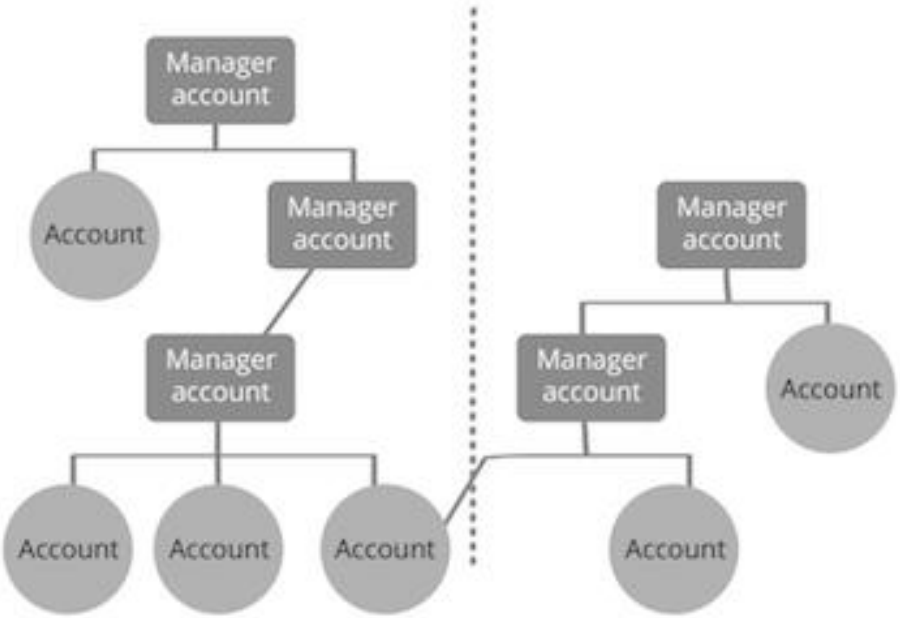


Figure 8.3: Linking an AdWords Account to a Manager Account

Linking an Existing AdWords Account

When an existing AdWords account is linked to a manager account, its account history remains unchanged. For example, invoicing and payment methods remain unchanged when an account is associated to a manager account. The access privileges to the account's billing and sign-in information will remain the same for original users of the new managed account. Also, for original users, the account and permissions remain unchanged and they can login with the same sign-in information as before. When an existing AdWords account is linked, it will not have administrative ownership by default.

Complete the following steps to link another manager account or an existing AdWords account to your manager account:

1. Find the AdWords customer ID number (shown in the top corner of AdWords account).
2. Sign in to the manager account using the link https://adwords.google.com.
3. Click the **Accounts** tab.
4. Click the **Performance** subtab.
5. Click the **+ Account** button.
6. Select **Link existing accounts**.
7. Enter the AdWords account's customer ID number in the **client accounts** field after reading through the terms for linking accounts. To link many accounts at the same time, enter one customer ID per line.
8. Click **Continue**, then click **Submit**.
9. After clicking Submit, the AdWords account receives an account notification and e-mail inviting them to associate with the account. A user must have administrative privileges for the linked manager account or for the invited account to accept the invite. To accept, click the gear icon, select Account settings from the drop-down menu. Then, on the side navigation bar, select **Account access** and click **Accept invitation**.
10. During this procedure, one can view a pending notification for the managed account (soon to be created) in the manager account's 'Pending invitations'. This can be accessed from the side

navigation bar. After the invited user accepts the invite, an e-mail confirmation will be received and that account will be associated to the manager account.

Creating and Linking a New AdWords or AdWords Express Account

Complete the following steps for creating a new AdWords or AdWords Express account and linking it to the manager account:

1. Sign in to the manager account using the link https://adwords.google.com.
2. Click the **Accounts** tab.
3. Click the **Performance** subtab.
4. Click the **+ New AdWords account** or **+ New AdWords Express account** button. Use this option to give choice of creating a new AdWords account or AdWords Express account.
5. Fill the form and click **Create account**.
6. After the account has been created, click **Done**.
7. To activate the new managed account and run ads, provide billing details from within the new account, or set up the new account with consolidated billing. For billing options in the new managed account, select the account name in the **Client** column and click the gear icon to choose **Billing.** This brings up the **Billing preferences** user interface.
8. Click the manager account's Campaigns tab to create campaigns for the new managed account.

Note: When a new AdWords or AdWords Express account is created and linked, the administrative owner setting is turned on automatically.

Unlinking an Account from the Manager Account

If one stops managing an account, then a manager account user or the managed account user (a person with the appropriate access level) must disassociate the two accounts. After unlinking, you will not be able to access the managed account.

After unlinking an account that was using the manager account, it will lose access to any shared remarketing lists or remarketing tag, the lists dependent on the shared tag, and any of the manager's shared lists. The functioning of the account's ad groups using these lists and any campaigns that do not use these lists will discontinue. If the account was sharing its own lists, the campaigns and ad groups in other accounts using these lists will be affected.

Unlinking an account that was using the cross-account conversion tracking tag causes the tag to stop tracking conversions for clicks that occur after the account was unlinked. However, the tag will continue to track conversions for clicks that occurred before the unlinking for the duration of the conversion window, which is typically 30 days. If the managed account was using its own conversion tracking tag, then the conversions tracking will remain unchanged.

Complete the following steps to unlink an account from the manager account:

1. Sign in to the manager account using the link https://adwords.google.com.
2. Click the **Admin** tab.
3. Select the accounts to unlink.
4. Click the **Edit** drop-down and select **Unlink accounts**.

Unlinking from a managed account that uses consolidated billing will not alter its billing settings. After unlinking, all active and pending budgets stay active, and the account's ads continue to run and will be charged to the original account.

To ensure that the manager account is not billed for the managed account that you plan to unlink, end all budgets for that managed account before unlinking. If the accounts are unlinked before this, the billing page cannot be accessed and the advertisers must call Google directly to ask for help from Google support staff.

Complete the following steps to end budgets prior to unlinking:

1. Click the gear icon and select **Billing** (from the managed account).
2. Click the **Orders** link and search for the budget order to delete, end, or edit.
3. After finding the budget order, view the **Actions** column. Click **Delete** to remove a budget order that is pending activation or review. To end a budget order (that is active), click **End order**.
4. Click **Submit**.

In step 2 of the preceding procedure, if an **Account budgets** link is visible rather than an **Orders** link, use the following steps to end budgets:

1. Click the gear icon and select **Billing** (from the managed account).
2. Click the **Account budgets** link and search for the budget to delete, end, or edit.
3. After finding the budget, view the **Actions** column. Click **Cancel** to delete a budget that is **Under review**. Click **Delete** to end a budget that is pending activation. Click **End** to terminate an active budget.
4. Click **Submit**.

No action is required if linking the account to a manager account for which you already have access because the same manager account will be charged for the accounts under it.

Unlinking and Cross-Account Conversion Tracking

If an account, which was utilizing the cross-account conversion tracking tag is moved, but the managed account is still part of the account structure, then the cross-account conversion tracking tag will continue to work on the managed account. However, if the managed account is not part of the account structure, then the tag will be discontinued. It will not track any conversions for clicks that occur after the account was shifted. However, the tag will proceed to track conversions for clicks that occurred prior to the account shift for the length of the conversion window, which is generally 30 days. If the managed account used its own tag, which was installed on the site beforehand, it continues to record conversions.

8.2.4 AdWords Editor and API

Adwords Editor is a tool used by an advertiser to manage many AdWords accounts. Using this tool, advertisers can perform the following functions:

- Save multiple AdWords accounts to easily view and edit them.
- Create new campaigns by designing and sharing with them a sample campaign that can be utilized in many, different AdWords accounts.
- Copy or transfer campaigns between accounts or within an account.

AdWords API helps developers to design and use applications that communicate directly with the AdWords server to manage their accounts, rather than using the online AdWords interface. Using the AdWords API, developers can perform the following functions:

- Create automatic keyword, ad text, URL, and custom reports.

- Incorporate AdWords data with other databases, such as inventory systems

Note: It is recommended that only the advertisers who engage developers utilize the AdWords API because the application development demands technical expertise. These advertisers may be large advertisers and third parties, such as SEMs, agencies, and other online marketing experts who maintain many client accounts or huge campaigns.

8.2.5 Managing Access Levels

Similar to AdWords accounts, the following four levels of access can be given to users of manager accounts:

- Administrative
- Standard
- Read only
- E-mail only

These access levels decide up to what extent a user can view and perform within a manager account and the accounts associated to. They also determine if the manager account has an administrative owner privilege on an account.

Following are the effects of access levels on manager accounts:

- Users who have access to linked manager accounts that are above the manager account in the account structure can modify the manager account.
- Users who have access to manager accounts managed by you (beneath the account in the account structure) cannot modify your account.
- Managers can end relationships with managed accounts whenever required, provided those accounts include an administrative owner manager account or users, by unlinking the account from their manager account.
- User who have administrative access on administrative owner manager accounts can restrict user access for their managed accounts.

Following are the effects of access levels on individual AdWords accounts:

- Users can access their AdWords accounts whenever required and users with administrative access can end relationships with the manager account by unlinking their account from the manager account.
- Many AdWords accounts can be associated with a manager account but users of these AdWords accounts have access only to their own accounts.
- Users with administrative access on an individual AdWords account can still control the access levels of users on the account. They have the privilege to grant, modify, and end access.
- Managers may supervise ad performance and account tasks, and update campaigns for their managed accounts, but they cannot modify proprietary details, such as the login details of a managed account.

Table 8.2 provides an insight into the various access levels for manager account users and tasks that they can perform:

Access level for manager account user	Tasks that a manager account user can perform in the manager account	Tasks that a manager account user can perform in linked managed accounts
Administrative access	➢ Link existing accounts and create new linked accounts ➢ Unlink other manager accounts and individual AdWords accounts ➢ Invite users ➢ Cancel invitations sent by other users ➢ Delete a user ➢ Modify access levels for users ➢ Accept and decline link requests	If the manager account is not an administrative owner, a user with administrative access can perform the following: ➢ Invite users with 'Standard', 'Read only', or 'E-mail only' access levels ➢ View, edit, and manage any part of linked accounts and campaigns ➢ Change user access from 'Standard' to 'Read only' ➢ Change user access from 'Read only' to 'Standard' ➢ Receive notification e-mails for linked accounts ➢ Receive e-mailed reports, if added to e-mail list ➢ If the manager account is an administrative owner, a user with administrative access can also: ➢ Invite users with 'Administrative' access ➢ Change user access from 'Administrative' to 'Standard' or 'Read only' ➢ Change user access from 'Read only' or 'Standard' to 'Administrative' ➢ Grant another manager account administrative ownership ➢ Remove administrative ownership ➢ Accept and decline link requests from other manager accounts ➢ Unlink another manager account ➢ Turn remarketing list sharing ON and OFF

Access level for manager account user	Tasks that a manager account user can perform in the manager account	Tasks that a manager account user can perform in linked managed accounts
Standard access	Browse the manager account	➢ View, edit and manage any part of linked accounts and campaigns ➢ Sign in and run reports for linked accounts ➢ Receive notification e-mails for linked accounts ➢ Receive e-mailed reports, if added to e-mail list
Managed standard access This access level is assigned when a manager account user lowers another user's access level from 'Administrative' to 'Standard', and that user was originally invited to the account by someone else.	Browse the manager account Link existing accounts and create new linked accounts Unlink from accounts managed by this manager account	➢ View, edit, and manage any part of linked accounts and campaigns ➢ Receive notification e-mails for linked accounts ➢ Receive e-mailed reports, if added to e-mail list
Read-only access	Browse the manager account	➢ View, sign in and run reports for linked accounts ➢ Receive notification e-mails for linked accounts ➢ Receive e-mailed reports, if added to e-mail list
Managed read-only access This access level is assigned when a manager account user lowers another user's access level from 'Administrative' or 'Standard' to 'Read only', and	Browse the manager account Link existing accounts and create new linked accounts Unlink from accounts managed by this manager account	➢ Sign in and run reports for linked accounts ➢ Browse linked accounts ➢ Receive notification e-mails for linked accounts ➢ Receive e-mailed reports, if added to e-mail list

Access level for manager account user	Tasks that a manager account user can perform in the manager account	Tasks that a manager account user can perform in linked managed accounts
that user was originally invited to the account by someone else.		
Email only access	Receive notification e-mails for manager account	➢ Receive notification e-mails for linked accounts ➢ Receive e-mailed reports, if added to e-mail list

Table 8.2: Different Access Levels for Manager Account Users

To view all users with access to a manager account or any of its associated accounts, download a user access report using the following steps:

1. Click the gear icon in the manager account and select **Account settings**.
2. Click **Account access**.
3. Go to the **Users with account access** section and click the download icon.
4. Choose the format to download from the drop-down menu and click **Download**.

Access Levels for Individual AdWords Accounts

In addition to the common AdWords account access levels, AdWords accounts' users can also be given 'Managed – Standard' and 'Managed - Read only' access levels. In addition to 'Standard' and 'Read only' functions, users assigned with these access levels can unlink from their manager accounts as well.

Note: There are chances of multiple managers making conflicting modifications to the same account. To prevent this, communicate amongst all users about the roles and responsibilities for account management and modifications to the account.

Administrative owners

Managers with this permission level on a managed account can manage access levels of users on that account. Users of manager accounts having administrative ownership can perform the following:

- Grant and delete access for all users on the managed account.
- Modify levels of access for all users on the managed account.
- Accept and reject link requests to the managed accounts received from other managers.
- Assign and cancel administrative ownership for other managers.
- Delete users from a managed account.
- Assign and cancel remarketing list sharing for a managed account.

If a manager opens a new account, he/she automatically becomes an administrative owner of that account. Thereafter, if a user assigned with administrative privilege is added to that account, the manager still continues to be the administrative owner.

Complete the following steps to make a manager an administrative owner:

1. Click the Gear Icon in the managed account and select **Account settings**.
2. Click **Account access**.
3. In the **Client managers** section, click **On** or **Off** adjacent to the required manager in the **Administrative owner** column.

8.2.6 Managing the Account Structure

One can give access to a user to only some of the accounts associated to the manager account by utilizing the manager account's privilege to link to another manager account. Let us understand this with an example.

Gracy manages six accounts of which four accounts are for direct sales and two accounts are for channel sales. She wants her partner, Tom, to manage the channel sales accounts. To perform this:

1. Tom creates his own manager account.
2. Gracy links Tom's account to her own manager account. Tom now has a sub-manager account that is managed by Amy's account.
3. Gracy changes the manager for the two channel sales accounts to Tom's manager account.

Now Tom has access to the two accounts that he manages, while Gracy can still see each of the accounts from her own manager account.

If Gracy wants to unlink one of the channel sales account from Tom, she can achieve this without Tom losing any account's campaign history or access to any AdWords features.

Complete the following steps to unlink an individual AdWords account from a manager account:

1. Sign in to the managed AdWords account using the link https://adwords.google.com.
2. Click the gear icon in the top corner.
3. Click **Account settings**.
4. Click **Account access** from the side navigation bar.
5. In the **Client Managers** section, go to the manager account row and to unlink, click the **Actions** drop-down menu and choose **Terminate access**.
6. Click **OK**.

8.3 Account Security and Safety

Google employs industry-standard Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) technology to shield all interactions with AdWords. This protects the login, payment, and other personal details. Google stores all the details behind a firewall and then encrypts the details for further security. Let us get familiar with the security tips before understanding the SSL technology.

Account Security Tips

Google manages all the information with utmost safety and security and it is done on priority. While Google always watches out for any suspicious activity, following are some of the tips for users to keep their AdWords account secure:

- **Check for unauthorized changes**: It is always recommended to sign in to AdWords account frequently to check for any unexpected or unauthorized activity such as modifications to the ads or budget. If any such unauthorized access is found, check the bank or credit card statements also for any unauthorized activity.

- **Scan computers for malware:** Ensure the system's antivirus protection is up-to-date and perform a full system scan. Hackers can pilfer personal details using malware, thus, performing a full system scan frequently helps to identify malware, if any.
- **Use strong, unique passwords, and update them regularly:** It is recommended to change passwords frequently, at least twice a year. A good password includes a combination of numbers, characters, and case-sensitive letters, preventing it from being guessed easily. Do not use the same password across many Web sites as hackers can gain access to other online accounts as well.
- **Enable 2-step verification:** Using the 2-step verification provides extra security to the Google Account as it requires access to the phone along with the username and password to sign in. This implies that even if hackers steal or guess the password, they will not be able to sign in to the account unless they also have access to the phone.

Following are the security tips for accounts with multiple users:

- **Create separate user profiles for every user using your account**: If many users access your AdWords account, avoid sharing the same username and password. As an alternate, create new user profiles for your AdWords account by choosing the **Account settings** option from the gear icon menu, and clicking **Account access**.
- **Grant minimum access for each user**: Assign different access levels for every profile while creating new user profiles. For example, administrative access allows you to invite new users whereas standard access does not.
- **Disable any inactive users, like former employees**: Disable users who have quit your company or are not a part of AdWords as they can still access the account and make modifications without your knowledge. It is always a good practise to keep your user list updated in order to identify who is making modifications in your account.

8.3.1 Protection from Malware

Online criminals and hackers create trouble by spreading malware. Let us understand how to prevent malware attacks by understanding what malware is and how it spreads.

Malware is any kind of software that is created to harm a computer. It is capable of stealing confidential details from a computer, slowing down the system performance, or sending fake e-mails from an e-mail account. Following are the common types of malware:

- **Virus**: It is a harmful computer program capable of copying itself and infecting a computer.
- **Worm**: It is a malicious computer program capable of sending many copies of itself to other computers through a network.
- **Spyware**: It is a malware that gathers data from people without their knowledge.
- **Adware**: It is a software capable of automatically displaying, downloading, or running advertisements on a computer.
- **Trojan horse**: It is a destructive program capable of imitating to be a useful application, but creates problems on the computer or steals data after it is installed.

Systems can be affected by malware in a number of different ways. Following are some common examples of how malware spreads:

- By downloading free software using the Internet that secretly contains malware.
- By visiting a Web site affected with malware.
- By clicking a fake error message or pop-up window that begins a malware download.
- By opening an e-mail attachment that includes malware.

Though malware spreads unknowingly, there are many ways to prevent it. Let us understand the practical steps that one can take to prevent malware.

- **Updating your computer and software**: Windows and Mac operating systems often release updates and it is a good practise to install them. These updates generally include fixes that increase the security of the computer. Windows users can install updates using the 'Windows Update' feature, while Mac users can install using the 'Software Update' feature. In addition to the operating system, computer's software should also be up to date as newer versions include many security fixes to stop malware attacks.
- **Using a non-administrator account**: Many operating systems offer multiple user accounts creation so that every user can have their preferable settings. One can set different security settings for these user accounts. For example, an 'admin' account has the privilege to install new software, whereas 'limited' or 'standard' accounts do not. For Web browsing, a 'limited' or 'standard' user account is sufficient as you probably do not need to install new software. Doing this can help in preventing malware installations on your computer and making system-wide modifications.
- **Thinking before opening links or downloading anything**: One should be cautious before viewing unfamiliar Web sites that claim to provide things for free such as free video editing programme or role-playing game. It is recommended to search for reviews or details about that Web site or program before downloading or installing anything. As downloads are the main ways through which malware is spread, think twice about what you are downloading and where you are downloading it from.
- **Being careful about opening e-mail attachments or images**: Be cautious when a random person sends a suspicious e-mail consisting of attachments or images. Though such e-mails might just be spam, sometimes they secretly contain harmful malware.
- **Do not trust pop-up windows prompting to download software**: While browsing, a window may pop-up showing that the computer has been infected and insists on downloading some software in order to protect the computer. It is recommended to not click inside the window but to close it.
- **Limiting file sharing**: Some sites and applications offer easy file sharing options but they provide no protection against malware. Be cautious while exchanging or downloading files using such options because malware can be masked as a famous movie, album, game or programme.
- **Using antivirus software**: Before downloading, use an antivirus to scan the download for malware even before opening it. Antivirus software also scans the complete system for malware and it is recommended to run regular scans of your system to detect malware and prevent it from spreading.

8.3.2 SSL (https:)

When doing business online, advertisers may require customers' personal and financial details. To protect the customers' details, a technology called SSL is used to encrypt the data transferred between a Web browser and a Web server. Web addresses protected with SSL technology start with https: instead of http: and therefore it is referred to as 'HTTPS'.

Using SSL offers enhanced privacy and security than an unencrypted Web connection. It decreases the chances of customer details being captured and exploited by a third party. Many customers prefer sharing financial and other personal details when they know that they are using an SSL connection.

Most Web browsers display a lock icon to show that an SSL connection is established. Another simpler way to identify SSL is to insert the URL into the browser prefixed with https://, for example, https://adwords.google.com. If a lock icon is displayed in the browser, then the page is secured with SSL, if not, then the page is not secured. Click the lock icon for additional details to validate that the

connections are secure. Many Web sites only use SSL on pages where sensitive or confidential details, such as a password or credit card number, is transferred.

Setting up SSL

If advertisers are not using SSL but need to implement it on one or more pages, complete the following steps:

1. **Obtain an SSL certificate for the Web site**: An SSL certificate is an electronic document that validates the business identity and permits a Web server to launch a secure encryption with a visitor's Web browser. Web site hosting offers numerous SSL certificate providers and options. Check with your existing Web host for the SSL certificate they offer and whether they can help with certificate installation. The most affordable possibility provided by Web hosts is known as a 'shared certificate'. A shared certificate satisfies the AdWords SSL policy requirements.
2. **Install the SSL certificate on the Web server**: The installation process varies based on the Web server and certificate purchased. Generally, the installation instructions, resources and support are provided by the certificate provider or the Web host.
3. **Identify pages on the Web site to secure with SSL**: The most secure pages use SSL. However, AdWords policy outlines the use of secure connections only on pages that gather or transfer personal and financial details.
4. **Edit links to the pages (and page elements) to load securely**: To load pages securely, prefix the links of those pages with https:// instead of http://. For example, to change http://checkout.google.com/login.htm to secure, change all links to that page on the Web site to https://checkout.google.com/login.htm. One can also set up server redirects to automatically route users trying to view an insecure URL, such as http://checkout.google.com/login.htm, to a secure connection, such as https://checkout.google.com/login.htm.
5. **Test to verify that the pages are secure**: View all the new secure pages with a minimum of two browsers that the users might generally use. If a lock icon appears in the browser, click the icon for more details to confirm that the connections are secure. A familiar error is using mixed content on an https: page. It means one or more elements such as images, CSS files, or flash files are running on an https: page using a non-secure http:// URL. Many recent browsers list insecure resources on mixed content pages in their JavaScript console (in some browsers, it is known as 'JavaScript debugger'). To resolve this issue, view the HTML code for that page and perform the following:
    - Find http://
    - Replace all the occurrences with //
    - Save the changes to the Web server and test again

If the issue persists, it is likely a result of issues within the JavaScript or flash code.

The fee for SSL services varies but as of 1st March 2012, many SSL certificate providers are providing annual certificates for lesser than $100 USD. Many Web and e-commerce hosts offer key SSL services in their Web hosting packages at no extra cost.

8.4 Issues with Payments and Charges

With multiple campaigns running and frequent changes in bids, it is very difficult for advertisers to track details pertaining to payments and charges. As a result, at the end of the month they face issues such as ads are not showing up or invoices with staggering amount to pay. This section details out the common financial issues, how to track and analyze them and fix the issues.

To resolve a declined payment, it is important to know why it was declined. This generally requires contacting the bank or credit card company. After the issue is resolved, one can pay off the dues using

many available ways, thus, allowing the ads to run again. A declined payment may occur infrequently causing your ads to stop running until the payment is made.

8.4.1 Resolving Unapplied Payments, Adjustments, and Lost Payments

In some cases payments or adjustments cannot be made as there is no sufficient details regarding the account or invoice that should receive the payment or adjustment. Also, occasionally payments are lost while being transmitted to Google.

Whenever there is an unapplied payment or adjustment in the account, an alert can be seen beside the due amount on the billing pages. To go there, click the gear icon  and choose **Billing**. In case of lost payment, contact the collections team mentioned in the monthly invoice or shown in table 8.3.

Country	e-mail address
Argentina	collections-ar@google.com
Australia	collections-au@google.com
Belize	collections-lm@google.com
Bolivia	collections-lm@google.com
Brazil	collections-br@google.com
Canada	collections-ca@google.com
Chile	collections-lm@google.com
China	collections-cn@google.com
Colombia	collections-lm@google.com
Costa Rica	collections-lm@google.com
Cuba	collections-lm@google.com
Denmark	collections-dk@google.com
Dominica	collections-lm@google.com
Dominican Republic	collections-lm@google.com
Ecuador	collections-lm@google.com
El Salvador	collections-lm@google.com
Finland	collections-fi@google.com
France	collections-fr@google.com
Germany	collections-de@google.com
Grenada	collections-lm@google.com
Guadeloupe	collections-lm@google.com
Guam	collections-lm@google.com
Guatemala	collections-lm@google.com
Honduras	collections-lm@google.com
India	collections-in@google.com
Ireland	collections-ie@google.com

Country	e-mail address
Italy	collections-it@google.com
Japan	collections-jp@google.com
Mexico	collections-mx@google.com
Netherlands	collections-nl@google.com
Netherlands Antilles	collections-nl@google.com
New Zealand	collections-au@google.com
Norway	collections-no@google.com
Panama	collections-lm@google.com
Paraguay	collections-lm@google.com
Peru	collections-lm@google.com
Poland	collections-pl@google.com
Portugal	collections-pt@google.com
Russian Federation	collections-ru@google.com
South Korea	collections-kr@google.com
Spain	collections-es@google.com
Sweden	collections-se@google.com
Switzerland	collections-de@google.com
Taiwan	collections-tw@google.com
United Kingdom	collections-uk@google.com
United States	collections-us@google.com
United States Minor Outlying Islands	collections-us@google.com
Uruguay	collections-lm@google.com
Venezuela	collections-lm@google.com
Virgin Islands (US)	collections-us@google.com
All other countries	collections-row@google.com

Table 8.3: Local Collections Team

If one cannot find the relevant team, an e-mail can be sent to **collections-row@google.com**.

Unapplied Adjustments

In case of unapplied adjustments like credits that are not applied to an invoice yet, the following are the two options that advertisers can follow for applying these credits:

- Underpay the next month invoice by the unapplied adjustment amount. For example, consider you have $60 unapplied adjustments and an open invoice for $300. You can pay for $240 ($300 - $60), and the close out the invoice will be closed.
- E-mail the AdWords collections team and inform them how the unapplied adjustments must be considered. For example, you can ask for your payment to be split into two and applied to two

open invoices. Ensure to mention the invoice numbers and amounts that needs to be applied to each.

Lost Payment

In case the payment is lost, e-mail the local collections team along with an attachment including the proof of payment to confirm that the payment was made. The proof of payment can be one of the following:

- A scanned copy or screenshot of the bank transfer receipt
- Bank or credit card statement
- Online bank or credit card account

The proof of payment must include the following details:

- The date of payment and if possible, details of all transactions for five days prior to and subsequent to the payment
- The amount paid and currency used for the payment
- The beneficiary of the funds, for example Google AdWords
- The bank name that sent the transfer

Also, for security reasons, black out any confidential details on the bank or credit card statement, for example, the bank account number or the middle eight digits of the credit card number.

8.4.2 Understanding the Charging Process

AdWords will not charge advertisers more than their advertising costs. However, the charge will not cross your billing threshold. The charge includes the advertising costs and any charges that are unpaid from the previous billing cycles:

Charged amount = Current costs (Amount from this billing period) + Outstanding balance (Unpaid amount from previous billing cycles)

In case the total charged amount exceeds the billing threshold (the amount that triggers a charge), the additional charge will be added to the unpaid balance for the next cycle. Let us understand this with an example:

Consider that you are charged automatically on March 20th for your AdWords costs. Let us say your account balance after being charged is $10. Your ads will continue to run and accrue costs. Following are some factors that must be considered:

- On April 19th, 30 days after your last automatic charge, you are charged partway through the day.
- In the 30-day period, you accrued costs of $200, which will be shown in the 'Transaction history' page under the Debits column. You received service adjustments of $0.50, which will be shown in the Credits column. So the amount due for this period is $199.50 ($200 - $0.50).
- You have the outstanding balance of $10 from the previous pay period. Add that to the $199.50, and the total cost accrued at the end of day on April 19th is $204.50. This will be the amount shown in the Balance column.
- However, as you were charged only partway through the day, and your ads ran the entire day, you were only charged $185. This is the balance amount before Google requested for payment.
- Your account balance after being charged is $19.50 ($204.50 - $185). This amount is the Starting balance on March 20th, and will be forwarded to your next charge.

8.5 Refunds and Adjustments

Periodically, Google tweaks the AdWords balance which is called an adjustment. Most of the time, this adjustment comes in the form of credits. Credits decrease the account balance, whereas debits increase the account balance.

To find if any adjustments are applied to the account, click the gear icon and select **Billing**, and view the **Credits** column of **Transaction history**. Following are the types of credit adjustments that one can see:

- **Service adjustment**: One can view this type when a promotional code or courtesy credit is used in your account. This credit is applicable for future advertising only and is not refunded.
- **Invalid activity**: One can view this type for invalid clicks and impressions, which are done by robots, automated clicking tools, and other deceptive software. This kind is prohibited and therefore, you do not have to pay for such invalid clicks and impressions. This credit is also applicable for future advertising only and is not refunded.
- **Overdelivery credit**: Sometimes the ads are shown exceeding their daily budget limit. In such cases, advertisers account will be credited to cover the excess costs.
- **Account budget overrun**: One can view this type if the advertising costs crosses the prepaid balance. In such cases, advertisers account will be credited to cover the excess costs. This happens for accounts using manual payments.

8.5.1 Requesting Refunds

A refund is requested by withdrawing the AdWords account while there is still credit in the account. Google automatically makes a refund to the bank account or the credit card linked with the AdWords account. It may take 2 weeks for Google to process this, and additional 10 business days for the credit card company to process the same. If the refund is not made within 4 weeks, contact Google.

Following are the reasons why a refund might not be available:

- Advertisers have cash remaining in their account from a promotional code.
- The account is still active.
- Advertisers have an unpaid outstanding balance.

8.6 Summary

- Google AdWords is the best tool to boost online business globally. Using this tool, advertisers, enterprises, organizations, agencies, SEMs (search engine marketers), third parties, and others can easily manage tens or hundreds of accounts effectively.
- AdWords offer some tools that include AdWords Manager Accounts. AdWords Editor, and AdWords Application Programming Interface (API). These tools are widely used to manage accounts easily either online or offline.
- A manager account can be considered as a main account with multiple individual AdWords accounts associated to it.
- To share your AdWords account with others, invite them to share access through their own Google Account.
- If you have acknowledged an invite to link to a manager account, people who possess administrative access to the manager account will get notification e-mails, and can supervise any part of the account and its campaigns.
- Sharing access to your AdWords account with other users in your business allows you to work with them on the same AdWords account.
- A single AdWords account can be associated with not more than five manager accounts, and the managed account structure cannot be more than six levels deep.
- The four levels of access given to users of manager accounts are administrative, standard, read only and e-mail only.
- The access levels decide up to what extent a user can view and perform within a manager account and the accounts associated to.
- Google employs industry-standard Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) technology to shield all interactions with AdWords.
- Malware is any kind of software that is created to harm a computer. It is capable of stealing confidential details from your computer, slowing down the system performance, or sending fake e-mails from your e-mail account.
- Web addresses that are secured with SSL technology start with https: instead of http: and therefore it is referred to as 'HTTPS'.
- Using SSL offers enhanced privacy and security than an unencrypted Web connection.
- AdWords will not charge you more than your advertising costs. However, your charge will not cross your billing threshold.
- Google periodically tweaks your AdWords balance, which is called an adjustment.
- A refund is requested by withdrawing your AdWords account while there is still credit in the account.

8.7 Check Your Progress

1. Which of the following tool is not used to manage Google AdWords accounts?
    a. AdWords Manager Accounts
    b. AdWords Editor
    c. AdSense
    d. AdWords Application Programming Interface
2. Which of the following can a user perform using an AdWords Manager Accounts?
    a. Create multiple logins in order to access multiple AdWords accounts
    b. See detailed-level statistics for all linked AdWords accounts in a single location
    c. Download the client dashboard into a .xls file
    d. Generate reports of multiple client accounts at once
3. Which of the following is not the most commonly used AdWords account credit adjustments?
    a. Service adjustment
    b. Invalid activity
    c. Lost payments
    d. Overdelivery credit
4. Which of the following helps to copy or move campaigns between accounts or within an account?
    a. Ad extensions
    b. Automated bid managers
    c. AdWords Editor
    d. AdWords API
5. Which of the following helps to generate automatic keyword, ad text, URL, and custom reports?
    a. Ad extensions
    b. Automated bid managers
    c. AdWords Editor
    d. AdWords API

8.7.1 Answer

1	**c**
2	**d**
3	**c**
4	**c**
5	**d**